



Faculty Handbook

2025/2026

معاً نصنع الفرق

MAKING A DIFFERENCE TOGETHER

Preface

Welcome to the University of Sharjah Faculty Handbook, a comprehensive guide that outlines policies, procedures, and essential information relevant to faculty members at our esteemed institution. Whether you are a new hire embarking on your academic journey with us or a seasoned faculty member, this handbook is designed to be your trusted companion throughout your career at UoS.

While we have endeavored to make this handbook as comprehensive as possible, it is important to note that it may not cover every aspect of faculty life. Therefore, we encourage faculty members to also consult their respective department and college handbooks, academic policies and procedures, the staff handbook, and other University documents to ensure they have access to all relevant information.

At the University of Sharjah, our commitment to excellence in teaching, research, and service serves as the foundation of our academic community. This handbook has been carefully crafted to provide guidelines and support to our faculty members, empowering them to uphold the highest professional standards as educators and scholars.

Our institution values the principles of academic freedom, diversity, shared governance, and social responsibility. As you navigate your academic journey with us, we trust that this handbook will play a pivotal role in fostering these ideals and advancing the overall mission of the University.

We emphasize that it is the responsibility of all faculty members to familiarize themselves with the contents of this handbook and to adhere to the policies and procedures outlined within. The University may periodically update this handbook, and we will ensure that significant changes are communicated to faculty members when applicable. Therefore, we urge faculty to regularly refer to the most current version to stay informed.

Once again, we extend our warmest welcome to the University of Sharjah and hope that this faculty handbook will be a valuable resource to you throughout your time with us. Your dedication and commitment to academic excellence are integral to the success of our institution, and we look forward to supporting you in achieving your professional goals.

Thank you for being a part of our academic community, and we wish you a fulfilling and successful academic journey at the University of Sharjah.

Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs

University of Sharjah



Important Notice:

This handbook is meant for the internal use of University of Sharjah faculty and academic staff and is intended to provide general information only and should not be seen as creating any contractual obligations. The University of Sharjah retains the right to modify or discontinue any policies or conditions described herein without prior notice.

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Chapter 1: The University

Established in 1997 by Emiri Decree No. (1) of 1997, the University of Sharjah (UoS) is an esteemed institution that embodies the qualities of renowned universities around the world. With a steadfast commitment to progress, our university offers comprehensive and multi-disciplinary education and research programs. We take pride in our ability to attract faculty members with diverse international experience, renowned stature, and numerous nationalities. Furthermore, UoS has established long-term cooperation agreements and strategic alliances with 40 leading academic institutions worldwide. These partnerships ensure that the education offered, and research conducted adheres to the highest international standards.

Located in the heart of the University City in the Emirate of Sharjah, our main campus is situated just a few kilometers away from the shores of the strategic Arabian Gulf. Our campus architecture beautifully expresses our Islamic and Arabic heritage through splendid buildings and captivating landscapes. It provides spacious and outstanding facilities that include multimedia study halls, advanced scientific and research laboratories, dedicated libraries rich with information resources, state-of-the-art IT infrastructure and computing labs, theatres, clubs, two major sports complexes, student centers with access to restaurants as well as numerous other amenities. Additionally, separate residential areas are available for both male and female students and faculty members, fostering a comfortable and inclusive environment.

Based on the wise vision of His Highness Sheikh Professor Sultan bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, the Ruler of Sharjah and member of the Supreme Council, the University of Sharjah has undergone significant transformation. Up until the academic year 2023-2024, the University operated three branch campuses to extend its educational reach to all regions of Sharjah, including Khorfakkan, Kalba, and Al Dhaid. These branches have now been transitioned into fully independent universities, each with its own distinct academic identity. These institutions now operate autonomously, enhancing the educational landscape across the region.

Our commitment to providing purposeful education and our relentless pursuit of excellence have earned us immense respect and eminence among other universities in the region. Our university prides itself on its diverse cultural mix, extensive academic programs, and an elegant campus setting, which are just a few of the remarkable characteristics that define UoS.

The University's Medical Complex encompasses the Colleges of Medicine, Dental Medicine, Pharmacy, Health Sciences, Medical Research Laboratories, the University General Hospital, and a Dental Hospital. Through this comprehensive complex, we ensure excellence in healthcare education, research, and medical services.

With the largest number of accredited programs in the United Arab Emirates, the University of Sharjah covers a wide range of academic and professional disciplines. Our programs encompass

literature, arts, humanities, social sciences, engineering, natural and life sciences, medical sciences and healthcare, law and Islamic studies, public policy, international relations, fine arts and design, communications and journalism, as well as business administration. As of the Fall semester of the academic year 2025/2026, we offer a total of 149 academic degree programs, including 62 Bachelor's degrees, 60 Master's degrees, 23 PhD degrees, and 4 Post Graduate and Professional Diploma degrees. While deeply rooted in Islamic and Arabic traditions, the University of Sharjah promotes an international outlook and fosters respect for individuals and cultures from around the world. UoS stands as a major international center for learning, culture, and education, where East meets West, and North meets South. We approach learning from an international perspective, and our educational programs are connected through agreements with universities in Germany, Spain, Australia, Canada, Japan, the United Kingdom, and the United States.

At the University of Sharjah, we take great pride in our renowned faculty members hailing from various parts of the world. Our university also welcomes a significant number of international students and offers them opportunities to engage in internship programs at various international destinations. Additionally, we enthusiastically welcome visiting international students, as this unique mix of cultures and nationalities enables our students to expand their horizons and learn from the individual uniqueness of our diverse student body, faculty and staff.

As we embark on a journey of learning, discovery, and growth, we extend a warm welcome to all faculty members of the University of Sharjah. Together, we aim to achieve excellence in teaching, research, and service, while embracing the rich academic environment that surrounds us.

1.1 Vision, Mission, and Core Values

1.1.1 Vision

Excellence in teaching together and research that matters to our community.

1.1.2 Mission

We are an innovative world-class teaching, learning and research institution providing a distinctive, inspirational, creative, and supportive environment.

1.1.3 Core Values

The University of Sharjah is united by six core values that underpin our daily actions as students, staff, faculty, administrators and alumni. They are as follows:

1. Integrity and Ethics: Ethical standards at the University of Sharjah are founded on ethical and civic responsibility in accordance with progressive Arab and Islamic ideals.
2. Dedication: Dedication to providing students with knowledge and support, so they are fully prepared to be the leaders of the future.
3. Inclusiveness: We welcome and value each other and embrace the diversity of ideas and people.
4. Excellence with limitless Drive: For quality enhancement and continuance improvement.

5. Accountability and Transparency: We pride ourselves on our responsibility and transparency in our actions, providing a fair and positive work environment.

6. Innovation and Entrepreneurship: We work without bounds to improve lives through creativity and innovation in the pursuit of academic excellence.

1.2 2024-2030 University Strategic Priorities

The University established a new strategic plan (EDGE) that spans from 2024-2030. The key four strategic priorities that are targeted by 2030:

Emiratization: 25% of the UoS faculty will be Emiratis, contributing on a world stage in research and education.

Digitization: 85% of all primary services will be fully digitized leading to a paperless, optimized, and efficient organization.

Global Engagement: Be ranked within the top 200 universities globally and be ranked number one in the UAE.

Entrepreneurship: UoS employees, faculty, students, and graduates will have initiated over 60 start-ups, patents, and other commercial research ventures.

The four strategic priorities will be delivered through five strategic pillars, these are:

1.2.1 Pillar 1: Impact-Centered Excellence in Teaching and Learning

The University of Sharjah stands as a distinctive beacon of higher education in the United Arab Emirates and beyond. At the heart of our mission lies a commitment to creating positive social, environmental, entrepreneurial, technological, and economic impact.

Our vision propelled by the belief that a student-centered approach, grounded in authentic positive impact, is the key to achieve excellence in education that delivers tangible outcomes. Recognizing the dynamic nature of job market, we embrace the pivotal role education plays in shaping students' future careers. Therefore, we are dedicated to equipping our students with the necessary knowledge and skills to thrive in their chosen professions.

Our commitment extends beyond merely meeting market demand; we aim to go above and beyond by fostering an entrepreneurial spirit and an innovative mindset. We will work tirelessly to develop a curriculum that not only addresses current market needs but also anticipates future trends. The objectives for the pillar are:

1. Impact Centered Learning
2. Leave no Graduate Behind
3. Student Centered Research University
4. Interdisciplinary Programs
5. Recruit, Retain and Develop Faculty
6. International Branding

1.2.2 Pillar 2: Excellent and Sustainable Research

Our research must continue to deliver a real impact: in sectors that matter, and in challenges that count. Whether it is helping to innovate a new technology, contributing to solving a global challenge or inspiring a new way of thinking, we must continue to lead change and pioneer progress that matters. As we aspire to become the top institution for research collaboration with the industry in the UAE, we aim to focus on impactful research to make a difference and add value

to the Emirate of Sharjah community and UAE society and UAE economy. Sustainable Research that matters to our community, government industry and academia is a key strategic pillar for the University of Sharjah.

We are committed to significantly enhancing the capacity building of Emirati researchers, positioning them as leaders on local, regional, and international fronts within key sectors outlined in the UAE's future strategy, including Energy & Environment, Space Science & Technology, ICT, AI & Robotics, Sustainable Technologies, Biotechnology & Medical Health.

Recognizing the essential role of social sciences and humanities research, we will employ these disciplines to drive the development and application of these strategic areas. Furthermore, we acknowledge that the highest caliber research contributes to substantial global impact. The objectives for the pillar are:

1. Achieving Tangible Research Impact
2. Surpass in Quality Research
3. Establish Entrepreneurship, Start-ups and a Commercialization Ecosystem
4. Partnership with Industry
5. Eco-system (Incubation and Acceleration)

1.2.3 Pillar 3: Our People and Our Performance

Our university is a place where personal dreams and ambitions can be realized, as demonstrated by the incredible achievements of our alumni. Our own journey to success has created the perfect environment, and our values of inclusiveness and collaboration will nurture and inspire our student's growth.

We will continue to focus on Emiratization to attract the talent we need. By 2030 we will ensure that 25% of our scientists, scholars, researchers, and academic leaders. Here, we must all come together to make a difference; to one another and to the world.

Our people and our performance are critical to enabling teaching together and research that matters. We will be known as an institute that champions operational excellence through great people, inspiring spaces, and systems renewal. We will attract and retain a diverse community of outstanding students, faculty, and staff.

We will create welcoming physical and virtual spaces for our students, faculty, staff, and community. We will transform university-level systems and processes through innovation and digitization in all areas from research, teaching, and administration. We will work towards attaining international quality certification in designated areas to ensure services provided to our students, researchers and faculty are of the highest quality.

We will continue to work towards ensuring financial sustainability and financial growth pathways by 2030. We will work towards diversifying our revenue sources and developing financial models to align our resources and to optimize our expenditures to support our university mission. The objectives for the pillar are:

1. Streamline and Optimize Administration
2. Digitization
3. Professional Development
4. Financial Sustainability and Growth
5. Campus masterplan

1.2.4 Pillar 4: Community Collaboration and Impact

Key to the success of our 2030 strategy will be collaboration and the impact of collaboration in enabling sustainable excellence in teaching together and sustainable research that matters to our community, government, industry, and academia. We will continue to develop more strategic local and international world-class collaborations leading to important partnership to support joint graduate programs, dual degrees and joint research projects, labs, and centers.

The University of Sharjah has over 40,000 alumni in our databases, many of them are well established and have key leadership roles in the country and abroad. The Alumni Office will focus on the development of a graduate hub to ensure that no graduate is left behind, through providing re-skilling opportunities and opportunities to update knowledge through the continuous professional development services, career services and support from individual colleges.

- Continuous update of the UOS alumni database with periodic communication with every UOS alumnus.
- Enhance the UOS alumni package, which highlights the services and discounts offered to UOS alumni.
- Reach out to key UOS alumni and involve them in standing committees and advisory boards.
- Invite UOS alumni to regular events taking place in the University.
- Involve UOS alumni in university branding and community outreach programs.

This pillar contributes to ensuring UOS becomes a top 200 globally ranked institution by 2030 and maintains its status of being ranked number one within the United Arab Emirates (UAE). The objectives for the pillar are:

1. International Collaboration
2. Funding, Sponsorship and Philanthropy
3. Our Alumni Community
4. World-class Conferences
5. University Study Abroad System

1.2.5 Campus Experience Fit for the Future

Our award-winning campus is further proof of having reimagined how different a campus can be in terms of hybrid learning, extensive facilities, and an engaging student experience we are now delivering that: taking an existing strength and making it even stronger. By 2030 we will have attained a complete digital transformation and embrace advanced technology in a 100% paperless environment.

The Campus Experience is fit for the future to enable sustainable excellence in teaching together and research that matters. Happiness, quality of life and healthy life experiences is an important strategic pillar for the University of Sharjah. We will work towards developing an innovative world-class physical and virtual campus experience through ongoing improvements to our dormitories, faculty housing, sports centers, classrooms, and libraries to ensure our students and faculty have the best possible experience on campus and digitally.

Dormitories development will continue to ensure high quality facilities for our students, supported by top of the line fixtures and services which will ensure that our students will want to always remain on campus. Student counselling, academic advising, student support and career services

will continue to be developed to ensure that no graduate is left behind. The objectives for the pillar are:

1. Student Personalized Support
2. Enhance Quality of Life and Wellbeing for All
3. Empowerment of Students Skills and Knowledge
4. Optimization of Student Participation at Local and International Activities
5. Sustainability of Environmentally Friendly Catering Facilities and Healthier Options

1.3 Organizational Chart

The organization of the University of Sharjah is composed of the President, Board of Trustees, Chancellor, Vice Chancellors, Associate Vice Chancellors, Deans of Academic Units and Directors of Administrative Units.

The University of Sharjah's current organization chart was approved in January 2023 and best reflects the administrative and academic structure of the Institute. The current organization chart is depicted in Figure 1.

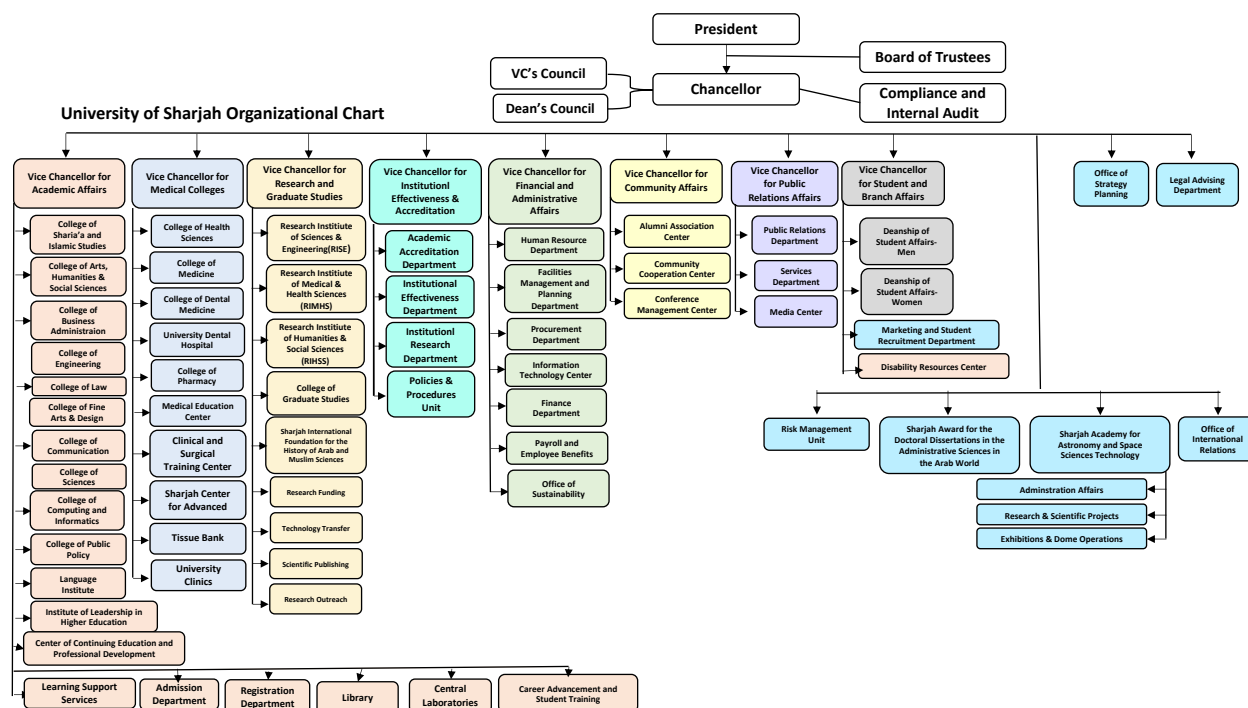


Figure 1: Organizational Chart of the University of Sharjah

1.4 University Governance

University governance encompasses the structure and processes of authoritative decision-making across issues significant to both external and internal stakeholders. The governance structures of the University of Sharjah are designed to ensure integrity, accountability, and effectiveness in all operations. Leadership responsibilities are comprehensively detailed in individual job descriptions, while the University's organizational structures and processes are clearly outlined in its policy and governance documents, aligned with its mission.

The University's policies and procedures, available on the official website, provide clear rules that govern decision-making processes. The organizational chart, also published online, offers a schematic view of the University's governance framework. Accountabilities for specific decision-making delegations are precisely defined in the signatory authority as extracted from the university bylaws and policies. These accountabilities are further detailed in the strategic planning process, where individuals with specific responsibilities must report on their progress towards achieving set goals, objectives, and activities.

Human resources policies mandate that supervisors annually assess the performance of their direct reports, based on their contributions to the goals and strategic plans of their departments and the University. All employees set personal goals for the upcoming year, aligned with the University's objectives and initiatives, and meet with their supervisors at the beginning and end of the year to review progress.

This governance framework ensures that the University operates with transparency, accountability, and a clear focus on its mission and strategic objectives.

1.5 The President

The President of the University holds the highest authority within the institution and assumes a significant mandate, accompanied by a range of essential responsibilities. In his capacity as President, he chairs both the Board of Trustees and the Executive Committee, providing crucial leadership and guidance in their deliberations and decision-making processes. This central role ensures effective governance and strategic direction for the institution.

One of the President's key responsibilities is the nomination of the Chancellor, who plays a pivotal role in leading the University. The President carefully selects and nominates a qualified and capable individual to assume this important position. The nomination is then presented to the Board of Trustees for approval, ensuring a rigorous and thorough selection process.

Furthermore, the President has the authority to approve the appointments of vice chancellors and deans within the University. This responsibility involves a thoughtful consideration of candidates' qualifications and suitability for their respective leadership positions within the institution.

The President's involvement extends to the formulation and enactment of bylaws that regulate various aspects of the University's operations. These bylaws serve as a comprehensive framework, governing academic, administrative, and financial activities. They foster an environment of transparency and accountability, ensuring the smooth operation and effective management of the institution.

Additionally, the President holds the power to make organizational decisions that impact the University's functioning and development. These decisions span a wide range of matters, contributing to the overall effectiveness and strategic direction of the institution.

The President's role is not limited to the responsibilities mentioned above. They are also empowered to undertake any other functions and responsibilities authorized by the Board of Trustees. This flexibility allows the President to address emerging needs, tackle challenges, and ensure that the University remains adaptable and responsive in today's dynamic landscape of higher education.

Through visionary leadership and guidance, the President plays a pivotal role in shaping the University's vision, fostering academic excellence, and promoting the overall advancement of the institution.

1.6 The Board of Trustees

The University's highest authority, overseeing its management, is vested in a Board of Trustees composed of a number of distinguished members, formed by the decision of the President. The term of membership on the Board is three years, commencing from the first meeting, with the possibility of renewal for a similar period. The Board continues its work until the end of its term and the formation of a new Board, allowing for the reappointment of members whose terms have expired.

In forming the Board, consideration is given to the following membership criteria: the Chancellor, several public figures from the community, and several eminent scholars. The President holds the authority to terminate the membership of Board members through a decision.

The Board plays a vital role in the governance and decision-making processes of the University, ensuring its continued growth, excellence, and adherence to the highest standards of education, research, and service.

The following are the current members of the Board of Trustees:

	Name	Position on the Board	Titles and Poistions
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1	H.H. Sheikh Sultan Bin Ahmed Al-Qassimi	Chairman	Deputy Ruler of Sharjah and President of the University of Sharjah
2	Dr. Obaid Al Muhairi	Member	Former Executive Dean of Arabic Language and UAE Studies, Higher Colleges of Technology, BoT Chairman of Academic Committee
3	Prof. Hamid M. K. Al Naimiy	Member	Director of SASST and President of the Arab Union for Astronomy and Space Sciences (AUASS)
4	Mr. Mohammed Abdallah	Member	CEO, Sharjah Islamic Bank
5	Mr. Saeed Sultan Al Suwidi	Member	Chairman of the Sharjah Electricity and Water Authority
6	Dr. Muhadditha Al Hashimi	Member	Chairperson of Sharjah Private School Authority
7	Dr. Khawla Al Mulla	Member	Secretary General of the Supreme Council for Family Affairs in Sharjah
8	Dr. Mansour Bin Nassar	Member	The Legal Advisor and the Chairman of Sharjah Government Legal Department, Professor of Administrative and Constitutional Law at Sharjah Police Science Academy
9	Prof. Jacques Fermont	Member	President and Vice Chancellor of University of Ottawa, Canada.
10	Prof. Alexander Kuleshov	Member	President of Skolkovo Institute of Science and Technology (Skoltech) Moscow, Russia.
11	Prof. Tan Eng Chye	Member	President of the National University of Singapore, Singapore.
12	Prof. Kamal Youcef-Toumi	Member	Professor of Electronics Engineering and Co-Director of the Center for Clean Water at Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), USA
13	Prof. Paul M O'Byrne	Member	Dean of the College of Health Sciences and Vice President of McMaster University, Toronto, Canada.
14	Prof. Dato Ir. Dr. Mohd. Hamdi Abd Shukor	Member	Vice Chancellor of the University of Malaya, Malaysia
15	Prof. Martin Barstow	Member	Pro-Vice Chancellor, Head of the College of Science and Engineering, and Professor of Astrophysics and Space Science at the

			University of Leicester and President of the Royal Astronomical Society, UK
16	Prof. Oussama Khatib	Member	Professor of Computer and Electrical Engineering and Director of the Stanford Robotic Center, USA
17	Prof. Esameldin Agamy	Member	Chancellor of the University of Sharjah

1.7 The University Administration

1.7.1 Chancellor

The Chancellor of the University assumes significant responsibilities as the head of all administrative and academic staff, being accountable to the President and the Board of Trustees. The Chancellor plays a pivotal role in implementing the policies set forth by the Board, conducting the University's affairs, developing its purpose, and enhancing its status. To ensure the continual development of the University, the Chancellor undertakes all necessary business and activities within the framework of applicable laws, bylaws, and the decisions and directives issued by the President and the Board.

As the representative of the University, the Chancellor heads all public academic occasions and represents the institution before external parties. However, when deemed appropriate, the Chancellor may delegate this responsibility to an appropriate representative. Regular reporting is an essential aspect of the Chancellor's role, involving the submission of comprehensive reports to the President, the Board of Trustees, and the Executive Committee, providing updates on the University's activities and affairs.

The Chancellor has the authority to delegate some responsibilities and jurisdictions to vice chancellors, department directors, and other relevant staff members at the University. This delegation of authority promotes effective management and decision-making throughout the institution.

Additionally, the Chancellor may be entrusted with any other mandates or authorities commissioned by the President. These additional responsibilities contribute to the Chancellor's role as a key leader in advancing the University's mission and vision.

By assuming these responsibilities, the Chancellor plays a crucial role in driving the University's progress, ensuring effective administration, and fostering academic excellence. With their leadership and dedication, the Chancellor contributes to the University's success and overall development.

1.7.2 Vice Chancellors

There are eight Vice Chancellors that support the Chancellor in the daily operation of the University of Sharjah. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Vice Chancellor for

Medical and Health Sciences Colleges are delegated academic responsibilities, while the Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies is managing the research enterprise of the University. The Vice Chancellor for Financial and Administrative Affairs is delegated the non-academic responsibilities. Meanwhile, the Vice Chancellor for Community Affairs is responsible for Alumni and Community Relations and the Vice Chancellor for Public Relations is responsible for all public activities inside and outside the university. The Vice Chancellor Office for Institutional Effectiveness and Accreditation supervises activities related to institutional effectiveness and academic accreditation. The Vice Chancellor for Student Affairs is responsible students' non-academic aspects (e.g. administering the Sports Complex, Student Counseling and Student Dorms).

Academically, the University is composed of fifteen academic colleges reporting to three Vice Chancellors. Ten colleges report to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and include College of Sharia'a and Islamic Studies, College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences, College of Business Administration, College of Engineering, College of Law, College of Communication, College of Fine Arts and Design, College of Sciences, College of Computing and Informatics, and College of Public Policy. In addition, the Center for Continuing Education and Professional Development, the Institute of Higher Education Leadership, the Language Institute, Admission, Registration, Student Records, Libraries, and Laboratories Services, are also reporting to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs.

Four colleges report to the Vice Chancellor for Medical and Health Sciences Colleges and includes College of Medicine, College of Dentistry, College of Pharmacy, College of Health Sciences, Medical Education Unit, Medical Services Department, Clinical Training Center, Dental Hospital and Institute of Medical Research. Meanwhile, the college of Graduate Studies reports to the Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies.

1.7.3 Deans Council

The Deans Council is responsible for overseeing the academic and educational affairs of the institution, as well as faculty, research, and publication matters.

The Deans Council is chaired by the Chancellor, who assumes leadership in this important body. The formation of the Deans Council is initiated through a decision made by the Chancellor, highlighting the significance of this Council in the University's governance structure.

The specific mandate, jurisdictions, and meeting requirements of the Deans Council are outlined in the Academic Bylaws, which are issued by a decision of the President. These bylaws serve as a regulatory framework, ensuring clarity and consistency in the council's responsibilities and operations.

As a crucial component of the University's academic governance, the Deans Council plays a pivotal role in shaping and advancing the institution's educational mission, promoting excellence in research and scholarship, and facilitating collaboration among faculty members and academic units.

1.7.4 College Council

Each College within the University is supported by a designated council known as the College Council. This Council is formed by a decision from the Dean and chaired by the Dean. The College Council consists of key members, including the Vice/Assistant Dean, Department Chairs within the college, a faculty representative from each academic department, and student representative.

At the discretion of the Dean, one or more individuals may be invited to seek their opinions during the discussions of the College Council. This ensures a comprehensive and inclusive decision-making process within the Council.

Regular meetings of the College Council are held at least once every month, upon invitation from the Dean. The presence of an absolute majority of the council members constitutes a quorum for the meeting. Decisions and recommendations are made by an absolute majority, and in the event of a tie, the chairperson's side carries the motion.

At the beginning of each academic year, during the first meeting of the College Council, the Dean appoints one of its members as the Permanent Secretary. The Permanent Secretary is responsible for recording and filing the minutes of the council meetings, which are subsequently signed by both the Dean and the Secretary, ensuring accurate documentation of the council's proceedings. The Minutes of Meeting are shared with College Faculty and Staff, and a copy is sent to the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs.

The College Council holds the mandate and authority to oversee various aspects of the college's academic, teaching, administrative, financial affairs, and student affairs. In accordance with the policies laid down by the Board and within the provisions of the bylaws, the College Council performs the following functions:

- Proposing study plans and establishing the requirements for granting academic degrees within the college.
- Approving curricula proposed by department councils.
- Coordinating graduate studies, including the appointment of supervisors for theses/dissertations and recommending the formation of discussion panels.
- Supervising the organization of studies within the college and facilitating coordination among different departments.
- Ensuring the proper conduct of assessments within the college, overseeing the examination process, and reviewing and approving the results submitted by various departments.
- Recommending to the Deans Council the conferral of academic degrees and certificates.
- Proposing internal bylaws for the college, which are subsequently submitted to the Deans Council for approval. These bylaws come into effect after being approved and issued by the Chancellor.
- Developing the annual draft budget for the college.

- Overseeing and promoting research activities within the college.
- Considering issues referred by the Dean.
- Making recommendations on matters related to faculty members and academic staff within the college.
- Reviewing the annual reports from departments.
- Establishing permanent and ad-hoc committees comprised of College Council members to address matters within the council's jurisdiction.
- Examining and linking evaluation and assessment results from the departments to learning outcomes, preparing a final annual report to be submitted to the Chancellor, along with the department reports from the college.

Through its diverse responsibilities, the College Council plays a vital role in ensuring the effective functioning, development, and academic excellence within the respective college.

1.7.5 Department Council

In line with our commitment to academic excellence, each academic department within the University operates as an independent academic entity, responsible for overseeing the teaching of courses within its specialized field. To ensure effective governance and decision-making, each department establishes a Departmental Council comprising all academic staff members. This Council assumes the vital role of overseeing academic, educational, administrative, and financial matters, as well as student affairs within the college. It operates within the policies set by the Board of Trustees, the Deans Council, and the College Council, while adhering to the provisions of the law, by-laws, and regulations.

The Departmental Council is vested with specific powers and responsibilities to fulfil its duties effectively:

- The Council actively engages in the submission of proposals regarding study plans within the department, contributing to the continuous development and enhancement of the academic curriculum.
- It coordinates curricula within the department, ensuring the appropriate selection of course textbooks and references, as well as facilitating students' access to these resources. Additionally, the council organizes examinations in accordance with the university's by-laws.
- The promotion and coordination of academic research activities, including community service, lie within the purview of the Departmental Council. It plays a vital role in fostering a culture of research excellence within the department.
- The council provides opinions and recommendations on matters relating to academic staff, such as appointments, promotions, and holidays. However, it is important to note that no

staff member may participate in the promotion and/or appointment of a staff member of a higher rank.

- Distribution of courses among instructors within the department is a responsibility of the council, ensuring an equitable and efficient allocation of teaching assignments.
- The Departmental Council takes an active role in organizing academic advising and providing guidance and pastoral care to students. This support system contributes to students' holistic development and academic success.
- Recommendations regarding lists of graduates are proffered to the College Council by the Departmental Council, recognizing the achievements and successful completion of academic programs.
- The council is entrusted with providing opinions and recommendations on matters referred to it, actively participating in relevant discussions and decision-making processes.
- The review and evaluation of the department's learning outcomes plan are essential responsibilities of the Departmental Council. It approves, monitors, and updates the plan, taking appropriate measures to enhance the educational process in alignment with the outcomes achieved.
- Academic accreditation is a crucial aspect of program quality. The Departmental Council reviews, studies, and prepares program files for academic accreditation, ensuring they are complete with all the required documents to meet the accreditation standards.

Through the dedicated efforts of the Departmental Council, each academic department at the University maintains its commitment to excellence, innovation, and continuous improvement in delivering high-quality education and fostering an engaging academic environment.

1.7.6 University Academic Advisory Council

The University Academic Advisory Council (UAAC) is composed of various members who contribute to its diverse perspectives and expertise. The Council consists of faculty members recommended from each college, including the College of Graduate Studies and Research, to serve for a term of one year. Additionally, seven students are elected from different colleges to represent their respective student bodies for a one-year term. The representation includes students from the College of Sharia and Islamic Studies and the College of Law, the College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences, and the College of Communication, the Medical Colleges and College of Health Sciences, the College of Engineering and the College of Sciences, the College of Business Administration, the College of Computing and Informatics, the College of Fine Arts and Design, College of Public Policy and the College of Graduate Studies. The President of the Alumni Association or a designated member, along with other non-voting members such as vice chancellors, deans, and others, also participate in the Council.

The UAAC is driven by specific objectives. These objectives focus on fostering active participation from faculty members, students, and the university administration in matters related

to academic strategic directions, institutional effectiveness, and academic services and activities that support teaching and research.

The UAAC's mandate encompasses reviewing proposals and recommendations brought forth by College Councils regarding academic affairs, as well as services and activities related to academic support. The Council examines reports from the Office of Quality Assurance, Institutional Effectiveness and Accreditation, the two deanships of Student Affairs, and the Deanship of Graduate Studies and Research. It provides recommendations and consultations to the Deans Council on various matters, including offering new academic programs, annual study plans, the establishment or cancellation of academic departments, general policies for faculty promotion (excluding individual promotion cases), bylaws and regulations for appointing faculty members, conferral of honorary and academic degrees, and institutional effectiveness and performance indicators.

The UAAC meetings are chaired by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs, and a secretary is elected each year from among the faculty on the Council who hold the rank of full professor and are members of the Deans Council. The Secretary records the minutes of each meeting and signs them. The Council convenes at least once per semester, with a proposed agenda provided in the meeting announcement. A quorum is achieved with the presence of an absolute majority of council members. Non-voting participants may be invited to attend the meetings, and the outcomes and recommendations from each meeting are submitted to the Deans Council in a written report, including any opposing viewpoints.

1.7.7 University Committees

Standing committees play a crucial governance role at the University of Sharjah, enabling faculty and other members of the institution's community to actively contribute to policy development and decision-making. The responsibilities and scope of authority for each standing committee are outlined in their respective terms of reference, published in the Standing Committee Handbook.

Beyond formal decision-making structures, the university utilizes several external advisory bodies, such as the College and Department Advisory Boards. These bodies provide valuable advice and recommendations to help guide the colleges in achieving their missions.

The University have the following standing committees:

- University Policy
- Faculty Contract Renewal and Hiring
- Study Plans and Curricula
- UOS Men's Student Disciplinary
- UOS Women's Student Disciplinary

- Disciplinary Committee for Addressing Problems Involving Male (Men) and Female (Women) Students Jointly
- Student Affairs
- Student Support Fund
- Central Committee to Supervise the Formation of Student Councils
- Graduation
- Student Success
- Laboratory Safety
- University Central Laboratories
- Institutional Effectiveness and Accreditation
- Central Committee for Faculty Promotion
- Central Committee for the Selection and Renewal of Faculty Members
- Faculty Housing Committee
- Faculty Grievance Committee
- Standing Investigation Committee
- Employee Disciplinary Committee
- Committee for International Relations and Rankings
- Employees' Grievance
- Supervisory Committees for the Ideas and Innovation Fund
- University Learning Environment
- University Project Advisory
- Women in Research
- Committee to Complete the Application Required for UI GreenMetric World University Rankings on Sustainability
- Tender Review
- Graduate Studies Council
- University Research Board
- Scientific and Administrative Board for the Sharjah Academy for Astronomy, Space Sciences and Technology
- Scientific Consultative Council for the Sharjah International Foundation for the History of Arab and Muslim Sciences
- Center for Continuing Education and Professional Development Council
- Sustainability Circles and the Appointment of Leaders for Sustainability Related Tracks
- Editorial Boards for the University of Sharjah Journal
- Council for the Scientific and Consultancy Services
- Technology Governance
- Continuing Education Board
- Radiation Safety

1.8 Shared Governance

At the University of Sharjah, we value and prioritize shared governance, recognizing the importance of faculty engagement in shaping the institution's processes and decisions. This commitment to shared governance is reflected through meaningful involvement at three critical levels.

Firstly, our academic units actively participate in the initial self-studies, which serve as the foundation for institutional planning. The outcomes of these self-studies are collected and considered at the institutional level, providing departments with an opportunity to influence the setting of institutional priorities. This process allows academic departments to showcase their achievements, highlight areas of concern, and contribute to the overall strategic direction of the University.

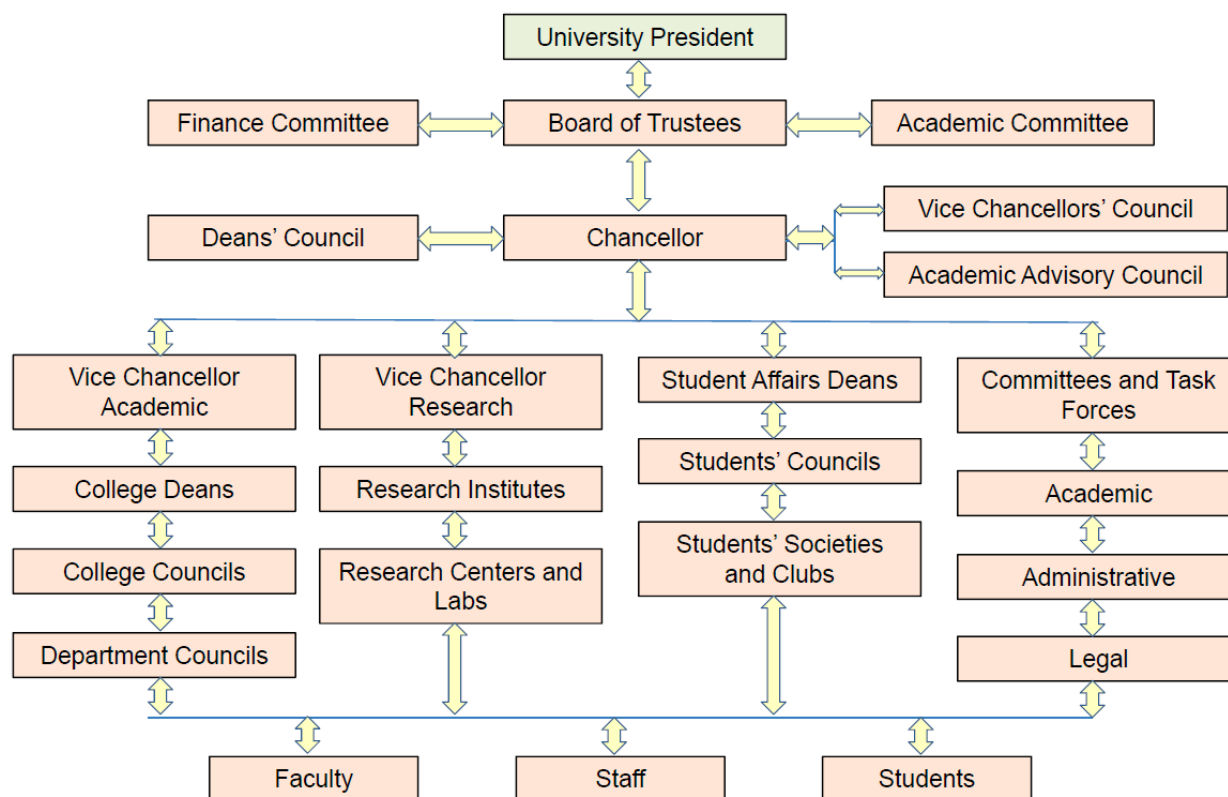
Secondly, we empower academic departments to develop their own plans aligned with institutional priorities. This approach recognizes that each department possesses unique insights and perspectives on how best to address challenges within their respective contexts. By providing flexibility, departments can devise tailored solutions, ensuring relevance and ownership in achieving shared goals.

Furthermore, faculty members actively engage in the development of personal annual faculty plans, which are aligned with their department's objectives. This process increases the connection between individual faculty members and their department's goals, fostering a sense of ownership and shared responsibility. Samples of faculty annual plans and reports can be accessed in the faculty portfolio, serving as valuable resources for faculty development and alignment.

In addition to these institutional structures, faculty members have formed their own "Faculty Affairs Committee." This Committee serves as a dedicated forum for faculty to voice their concerns, provide feedback, and represent their interests at various levels within the University. The Committee facilitates open discussions between faculty and the university administration on relevant matters, ensuring a collaborative approach to decision-making.

Moreover, faculty members are actively represented in numerous committees and administrative structures of the University. This participation ensures that faculty perspectives are considered in crucial decision-making processes, promoting transparency and inclusivity in the governance of the institution.

By embracing shared governance, we foster an environment of collaboration and mutual respect, where faculty members are integral partners in shaping the University's policies, procedures, and future direction. Figure 2 below demonstrates the engagement of different members of the university community in the decision-making process.



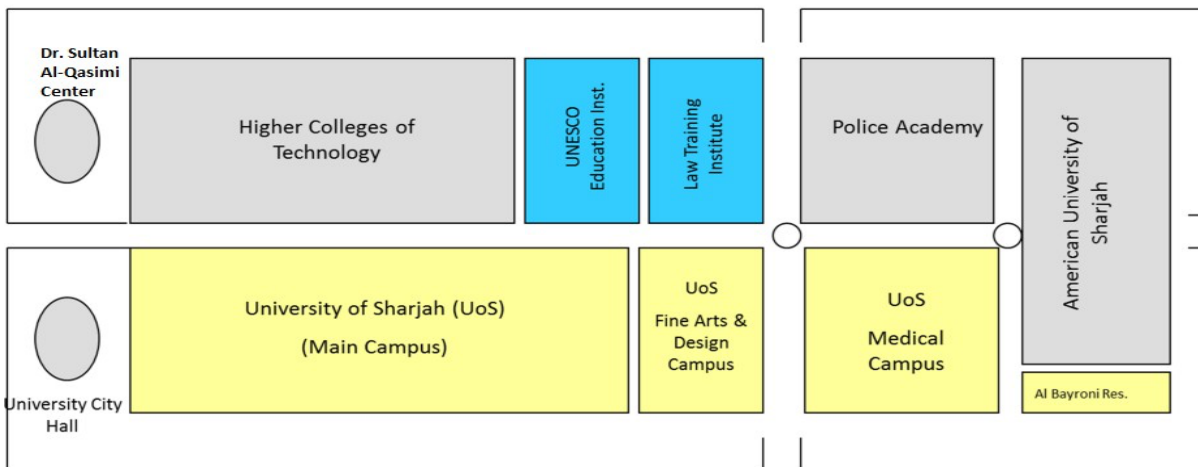
1.9 Campuses, Colleges, Departments, Programs and Degrees

1.9.1 Campuses

The main campus of the University of Sharjah is located twelve kilometers from Sharjah City and center and is divided into five interlinked sub-campuses: Men's Campus, Women's campus, Fine Arts and Design Campus and Medical Colleges Complex, in addition to a central campus (M11) which holds the University Administration. Up until recently, the University had three branches and campuses at Khorfakkan, Kalba and Al Dhaid. These branches have been transformed to standing universities. In 2022 the branch in Khorfakkan transformed to the University of Khorfakkan. In 2023 the branch in Kalba transformed to the University of Kalba and in 2024 the branch in Al Dhaid transformed to the University of Al Dhaid. During the transformation period, the UoS students studying at the branches will continue to be supported by the University of Sharjah. The University of Sharjah students attending the branches and the UoS faculty teaching at the branches are governed by the same governing bodies and the same by-laws, policies, procedures and standards.

The main campus includes separate male and female student facilities housed in buildings with classrooms, laboratories, and IT support units that are appropriately equipped with the latest instructional and educational aids. The College of Fine Arts and Design Campus and the Medical Colleges Complex have a co-educational system (See Figure). The University fosters social, cultural and other extra-curricular activities and sports. The spacious landscaped campus houses student dormitories, sports facilities, and medical clinics. Its architectural design is monumentally harmonious, inspires innovation, and reflects the peace emanating from the perennial surrounding desert environment. Most buildings are connected with each other, making it easier for faculty, staff, and students to move between facilities in air-conditioned pathways.

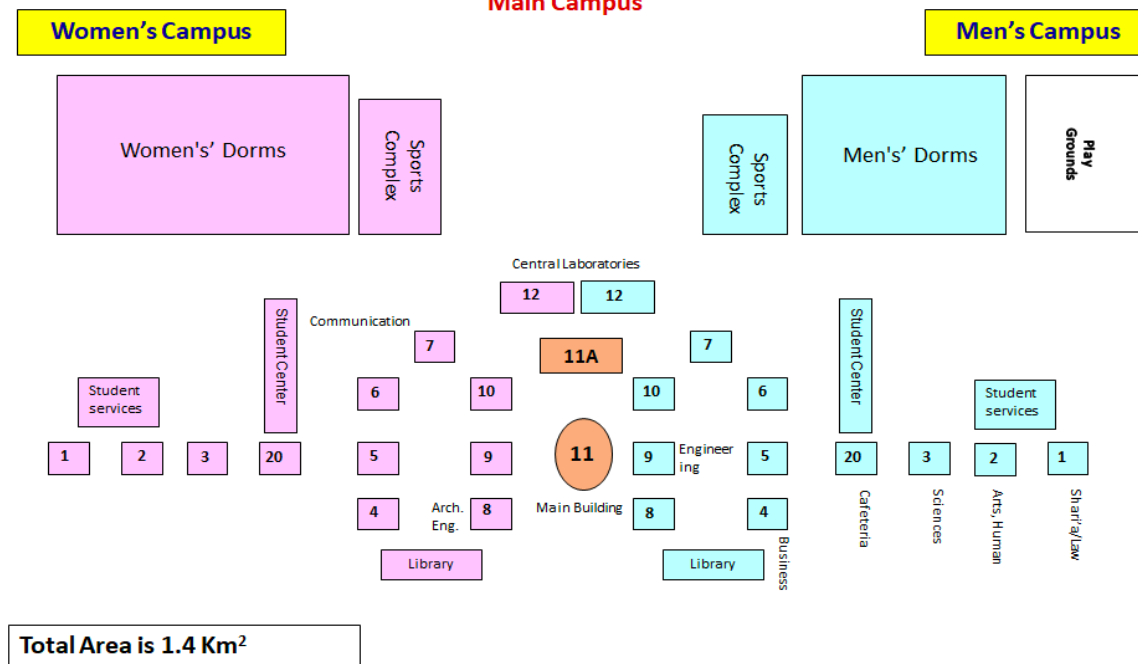
المدينة الجامعية University City



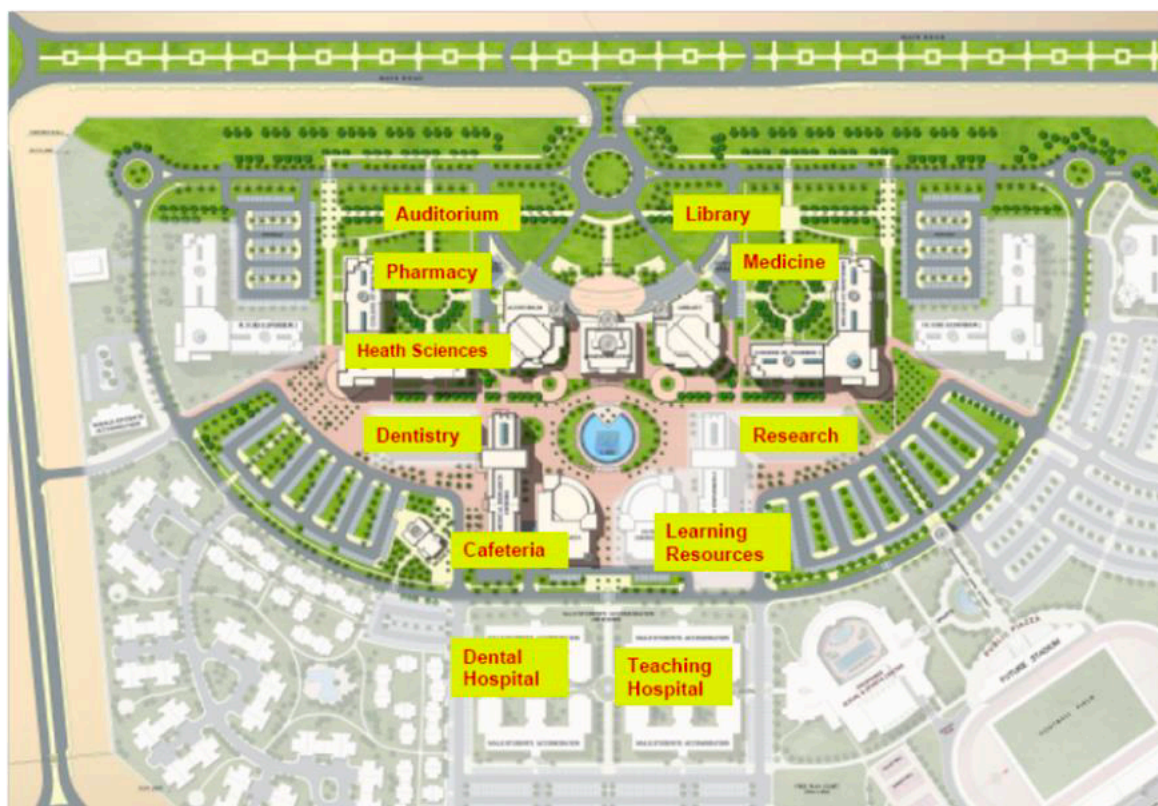
Total Area is 7.5 Km²

University of Sharjah

Main Campus



Medical and Health Sciences campus



1.9.2 Colleges

1.9.2.1 College of Sharia and Islamic Studies

The College of Sharia and Islamic Studies encompasses two significant departments: Jurisprudence and its Foundations, as well as Foundations of Religion. These departments play an integral role in promoting knowledge and understanding in the fields of Sharia and Islamic Studies.

The College offers a range of academic degrees within the specializations of Sharia and Islamic Studies, providing students with diverse educational pathways to pursue their interests and goals. The degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor in Sharia – Jurisprudence and its Foundations
- Bachelor in Sharia – Foundations of Religion
- Bachelor in Discourse and Community Communication (New)
- Bachelor in Sharia and Law (phasing out)
- Master in Exegesis and Hadith
- Master in Jurisprudence and its Foundations

- PhD in Hadith and its Sciences
- PhD in Quran Exegesis and its Sciences
- PhD in Jurisprudence and its Foundations

1.9.2.2 College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences

The College of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences encompasses several departments, each contributing to the rich academic landscape of the College. The departments within the college are as follows:

- a. Department of Arabic Language and Literature
- b. Department of Foreign Languages
- c. Department of History and Islamic Civilization
- d. Department of Sociology
- e. Department of Education

The College offers a wide range of academic degrees within the specializations of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences. These degrees provide students with the opportunity to pursue their interests and develop expertise in their chosen fields. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Arts in Arabic Language and Literature
- Bachelor of Arts in Arabic for Non-Native Speakers (New)
- Bachelor of Arts in English Language and Literature
- Bachelor of Arts in French Language and Literature
- Bachelor of Arts in History and Islamic Civilization
- Bachelor of Arts in History and Islamic Civilization – Tourism Guidance
- Bachelor of Arts in Sociology
- Bachelor in Family Counseling and Guidance (New)
- Bachelor of Education in Early Childhood
- Postgraduate Diploma in Leadership in Higher Education
- Professional Diploma in Teaching
- Master of Arts in Arabic Language and Literature
- Master of Arts in Translation
- Master of Arts in History and Islamic Civilization
- Master of Arts in Applied Sociology
- Master of Leadership in Higher Education
- PhD in History and Islamic Civilization
- PhD in Applied Sociology
- PhD in Arabic Language and Literature
- PhD in Linguistics and Translation

1.9.2.3 College of Business Administration

The College of Business Administration encompasses several departments and programs, each dedicated to fostering excellence in business education. The departments and programs within the College are as follows:

- a. Department of Finance and Economics
- b. Department of Management
- c. Department of Accounting
- d. Program for the Executive Master in Business Administration.

The College awards a range of academic degrees within the specializations of Business Administration, allowing students to tailor their education to their specific interests and career goals. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Science in Accounting
- Bachelor of Science in Business Administration – Management
- Bachelor of Science in Business Administration – Marketing
- Bachelor of Science in Business Administration- Human Resource Management
- Bachelor of Science in Finance
- Bachelor of Science in Economics
- Bachelor of Science in Supply Chain Management
- Executive Master in Business Administration (EMBA)
- Master in Business Administration (MBA)
- Master of Science in Business Analytics
- Doctor of Business Administration (DBA)

1.9.2.4 College of Engineering

The College of Engineering comprises a diverse range of departments, each dedicated to advancing knowledge and innovation in various engineering disciplines. The departments within the college are as follows:

- a. Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering
- b. Department of Electrical Engineering
- c. Department of Architectural Engineering
- d. Department of Industrial Engineering and Engineering Management
- e. Department of Mechanical and Nuclear Engineering
- f. Department of Sustainable and Renewable Energy Engineering

The College offers a comprehensive selection of academic degrees within the specializations of Engineering, providing students with the opportunity to specialize in their areas of interest. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering
- Bachelor of Science in Electrical and Electronic Engineering
- Bachelor of Architectural Engineering
- Bachelor of Science in Industrial Engineering and Engineering Management
- Bachelor of Science in Sustainable and Renewable Energy Engineering
- Bachelor of Science in Nuclear Energy Engineering
- Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering
- Bachelor of Science in Chemical and Water Desalination Engineering
- Bachelor of Science in Mechatronics and Robotic Engineering
- Master of Science in Civil Engineering
- Master of Science in Environmental Science and Engineering
- Master of Science in Electrical and Electronic Engineering
- Master of Science in Biomedical Engineering
- Master of Science in Engineering Management
- Master of Science in Mechanical Engineering
- Master of Science in Architecture
- Master in Conservation Management of Cultural Heritage (jointly with ICCROM)
- Master of Science in Sustainable and Renewable Energy Engineering
- PhD in Engineering Management
- PhD in Civil Engineering
- PhD in Electrical and Computer Engineering (jointly with the College of Computing and Informatics).
- PhD in Science and Technology for Heritage Conservation and Management

1.9.2.5 College of Health Sciences

The College of Health Sciences encompasses a range of departments dedicated to advancing knowledge and practice in various fields of health sciences. The departments within the College are as follows:

- a. Department of Medical Lab Sciences
- b. Department of Medical Diagnostic Imaging
- c. Department of Nursing
- d. Department of Physiotherapy
- e. Department of Health Services and Hospitals Administration
- f. Department of Environmental Health
- g. Department of Clinical Nutrition and Dietetics



The College offers a comprehensive selection of academic degrees within the specializations of Health Sciences, providing students with the opportunity to pursue their passions and develop expertise in their chosen fields. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Science in Medical Laboratory Sciences
- Bachelor of Science in Diagnostic Imaging
- Bachelor of Science in Nursing
- Bachelor of Science in Health Services Administration
- Bachelor of Science in Physiotherapy
- Bachelor of Science in Environmental Health Sciences
- Bachelor of Science in Clinical Nutrition and Dietetics
- Bachelor of Science in Audiology and Speech Language Pathology (New)
- Master of Science in Medical Laboratory Sciences
- Master of Science in Adult Critical Care Nursing
- Master of Science in Medical Diagnostic Imaging
- Master of Science in Physiotherapy
- Master of Science in Applied Nutrition
- Master of Science in Environmental Health
- Master of Medical Diagnostics Imaging
- Master of Public Health
- PhD in Physiotherapy (New)

1.9.2.6 College of Law

The College of Law encompasses departments dedicated to the study and practice of various aspects of law. The departments within the college are as follows:

- a. Department of Public Law
- b. Department of Private Law

The College offers a range of academic degrees within the specializations of Law, allowing students to pursue their interests and develop expertise in specific areas of legal practice. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor in Law
- Bachelor in Law (English)
- Master in Private Law
- Master in Public Law
- Master in Air and Space Law
- PhD in Private Law
- PhD in Public Law

1.9.2.7 College of Fine Arts and Design

The College of Fine Arts and Design is home to a vibrant array of programs that foster creativity, artistic expression, and design innovation. Programs are housed in two academic departments as follows:

- a. Department of Fine Arts
 - Fine Arts Program
 - Art History and Museum Studies Program
- b. Department of Applied Design
 - Fashion Design and Textiles Program
 - Interior Design Program
 - Visual Communication Program

The College offers a diverse range of academic degrees within the specializations of Fine Arts and Design, allowing students to pursue their artistic passions and develop expertise in their chosen fields. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor in Fine Arts
- Bachelor of Fine Arts in Fashion Design and Textiles
- Bachelor of Fine Arts in Interior Design
- Bachelor of Fine Arts in Visual Communication
- Bachelor of Fine Arts in Art History and Museum Studies
- Master of Arts in Curatorial Practice (New)

1.7.2.8 College of Communication

The College of Communication encompasses departments dedicated to the study and practice of various aspects of communication. The departments within the college are as follows:

- a. Department of Mass Communication
- b. Department of Public Relations

The College offers a range of academic degrees within the specializations of Communication, allowing students to specialize in their areas of interest. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Electronic Journalism
- Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Radio and Television
- Bachelor of Arts in Public Relations
- Bachelor of Arts in Mass Communication



- Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Digital Media Design
- Bachelor of Arts in Strategic Communication and Advertising (New)
- Master of Arts in Communication
- Master of Science in Media Entrepreneurship and Digital Innovation
- PhD in Communication

1.9.2.9 College of Medicine

The College of Medicine is dedicated to providing exceptional medical education and advancing knowledge in the field of healthcare. The departments within the College are as follows:

- a. Department of Basic Medical Sciences
- b. Department of Clinical Sciences
- c. Department of Family and Community Medicine and Behavioral Sciences

The College offers a range of academic degrees within the specializations of Medicine, providing students with a comprehensive education and equipping them with the skills needed to excel in their medical careers. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Medicine and Bachelor of Surgery (MBBS)/Doctor of Medicine (MD)
- Bachelor of Medical Sciences (New)
- Postgraduate Diploma in Ultrasound Technology Applications
- Master of Science in Molecular Medicine and Translational Research
- Master of Science in Leadership in Health Professions Education
- Master of Science in Diabetes Management
- PhD in Molecular Medicine and Translational Research
- PhD in Health Professions Education
- PhD in Public Health

1.9.2.10 College of Dental Medicine

The College of Dental Medicine is dedicated to providing exceptional education and training in the field of dentistry. The college comprises two departments, each playing a vital role in shaping the dental curriculum, conducting innovative research, and fostering clinical excellence among our students. The departments within the College of Dental Medicine are as follows:

- a. Department of Oral and Craniofacial Health Sciences
- b. Department of Preventative and Restorative Dental Medicine
- c. Department of Orthodontics, Pediatric and Community Dentistry

The College offers a range of academic degrees within the specializations of Dental Medicine, providing students with a comprehensive education and equipping them with the skills needed to excel in their dental medicine careers. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Dental Surgery (BDS)
- Master of Dental Surgery in Oral Surgery
- Master of Dental Surgery in Prosthodontics
- Master of Dental Surgery in Periodontology
- Master of Dental Surgery in Endodontics
- Master of Dental Surgery in Orthodontics
- Master of Dental Surgery in Pediatric Dentistry (New)
- PhD in Dental Sciences

1.9.2.11 College of Pharmacy

The College of Pharmacy is dedicated to providing comprehensive education and training in the field of pharmacy. The College consists of three departments, each contributing to the development of knowledgeable and skilled pharmacists who play a vital role in patient care and medication management.

The departments within the College of Pharmacy are as follows:

- a. Department of Pharmacy Practice and Pharmacotherapeutics
- b. Department of Pharmaceutics and Pharmaceutical Technology
- c. Department of Medicinal Chemistry

The College offers a range of academic degrees within the specializations of pharmacy, providing students with a comprehensive education and equipping them with the skills needed to excel in their pharmaceutical careers. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Pharmacy
- Master in Pharmaceutical Sciences
- Master in Doctor of Pharmacy (PharmD)
- Master of Science in Pharmacy Practice (New)
- Doctor of Philosophy of Pharmaceutical Sciences

1.9.2.12 College of Sciences

The College of Sciences is dedicated to promoting scientific inquiry and discovery across various disciplines. The College comprises several departments that contribute to advancing knowledge

and understanding in their respective fields. The departments within the College of Sciences are as follows:

- a. Department of Mathematics
- b. Department of Chemistry
- c. Department of Applied Physics and Astronomy
- d. Department of Applied Biology

The College offers a range of academic degrees within the specializations of Science, providing students with a solid foundation in scientific principles and skills. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Science in Chemistry
- Bachelor of Science in Applied Physics
- Bachelor of Science in Petroleum Geosciences and Remote Sensing
- Bachelor of Science in Mathematics
- Bachelor of Science in Biotechnology
- Master of Science in Astronomy and Space Sciences
- Master of Science in Geographic Information Systems and Remote Sensing
- Master of Science in Physics
- Master of Science in Biotechnology
- Master of Science in Chemistry
- Master of Science in Applied Mathematics
- PhD in Space Science and Technology (New)

1.9.2.13 College of Computing and Informatics

The College of Computing and Informatics is dedicated to advancing the field of technology and equipping students with the knowledge and skills needed for successful careers in computing and informatics. The College comprises several departments that offer specialized programs and contribute to cutting-edge research and innovation in the field. The departments within the College of Computing and Informatics are as follows:

- a. Department of Computer Engineering
- b. Department of Computer Science
- c. Department of Information Systems

The College awards a variety of academic degrees within the specializations of Computing and Informatics, enabling students to develop a strong foundation and expertise in their chosen field. The academic degrees awarded in these specializations include:

- Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
- Bachelor of Science in Business Information Systems
- Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity Engineering.
- Bachelor of Science in Information Technology-Multimedia
- Bachelor of Science in Biomedical Informatics
- Master of Science in Computer Engineering
- Master of Science in Computer Science
- Master of Science in Data Science
- Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence
- Master of Science in Cybersecurity Engineering
- Master of Science in Robotics and Control Systems (New)
- Master of Science in Digital Transformation (New)
- PhD in Electrical and Computer Engineering (Jointly with the College of Engineering)
- PhD in Computer Science

1.9.2.14 College of Public Policy

The Board of Trustees, in its January 2023 meeting, approved the establishment of the College of Public Policy that is envisioned to house three academic departments:

- a. The Department of International Relations
- b. The Department of Political Science
- c. The Department of Public Policy

The once approved, the departments shall offer the following degrees:

- Bachelor of Arts in International Relations
- Master of Arts in International Relations
- Master of Leadership in Higher Education
- Postgraduate Diploma in Leadership in Higher Education
- Master of Public Policy
- Ph.D. in Public Policy

1.9.2.15 College of Graduate Studies

The College of Graduate Studies is committed to fostering academic excellence, promoting research, and providing further studies in various fields of knowledge. The College has established clear goals to achieve its mission and contribute to the overall development of the United Arab Emirates.

The responsibilities of the College of Graduate Studies include:

1. **Student Administration:** The College is responsible for accepting students into graduate-studies programs and overseeing their administrative affairs until graduation. This includes admissions, enrolment, and other related administrative processes.
2. **Academic Supervision:** The College arranges academic supervision for students' master's theses and Ph.D. dissertations, ensuring that students receive guidance and support throughout their research endeavors.
3. **Teaching Assistant Scholarships:** The College offers teaching assistant scholarships to distinguished students, providing them with valuable teaching experience while financially supporting their studies.
4. **Program Development:** The College is actively involved in the development of existing programs and the creation of new ones. This ensures that the programs offered align with current research trends and the evolving needs of various fields of study.
5. **Regulatory Recommendations:** The College plays a crucial role in recommending necessary regulations that guide the organization and development of graduate studies courses. These regulations aim to maintain high academic standards and ensure the quality of graduate programs.

1.10 Language Institute

The Language Institute is one of the largest and most dynamic academic units at the University of Sharjah, dedicated to enhancing language education and services within the University and extending its reach to local and regional communities. The Institute comprises five specialized centers, each with a unique mission and scope of services:

1. **English Language Center (ELC):** The ELC plays a crucial role in preparing students for success in English-medium specializations by ensuring they meet the University's minimum English language admission requirements. The Center is dedicated to providing high-quality English language instruction that equips students with the necessary language skills for academic and professional excellence.
2. **Center for Teaching Arabic to Non-Native Speakers:** This Center aspires to be a leader in the teaching of Arabic to non-native speakers both nationally and regionally. It offers a distinctive education that emphasizes practical communication skills in Arabic, focusing on the four fundamental language skills: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. The Center is committed to fostering a deep understanding of the Arabic language and culture among its learners.
3. **Foreign Language Center:** The Foreign Language Center is aligned with the University's objectives of achieving excellence in community service and meeting the evolving needs of the UAE. The Center strengthens the country's international relations by preparing qualified professionals who can communicate effectively in various languages, thereby facilitating cultural, scientific, and technological exchanges on a global scale.
4. **Writing Center:** The Writing Center serves all students enrolled in courses where English is the medium of instruction. Its primary goal is to assist students in becoming more confident and proficient writers. The Center offers personalized support and guidance to

help students improve their writing skills, ensuring they can express their ideas clearly and effectively in academic contexts.

5. **Translation Center:** The Translation Center provides translation, interpretation, training, and consultation services to the University of Sharjah community and the public at both local and regional levels. The Center is also dedicated to the translation of Arab and Islamic scientific and intellectual achievements into various languages, thereby making these contributions accessible to a global audience.

1.11 Accreditation

The University of Sharjah is committed to maintaining high academic standards and ensuring the quality of its programs through both national and international accreditation. It holds full licensing and accreditation from the Commission for Academic Accreditation (CAA) of the Ministry of Education in the United Arab Emirates. All programs currently offered by the University have received accreditation from the CAA, demonstrating their adherence to the national standards of educational quality.

In addition to national accreditation, the University strives to obtain international accreditation and recognition for its programs. This reflects its commitment to meeting global standards and providing students with an education that is recognized and valued worldwide.

The College of Engineering offers several programs that have received accreditation from the prestigious Accreditation Board for Engineering and Technology (ABET). These programs include Bachelor of Science degrees in Civil Engineering, Electrical and Electronics Engineering, Architectural Engineering, Industrial Engineering and Engineering Management, Sustainable and Renewable Energy Engineering, Nuclear Engineering, and Mechanical Engineering. The College of Sciences also has programs accredited by ABET, including Bachelor of Science degrees in Mathematics, Chemistry, and Biotechnology. The College of Computing and Informatics has accredited programs as well, including Bachelor of Science degrees in Computer Engineering, Computer Science, and Information Technology – Multimedia.

The College of Business Administration has achieved accreditation from the Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB) for all of its programs. These include the Master of Business Administration (MBA), Executive Masters of Business Administration (EMBA), Bachelor of Science in Accounting, Bachelor of Science in Business Administration – Management, Bachelor of Science in Business Administration – Marketing, Bachelor of Science in Finance, Bachelor of Science in Public Administration, and Bachelor of Science in Management Information Systems. AACSB accreditation is recognized worldwide as a mark of excellence in business education.

The College of Communication has received accreditation from the Accrediting Council on Education in Journalism and Mass Communications (ACEJMC) for several programs. These

programs include the Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Electronic Media, Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Graphic Design and Multimedia, Bachelor of Arts in Communication – Journalism, Bachelor of Arts in Mass Communication, and Bachelor of Arts in Public Relations. ACEJMC accreditation signifies the College's commitment to meeting the highest standards of journalism and mass communication education.

The College of Law received an evaluation visit from The High Council for the Evaluation of Research and Higher Education (Hcéres) for all of its programs in Spring 2024 and is expected to receive accreditations for all of its programs in Fall 2024.

The College of Pharmacy Bachelor of Pharmacy and Doctor of Pharmacy programs are accredited by the Accreditation Council for Pharmacy Education. The programs offered by the College of Dental Medicine are accredited by the Australian Dental Council. The following programs offered by the College of Health Sciences are accredited by the Accreditation Agency in Health and Social Sciences: Master of Science in Environmental Health, Master of Science in Adult Critical Care Nursing, Master of Science in Physiotherapy, Master of Science in Medical Laboratory Sciences, Bachelor of Science in Medical Laboratory Science, Bachelor of Science in Medical Diagnostic Imaging, Bachelor of Science in Nursing, Bachelor of Science in Health Service Management, Bachelor of Science in Physiotherapy, Bachelor of Science in Environmental Health Sciences, and Bachelor of Science in Clinical Nutrition and Dietetics.

The Master of Science in Leadership in Health Profession Education is accredited by the Academy of Medical Educators.

The Sharjah Surgical Institute (SSI) offers training programs for surgeons from the region, in cooperation with international partners, including Johnson and Johnson and Olympus. The Clinical Training Center (CTC) is accredited as a medical training and testing center by the:

- Royal College of Surgeons in England
- International Federation of Surgery and Obesity and Metabolic Disorders (IFSO)
- European Association for Endoscopic Surgery (EAES)
- American Heart Association
- University Dental Hospital Sharjah Accredited by Canadian Board
- University Dental Hospital Sharjah has been Accredited as an age-friendly establishment.

The Bachelor of Science in Medical Diagnostic Imaging is recognized by the College of Radiographers. The Department of Medical Diagnostic Imaging is a member of the European Federation of Radiographer Societies.

These accreditations and recognitions validate the quality and rigor of the University's programs, providing students with assurance that their education meets rigorous standards and prepares them for successful careers in their chosen fields.

1.12 Office of International Relations

The Office of International Relations (OIR) serves as the strategic platform for coordinating the University of Sharjah's efforts in establishing and advancing international collaborations and partnerships with universities and institutions worldwide. OIR is dedicated to supporting the University's mission of becoming a globally recognized leader in education and research by facilitating international engagement and partnerships.

Key Functions of the Office of International Relations:

1. Facilitating International Collaborations:

- OIR assists faculty and staff in preparing agreements and managing approvals for international collaborations that are crucial to the internationalization of their research and professional development.
- The office supports the development and maintenance of strategic international alliances that enhance the University's global reach and impact.

2. Supporting Joint and Dual Academic Programs:

- OIR collaborates with colleges and departments to identify and engage in joint and dual academic programs at both graduate and undergraduate levels with partner universities.
- These initiatives respond to the growing need for the internationalization of academic programs, ensuring that UoS students benefit from a globalized educational experience.

3. Promoting Strategic Research Partnerships:

- OIR is committed to forging strategic research partnerships that promote the globalization of the University's research institutes and centers.
- By connecting UoS researchers with their counterparts in the global network of alliances, OIR helps to elevate the University's research profile on the international stage.

4. Facilitating International Exchange and Mobility:

- OIR creates and facilitates opportunities for the international exchange and mobility of students, faculty, and staff.
- The inbound and outbound mobility programs offer valuable experiences for UoS and its global partners to cooperate on mutual priority research areas and elevate their global standards.

5. Enhancing International Visibility and Competitiveness:

- OIR is dedicated to positioning the University of Sharjah among the world's leading research and educational institutions through strong international alliances and partnerships.

- The office works to enhance the University's visibility in global research and educational arenas by fostering sustainable international cooperation with reputable institutions.
- OIR also focuses on improving the University's performance in the world's leading university ranking systems (e.g., QS, THE World University Rankings) by supporting collaborations and continuous performance enhancement.

1.13 University Ranking

The University of Sharjah (UoS) is proud of its remarkable achievements in the latest global university rankings, further solidifying its position as a leading institution in the region and on the international stage. UoS has achieved notable recognition in the U.S. News Best Global Universities ranking, the QS World University Rankings, and the Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings.

U.S. News Best Global Universities Ranking

In the most recent U.S. News Best Global Universities ranking, the University of Sharjah has been acknowledged for its exceptional academic programs, impactful research, and strong international partnerships. It was ranked as 245 out of 2551 international Universities making it ranked first in the UAE and fourth in the Arab World and GCC. This recognition is a testament to the hard work and dedication of our faculty, staff, and students, who have collectively contributed to elevating the University's standing globally.

QS World University Rankings

The University of Sharjah has also made significant strides in the QS World University Rankings, one of the most prestigious global assessments of academic institutions. Our improved ranking in the QS reflects our unwavering commitment to providing high-quality education, fostering a vibrant research culture, and engaging in meaningful international collaborations. UoS's strategic focus on enhancing the student experience, research output, and academic reputation has been instrumental in achieving this milestone.

Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings

In addition to these accomplishments, UoS has been recognized in the Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings, further affirming our status as a top-tier institution. The THE ranking evaluates universities based on their teaching, research, knowledge transfer, and international outlook. UoS's performance in these key areas underscores our dedication to excellence and our ongoing efforts to position the University among the world's leading research and educational institutions.

A Testament to Excellence

These rankings are a reflection of the University of Sharjah's commitment to academic excellence, innovative research, and global engagement. Our success in these highly regarded rankings is a result of the collective efforts of our entire university community, including our global partners, whose collaborations have been integral to our achievements.

As we continue to advance in these global rankings, the University of Sharjah remains focused on further enhancing our academic offerings, expanding our research capabilities, and strengthening our international partnerships. We are dedicated to maintaining our upward trajectory and ensuring that UoS continues to be recognized as a world-class institution that meets and exceeds the expectations of the global academic community.

1.14 Academic Calendar

Fall Semester 2025/2026

Day	Date		Description
	AD	H.	
Mon	23 June	27 Dhi Al-Hijja	Beginning of regular online admission in Fall 2024/2025 for bachelor programs
Thu	26 June	1 Muharam 1447	Alhijiri New Year
Thu	10 July	15 Muharam	The last day of regular online admission for Colleges of Medicine and Dental Medicine.
Thu	31 July	06 Safar	The last day of regular online admission for other colleges
Mon	18 Aug	24 Safar	Return of Academic Staff
Mon - Thu	18-21 Aug	24 - 27 Safar	New Students Orientation Week
Mon	25 Aug	02 Rabi I	Classes begin
Thu	28 Aug	05 Rabi I	Last day for Add/Drop
Mon – Thu	13-23 Oct	21 Rabi II- 01 Jumada I	Midterm exams
Thu	30 Oct	08 Jumada I	Last day for dropping courses without 'F'
Thu	20 Nov	29 Jumada I	Last day for withdrawal from semester
Mon	01 Dec	10 Jumada II	Martyr's Day
Tue - Wed	02-03 Dec	11 - 12 Jumada II	UAE National Day
Thu	04 Dec	13 Jumada II	Classes end
Sat -Tue	06-16 Dec	15 -25 Jumada II	Final Exams
Wed-Thu	17-18 Dec	26-27 Jumada II	Last day to remove Incomplete Grades
Wed	24 Dec	04 Rajab	Winter break starts

Spring Semester 2025/2026

Day	Date		Description
	AD	H.	
Thu - Sun	04 Dec – 03 Jan	13 Jumada II - 14 Rajab	Online admission for Spring semester 2025/2026
Wed	01 Jan 2026	12 Rajab	New Year Holiday
Mon	05 Jan	16 Rajab	Return of Academic Staff
Mon-Thu	05-08 Jan	16-19 Rajab	New Student Orientation Week
Mon	12 Jan	23 Rajab	Classes begin
Thu	15 Jan	26 Rajab	Last day for Add/Drop
Mon - Thu	02- 12 Mar	13-23 Ramadan	Midterm Exam
Mon-Thu	16Mar- 26 Mar	27 Ramadan - 07 Shawal	Spring Break
Mon	30 Mar	11 Shawal	Last day for dropping courses without 'F'
Thu	16 Apr	28 Shawal	Last day for withdrawal from semester
Thu	30 Apr	13 Dhi Al-Qida	Classes end
Fri - Sun	01 - 31 May	14 Dhi Al-Qida - 14 Dhi Hijja	Early online admission in Fall 2026/2027 for bachelor programs
Sat - Tue	02 - 12 May	15 -25 Dhi Al-Qida	Final exams
Wed-Thu	13-14 May	26-27 Dhi Al- Qida	Last day to remove Incomplete grades
Thu	15 June	29 Dhi Hijja	Last working day for faculty with no summer teaching

Summer Semester 2025/2026

Day	Date		Description
	AD	H.	
Tue - Fri	26 - 29 May	09 - 12 Dhi Al-Hijja	Eid Al-Adha Holidays
Mon	01 June	15 Dhi Al-Hijja	Classes begin
Tue	02 June	16 Dhi Al-Hijja	Last day for Add/Drop

Thu	15 June	29 Dhi Al-Hijja	Last working day for faculty who do not have Summer teaching
Wed	17 June	01 Muharam 1448	Alhijiri New year
Thu	02 July	17 Muharam	Last day for dropping courses without grade 'F'
Thu	16 July	02 Safar	Summer classes end
Sat - Thu	18 - 23 July	04 - 09 Safar	Final exams
Mon-Tue	27-28 July	13-14 Safar	Last day to remove Incomplete grade
Mon	17 Aug	04 Rabi I	Return of academic staff
Mon	24 Aug	11 Rabi I	Classes begin for Fall 2026-2027

1.15 Statement on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Diversity and social inclusion are deeply ingrained values within the University of Sharjah. These values are central to our teaching and research, reflecting the mission of the university. Our goal is to foster a culture of critical inquiry in a diverse learning environment, which leads to the discovery, creation, and dissemination of knowledge. We are committed to enhancing the personal, social, academic, and career development of all students, faculty, and staff while serving the needs of the community and society in the United Arab Emirates and beyond.

Our commitment to diversity and inclusion extends to every aspect of the University, including our teaching, research, organizational structures, and culture. While maintaining our cultural values, we strive to produce knowledge and provide education that promotes integration and inclusion for all individuals and communities, embracing a broad range of identities and backgrounds. We aim to be a transformative factor in society by ensuring that our syllabi, curricula, and organizational practices reflect and convey diversity and inclusion.

The University's Statement, Policy, and Strategy on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion exist to promote an inclusive and equitable environment that values and supports all members of our community. Our main priorities include:

1. Creating a safe and inclusive working environment for all.
2. Ensuring that our syllabus and curriculum reflect diverse histories, cultures, and perspectives.
3. Incorporating diversity in our research and contributing to inclusive knowledge production.
4. Promoting opportunities for people from all economic and ethnic backgrounds in recruitment and retention of faculty, students, and staff.
5. Providing transparent mechanisms for individuals to voice their views.
6. Creating spaces for integration and inclusion within the campus.

To translate our commitment to diversity into tangible outcomes, the University implements specific policies and actions:

1. **Students:** All students are treated with care and respect, ensuring their full inclusion, and addressing their specific circumstances. Students are expected to respect the cultural heritage of the institution and the wider Emirati society, fostering common spaces for dialogue, understanding, and inclusion.
2. **Faculty:** Faculty members are fully incorporated into the University's structures and systems based on their abilities and contributions. They are treated with care and respect, with channels available to express diversity and inclusion-related concerns. Faculty are expected to be sensitive to students' differences and deliver teaching that accommodates diverse backgrounds. Their research should align with ethical criteria, promoting accessibility and representation of all groups when appropriate.
3. **Staff:** All staff members receive support and care, regardless of their backgrounds. The recruitment and assessment processes are transparent and equitable, recognizing the contributions of each individual. Staff are expected to treat colleagues and students with care and respect, fostering diversity and inclusion throughout the organization.

The University of Sharjah is committed to diversity, inclusion, and cohabitation among students, faculty, and staff. We celebrate multiculturalism, gender balance, and diverse socio-economic backgrounds. Our efforts aim to foster innovation and creativity, creating a space where individuals are embraced for their backgrounds. We continue to enhance and uphold our tradition of diversity as a source of strength and resilience in the University of Sharjah.

1.16 Contact Information

Office / College / Department	Telephone Number	Fax Number
Chancellor's Office	+971 6 5050001	+971 6 5585185
Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs	+971 6 5053032	+971 6 5053034
Vice Chancellor for Medical & Health Sciences Colleges	+971 6 5057201	+971 6 5585879
Vice Chancellor for Finance & Administrative Affairs	+971 6 5050103	+971 6 5050101
Vice Chancellor for Public Relations	+971 505 0055	
Vice Chancellor for Community Affairs	+971 6 5057030	+971 6 5050523
Vice Chancellor for Student Affairs	+971 6 505 0004	
Call Center for New Students	600-522251	
Admissions	+971 6 5050000	+971 6 5585184

Office / College / Department	Telephone Number	Fax Number
Registration	+971 6 5050000	+971 6 5050717
Disability Resource Center	+971 6 5053028	+971 6 5053112
Dental Hospital Call Center	+971 6 5057666 (External)	Ext 7666 (Internal)
Student Housing	Men: +971 6 5052778	
	Women: +971 6 5051406 / +971 6 5051401 / +971 6 5051443 / +971 6 5051414	+971 6 5585487 / +971 6 5585419
Passport Unit	+971 6 5050066	+971 6 5050026
College of Shari'a & Islamic Studies	+971 6 5050181	+971 6 5050334
College of Sciences	+971 6 5050225 / +971 6 5050226	+971 6 5050489
College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences	+971 6 5053301	+971 6 5050644
College of Business Administration	Men: +971 6 5053501	
	Women: +971 6 5053502	+971 6 5050100
College of Engineering	Men: +971 6 5050901	
	Women: +971 6 5050952	+971 6 5585173 / +971 6 5585191
College of Health Sciences	Men: +971 6 5057501	
	Women: +971 6 5050801	+971 6 5057502 / +971 6 5050802
College of Law	Men: +971 6 5050195	
	Women: +971 6 5053187	+971 6 5050140 / +971 6 5053155
College of Fine Arts & Design	+971 6 5053441	+971 6 5053444
College of Communication	+971 6 5050695	+971 6 5050688
College of Medicine	+971 6 5057201	+971 6 5585879
College of Dental Medicine	+971 6 5057301	+971 6 5585641
College of Pharmacy	+971 6 5057401	+971 6 5585812
College of Computing & Informatics	+971 6 5050524	+971 6 5050523 / +971 6 5050539
College of Public Policy	+971 6 505 3212	

Office / College / Department	Telephone Number	Fax Number
College of Graduate Studies and Research	+971 6 5050550	+971 6 5050552
Deanship of Student Affairs	Men: +971 6 5050759	
	Women: +971 6 5050701	+971 6 5585174 / +971 6 5585160
Information Technology Center	+971 6 5050000	+971 6 5585101
Physical Plant	+971 6 5050058	+971 6 5050051
Human Resources	+971 6 5050023	+971 6 5585200
Public Relations	+971 6 5050020	+971 6 5585099
Media Center	+971 6 5050020	+971 6 5585099
Finance Department	+971 6 5050040	+971 6 5585183
Alumni Association	+971 6 5050527	+971 6 5050523
Center for Continuing Education and Professional Development (CCE)	+971 6 5057081 / +971 6 5057087	+971 6 5057078
Central Laboratories	+971 6 5053453	+971 6 5050444
Medical Service Department	Men's Clinic: +971 6 5050207	
	Women's Clinic: +971 6 5050642	
Emergency Numbers	Emergency Males: 050/3619222	
	Emergency Females: 050/3619333	
	Ambulance: 050/5272233	
	Medical Laboratory: +971 6 5585416	
	Pharmacy: +971 6 5053272 / +971 6 5053222 / +971 6 5053250	
Libraries	Medical Colleges Library: +971 6 5057161	
	College of Fine Arts & Design Library: +971 6 5053190	
	Men's Library: +971 6 5050245	
	Women's Library: +971 6 5050673	+971 6 5585186 / +971 6 5053167



Office / College / Department	Telephone Number	Fax Number
Business Services and Purchases Department	+971 6 5050081	+971 6 5050419
University City Security - Sharjah	Main Number (Operator): 06-5059555	

Chapter 2: Faculty Appointment

The University of Sharjah aims to attract and retain top talent to achieve its vision. The Faculty Employment Policy is designed to rigorously select and appoint the best candidates across all academic units, ensuring the recruitment of highly qualified individuals. Section Four of the University President Decision No. (3) of 2019, defines different faculty classes and types of appointments, outlines the selection process, and determines the jurisdiction of faculty employment. Its purpose is to provide a comprehensive framework for employing highly skilled individuals through an effective and robust employment process.

Abbreviations and Definitions

- University President Decision No. (3) of 2019: Refers to the Academic Staff Members Bylaws at the University of Sharjah.
- Faculty: Denotes an academic appointment with a professional title, such as Assistant Professor, Associate Professor, or Professor.
- Academic Non-Faculty: Represents a flexible term and compensation model for personnel involved in teaching and/or research, including positions like Lecturer, Senior Lecturer, Instructor, and Senior Instructor.
- Acting: Pertains to a temporary administrative appointment within the faculty.
- Adjunct/Part-Time: Relates to a temporary teaching or research appointment or other designated functions as determined by the appointing program.
- Affiliate: Refers to a faculty title wherein an individual is appointed in one program and participates in another program without joint compensation or evaluation requirements.
- Clinical: Applies to a faculty or academic non-faculty appointment used in conjunction with professional degree programs.
- Courtesy: Entails a faculty appointment that provides special privileges to the appointee, not otherwise provided by the program.
- Emerita/Emeritus: Represents an honorary title conferred on a faculty member in recognition of their distinguished service to the University.
- Endowed: Denotes a faculty appointment that rewards exceptional accomplishments and is contingent upon securing endowment from a donor.
- Joint: Indicates a faculty appointment where an individual is appointed to two different units within the University.
- Regular: Identifies a faculty appointment that signifies continuous employment.
- Visiting: Involves a faculty appointment for a limited period, not exceeding three years.
- Ranked Faculty Position: Refers to Assistant, Associate, and Professor ranks without modifiers (e.g., visiting, research).

Appointment Policy Authority and Responsibility

- The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs, in consultation with the Chancellor, exercises authority over the Faculty Employment Policy.

- The Department of Human Resources (HR) provides recruitment-related services in coordination with the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs Office.

2.1 Faculty Appointment Classes

All faculty appointments must be assigned a title and an employee class, which include regular, acting, adjunct, affiliate, clinical, courtesy, emeritus, joint, endowed, visiting, and lecturer (senior lecturer/instructor/senior instructor).

2.1.1 Regular Faculty Appointments

Regular faculty appointments follow Article 4 of the University President Decision No. (3) of 2019 and involve the following ranks:

- Assistant Professor: Requires a recognized terminal degree in the field of study and demonstration of potential and ability in teaching, service, and research. Specific requirements include holding a Ph.D. or terminal degree from a recognized university and being physically fit in accordance with university and country laws.
- Associate Professor: Expects recognition, a growing international reputation in a specialty, commitment to the University's vision and mission, and records of higher education teaching and scholarly output equivalent to or higher than peers in the same rank. Minimum requirements include holding the position of an assistant professor for at least five years at a recognized university.
- Professor: Demands outstanding expertise, experience, and international recognition through peer organizations or the profession. Candidates must demonstrate having impacted their field significantly. Minimum requirements include holding a Ph.D. or terminal degree from a recognized institution and having held the position of an associate professor for at least five years.

2.1.2 Appointment of Faculty with Title Modifier

Appointment of faculty with title modifiers (e.g., teaching track, clinical track) follows specific policies applicable at the time of employment.

2.1.3 Academic Non-Faculty Titles/Ranks

Instructor, Senior Instructor, Lecturer, and Senior Lecturer positions are dedicated to teaching and service. These ranks have specific requirements for qualifications, including degrees and potential for effective teaching and professional development. Individuals in these positions may also engage in research activities that contribute to their evaluation.

2.2 Recruitment and Hiring

2.2.1 Integrity, Fairness, and Conflict of Interest

- The University of Sharjah places high value on the integrity of employees involved in the employment process.
- All members of the University community are expected to act in the best interests of the University, observe principles of fairness, impartiality, and equal opportunity in their roles.
- A strict Conflict of Interest policy governs the employment process at UoS.

2.2.2 Search and Selection Process

1. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs determines and approves the details of the faculty position to be filled.
2. All vacancies, including relevant details, must be posted on the UoS HR website and other pre-approved international talent acquisition websites within a reasonable advertisement deadline.
3. The relevant department, in consultation with the college dean, nominates a Hiring Committee comprising a minimum of three members, preferably professors. The Hiring Committees at the college level require endorsement and approval from the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and act as the University's agent to search for and attract top talent. All decisions related to faculty recruitment prioritize merit. Members of the Hiring Committees must adhere to the following principles:
 - Avoid potential or actual conflicts of interest and disclose relevant information to the academic administrator.
 - Declare any personal or previous work relationships with candidates.
4. Each college forms a Department and College Hiring Committee at the beginning of each year. The Department Hiring Committee, chaired by the department chair or designee and consisting of at least three members with the rank of professor or associate professor, carries out the following responsibilities:
 - Gather reliable and detailed information on candidates to ensure merit-based decision-making.
 - Prepare a comprehensive letter describing the search positions, including job descriptions, qualifications, and deadlines, in consultation with the department chair and the dean.
 - Advertise the position publicly and utilize appropriate methods for candidate solicitation (in coordination with UoS HR).
 - Review the pool of applicants and shortlist candidates for interviews and/or campus visits.
 - Recommend candidates for appointments to the College Hiring Committee.

5. The College Hiring Committee, chaired by the Dean or designee and comprising a representative from each department with the rank of professor/associate professor, carries out the following responsibilities:
 - Review the department recommendations.
 - Endorse or reject the department's recommendation and conduct candidate interviews if necessary.
 - Recommend endorsed candidates to the University Central Committee.
6. The Central Hiring Committee, appointed by the Chancellor at the beginning of each academic year, reviews, evaluates, and recommends new faculty appointments based on university policies and procedures. The Chancellor has final approval for all recommended candidates.
7. Once approved by the Chancellor, the HR department provides the selected candidate with a detailed offer, including title, salary, contract type, job assignment, and information about UoS.

2.2.3 Faculty Recruitment Process and Steps

2.2.3.1 Projection of Faculty Requirements

- During the annual budget review, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs (VCAA) presents a projection for the required number of faculty members in each academic unit.
- A contingency request is allocated at the VCAA Office to cover the initiation of new programs or expansion of existing programs.

2.2.3.2 Talent Request Submission

- The academic unit submits a Talent Request through the HR channels, supported by required documentation, which must be approved by the VCAA.
- The documentation includes:
 - Academic/job title of the requested position.
 - Detailed job description.
 - Anticipated start date.
 - Advert document in the UoS format.
 - Any other necessary requirements to secure the sought talent.

2.2.3.3 Candidate Sourcing

- HR adopts fair and consistent employment methods to acquire the best available talent.
- HR liaises with the VCAA Office to develop and implement a robust sourcing strategy and innovative employment marketing/employer branding techniques.

- HR collaborates with the VCAA Office to continuously review, and update sourcing techniques based on market practices, industry trends, and candidate requirements.
- HR adopts a proactive sourcing strategy to build a talent pipeline.
- HR collaborates with the VCAA Office to identify effective sourcing channels, measure their effectiveness, and utilize channels such as UoS Database, UoS Jobsite, relevant job portals, headhunting, employment agencies, advertising, and employee referrals.
- HR provides the VCAA Office with yearly measures of the effectiveness of sourcing channels.

2.2.3.4 Structured Candidate Assessment and Interview Process

- Formal Candidate Assessment/Interview Feedback forms are used by both the Department Hiring Committee and the College Hiring Committee to ensure a structured and consistent interview process.
- The Assessment/Interview Feedback forms should:
 - Align with required technical competencies, behavioral competencies, and values.
 - Include interview questions that reflect the criteria.
 - Provide ratings guidelines/rubrics for clear understanding of the criteria by panel members.
 - Capture interview information and interviewer recommendations.

2.2.3.5 Central Committee Review

- A summary of all Assessment Forms, along with relevant documentation, is submitted to the Central Committee for a comprehensive review of candidates' credentials and interview forms.
- The Central Hiring Committee may request additional information and justification if necessary.

2.2.3.6 Initiating the Employment Process

- Upon successful selection based on the policy, the candidate's information is passed to HR to commence the employment process.
- The candidate must provide the following to HR:
 - Evidence of all employment requirements with authentic documents (educational, professional qualifications, certificates, etc.).
 - Education attestation and equivalency evidence and approvals.
 - Eligibility to work in the UAE (residency visa or eligibility for sponsorship).
 - Completion of pre-employment medical check-up.

- Completion of background check/references.
- Obtaining the Security Clearance.
- Obtaining the Good Conduct Certificate (for applicants from within the UAE).
- Not having previous convictions related to integrity and honor, or having previous convictions that were revoked.
- Not having previous termination with a court order or final disciplinary decision.
- Satisfactory previous employment history.

2.2.3.7 Candidate Communication and Offer

- HR manages all communication with candidates and potential recruits, ensuring effective and consistent messaging.
- HR informs candidates that employment is subject to obtaining a clearance.
- Employment offers are drafted by HR upon receiving the selected candidate's Security Clearance.
- HR manages the candidate's compensation expectations, ensuring alignment with the approved Pay Scale.
- HR informs the candidate to review the Employment Offer and submit an offer acceptance within 10 days.
- Employment Offers are considered final upon submission of the signed copy by the candidate to HR.

2.2.3.8 Pre-joining Formalities

- HR compiles all required documents and information to maintain in the Employee File.
- New faculty members are informed to promptly notify HR of any changes in personal data and documents.
- Document authentication is required for obtaining residence visas in the UAE, and HR informs new faculty members of the documents that should be attested in their home country.
- HR provides information to new faculty members through an Employee Handbook, (covering various topics such as UoS overview, HR policies, employment policies, living in the UAE, and settling in the UAE).

2.2.3.9 Entry Visas, Travel, and Accommodation

- HR assists new faculty members in obtaining entry visas through the Passport Unit.
- HR arranges travel and hotel accommodations for new faculty members.
- HR coordinates with the Services Department to provide on-campus accommodation or housing allowances.

2.2.3.10 New Faculty Induction

- The Institute of Leadership in Higher Education (ILHE) develops and implements a structured New Faculty Induction Program/Event.
- The New Faculty Induction Program aims to facilitate integration, drive engagement, address questions/concerns, and enhance readiness for joining UoS and new roles.
- The program includes an overview of UoS, leadership and governance, HR policies, campus and facilities tour, and other relevant information.
- Feedback from new faculty members is collected to improve the induction program.

2.2.4 Hiring Exceptions

The Chancellor holds the jurisdiction to appoint national faculty who fulfil required criteria and professors with a high Scopus H-index or rare specializations without undergoing the regular review and appointment process.

2.3 Contract Types

The University offers various contract types for regular and non-regular faculty:

- **Definite Contract:** Initial appointment for regular faculty is a two-year offer, including a probation year. The contract may be renewed for three years upon successful annual evaluations as per UoS policies. Subsequently, the contract may be renewed for four years after successful annual evaluations. Regular faculty members must apply for promotion to associate professor during their appointments and within ten years of obtaining the assistant professor rank. The tenth year of the contract is conditional upon obtaining the promotion. Failure to achieve a successful promotion in the tenth-year results in automatic contract termination. Faculty who apply for promotion on their eighth year and fail will be given a second chance. A second failure leads to automatic termination. Similar conditions apply to the associate professor rank, with promotion to full professor required within twelve years of obtaining the associate professor rank.
- **Joint Appointment:** Allows faculty members to perform responsibilities across two or more units within UoS. The primary unit, responsible for decisions regarding performance review, promotion, and other conditions, must account for at least 60% of the appointment. Joint faculty members are evaluated based on the qualifications of the rank they hold and are eligible to participate in the committees of both units.
- **Adjunct/Part-time Appointment:** Reserved for individuals outside UoS who make substantial contributions to the teaching and/or research objectives of a college. Criteria and evaluation methods for adjunct faculty are similar to those for faculty appointed within UoS.

- Visiting Appointment: Involves a definite term contract of up to two years, including a probation year. Renewal for the second year is subject to department needs and successful annual evaluations as per UoS policies. In exceptional cases, and with Chancellor approval, the visiting contract may be extended for an additional year. Visiting faculty members contribute to teaching, research, and service during their appointment.
- Lecturers/Senior Lecturers/Instructors and Senior Instructors: Appointed on a definite contract for two years, including a probation year. The contract is renewable every two years based on satisfactory performance as per UoS policies.

2.4 Probation and Resignation Notice

- The faculty probation period is one year, extendable to a maximum of two years under exceptional circumstances with Chancellor approval. Termination during the probation period requires a recommendation by the relevant academic administrators and approval from the Dean, Vice Chancellor, and Chancellor. Faculty members intending to resign during probation must provide a six-month notice.
- Faculty members intending to resign from UoS must submit their resignation to their respective college deans and through the HR portal at least six months before the effective date and must coincide with the end of an academic semester (typically January or August). Failure to comply may result in a 50% deduction from the end of service compensation unless exceptions are granted by the Chancellor. New faculty members who are terminated during probation are entitled to return tickets, while new faculty members who resign during probation are not entitled to benefits such as annual leave and ticket allowances.

2.5 Confirmation

- At the end of the first year of the contract, the performance of new faculty members is evaluated by the department chair, dean, central hiring and evaluation committee, and student evaluations. The evaluation results determine whether the faculty member's contract is renewed, probation is extended, or contract renewal occurs with specific teaching and research terms.
- New faculty members must receive written notification of employment confirmation or termination six months before the end of the contract. If neither occurs, the new faculty member's employment is considered confirmed. Employment confirmation includes the probation period when calculating the employee's End of Service Benefit.

2.6 Dual Career

Faculty candidates with spouses also seeking employment at UoS may be provided with opportunities for both individuals if feasible.

2.7 Special Appointments for Academic Administrators

- All University-level academic administrators receive regular academic appointments in the appropriate college and rank based on their credentials upon assuming an administrative appointment. Faculty appointments for academic administrators survive the term of the administrative appointment, and administrators may choose to take up faculty roles at the expiration of their administrative terms.
- Academic appointments for administrators are made in writing simultaneously with the administrative appointment.

2.8 Termination for Cause of a Contract

- UoS may terminate faculty contracts in the event of discontinued academic colleges/divisions/departments or financial emergencies declared by the Board of Trustees (BOT), necessitating faculty reduction according to UoS HR policies. Terminated faculty members receive a minimum six-month notice.
- Termination of faculty contracts for cause requires the approval of the Chancellor, and recommendations for termination must be made with justifiable reasons.

2.9 Hiring and Transitioning of Emirati Faculty Members

The University of Sharjah strategically promotes the recruitment of Emirati talent as faculty members to contribute effectively to national human development. This policy provides guidelines for the hiring and transitioning of Emirati terminal degree holders into full-time faculty positions.

2.9.1 Assistant Professor-Emirati Track

2.9.1.1 Eligibility for “Assistant Professor-Emirati Track” Appointment (New Graduate):

- a. Applicants must be Emirati Nationals.
- b. Applicants must have obtained their terminal degree within two years of the application.
- c. Applicants must be below 40 years of age. Exceptions are subject to Chancellor’s approval.
- d. Applicants must have a cumulative grade point average of “Very good” in their bachelor’s degree and “Excellent” in their master’s and doctorate degrees.
- e. Applicants must have published at least two articles in Scopus indexed journals or equivalent.
- f. Applicants must possess language proficiency suitable for teaching in the academic program.

2.9.1.2 Initial Faculty Appointment:

The first faculty appointment on the Assistant Professor Emirati Track shall be for a duration of three years.

2.9.1.3 Teaching Load Reduction:

In the first year of appointment, faculty on the Assistant Professor Emirati Track are entitled to a teaching load reduction of 6 credit hours.

2.9.1.4 Performance Evaluation:

Faculty members must maintain above-average performance in their annual evaluations, including teaching, research, and service. Unsatisfactory performance during the first three years may lead to contract termination.

2.9.1.5 Mandatory Training:

During the first year of appointment, faculty members must attend a mandatory training program designed to enhance their effectiveness in teaching and advising.

2.9.1.6 Faculty Mentorship:

Throughout the first three years, faculty members must engage in regular meetings with a college-assigned senior faculty member.

2.9.1.7 Faculty Composition Limitation:

The percentage of faculty recruits under this policy shall not exceed 25% of the total faculty in any department or college.

2.9.1.8 Transition to Regular Faculty Track:

At the end of the initial three-year contract, the faculty member shall transition to a regular faculty track and be subject to all applicable University of Sharjah bylaws concerning annual evaluation and promotion.

2.9.2 Regular Faculty Appointment

- a. Emirati nationals who are not recent graduates (terminal degree obtained more than 2 years ago) shall be considered on a competitive basis among applicants for open positions.
- b. Hired Emirati faculty on a regular faculty track shall be evaluated and promoted in accordance with the applicable policies and procedures for regular faculty.
- c. Hired Emirati faculty on academic-nonfaculty track, part-time, or visiting basis shall be subject to relevant enforced bylaws.

2.9.3 Transfer Between Branches/Campuses

- Transfer between branches/campuses is not applicable for Assistant Professor-Emirati Track.
- Applicants must have served a minimum of three years on-site.
- The transfer is subject to the availability of an open position in the same field at the desired branch.
- Applicants must meet the criteria for the position.
- Approval is required from the Department Chairs, Deans, Vice Chancellors, Chancellors, and the Presidents of both sites.

2.9.4 Academic Non-Faculty

2.9.4.1 Preferential Appointment for Emirati Part-Timers/Adjunct Faculty:

Qualified Emirati individuals may receive preferential appointments as part-timers/adjunct faculty for a semester, subject to subsequent renewals based on need and favorable evaluation by the Department Chair and the College Dean.

2.9.4.2 Priority for Visiting Faculty and Lecturer Appointments:

Vacant visiting faculty appointments and lecturer positions shall be offered first to qualified Emirati applicants.

2.9.5 Decision Appeal

Applicants with denied applications may submit a written reasoned appeal to the Office of the Chancellor within one week of receiving the denial notification. The decision of the Chancellor shall be final.

2.9.6 Procedures for Appointments to the Assistant Professor-Emirati Track

2.9.6.1 Application and Initial Screening:

- Applicants meeting the conditions in this policy must apply through the University Portal or the Office of Emiratization and include all necessary documentation to justify the requirements.
- The Faculty Emiratization Committee conducts an initial screening to ensure applications meet the requirements. Applicants who do not meet the requirements are excluded, and rejection notifications are sent by the Office of the Faculty Emiratization.

2.9.6.2 Academic Credential Evaluation:

The Faculty Emiratization Committee sends the applications to respective departments/colleges to evaluate the academic credentials of the applicants.

2.9.6.3 Academic Review Report:

The Dean submits a report detailing the results of the academic review, including reasoned rejections.

2.9.6.4 Interview and Hiring Approval:

- The Faculty Emiratization Committee and the College interviews candidates recommended for hiring by the colleges.
- Approved applicants are passed to the Office of the respective Vice Chancellor for the formal hiring process.

2.9.6.5 Recordkeeping and Progress Monitoring:

The Office of the respective Vice Chancellor maintains active records for all new hires, including mandatory training dates, mentor assignments, and progress monitoring during the first three years of appointment.

2.9.6.6 Annual Evaluations and Mentorship:

Annual evaluations are conducted in a similar procedure to those of regular faculty, with the College Dean mentoring newly appointed faculty to support their progress.

2.9.6.7 Mandatory Training Program:

The Institute for Higher Education Leadership designs the mandatory training program and reports attendance to the respective College Dean and Vice Chancellor.

2.9.6.8 Faculty Mentor Assignment:

The College Dean, in consultation with the Department Chair, appoints a senior faculty member to mentor the newly appointed faculty during the first three years. The mentor provides regular reports on the activities of the newly appointed faculty member to the College Dean and respective Vice Chancellor at the end of each regular semester.

2.9.6.9 Unsatisfactory Performance and Termination:

Newly appointed faculty members not meeting UoS standards should be notified as early as possible. If unsatisfactory performance persists, the College Dean notifies the respective Vice Chancellor to initiate the contract termination procedure.

2.9.7 Regular Faculty Appointment

2.9.7.1 Application and Screening:

- Emirati Nationals who are not newly graduates should apply through the University Portal or the Office of Emiratization.
- The Faculty Emiratization Committee screens all applications, passing qualified applicants to the respective Vice Chancellor for further consideration. Applicants academically fitting open positions are reviewed by the respective college, while those who do not meet the requirements receive apologies from the Faculty Emiratization Committee.

2.9.7.2 Interview and Appointment:

- Candidates receiving positive feedback from the college are interviewed by the Faculty Emiratization Committee.
- Those passing the interview are nominated for appointment following the established faculty employment policy and procedure.

2.9.7.3 Transfer Between Branches/Campuses

Faculty wishing to transfer should submit an official request through the Department Chair/Dean to the respective Vice Chancellor. The faculty member shall be notified based on subsequent approvals outlined in the policy. The HR should be notified for those granted the transfer.

2.9.7.4 Academic Non-Faculty

Qualified applicants should follow the established procedure for appointment as academic non-faculty.

2.10 Clinical Faculty Appointment and Promotion

Clinical faculty play a critical role in providing instructional, supervision, and professional training to students in disciplines that require professional licensing to practice. Clinical faculty promotion is based on the candidate's contributions and expected contributions to the excellence of the University, the advancement of their academic field, the quality of education and research, and their contributions to the welfare of the University and the community. The hiring procedure of a clinical faculty shall utilize the procedure outlined in regular faculty hiring, wherein recommendations of all three bodies (Department Hiring Committee, College Hiring Committee, and Central Hiring Committee) shall be deployed in the hiring process of a clinical faculty member. The appointment of clinical faculty and clinical academic non-faculty shall be made through a formal selection process conducted by the appropriate department or college.

2.10.1 Hiring Limitation

- The appointment of clinical faculty/academic non-faculty is limited to Medicine, Dental Medicine, Pharmacy, Physiotherapy, Nursing, and Law.
- Without prior approval by the Chancellor, under no circumstance shall the number of clinical faculty and clinical academic non-faculty exceed 20% in a department and or a college. For small departments and or colleges (10 faculty or less), the number of clinical faculty shall not exceed one faculty member.
- The clinical faculty/academic non-faculty must hold appropriate professional certification/license/registration in their discipline permitting them to practice in the field of the clinical appointment. The licensing credential should be by a recognized licenser in the field of the clinical appointment.
- The clinical faculty/academic-non-faculty member shall maintain a license from a relevant licensing body during the appointment as a clinical faculty/academic non-faculty member.
- The clinical faculty/academic non-faculty must provide evidence of effective clinical teaching abilities and commitment to educational excellence.
- A clinical faculty member shall not be permitted to transfer to a regular faculty member (teaching and research) while employed at UoS.
- Based on the recommendation of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs, the Chancellor may grant special permission for a clinical faculty appointment in disciplines other than those listed in herein.
- A clinical faculty may serve in a relevant administrative capacity, such as clinical coordinators.

2.10.2 Recognition of Past Achievement.

- The rank of a newly appointed clinical faculty member is determined at the time of appointment.
- Clinical faculty members with no prior appointment in an academic setting shall be appointed at the rank of an assistant clinical professor.
- The length of past practical experience has no bearing on the appointment rank of the newly appointed clinical faculty.

2.10.3 Term of Appointment.

Clinical faculty appointment shall be for a definite term and shall follow the process outlined in regular faculty appointment.

2.10.4 Performance Evaluation

- Clinical faculty/academic non-faculty members' evaluation follows the same timeline and process as that of regular faculty.

- The evaluation review should include the assessment of teaching, service, and research. However, more emphasis is placed on the clinical performance of the three evaluation domains.

2.10.5 Promotion of Clinical Faculty

- Clinical faculty are required to participate in research or scholarly activities as part of their regular appointment. Unless a deviation is not violating accreditation standards, the quantity of required contribution in research and scholarship is 50% of those required by a regular faculty member.
- While the required contribution in research and scholarship is lower than that of a regular faculty member, the clinical faculty is required to substantially contribute to instructional-related issues and provide services to the department, college, and the university.
- A clinical faculty member shall serve a minimum period of service at the rank of Clinical Assistant Professor/Clinical Associate Professor before being considered for promotion to the rank of Clinical Associate Professor/Clinical Professor. The minimum period of service is 12 years, including those spent outside UoS. However, deviation from the twelve-year minimum period may be considered based on academic discipline norms.
- The minimum length of service/residence years at UoS must not be less than three years before a candidate is considered for promotion, irrespective of prior years of service.
- In exceptional cases, the minimum residence period at UoS or the minimum period of service for promotion may be reduced or increased upon approval by the Chancellor.
- Clinical faculty shall apply for promotion to the rank of clinical associate professor upon completing the minimum period of service (twelve years).
- If the promotion is denied, the clinical faculty shall be allowed a second attempt, no later than the next promotion cycle. If the second attempt is not successful, the faculty will receive a terminal contract for one year.

2.10.6 Promotion Criteria

- Promotion criteria to the rank of Clinical Associate Professor are based upon successful evidence that the faculty candidate has made significant contributions in the quality and quantity of teaching, research, and service and shows the likelihood of sustaining these contributions.
- Promotion from Clinical Associate to full Clinical Professor is another major milestone in one's academic career. Clinical faculty members must demonstrate leadership through significant accomplishments, recognition, and scholarly contributions to their discipline; they must have reached high levels of teaching excellence and have engaged in university governance or service to one's profession.

- The process for promotion evaluation shall follow the same established process of a regular faculty, with the exception that the internal and external evaluations take into consideration the articulations in this document.

2.11 Emeritus Faculty Appointment

Emeritus faculty status is an honorary designation granted to retired professors who have made significant contributions to the University through their teaching, research, and service. The policy is intended to recognize the valuable contributions of retired faculty members by granting them continued affiliation and support. This honor serves to acknowledge their legacy while maintaining their connection to the University's academic and intellectual life. Emeritus status is conferred upon retired faculty at the rank of Professor who have demonstrated exemplary service and significantly enriched the University's mission. The title, "Professor Emeritus of [discipline]," is granted for life but can be revoked if the appointee violates University rules, regulations, or conduct policies. Although it is an honorary title without employment rights or obligations, emeritus faculty may serve ex officio on committees and teach courses as needed, with compensation provided according to University policies.

To be eligible for emeritus status, faculty members must have served the University for at least six years and demonstrated excellence in teaching, scholarship, and service. Nominations can be made by department chairs, deans, or the faculty themselves, with a detailed justification and a personal statement from the nominee. These nominations are reviewed by the college dean and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs, who may form a committee for evaluation. Final recommendations are made to the Chancellor and endorsed by the President. Emeritus faculty receive formal recognition, access to University facilities and resources, and may participate in academic activities and events. They may also be eligible for certain benefits, including health insurance and retirement benefits. If an emeritus faculty member's behavior is found to contradict the University's values, their status may be revoked following due process procedures. The Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs is responsible for implementing and periodically reviewing this policy, ensuring its alignment with the University's goals and values. All discussions related to emeritus status nominations are conducted with confidentiality to protect the privacy and reputation of the nominees.

2.12 Administrative Appointment of Regular Faculty

A faculty member's primary and continuous appointment remains their faculty role, even when holding an administrative title. Senior administrative appointments require Chancellor approval, except for Deans, Vice Chancellors, and the Chancellor, whose appointments are endorsed by the Chancellor and approved by the Board of Trustees and the President. Acting administrative appointments may be offered by the Appointing Official (the President or Chancellor) and must conclude by a specified deadline, after which a permanent appointment may be considered. Administrative appointees receive a stipend per University bylaws, with compensation and

workload releases determined by the role's nature and scope. Responsibilities must align with the appointee's qualifications, and a detailed appointment letter must outline the job description, stipend, term length, and transition terms back to the faculty role. Incoming faculty accepting administrative roles receive an offer letter detailing the start date, rank, salary, probationary period, and duties during and after the administrative term.

Faculty members assigned to administrative positions will have their contracts renewed according to University bylaws, and they are expected to maintain a level of instructional and research activity appropriate to their rank. Only regular ranked faculty may be offered administrative appointments. Upon concluding an administrative role, faculty members return to their previous faculty rank, with a documented transition plan approved by the Chancellor. Human Resources (HR) supports appointment processes in coordination with the Appointing Official, ensuring compliance with university policies.

2.13 Prohibited Nepotism and Employment of Relatives

The University of Sharjah is committed to maintaining a fair and equal opportunity employment policy, emphasizing competence and merit, and refrains from any discriminatory practices favoring or opposing the employment of relatives. However, recognizing the potential for conflicts of interest and perceptions of favoritism, the University strictly prohibits the appointment of relatives in the following circumstances:

1. Direct or Indirect Line Management: Employment of a relative in a position where they directly or indirectly manage another relative is not allowed. In some cases, indirect authority can still influence the direct manager in favor of the employee.
2. Decision-Making Authority: Relatives are barred from being responsible for or having the ability to influence decisions concerning recruitment, compensation, performance assessment, promotion, increments, disciplinary procedures, and termination.
3. Potential Conflicts of Interest: Employment of relatives may be restricted when it leads to actual or reasonably foreseeable conflicts of interest between the interests of the University and the personal interests of the employees.
4. Authority and Confidentiality: Relatives in positions of authority must avoid any actions that could lead to favoritism, undue influence, or a breach of confidentiality.

2.13.1 Disclosure of Relationships and Conflict of Interest

1. Prospective employees must disclose any relevant information about relatives already employed at the University during the recruitment process and complete the Employment of Relatives Disclosure Form.
2. Current employees have the following responsibilities:

2.1 Within fourteen days of the effective date of the Employment of Relatives Policy, they must disclose existing relationships with relatives employed by the University.

2.2 Provide information about relatives employed by the University when requested.

2.3 Disclose information about new relationships (by blood or marriage) with University employees.

2.4 Report any noncompliance with the Employment of Relatives Policy due to transfer, promotion, or reorganization.

2.5 Inform the Human Resources Department if a relative is a candidate for employment at the University.

3. Employees must complete the Employment of Relatives Disclosure Form in September of each year to report any changes in relationships.

2.13.2 Management of Conflict Situations

1. Job Candidate Rejection: The University reserves the right to reject job candidates who are relatives of current University employees if any of the situations listed in the policy apply.
2. Conflict Management for Current Employees: If any of the situations listed in the policy apply to current employees, the line manager, in conjunction with a mitigation plan, should submit a report describing the conflict to the Human Resources Department for review. Decisions to address the conflict will be made by management.
3. Conflict Management for Transfers, Promotions, or Reorganization: For decisions involving transfer, promotion, or reorganization that may lead to any of the listed conflict situations, the line manager must develop a report documenting potential conflicts and mitigation plans, which will be reviewed by the Human Resources Department. Decisions to address the conflict will be made by management.
4. Transfer Rejection: The University reserves the right to reject transfer requests by employees if the transfer would result in any of the conflict situations outlined in the policy.
5. Change in Marital Status or Personal Relationship: If a change in marital status or personal relationship leads to any of the conflict situations, the University will make reasonable efforts to transfer one of the employees to a suitable position to maintain their employment. Such a transfer should be arranged within 30 days. A conflict management report should be developed and submitted for approval. If not convinced, termination can be decided by management. Termination should not be the first resort.
6. Employee Transfer Decision: The University, at its sole discretion, will decide which employee will be transferred, considering the preferences of the involved employees whenever feasible. If a mutually satisfactory decision cannot be reached, the University reserves the right to determine the transfer or termination based on business needs.

7. Policy Exception Approval: Any exception to the Employment of Relatives Policy must be approved by the Board of Trustees upon the written recommendation of the Chancellor.

2.13.3 Policy Violation

Failure to adhere to the Employment of Relatives Policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. For further details, refer to UoS policies and procedures policy number: HR-ER-20.

Chapter 3. Responsibilities of the Faculty

3.1 Teaching Responsibilities

Quality education lies at the core of University of Sharjah's mission statement and strategic directions. As such, all faculty members at the University are expected to embrace the following responsibilities:

1. **Responsibility for Teaching Excellence:** Faculty members must approach their teaching assignments with seriousness and conscientiousness. This includes meticulously planning courses, preparing engaging lectures, consistently meeting scheduled classes, and clearly communicating course requirements through well-structured syllabi. Additionally, faculty should assess the effectiveness of their courses and programs and conduct fair and impartial grading in accordance with the University standards.
2. **Commitment to Continuous Improvement:** Embracing a growth mindset, faculty members are responsible for seeking ways to enhance their effectiveness as teachers. This involves exploring innovative methods of presenting academic subject matter, aligning teaching practices with national and international qualification frameworks, motivating and inspiring students, and refining methods for evaluating student performance.
3. **Role Modelling and Mentorship:** Faculty members understand their pivotal role as models for the younger generation. They are expected to uphold high standards in academic excellence, professional ethics, and personal integrity. By setting exemplary behavior, faculty members inspire students to strive for excellence in their own academic and personal pursuits.

The University places paramount importance on classroom responsibilities, recognizing that committed and effective faculty members are instrumental in fostering a vibrant and enriching learning environment for the entire University community.

3.1.1 Eligibility to Teach Graduate Courses and Supervise Theses/Dissertations

The University of Sharjah recognizes the vital role of qualified faculty members in providing exceptional education and guidance to graduate students pursuing advanced knowledge. To ensure high standards in graduate programs, the following criteria have been established for faculty eligibility to teach graduate courses and supervise theses/Dissertations:

3.1.1.1 Criteria for Selection of Faculty in Graduate Programs:

- a) In order to participate in teaching graduate courses, serving on thesis/dissertation committees, or acting as a major advisor at the master or doctoral level, faculty members must meet the qualifications set forth by the Graduate Studies Council. Selection is based on academic training,

experience, demonstrated potential for creative work and scholarly research, and the ability to effectively direct and supervise graduate students.

b) Faculty members are nominated by their respective Department Chairpersons and College Deans. Final review and approval are granted by the Graduate Studies Council.

3.1.1.2 Teaching Graduate Courses:

- Faculty members must demonstrate evidence of effective instruction or excellence in other professional presentations.
- A strong record of active engagement in research and scholarship related to the discipline is expected.
- Minimum academic rank: Assistant Professor (except for professional programs where significant professional experience as a practitioner in the discipline is required).

3.1.1.3 Directing Non-Thesis Students:

- Faculty members must provide evidence of professional activity or scholarship to stay abreast of current advances in the discipline or profession.
- Effectiveness in advising and directing non-thesis student programs should be demonstrated for re-designations.
- Minimum academic rank: Assistant Professor (except for professional programs where significant professional experience as a practitioner in the discipline is required).

3.1.1.4 Serving on Graduate Student Committees:

- Faculty members serving on graduate student committees should hold a doctorate degree relevant to the student's degree level.
- Evidence of professional activity or scholarship to stay informed of recent developments in the discipline or profession is required.
- Effectiveness in advising, participating in graduate student committees, and supervising graduate student research should be evident for re-designations.
- Minimum academic rank: Assistant Professor (except for external co-advisors/committee members whose qualifications shall be approved by the Dean of the College of Graduate Studies).

3.1.1.5 Supervising Master Theses:

- Faculty members must hold a doctorate or terminal degree in a relevant field.
- Evidence of professional activity in the discipline or profession is necessary.

- A strong record of active engagement in research and scholarship related to the discipline is expected.
- Preferred evidence of experience and effectiveness in serving on graduate student committees.
- Evidence of successful participation in advising graduate students and directing master thesis research should be provided for re-designations.
- Minimum academic rank: Assistant Professor.

3.1.1.6 Supervising Doctoral Dissertations:

- Faculty members must possess a doctorate degree in a relevant field.
- Evidence of professional activity in the discipline or profession is required.
- A strong record of active engagement in research and scholarship related to the discipline is essential.
- Successful participation in directing master students' research and serving on doctoral dissertation committees is necessary.
- Evidence of successful participation in advising graduate students and directing doctoral thesis research should be supplied for re-designations.
- Minimum academic rank: Assistant Professor, and a minimum of one other advisory committee member should hold a rank of Associate Professor or higher. In the case of an external committee member, the qualifications shall be approved by the Dean of the College of Graduate Studies.

3.1.1.7 Terminal Degree:

- Faculty teaching courses and supervising theses/dissertations in graduate degree programs must possess a terminal degree in the discipline. Exceptions to this requirement may be considered if fully justified and documented by the college under the following conditions:
 - a) Faculty members in applied fields with a master degree in the teaching field or a doctorate in a related field, combined with extensive senior-level experience in the applied field, such as corporate management or accounting, or internationally recognized professional association certification.
 - b) Fully justifiable in terms of education, training, and professional experience.
 - c) Restricted to no more than 10% of all faculty in the institution.
 - d) Requests for exceptions must be reported to the Commission for Academic Accreditation for approval before the start of the semester in which the faculty member shall teach. Reports must include the faculty member's name, the highest degree earned and the conferring institution, area of specialization, justification for the exception, and a list of assigned courses.

3.2 Responsibilities in Student Advising and Availability

In addition to their dedication to teaching excellence and role modelling, faculty members at the University of Sharjah have vital responsibilities in providing comprehensive support to their assigned students. These responsibilities include:

1. **Guidance in Career Development:** Faculty members are entrusted with the responsibility of advising their students on developing career goals. By offering insights into various career paths and opportunities, faculty help students make informed decisions that align with their aspirations and strengths.
2. **Assistance in Course Registration:** Faculty members play a crucial role in guiding students through the course registration process. They should provide clarity on available course options, prerequisites, and potential pathways, empowering students to create well-balanced and purposeful academic schedules.
3. **Understanding University Policies:** As stewards of academic knowledge, faculty members must ensure that their students have a clear understanding of university policies. By effectively communicating these policies, faculty help students navigate the academic landscape with confidence and avoid any potential issues.
4. **Connecting to Campus Resources:** Faculty members are instrumental in introducing students to the diverse array of campus resources available to support their academic and personal growth. By encouraging students to explore libraries, writing center, tutoring services, career center, and other resources, faculty contribute to a well-rounded university experience.

To fulfill these responsibilities effectively, faculty members must commit to maintaining regular office hours. By designating specific times and locations for office hours, faculty ensure their availability to students and other members of the university community. This accessibility fosters an environment where students feel comfortable seeking guidance and clarifications on academic matters.

At the University of Sharjah, the emphasis on student advising and availability is pivotal in nurturing a supportive and empowering learning environment. Faculty members' active engagement in these areas strengthens the bond between students and educators, contributing to the overall success and fulfillment of each student's academic journey.

3.3 Responsibility to Curriculum Development

In line with the commitment to quality education and academic excellence, faculty members at the University of Sharjah carry the responsibility of actively contributing to curriculum development. This essential role ensures that academic programs remain relevant, dynamic, and aligned with the ever-evolving needs of students and society. The following are the key responsibilities related to curriculum development:

1. **Contributing to Curriculum Improvement:** Faculty members are entrusted with the task of actively participating in curriculum studies at both the departmental and college levels. By lending their expertise and insights, they play a crucial role in shaping the content, structure, and learning outcomes of academic programs. Through constructive dialogue and collaboration with colleagues, faculty members contribute to the continuous improvement of curricula.
2. **Enhancing Course Effectiveness:** Faculty members bear the responsibility of continuously enhancing the effectiveness of the courses they teach. This entails a proactive approach in seeking feedback from students and peers, as well as rigorously analyzing assessment results. By leveraging these valuable insights, faculty members can identify areas for improvement, update course content, and implement innovative teaching methodologies that cater to diverse learning styles.
3. **Active Participation in Faculty Meetings:** Recognizing the significance of effective academic programs, faculty members are expected to actively engage in departmental, college, and University faculty meetings. These forums provide opportunities for meaningful discussions, exchange of ideas, and collective decision-making to strengthen academic programs. By contributing their perspectives and expertise, faculty members play a pivotal role in the successful operation and growth of the University's academic offerings.

Faculty members' commitment to curriculum development and continuous improvement ensures that the University of Sharjah provides a progressive and relevant education that empowers students to excel in their chosen fields and make meaningful contributions to society. As active contributors to the academic journey, faculty members uphold the University's legacy of educational excellence and innovation.

3.4 Responsibility to Office Hours

Recognizing the significance of being available for student consultation, faculty members at the University of Sharjah (UoS) embrace the responsibility to hold regular office hours outside of their scheduled instructional time. This commitment ensures that students have ample opportunities to seek guidance and support from their instructors. The following guidelines outline the faculty's dedication to office hours:

1. **Full-Time Faculty:** Full-time faculty members in academic and career/technical programs are required to schedule a minimum of five office hours per week, spread over a minimum of two days. These office hours provide dedicated time for students to discuss course-related matters, seek clarifications, and receive academic support.
2. **Part-Time Faculty:** Part-time faculty members' office hours will be prorated based on their teaching assignments. While the number of office hours may vary, part-time faculty are equally encouraged to allocate sufficient time for student consultations to enhance the learning experience.

3. **Consideration for Evening Courses:** Faculty members assigned to teach evening courses should schedule at least one office hour during the evening. This thoughtful arrangement ensures that students attending evening classes could meet with their instructors before their class sessions.
4. **Timely Notification and Posting:** Each faculty member is responsible for providing the departmental administrative assistant with a copy of their timetable, indicating assigned class time and office hours. To facilitate student access, this timetable should be prominently posted outside the instructor's office. Additionally, faculty members are encouraged to clearly communicate their scheduled office hours in course syllabi or during class sessions.
5. **Flexible Accommodation:** Faculty members are expected to accommodate students whose timetables conflict with their scheduled office hours. In such cases, instructors should make reasonable efforts to arrange consultations at mutually agreeable times, ensuring that students receive the support they need.
6. **Communication of Absence:** If an instructor is unable to be present during their designated office hours, he/she should make reasonable efforts to inform students in advance. This proactive communication helps maintain transparency and facilitates appropriate arrangements for student consultations.

By upholding their responsibilities to office hours, faculty members foster a supportive and nurturing academic environment that promotes student success and encourages open communication between instructors and learners.

3.5 Responsibility to Research

In addition to their commitment to quality education, faculty members at the University of Sharjah hold a fundamental responsibility to advance knowledge in their respective academic disciplines through research and creative endeavors. The following are the key aspects of this crucial responsibility:

1. **Staying Current with Developing Knowledge:** Faculty members are expected to stay abreast of the latest developments in their academic fields. This involves actively engaging with recent publications, scholarly journals, and other relevant sources of knowledge. Participation in local or national professional societies and attending academic conferences and meetings, where appropriate, further enhances their understanding and awareness of the cutting-edge research in their disciplines.
2. **Contribution to Advancing Knowledge:** Faculty members have a central role in advancing knowledge through their individual research and creative work. By conducting original research, faculty contribute to the growth and evolution of their academic fields. They are encouraged to explore innovative ideas, contribute to the development of new theories, and conduct experiments or studies that push the boundaries of existing knowledge.

3. **Dissemination of Findings:** In line with their responsibility to advance knowledge, faculty members are encouraged to present their research findings at conferences, symposiums, and other professional meetings. Such scholarly presentations foster intellectual exchange, spark new collaborations, and provide valuable insights to the academic community.
4. **Supervision of Academic Activities:** Faculty members play an instrumental role in guiding students in their academic pursuits. This responsibility includes supervising dissertations, student research projects, and other academic activities. By providing mentorship and guidance, faculty contribute to the growth and development of the next generation of scholars.
5. **Theses/Dissertations Supervision:** To ensure effective mentorship and balanced workloads, the University has established specific guidelines for faculty engaged in the supervision of theses/dissertations:
 - A faculty member is allowed to supervise a maximum of four theses/dissertations simultaneously, exception may be granted by the College of Graduate Studies. This limitation ensures that each student receives adequate attention and support throughout the thesis process.
 - Faculty members are encouraged to advise a maximum of four students, exception may be granted by the College of Graduate Studies. By maintaining this reasonable number, faculty can dedicate sufficient time and resources to provide quality guidance to each advisee.

Upholding the responsibility to research is integral to the University's pursuit of academic excellence and the advancement of knowledge in diverse fields of study. Faculty members who actively engage in research enrich the academic environment, contribute to the growth of their disciplines, and inspire a culture of continuous learning and discovery at the University of Sharjah.

3.5.1 Faculty Responsibility in Internationalization, Ranking, and University Visibility

The University of Sharjah recognizes global engagement and visibility as key pillars of institutional success. Faculty members play a critical role in supporting the university's internationalization efforts and enhancing its global reputation. Faculty are expected to contribute to internationalization and ranking initiatives in the following ways:

- **Research Visibility**
 - Publish in high-impact, indexed international journals.
 - List "University of Sharjah" as their primary institutional affiliation.
 - Actively use platforms such as ORCID, Scopus, and Google Scholar to maintain an accurate public research profile.
- **Collaboration and Engagement**
 - Initiate or participate in international research collaborations, joint publications, and global academic networks.

- Supervise or host international students and postdocs.
- Represent the University of Sharjah in international conferences, consortia, and committees.
- Support the Global Media Unit efforts in internationalizing research output.
- **Global Teaching and Programs**
 - Support dual or joint degree programs.
 - Offer courses in English where appropriate to attract international students.
 - Integrate global perspectives and case studies into teaching content.
- **University Rankings and Visibility**
 - Participate in institutional surveys (e.g., QS, Times Higher Education) as requested.
 - Ensure accurate and timely input of scholarly outputs into the Faculty Information System.
 - Promote the university's achievements and programs on professional platforms.
- **Institutional Representation**
 - Serve as ambassadors of UoS in academic diplomacy and outreach.
 - Highlight UoS contributions in international grant proposals and peer networks.

3.6 Responsibility to Community Service

In alignment with University of Sharjah's commitment to community engagement and social impact, faculty members are entrusted with the following community service responsibilities:

1. **Supporting and Contributing to Social Communities:** Faculty members bear the responsibility of actively supporting and making meaningful contributions to social communities where they can have a positive impact. This involves utilizing their expertise and skills to serve and uplift the local and regional communities they are a part of.
2. **Positive Publicization and Outreach:** Faculty members are encouraged to be ambassadors of the University, promoting its values and achievements to the wider community. Active engagement in outreach activities that showcase the University's contributions and achievements is expected. This may include serving as a consultant or research partner in their respective professional areas, offering expertise as a resource person, delivering lectures to community groups, and participating in community events that enhance the University's reputation.
3. **Utilizing Academic Expertise for Community Benefit:** While engaging in community service, faculty members are encouraged to leverage their academic expertise to address local challenges and contribute to the betterment of society. By applying their knowledge, research, and teaching acumen, they can effectively address community needs and foster positive change.

Furthermore, faculty members are expected to actively participate in the University's councils and committees, collaborating with colleagues to shape the University's policies and initiatives. Additionally, when requested by the Chancellor or College Dean, faculty members should be

willing to undertake other responsibilities, as long as such tasks align with the nature of their work and contribute to the University's mission and objectives.

By embracing these community service responsibilities, faculty members play a vital role in advancing UoS's mission of creating a positive impact on society and empowering the communities they serve. Their dedication to community service enhances the University's standing as a socially responsible institution, inspiring students and fellow faculty members alike to contribute meaningfully to the betterment of the world around them.

3.7 Professional Development Responsibilities

As part of their core responsibilities, faculty members at the University of Sharjah are expected to actively participate in professional development activities that support excellence in teaching, research, and service. These activities are provided at both the departmental and university-wide levels and are designed to align with institutional goals and individual academic growth. Faculty are responsible for engaging in the following development activities:

- **Department-Level Development**
 - Collaborate with department chairs to identify and address individual development needs.
 - Utilize available resources such as travel funding, reassigned time, and mentoring support.
 - Participate in department-led initiatives and internal professional development sessions.
- **University-Level Development Programs**
 - Participate in cross-disciplinary faculty development programs offered by the University.
 - Engage in university-wide workshops and seminars focused on improving teaching, research, and service effectiveness.
- **New Faculty Development Training (via ILHE)**
 - Attend orientation and training programs covering pedagogy, technology, research skills, and institutional policies.
 - Participate in peer learning communities and mentoring programs to support early-career development.
 - Complete training modules on teaching strategies, Blackboard tools, curriculum design, and accreditation standards.
- **Instructional Development Activities**
 - Join programs such as peer coaching, classroom performance reviews, and teaching workshops.
 - Integrate advanced instructional technologies and assessment strategies in the classroom.
- **Professional and Organizational Development**
 - Engage in disciplinary development activities to strengthen academic expertise.

- Contribute to institutional initiatives, including accreditation and strategic planning efforts.
- **Participation in Peer Observation of Teaching (PoT)**
 - Engage voluntarily in PoT cycles that include pre-observation planning, classroom visits, and reflective feedback sessions.
 - Participate as either observer or observed, using the process to improve teaching practices in a supportive, non-evaluative environment.
 - Join the community of practice aimed at fostering continuous instructional growth and collegial collaboration.

3.8 Responsibility to Quality Assurance and Institutional Effectiveness

Ensuring the continuous enhancement of academic programs and institutional effectiveness is integral to UoS's commitment to excellence. Faculty members play a crucial role in this endeavor and are expected to fulfil the following responsibilities related to quality assurance:

1. **Defining Objectives and Outcomes:** Faculty members are responsible for clearly stating the objectives and learning outcomes for each of the courses they teach or specialize in. These outcomes serve as essential benchmarks for assessing student progress and program effectiveness.
2. **Outcomes Mapping:** Faculty members are required to conduct outcomes mapping for the courses they teach. This process involves aligning course objectives and learning outcomes with program-level outcomes, ensuring a cohesive and integrated educational experience.
3. **Classroom Assessment:** Faculty members must utilize the defined learning outcomes in their classroom assessments. Regularly assessing student performance against these outcomes provides valuable insights into the effectiveness of instructional strategies.
4. **Assessment Reporting:** Faculty members are responsible for preparing comprehensive assessment reports for the academic department's council. These reports provide data-driven evidence of student learning and contribute to program improvements.
5. **Active Participation in Assessment Activities:** Faculty members are expected to actively participate in all assessment activities mandated by their academic department and the University Outcomes Assessment Committee. Collaborative engagement in assessment initiatives fosters a culture of continuous improvement.
6. **Feedback Integration for Improvement:** Faculty members must use assessment feedback to enhance the academic content of their courses and refine their teaching and assessment methods. This iterative approach to improvement ensures a dynamic and relevant learning experience.

Apart from the specific quality assurance duties, all faculty members are encouraged to actively engage in the academic community through participation in department councils and committees. Their valuable insights and contributions aid in shaping and enhancing the University's academic programs. By collectively embracing these responsibilities, faculty members strengthen UoS's

commitment to quality education and institutional effectiveness, nurturing an environment conducive to academic excellence and holistic development.

3.9 Role and Responsibilities of Administrative Faculty

3.9.1 College Dean

Individuals appointed as Deans must hold the rank of full professor. In exceptional cases, a faculty member from a different rank may be assigned as the acting Dean of the college. The appointment of the Dean is subject to the decision of the Board of Trustees, based on the Chancellor's recommendation, for a period of three years, renewable only once.

Responsibilities

The College Dean's responsibilities include:

- Overseeing the administration of academic, administrative, and financial affairs, as well as scientific research matters within the college, adhering to University bylaws, policies, and procedures.
- Collaborating with other university entities to develop the college's strategic and operational plans.
- Monitoring the achievement of strategic performance indicators.
- Preparing the college budget, considering the college's needs, and coordinating with the Finance department.
- Ensuring the implementation of decisions made by the College and Deans Councils and the Board of Trustees.
- Ensuring the smooth functioning of teaching and research processes, maintaining discipline, and adhering to laws, bylaws, and policies.
- Providing a detailed annual report to the Chancellor at the end of the academic year, encompassing college activities and educational and research affairs.
- Supervising faculty and staff recruitment within the college, in line with the University's faculty recruitment process, in coordination with department chairs and faculty members.
- Evaluating department chairs and faculty members within the college based on performance evaluation criteria and systems implemented at the University.
- Overseeing the implementation of faculty and staff development programs.
- Coordinating and supervising all assessment activities in the college, including:
 - Overseeing and monitoring all assessment work conducted within the college.
 - Evaluating the role of department chairs in the assessment process.
 - Ensuring the completion of all required data and including them in the college's annual report.
 - Ensuring compliance with accreditation standards and university criteria in the creation of faculty, course, and program e-files.

- Implementing recommendations for course and program improvement derived from the learning outcome assessment process.
- Hold periodical College Council meetings (at least once a month) and meet with the Chairs and associate/assistant deans on regular basis.

3.9.2 Chair of Academic Department

The Chancellor appoints a faculty member preferably holding the rank of professor as department chair upon the recommendation of the Dean, for a period of three years, renewable normally only once. A department chair may also be appointed from among faculty members of a lower rank.

Responsibilities

The Department Chair's responsibilities include:

- Ensuring that teaching, research, and academic activities are carried out professionally and in accordance with University bylaws, policies, and procedures.
- Developing the department's strategic and operational plans in coordination with other college and university entities.
- Monitoring the achievement of strategic performance indicators.
- Preparing the department budget and submitting it to the college dean.
- Providing a comprehensive report to the college dean at the end of each academic year on the department's academic and educational affairs, research, publications, and community service.
- Proposing the conditions, specifications, qualifications, and experiences required for vacant positions within the department.
- Supervising faculty and staff recruitment within the department, in line with the University's faculty and staff recruitment process, in coordination with department faculty.
- Evaluating department faculty and staff based on performance evaluation criteria and systems implemented at the University.
- Allocating students to academic advisors and monitoring their study plans' progress.
- Proposing the distribution of courses among faculty and submitting the plan to the Departmental Council.
- Overseeing the implementation of faculty and staff development programs.
- Coordinating and supervising all assessment activities within the department, including:
 - Supervising and monitoring all assessment work conducted within the department.
 - Evaluating faculty's role in the assessment process.
 - Ensuring the completion of all required data and including them in the department's annual report.
 - Ensuring compliance with accreditation standards and university criteria in the creation of faculty, course, and program e-files.

- Implementing recommendations for course and program improvement derived from the learning outcome assessment process.
- Assigning assessment implementation tasks to faculty and monitoring their performance.
- Maintaining records for departmental activities and university documents related to the department, adhering to university policies and procedures.
- Supervising the selection of course textbooks and references.
- Conduct the Department Council Meeting at least once a month.

3.9.3 Program Coordinator

The Program Coordinator's responsibilities include:

- Cooperating with the Department Chair/College Dean to prepare a statement regarding the department's needs and submitting the program to the Dean for budget consideration, following consultation with the department.
- Assisting the Department Chair/College Dean in overseeing program effectiveness activities, ensuring proper documentation of assessments, and facilitating continuous improvement and development of the program and its courses.
- Supporting the Department Chair/College Dean in maintaining records for departmental activities and university documents related to the department, adhering to university rules and practices.
- Participating in the selection of course textbooks and references.
- Proposing the distribution of courses among staff members and submitting the plan to the Department Chair.
- Encouraging academic research and assisting faculty in conducting research.
- Assisting students in developing suitable study plans and selecting academic advisors for their study period.
- Contributing to the preparation of all reports related to the program as required by the Dean's Office or the university administration.
- Coordinating and supervising all assessment activities within the program, including:
 - Supervising and monitoring all assessment work conducted within the program.
 - Ensuring compliance with accreditation standards and university criteria in the creation of faculty, course, and program e-files.
 - Implementing recommendations for course and program improvement derived from the learning outcome assessment process.
 - Supervising the selection of course textbooks and references.
- In the case of an interdisciplinary program, the program coordinator shall communicate with all stakeholders to ensure the program's smooth running.

3.9.4 Course Coordinator

The Course Coordinator's responsibilities include:

- Organizing and conducting a start-up meeting for all course instructors at the beginning of each semester to discuss and plan the implementation of actions developed during the previous cycle.
- Ensuring that all course instructors follow the course syllabus to achieve consistency among all course sections.
- Ensuring that all course instructors receive all course materials and textbooks in advance.
- Coordinating the preparation of unified exams, particularly the midterm and final exams, in collaboration with all course instructors.
- Organizing follow-up meetings with course instructors during the semester to ensure similar progress across all sections.
- Developing and implementing course assessment for multi-section courses, including:
 - Collecting data, feedback, and recommendations related to all sections from all course instructors.
 - Compiling aggregate data.
 - Completing the e-course file to reflect the course experience in all sections.

3.10 Academic Freedom and Responsibility

Academic freedom is a fundamental right of all members of the academic community at the University of Sharjah. It encompasses the freedom to study, discuss, investigate, teach, conduct research, and engage with the community in a manner appropriate to their roles and responsibilities. The University's primary mission is to provide a high-quality educational experience and contribute to human knowledge through discovery and scientific research, in collaboration with leading academic and research institutions worldwide. To fulfil this mission, the University recognizes the essentiality of academic freedom of expression and believes that all members of the University community should work collaboratively, in a culture of mutual respect, to support and uphold this principle. Simultaneously, the University takes pride in preserving, fostering, and promoting Arab and Islamic culture, and expects all faculty, staff, and students to adhere to these cultural values and demonstrate a high level of social responsibility.

The following statement serves as a guideline for faculty of the University of Sharjah in relation to academic freedom and respect:

1. The primary responsibility of a faculty is to utilize the freedom of their academic position to engage in honest and sincere efforts to explore and communicate knowledge within their respective discipline.

2. Faculty are encouraged to exercise their freedom in research and publication, as long as their scholarly work does not conflict with their assigned duties or the University's by-laws for scientific research and conflict of interest policies.
3. All faculty should uphold high levels of personal integrity and professional competence in their teaching, research, and community service activities.
4. While faculty are encouraged to exercise freedom in the classroom to discuss the subject matter, they should exercise caution when expressing personal views and avoid introducing unrelated controversial topics. Class discussions should maintain appropriate levels of sensitivity and respect for the Islamic and Arab culture and traditions embraced by the University of Sharjah.
5. Faculty should recognize that academic freedom is a shared right among all members of the University community. Mutual respect, confidence in colleagues, and professionalism should always be fostered within the University community.
6. When faculty speak or write for publication outside the classroom, they should be free to express their opinions, as long as their activities do not conflict with University laws and provisions. Faculty engaging in activities outside the University should coordinate with the University administration and clarify whether they are speaking for themselves or on behalf of the University.

As an active participant in the pursuit of academic excellence, the University Administration is committed to recruiting, retaining, and promoting faculty through fair and thorough processes. Faculty are appointed based on recommendations from department and college councils, approved by the Dean's Council, and finalized by a decision from the Chancellor. The University Administration is responsible for protecting, defending, and promoting a climate that supports freedom in teaching and research, as well as recognizing outstanding faculty. All administrative units are expected to develop appropriate policies and procedures to implement the University's general goals and directions. Administrators have the responsibility to safeguard and ensure these rights within the institutional framework. The Faculty Grievances Committee is entrusted with receiving, investigating, and making recommendations to the Chancellor regarding any grievances or disputes that may arise.

3.11 Workload Allocation Model (WLAM)

Articles 20 and 21 of the University President Decision No. (3) of 2019 in Issuance of the Faculty Bylaws at the University of Sharjah establishes the broad articulations for the faculty working and teaching loads.

The Deans Council approved guidelines for assigning faculty workload, encompassing the full spectrum of faculty responsibilities. The University has adopted Credit Hours as the primary basis for calculating faculty workload, aligning with best practices and accommodating various instructional methods. This model ensures equitable and transparent distribution of teaching, research, and service obligations across all full-time faculty and academic staff. While the calculation of Faculty Workload (FW) is primarily based on Credit Hours, it also considers the

number of contact hours for specific types of instruction. The workload applies to all full-time faculty members and academic non-faculty at the University. Its purpose is to define and regulate faculty workload in a manner that promotes academic excellence and student success, supports faculty research and scholarly activities, ensures faculty involvement in service and administrative roles, and maintains a sustainable and manageable workload for faculty members.

Abbreviations and Definitions

University President Decision No. (3) of 2019: Academic staff members Bylaws at the University of Sharjah.

Credit Hour: credit hour quantifies academic work through intended learning outcomes and student achievement evidence, roughly corresponding to:

- **Classroom Instruction:** At least one hour of classroom or direct faculty instruction coupled with a minimum of two hours of student work outside class each week over approximately sixteen weeks, equating to one semester credit hour. This can also apply to equivalent work completed over different time spans.
- **Other Academic Activities:** A comparable amount of work as outlined above for other academic pursuits, including lab work, internships, studio sessions, and additional scholarly activities that contribute to earning credit hours.

Contact Hour: A Contact Hour refers to 50 minutes of instructional time.

Lecture: Traditional classroom teaching that emphasizes theoretical instruction under the direct supervision of a faculty member.

Laboratory: Instruction focused on hands-on experimentation conducted in a lab or classroom, under the direct guidance of an instructor.

Independent Study: Allows students to delve deeply into a particular area of interest under the direct guidance and periodic consultation of a faculty member.

Internship: Provides structured employment opportunities that help students develop professional skills directly related to their field of study, coordinated with their academic program.

Field Work: Practical work conducted in the field as part of a course, either on a regular basis or within a designated timeframe, enabling students to apply classroom theory in real-world settings.

Studio Work: Instruction in a studio environment, providing students with practical, hands-on learning under an instructor's supervision.

Practicum: Experience-based learning conducted in real-world environments, supervised by faculty, aimed at developing practical skills pertinent to the discipline.

Clinical Practice: Involves practical, experience-based instruction in simulated or real-world environments, typically within healthcare or service fields, supervised directly by an instructor and including out-of-class assignments.

Seminars: Course-related sessions supervised by a seminar instructor or coordinator, often featuring different speakers and covering advanced topics in the student's major.

Online / Hybrid: Courses delivered either entirely online or through a blend of online and face-to-face instruction, where a significant portion or all content is provided digitally.

Senior Project: A culminating project for near-graduation undergraduate students, integrating their learning into a comprehensive project under faculty supervision, with regular consultation.

Thesis/Dissertation: An extensive research project for graduate students, producing original scholarly work under the guidance and supervision of a faculty member, with ongoing periodic consultations.

3.11.1 Basic Policy

- Pursuant to the University President Decision No. (3) of 2019:
 - Ranked full time regular faculty, visiting faculty or senior lecturer workload equal to 12 credit hours per regular semester or 24 credit hours per academic year.
 - Lecturer workload equal to 15 credit hours per regular semester or 30 credit hours per academic year.
 - Instructor workload equal to 20 credit hours per regular semester or 40 credit hours per academic year.
- Nomination for all administrative assignments at the level of Dean or lower are the responsibility of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs.
- Faculty with administrative release are not paid for teaching overload courses, unless an exception for special circumstances is approved by the Chancellor.

3.11.2 Faculty with Administrative Duties Workload Release:

- Pursuant to the University President Decision No. (2) of 2019 and the University President Decision No. (3) of 2019, faculty members with administrative roles shall have the following release and compensation:

Duty	Release time (CH/per semester)
Vice Chancellor	12
Dean	9
Director of Research Institute	6
Associate Dean for Academic Affairs	3-6
Associate Dean for Research	3
Chairman of Academic Department	3-6
Director	3-6
Coordinator	1-3
Special Assignment	1-9

- The Associate Dean for Academic Affairs is also known as the Associate Dean and the Associate Dean for Research is also known as the Assistant Dean for Research.
- The Director position shall include both Directors of academic and non-academic units and research centers.
- The coordinator position shall include both directors of academic programs and academic and non-academic units.

- Special assignments are made based on the university needs.

3.11.3 Principle of WLAM

- The workload is developed to ensure equitable work distributions across the University of Sharjah Colleges, taking into consideration the specificity in teaching and learning for some of the colleges. It also provides for a system of accountability to be held by college deans, chairs and faculty alike.
- Teaching needs of a college must be met as a priority regardless. Teaching releases is conditional on fulfilling all teaching needs of the college.
- The management of workload release is subject to the specific needs of the College and the approval of the College Dean and or the University Administration.
- Professional consulting and other bases of supplemental compensation should not be a factor in workload assessment.
- University and community service-related activities' expectations are four (4) hours per week, on average, excluding regular office hours and academic advising.
- Faculty may buyout teaching loads through external grants at an equivalent salary rate.
- Teaching in the summer session is typically considered out of load. All regular full-time faculty are eligible to teach in summer for additional compensation as articulated in a circular issued by the Chancellor.
- The workload shall be reviewed periodically by the Deans' Council.
- Faculty members who have concerns or disputes regarding their workload should first address them with their department chair.
- If the issue is not resolved, it may be escalated to the dean for further review and resolution. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs will serve as the final arbiter in unresolved disputes.
- The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs has the jurisdiction to clarify the policy.

Direct Teaching Workload

The direct teaching load shall include all instructional teaching.

1-A - Direct Teaching											
Type and Schedule Code	Description	Degree – Course Level	Course Credit Hours	Contact Hours Weekly (Instruction Time)	Contact Hours per 1 credit hour Semester (16 weeks)	Faculty Instructional Workload (WCH)	Measurement Type	Evidence	University Wide or College Specific	Minimum Capacity	Comments
Lecture Undergraduate LDU	An undergraduate course requiring the extended expression of thought supported by generally accepted principals or theorems of a field or discipline by an expert or qualified representative of the field or discipline.	Undergraduate	1	1	15	100	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University wide	50 for UR 10 for CRMR	
Lecture Graduate LUG	A graduate course requiring the extended expression of thought supported by generally accepted principals or theorems of a field or discipline by an expert or qualified representative of the field or discipline.	Graduate	1	1	15	133	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	5	
Seminar Undergraduate SMU	An undergraduate course that is heavily based on reading and discussion for learning the class content. Participation is the primary expectation in a seminar style course, and it is often for higher level topics.	Undergraduate	1	1	15	100	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	10	
Seminar Graduate SMG	A graduate course that is heavily based on reading and discussion for learning the class content. Participation is the primary expectation in a seminar style course, and it is often for higher level topics.	Graduate	1	1	15	133	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	5	
Studio Undergraduate - STU	An undergraduate course requiring visual- or aesthetic-focused experiential work where students test, observe, experiment, or practice a field or discipline in a hands-on environment.	Undergraduate	1	1	15	100	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	College Specific - Fine Arts	7	
Studio Graduate - STG	A graduate course requiring visual- or aesthetic-focused experiential work where students test, observe, experiment, or practice a field or discipline in a hands-on environment.	Graduate	1	1	15	133	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	College Specific - Fine Arts	5	
Remedial and Preparatory Courses - RPM Undergraduate	Non-credit course offered to applicants who have scored less than a specific score in an admission test, to improve their performance, for enrolment towards graduate programs.	Undergraduate	0	1	75	100	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University-Wide	35	Include intensive English, listening skills, reading skills, writing skills, and Remedial Courses
Laboratory - LAB	A course requiring focused experiential work where students test, observe, experiment, or practice a field or discipline in a hands-on environment, typically held in designated spaces.	Undergraduate and Graduate	1	1	15	0.50	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University-Wide	10	
Tutorial TUT	A course that requires small discussion groups led by a tutor. Weekly assignments are often set and may involve a presentation to the group, a written exercise, or participation in group discussion.	Undergraduate	1	1	15	0.50	Per Course Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University-Wide	10	
Office-based Lectures - OBN	Usually offered to a student that need to graduate, and is not able to register in a remaining course	Undergraduate and Graduate	1	1	15	0.00	Per Student	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University-Wide	1	Service to University
Independent Study - IND	A course requiring students to participate in individualized, independent, directed, or guided studies under the supervision of an expert or qualified representative of the field or discipline that cannot be otherwise classified as Internship, Field Experience, Cooperative Education, Practicum, Recital, Performance, or Ensemble.	Undergraduate and Graduate	1	1	15	0.00	Per Student	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	1	Service to University

Indirect Teaching

2A - Indirect Teaching, and Supervision											
Type and Schedule Code	Description	Degree – Course Type	Credit Hours	Contact Hours Weekly	Contact Hours Semester (16 weeks)	Faculty Instructional Workload (WCH)	Measurement Type	Evidence	University Wide or College Specific	Minimum Capacity	Comments
Senior Project (EDP CAP) Supervision - CAP	A course leading to graduation, usually project-based, provide student with the opportunity to engage in a culminating experience that integrates and applies the learning acquired during their program of study at the university to a project under the direct supervision and direction of a faculty with whom there is periodic contact and consultation throughout the project.	Undergraduate	1	1	15	0.30	Per Student	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University wide		Maximum FW per faculty/per CRN per semester = 3
Projects - PRU	A project-based course, related to a specific interest or academic discipline, supervised by a faculty member.	Undergraduate	1	1	15	0.30	Per Student	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University wide	10	Maximum FW per faculty/per CRN semester = 3
Thesis & Dissertation Supervision THM	Thesis provides students with the opportunity to engage in a comprehensive research experience to produce substantial original scholarly work under the direct supervision and direction of a faculty with whom there is periodic contact and consultation throughout the course.	Master	1	1	15	0.50	Per Student	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	Varies	Maximum FW per faculty per semester = 3 Maximum per student is 15 total supervision
Thesis & Dissertation Supervision THD	Thesis provides students with the opportunity to engage in a comprehensive research experience to produce substantial original scholarly work under the direct supervision and direction of a faculty with whom there is periodic contact and consultation throughout the course.	D doctorate	1	1	15	0.75	Per Student	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	Varies	Maximum FW per faculty per semester = 4 Maximum per student is 9 total supervision
Thesis & Dissertation Project Supervision THP	A course leading to graduation, usually project-based, provide student with the opportunity to engage in a culminating experience that integrates and applies the learning acquired during their program of study at the university to a project under the direct supervision and direction of a faculty with whom there is periodic contact and consultation throughout the project.	Master	1	1	15	0.50	Per Student	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	6	Maximum FW per faculty per semester = 3 Maximum per student is 15 total supervision
Clinical - CL Undergraduate	An experience-based instruction for the purpose of developing skills related to the discipline focused on "real world" activities that may be offered in a simulated "real world" environment generally in healthcare or service innovation programs. Clinical practice instruction is conducted under the direct supervision of an instructor.	Undergraduate	1	3	45	0.50	Per Contact Hour	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	Medical Campuses	Varies	Maximum FW per faculty per semester = 3
Field FIE Undergraduate	A course requiring the field practice of students under the supervision of an expert or qualified representative of the field or discipline	Undergraduate	1	1	15	5-1	Per Student Numbers	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	10	1-5 Student = 5 6-20 Student = 1 Maximum FW per Faculty per semester = 3
Internship and Practical Training Supervision INT PRS	A course requiring students to participate in a partnership, professional employment, work experience, or cooperative education with an entity external to the institution, generally under the supervision of an employee of the given external entity.	Undergraduate	1	1	15	5-1	Per Student Numbers	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University Wide	10	1-5 Student = 5 6-20 Student = 1 Maximum FW per Faculty per semester = 3
Comprehensive Exam COM		ALL	0	0	0	0.00	NA	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University-Wide	1	Service to University
Qualifying Exam QUA		ALL	0	0	0	0.00	NA	Instructor name must be assigned to CRN in Banner schedule	University-Wide	1	Service to University

University and Community Service (Non-instructional)

2-A – Course and Program – Related

Regular Faculty can't exceed 6 hours release time

Type	Measurement Type	Measurement Type	Non-Instructional Workload	Evidence	Comments
Coordination	Course Section - Regular Courses	Course Section - Regular Courses	0.5 per CRN Per faculty	Non-instructional release form with evidence	One faculty only with multiple sections
	Capstones (Senior Design Projects) course section	Capstones (Senior Design Projects) course section	.5 to 1 per CRN per faculty	Non-instructional release form with evidence	0-15 students .5 workload, more than 15, 1 hour -One faculty must meet numbers
	Program	Program	1 per faculty per program	Non-instructional release form with evidence	one faculty per program
Accreditation Committees	Per committee for all committee members	Per committee for all committee members	3.00	Non-instructional release form with evidence of committee formation, showing members	At the time of self-study report submission
New Course Development	per course for 1st semester	per course for 1st semester	1 per course per faculty	Non-instructional release form with evidence	Divided if more than one, after course is developed

2-C – Miscellaneous Non-Instructional

Type	Measurement Type	Measurement Type	Non-Instructional Workload	Evidence	Comments
Champions Advising for high risk students	Per faculty	Per faculty	0.50	Non-instructional release form with evidence	Champions advising students at risk, 20 students or more
Special Activity	Per faculty	Per faculty	0.5-10	Non-instructional release form with evidence	At the discretion of the College Dean and approval of the VCAA
University Committees	Per faculty	Per faculty	0.5-10	Non-instructional release form with evidence	Assignment by Chancellor or VCAA decrees
Exhibition Curator	Per faculty	Per faculty	0.50	Non-instructional release form with evidence	Impactful Exhibitions/enhance visibility off-campus with mainstream media coverage
International Conference & Symposium	Per faculty	Per faculty	1.00	Non-instructional release form with evidence	Chair of Scientific/Organizing Committee decided by the Dean
Active Research Faculty	Per faculty	Per faculty	3.00	Non-instructional release form with evidence	Varies based on College Average Performance
Intensive Research Faculty	Per faculty	Per faculty	6.00	Non-instructional release form with evidence	Varies based on College Average Performance

3.11.4 Workload Reduction

- Minimum direct teaching load for faculty with non-administrative duties is 6 credit hours per semester.
- The department courses should be fully covered regardless of the proposed profile.
- Workload will be applied yearly.
- Part-time appointments are not allowed, and no overload compensation shall be offered (unless there is a sudden increase in enrolment).
- Load Release is based on achievements over the LAST YEAR (Jan.1st -Dec 31st), an official request of the faculty and approval of the Department Chair and the Dean.
- Reductions may be cumulative but shall not exceed 6CH.
- Eligible faculty are ranked based on the “coefficient of Performance (CoP) of faculty over the last year (Jan.1st -Dec 31st).

Faculty Profile	C H	Innovative and Impactful Output, and Scholarly and Creative Research with International Reach
Regular Faculty	0	The baseline per year:

		2 Scopus publications or 2 A (1) publications or 2 internationally recognized scholarly or creative outputs, or combination of any of the above.
Active Research Faculty	3	In addition to the baseline, must have achieved in the previous year (from submission time) the following: ▪ 2 Scopus Q1(A) publications, or 2 Patents or 2 externally funded projects or 2 international competitive award-recognition for a practice-based project, or two of any combination of the above. ▪ The faculty must be the main author (First author for papers or PI for externally funded projects) in the above. ▪ Faculty must have UoS affiliation at the date of submission of the publication. The same condition applies to supervised students who are co-authoring the publications. ▪ Eligible faculty are ranked based on the faculty performance over the last year as quantified by the “coefficient of Performance (CoP)” defined below.
Intensive Research Faculty	6	In addition to the baseline, must have achieved over the last year (from submission time) the following ▪ 4 Scopus Q1(A) publications, or 4 Patents or 4 externally funded projects or 4 international competitive award-recognition for a practice-based project, or 4 of any combination of the above. ▪ The faculty must be the main author (First author for papers or PI for externally funded projects) in the above. ▪ Faculty must have UoS affiliation at the date of submission of the publication. The same condition applies to supervised students co-authoring the publications. ▪ Eligible faculty are ranked based on the faculty performance over the last year as quantified by the “coefficient of Performance (CoP)” defined below.
Lecturer/Senior Lecturer Researcher	3	In addition to the baseline, faculty must have achieved over the last year the following: ▪ 2 SCOPUS Q1(A) publications or 2 externally funded projects or international competitive award recognition for a practice-based Project or any combination of two of the above. ▪ Must be main author in 2 of the above
New Faculty	3	▪ 3CH reduction in the first semester only. ▪ Eligible for load reduction after one year of service at UoS.

3.11.5 Procedure

- **Annual Workload Plan:** Each faculty member will develop an annual workload plan in consultation with their department chair, outlining their teaching, research, service, and administrative commitments for the upcoming academic year.
- **Approval Process:** The department chair will review and approve the workload plan, ensuring it aligns with departmental goals and university policies. Final approval rests with the dean.
- **Annual Evaluation:** At the end of each academic year, the department chair will evaluate the faculty member's performance against the workload plan, providing feedback and recommendations for the next year.
- **Faculty Profile Workload Release Classification:** University of Sharjah faculty are classified into the following profiles:
 - **"A" Regular Faculty (Assistant, Associate, Full Professor)** is devoted to developing and delivering undergraduate and graduate courses, conducting research, and performing service. The baseline teaching load for this category is 12 credit hours per semester.
 - **"B" Active Research Faculty** has high research productivity compared to regular faculty. The teaching load for this category is 9 credit hours per semester.
 - **"C" Research Intensive Faculty** has exceptionally high research productivity. The teaching load is 6 credit hours per semester.
 - **"D" Teaching Track Faculty** are excellent in teaching and are expected to conduct educational and pedagogic applied publishable research. The teaching load is 15 credit hours per semester.
 - **"E" Lecturer** is mainly devoted to teaching and services. The teaching load for lecturers is 15 credit hours per semester.
 - **"F" Instructor** is mainly devoted to teaching and services. The teaching load for instructors is 20 credit hours per semester.
 - **"G" Lecturer or Senior Lecturer Researcher** is devoted to teaching, research, and services. The teaching load for Lecturer Researcher is 12 credit hours per semester.
 - **"H" Special Assignment** is dedicated to faculty assigned an administration or professional service task by the Dean, such as the Chair of the college teaching and learning committee or accreditation committee. The teaching load is at least 9 credit hours per semester.

Coefficient of Performance CoP

$$CoP = \sum_{i=1}^N n_i IF_i$$

where n_i is the number of publications of Impact Factor IF_i over the last year

- Sum is limited to a maximum number $N=10$.
- **IF =3** for **Patents**
- For Externally Funded Projects IF is calculated as follows:
 $IF = \text{Project Budget} / \text{AED}100K$
Example: For a project with AED 400K budget $IF=4$

For papers/patents that are co-authored by collaborators outside UoS, n_i is taken as the fraction of authors from UoS. For example, for a paper co-authored by 2 authors from UoS and 3 from outside, $n_i=2/5$

3.12 Academic Integrity and Student Honor Code

At the University of Sharjah, upholding Arab and Islamic culture and values is of utmost importance in all aspects of our academic community. Ethical conduct and integrity principles bind all members of the university, and the Honor Code serves as a means to foster these principles and instill in students the importance of academic honesty. Students are entrusted with the primary responsibility for maintaining academic integrity, and faculty members play a vital role in upholding the honor system. They not only make students aware of the honor code's significance but also ensure the integrity of all submitted academic work.

The Deanship of Students Affairs oversees investigations into any alleged misconduct, be it behavioral or academic, and handles the discipline process. To educate students and faculty on academic integrity, the Student Handbook dedicates a section to Academic Violations, where plagiarism, complicity in academic dishonesty, and cheating are discussed in detail.

In our roles as scholars, educators, and members of the scholarly community, faculty adhere to a professional code of ethics, which encompasses integrity, honesty, fairness, collegiality, and a commitment to scholarly inquiry free from constraints. The faculty is dedicated to the pursuit of truth within their respective subjects, continuously striving to enhance their scholarly competence, and exercising critical self-discipline and judgment in expanding and sharing knowledge.

In our capacity as teachers, we value the academic freedom of our students and hold ourselves to the highest scholarly and ethical standards within our disciplines. We treat students with respect, serving as intellectual guides, and ensure honest academic conduct while evaluating their performance objectively. Confidentiality between faculty and students is maintained, and any academic or scholarly assistance received from students is acknowledged. Exploitation, harassment, or discrimination of students is strictly avoided, and academic freedom is safeguarded.

As colleagues, we promote a culture of mutual respect and intellectual freedom. We do not discriminate against or harass our fellow colleagues, and we value and defend their right to pursue free inquiry. In exchanges of ideas and criticism, we demonstrate respect for differing opinions and acknowledge academic debt while maintaining objectivity in our professional judgments.

As members of the university community, we adhere to the institution's regulations while maintaining our academic freedom to criticize and seek revision when necessary. We recognize our responsibilities within the university and the impact of our actions on the institution's programs. In our interactions with other UAE residents, we uphold our obligations and consider their urgency in light of our responsibilities to our subject, students, profession, and university. When we speak or act as private individuals, we ensure that our actions do not create the impression that we represent our college or university.

Given that our profession relies on freedom for its health and integrity, we hold a special obligation to foster an environment conducive to free inquiry and a deeper understanding of academic freedom. By promoting these conditions, we ensure the continuous growth and advancement of knowledge within our academic community.

3.13 Professional Ethics and Disciplinary Actions

The University of Sharjah's core mission in teaching, research, and community service relies on the adherence of all community members to ethical and professional standards and laws. This section outlines the required professional and ethical guidelines for the University community and establishes procedures for addressing complaints related to professional misconduct. UoS upholds principles of professional ethics pursuant to Article (41) of University President's Decision No. (3) of 2019, and its faculty and students recognize and adhere to academic integrity standards. The main purposes of the policy herein are to:

- Prevent academic plagiarism, copyright issues, conflict of interest, and misconduct.
- Ensure all practices and behaviors at UoS adhere to professional and ethical standards.
- Outline the professional and ethical guidelines.
- Establish guidelines for disciplinary actions in case of policy violations.

Abbreviations and Definitions

- Article 41: Refers to the relevant section of the University President's Decision No. (3) of 2019, stating the duties and conduct expected from faculty members.
- Allegation of Misconduct: Communication disclosing an allegation against an academic who is believed to have violated ethical or professional conduct.
- Academic: A member of UoS faculty/academic staff as defined in the University President's Decision No. (3) of 2019.
- Complainant: The person making the misconduct allegation.
- Anonymous Allegation: A complaint lacking sufficient information to identify the complainant.
- Malicious Allegation: A complaint with harmful intent to defame another member of the University community.

- Whistleblower: A person reporting misconduct or wrongdoing through the University-approved portal.
- Fabrication: Intentional misrepresentation of data or results.
- Forgery: Deliberate manipulation or misrepresentation of material, data, or results.
- Authorship: Determining the contributors to a scientific publication based on their substantial contribution to research design, methods, and content.
- Initial Inquiry: Fact-finding procedure to determine whether an allegation warrants further investigation.
- Preliminary Inquiry Committee: A standing committee appointed by the Chancellor to assess the seriousness of complaints and allegations.
- Investigation: A formal and in-depth assessment of alleged misconduct to determine appropriate action.
- Plagiarism: Appropriating another person's words, ideas, findings, or work without proper acknowledgment.
- Self-Citation: Reusing elements of one's previously published work without appropriate acknowledgment.
- Collusion: Concealing someone else's work in a joint scholarly work or allowing others to copy someone else's work as their own.
- Fair Use: Waiving breach of copyright laws for limited or transformative purposes such as criticism, commentary, teaching, scholarship, or research.
- Professional Misconduct: Breach of conduct recognized in a relevant profession, including conflict of interest, misuse of funds, and breach of professional ethics.
- Research Misconduct: Fabrication, forgery, or plagiarism in proposing, implementing, reviewing, or reporting research results.

3.13.1 Policy Statements on Professional Ethics

- UoS academics shall uphold the highest standards of academic and ethical principles, ensuring intellectual and scholarly integrity without compromising academic integrity.
- Academics shall avoid conflicts of interest and uphold professional conduct.
- Academics shall hold their students and research assistants to scholarly ethical standards.
- Academics shall respect and mentor their students, ensuring fair and merit-based evaluation.
- Academics shall foster collegial relationships, respecting the opinions of others.
- Academics shall adhere to institution policies and procedures, striving to be effective educators and scholars.
- Academics shall give due notice of their intentions to leave the University, understanding the consequences.
- Misconduct does not require intent and shall be investigated according to institutional procedures.
- UoS has no statute of limitations for professional misconduct and may take action for violations during academic employment.

- Disciplinary actions for confirmed misconduct shall be managed within the policy guidelines.
- Retaliation against those involved in an investigation is prohibited, and penalties shall be enforced for intimidation or retaliation.
- Malicious reports will not be tolerated, and penalties shall be enforced against complainants with malicious intent.
- The policy shall undergo periodic review to adhere to international standards, following standard approval procedures.

3.13.2 Procedures Duty to Report and Investigate Misconduct:

1. All UoS community members shall act with the highest standards of professional and moral ethics.
2. All UoS community members shall report any misconduct violating UoS policies and bylaws.
3. All procedures for inquiry and investigation shall remain confidential.
4. The Chancellor shall be notified upon receiving a report through the whistleblower portal to determine appropriate action:
 - a. If the allegation is from a complainant, the Preliminary Inquiry Committee shall conduct an initial inquiry. Based on their recommendation, the Chancellor may dismiss or appoint an official investigation committee.
 - b. If the allegation is anonymous and warrants an initial inquiry, the Preliminary Inquiry Committee shall conduct it. Based on their recommendation, the Chancellor may dismiss or appoint an official investigation committee.
 - c. Anonymous allegations lacking evidence shall be dismissed.

3.13.3 Publishing and Plagiarism:

1. UoS publications shall include the University's affiliation address.
2. Academic and research integrity is paramount at UoS, and plagiarism is prohibited.
3. The severity of plagiarism shall be determined based on the extent of similarity to other works.
4. Self-plagiarism and citation errors shall be investigated and corrected.

3.13.4 Authorship:

1. Academics shall acknowledge significant contributions from students and research assistants.
2. Violations of authorship shall be categorized as disputes or misconduct and shall be investigated accordingly.

3.13.5 Professional Conduct and Observation of UAE Laws:

Academics must comply with UAE laws and regulations while working at UoS.

3.13.6 Penalties:

1. Decisions shall be evidence-based, and the severity of penalties shall match the proven misconduct.
2. Dismissal for cause is the most severe penalty imposed upon a faculty member.
3. Proven misconduct shall prohibit the use of published work for evaluation and promotion and shall be excluded from academic resumes at UoS.

3.13.7 Whistleblower Protection Policy

The University of Sharjah is committed to upholding the highest standards of ethical conduct, integrity, and transparency. This Whistleblower Protection Policy ensures that faculty and academic staff who report misconduct, unethical behavior, or violations of university policies are protected from retaliation.

A “whistleblower” is any member of the faculty who, in good faith, reports suspected:

- Academic misconduct or research fraud.
- Misuse of university resources or financial fraud.
- Discrimination, harassment, or retaliation.
- Violation of laws, regulations, or university policies.

Reporting Procedure

- Reports should be submitted confidentially through the designated online whistleblower portal or to the Office of Legal Counsel.
- Reports may be made anonymously but must contain sufficient information to be actionable.

Non-Retaliation Clause

The university strictly prohibits any form of retaliation against whistleblowers. Faculty who engage in retaliation may be subject to disciplinary action, including termination.

Investigation and Confidentiality

- All reports will be investigated promptly, fairly, and discreetly.

- Investigations will maintain confidentiality to the greatest extent possible.
- The whistleblower may be informed of the investigation's outcome where appropriate.

False Claims

Deliberately false or malicious reports are not protected under this policy and may result in disciplinary measures.

3.14 Faculty Discipline and Grievance

3.14.1 Disciplinary Measures

At the University of Sharjah, faculty have a duty to carry out their academic responsibilities in compliance with all applicable laws, regulations, and university decisions. Embracing collegiality among fellow faculty and maintaining positive relations with students and the community, both within and outside the University, are essential values rooted in the Arab-Islamic society of the UAE. It is imperative for faculty to refrain from engaging in any activities that may tarnish the reputation of the University or its employees, as such actions could lead to disciplinary measures as outlined below.

1. Investigations/Disciplinary Hearings

When certain offenses are alleged, the Chancellor shall appoint a faculty member, whose rank is at least equivalent to that of the accused faculty member, to conduct a thorough investigation of the alleged offense. The findings of the investigation shall be compiled in a detailed report containing clear recommendations. The Chancellor shall then decide on appropriate action, which may include issuing a letter of reprimand, forwarding the case to the Disciplinary Council, or taking any other necessary measures. The confidentiality of all aspects of the case shall be strictly maintained, and proper legal procedures shall be followed.

2. Disciplinary Process

As a precautionary measure, the Chancellor may suspend the faculty member under investigation from their duties for a maximum of three months, if deemed necessary for the investigation. The suspension period may only be extended by a decision from the Disciplinary Council. Unless otherwise specified by the Disciplinary Council, suspension from duty also results in the suspension of salaries from the date of the suspension decision. If the case is not referred to the Disciplinary Council within one month after the suspension decision, the suspension shall be revoked, and the Disciplinary Council's decision shall be enforced.

3. Notification and Right to Defense

The faculty member under investigation shall be sent a detailed report of the accusations against them, along with a copy of the investigator's findings, via registered mail at least fifteen days before the disciplinary session. The faculty member has the right to be informed of the findings and is entitled to seek defense through a lawyer or another faculty member before the Disciplinary Council.

4. Composition of the Disciplinary Council

The Disciplinary Council for faculty shall consist of the Vice-Chancellor for Academic Affairs as Chair. In the Vice-Chancellor's absence or due to a legal or compelling reason, a designated representative may take this position. The Dean of the College to which the faculty member under investigation belongs shall also be part of the Council, along with a faculty member chosen by the Chancellor and the faculty member assigned to conduct the investigation.

5. Disciplinary Measures

The Disciplinary Council has the authority to impose various disciplinary measures, including:

- a. Warning.
- b. Reprimand.
- c. Reprimand with a one-year suspension of annual increment or promotion to a higher rank.
- d. Reprimand with partial or total suspension of salary for up to six months.
- e. Termination of the contract, with or without full rights to salaries and indemnities.

6. Issuing Disciplinary Actions

The penalties of a warning may be issued by the Department Chair, with the faculty member having the right to appeal to the Dean within seven days. The Dean may issue the penalties mentioned in (a) and (b) above, and the faculty member may appeal within seven days to the Chancellor. In more severe cases, the Chancellor may impose the penalties in successive order. The Disciplinary Council has the authority to issue any penalty mentioned above.

7. Final Decisions and Grievances

The decisions of the Disciplinary Council are considered final, and any grievances against these decisions may be directed to the President within two weeks of notification. The President's decision on the matter shall be conclusive and not subject to further appeal.

8. Resignation Does Not Void the Case

The investigation case is not rendered void if the faculty member under investigation submits their resignation.

9. Separation from Criminal or Civil Proceedings

Disciplinary measures taken against a faculty member shall not affect any concurrent criminal or civil proceedings related to the same event that led to the disciplinary action.

3.14.2 Faculty Grievance

a) Filing a Grievance

A Faculty member may file a written and signed grievance with the Chair of the Faculty Grievance Committee within sixty calendar days of the administrative action or inaction prompting the grievance, or within sixty calendar days of first becoming aware of such action or inaction.

b) The Faculty Grievance Committee

The Faculty Grievance Committee, composed of seven faculty members elected annually from the faculty at-large, shall be responsible for addressing grievances. The Committee shall elect a Chair from its members. Any Committee member with a conflict of interest that may impede impartial decision-making may dismiss themselves, or the Committee may dismiss a member by majority vote. The grievant may also challenge a Committee member's impartiality, and the Committee may dismiss the member by majority vote.

c) Informal Resolution

Upon filing a grievance, the Committee Chair may suspend any applicable time frames to permit informal discussions or mediation to resolve the grievance. If all parties involved sign a confidential, written statement describing the resolution, the grievance shall be considered informally resolved.

d) The Grievance Hearing

The Faculty Grievance Committee shall hold a hearing within thirty days of receiving the written grievance, providing written notice of the date and time to all parties. The hearing may be open to the public unless one or both parties request a closed hearing. Legal representation is generally not permitted, except when the individual is facing criminal charges related to the grievance. The grievant bears the responsibility of demonstrating the merits of their grievance during the hearing, showing by a preponderance of evidence that the action or inaction in question adversely affected them and that an appropriate remedy is warranted.

e) Conduct of the Hearing

During the hearing, both the faculty member and the University administrator responsible for the action or inaction being contested have the opportunity to make opening and closing statements, examine and cross-examine witnesses, and present documentary evidence. The Faculty Grievance Committee may contact witnesses upon request, ensuring their appearance at the hearing, unless the Committee Chair determines it to be unreasonable or irrelevant to the issues at hand. The Committee Chair is responsible for conducting the hearing efficiently and professionally, ruling on all procedural and substantive matters. Formal rules of evidence do not apply to the hearing.

f) Deliberations, Findings, and Recommendations

The Faculty Grievance Committee shall deliberate privately, without recording the proceedings, and shall prepare a written report of its findings, including reasons for its decisions, recommendations, and any dissent. The report shall be shared with the Chancellor and all parties involved within ten days after the hearing concludes.

g) Written Exceptions

The faculty member may file written exceptions to the Faculty Grievance Committee's report within five working days after receiving it. Exceptions may be based on specific grounds, such as procedural errors, bias, inconsistent or excessive penalties, or failure to consider all evidence.

h) Chancellor's Decision

Within ten days of receiving the Faculty Grievance Committee's report or the faculty member's written exceptions, the Chancellor shall report in writing to all parties and the Chair of the Faculty Grievance Committee, providing the final decision and any proposed actions. While the Chancellor typically weighs heavily on the Committee's findings and recommendations, an explanation shall be provided if the recommendations are not implemented.

Chapter 4: Appointment Benefits

4.1 Basic Salary

The University of Sharjah offers a competitive basic salary based on faculty rank and specialization, following the salary scale below:

Academic Rank	Basic Monthly Salary (AED)
Professor	30,576 – 43,860
Associate Professor	25,318 – 37,926
Assistant Professor	20,142 – 31,674
Lecturer	14,242 – 23,022
Instructor	18,744 – 22,744

- At the of their service, faculty members will receive an end-of-service salary equivalent to one month's salary for each year served.
- Faculty engaged in clinical activities will be eligible for a clinical allowance ranging from 10% to 20% of the basic salary.

4.2 Monetary Benefits

Faculty members are entitled to various benefits as part of their employment package:

- **Annual Return Air Ticket:** Faculty members, their spouse, and three dependent children are eligible for an annual return air ticket to their home country, as per university regulations.
- **Housing:** Suitable free housing with electricity and water is provided in UoS housing compounds. In case suitable accommodation is unavailable, a housing allowance shall be given according to university regulations.
- **Furniture Allowance:** A one-time furniture allowance of 30,000 Dirhams is provided, which can be utilized over four years.
- **Health Insurance:** Comprehensive health insurance is offered for faculty members, their spouse, and up to three dependent children under 18 years old.
- **Shipment Allowance:** A shipment allowance is provided at the beginning and end of the contract, following university regulations.
- **Children's Education:** An annual children's education allowance of up to 25,000 Dirhams per child (inclusive of textbook fees) is provided, with a maximum of 75,000 Dirhams for all qualifying children from KG1 to the end of their secondary education.
- **Scholarships:** Two scholarships covering tuition fees only for two children studying concurrently at the University of Sharjah to complete a bachelor's degree.

4.3 Leaves and Absences

4.3.1 Vacation Leave

- Vacation days are provided as per the Faculty and Staff Pay Grade and Benefits Chart, including summer vacation, religious and national holidays, and other specified vacations in the academic calendar.
- During mid-semester and final exams, faculty involved in the exam process are expected to conduct exams, even during weekends and regular holidays.

4.3.2 Sick Leave

- Faculty are entitled to sick leave with full pay for up to 15 working days and half pay for an additional 15 working days per contract year. This applies to personal illness or attendance upon an ill immediate family member, either in or out of the UAE.
- If all sick leave days have been utilized, annual vacation leave may be used. In special circumstances, up to an additional 30 days of sick leave without pay may be granted.

4.3.3 Maternity Leave

- Female faculty employed on a full-time basis are entitled to sixty calendar days of maternity leave with full pay. Additional maternity leave without pay, up to a maximum of thirty days, may be approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs.

4.3.4 Unpaid Special Leave

Unpaid special leave, not exceeding thirty days, may be granted upon approval from appropriate University authorities if the employee has no unused vacation leave. The unpaid leave will be deducted from the next month's salary.

4.3.5 Hajj Leave

Muslim faculty attending their first Hajj may receive up to twenty calendar days of paid leave.

4.4 Duplication of Benefits

- If a university employee's spouse also receives benefits from another UAE government or partially owned UAE government entity, duplication of benefits may occur.
- The University will adjust benefits accordingly to avoid duplication.

4.5 Compensation for Administrative Positions

- Compensation for administrative positions includes a monthly amount and a reduction in teaching load for certain faculty roles:
 - **Dean:** Monthly compensation of AED 10,000 and a reduction in teaching load of nine credit hours per semester.
 - **Associate Dean:** Monthly compensation of AED 5,000 and a reduction in teaching load of three to six credit hours per semester.
 - **Assistant Dean:** Monthly compensation of AED 4,000 and a reduction in teaching load of three credit hours per semester.
 - **Chairperson:** Monthly compensation of AED 4,000 and a reduction in teaching load of three to six credit hours.
 - **Director of a Unit:** Monthly compensation of AED 2,000 to AED 3,000 and a reduction in teaching load of three to six credit hours.
 - **Program Coordinator:** Monthly compensation of AED 2,000 and a reduction in teaching load of three credit hours.

4.6 Annual Incentives for Distinguished Faculty Members

The “Annual Bonus Award for Outstanding Faculty” is a prestigious recognition bestowed upon distinguished academic faculty at the University of Sharjah who have exhibited exceptional academic achievements. This award serves as an incentive, motivating UoS faculty to strive for excellence in their teaching, research, administrative, and community service endeavors. It is important to note that the award shall not impact the monthly salary of faculty members.

4.6.1 Rationale for the Award

The University of Sharjah places immense value on recognizing and rewarding outstanding academic performance among its faculty members. The Annual Bonus Award is designed to serve the following purposes:

1. **Retention of Excellence:** By rewarding exceptional faculty, the University aims to retain and nurture its top talent, fostering a stimulating academic environment.
2. **Competitive Incentive:** Offering merit-based incentives ensures that UoS remains competitive with other UAE-based universities that provide similar recognition programs.
3. **Acknowledgment of Contributions:** The award seeks to acknowledge the strong contributions made by faculty, benefiting specific programs, colleges, and the overall objectives of the University.

4.6.2 Applicants' Performance Evaluation

Candidates for the Annual Bonus Award shall be evaluated based on their professional responsibilities in the following areas:

1. **Teaching and Curriculum Development**
2. **Research and Scholarly Activities**
3. **University and Community Service**
4. **Administrative Responsibilities**

The University's annual evaluation system for faculty members shall serve as one of the criteria for nominating eligible candidates for the award. Recognizing that activities may vary across academic units, faculty shall collaborate with the Department Chair/Director of their academic unit to set goals and objectives relevant to their program's aspirations. The "Annual Plan of Faculty Member Activities," a standard UoS form, shall be used for this purpose.

4.6.3 Areas for the Award

Candidates applying for the award must have demonstrated exceptional performance in one of the following areas:

1. **Research and Scholarly Activities**
2. **Teaching and Curriculum Development**
3. **University and Community Service**

Faculty members may apply for only one area, and a professional performance portfolio for each candidate shall be maintained in the Dean's Office. The portfolio should encompass essential information, including faculty annual report forms, course teaching records, teaching evaluations, publications, performances and presentations, university and community service contributions, and administrative responsibilities.

4.6.4 Conditions for Granting the Award

The process for awarding the Annual Bonus entails the following conditions:

1. **Clear and Excellent Performance:** Faculty members must demonstrate outstanding performance in the area they have applied for, attaining a score of over 90%. Additionally, they should exhibit very good performance (over 80%) in the other areas.
2. **Limited Eligibility:** The award shall be granted to approximately 10% of the University's faculty members.
3. **Yearly Application:** Faculty members are eligible to apply for the award every year.

4. **Performance Assessment Period:** The academic performance of applicants shall be evaluated over the immediately preceding two academic years.
5. **Application Procedure:** Applicants for the award must submit their applications, supported by evidence of distinction, to their department's chair.
6. **Evaluation Committees:** Department and college-level committees, free from any conflict of interest, shall assess the applications and submit their reports to the Chancellor of the University.

4.6.5 Award Finances

To support the Annual Bonus Award, the University Chancellor allocates a lump sum equal to 5% of the rare specialization a Full Professor's annual salary in the first year of the salary scale designated to this rank, multiplied by the number of faculty members at the University. This sum shall be distributed as follows:

1. **Allocation Percentage:** A maximum of 10% of the faculty members shall be eligible for the award each year.
2. **Award Amounts:** The bonus award shall be presented as a lump sum/bonus payment, with the following amounts for each winner:
 - a. AED 20,000 for distinction in Research and Scholarly Activities
 - b. AED 15,000 for distinction in Teaching and Curriculum Development
 - c. AED 10,000 for distinction in University and Community Service

4.6.6 Institutional Guidelines

1. **Eligibility:** To be eligible for the award, a faculty member must be full-time and have completed at least two academic years at UoS by the time of submitting the Annual Activity Report. Faculty members may apply for the bonus award in consecutive years. Parttime and visiting faculty members are not eligible for the bonus award.
2. **Performance Reviews:** College Deans and Department Chairs are responsible for conducting annual performance reviews for all faculty, utilizing the standardized UoS form. Timely completion of documented performance reviews is crucial to the successful implementation of the Bonus Award Program, ensuring that all faculty are aware of the policy and guidelines for the award.

4.7 Demise Policy

The University of Sharjah (UoS) recognizes the importance of providing support and assistance to the faculty's family members contracted on secondment or through personal contracts in the unfortunate event of their demise. The Demise Policy outlines the compassionate provisions to be offered to the dependents in such difficult circumstances:

1. **Immediate Financial Assistance:** Upon the demise of a faculty member, the dependent family members shall receive the total salary for the month in which the death occurs. This one-time payment offers immediate financial support to help cope with the initial challenges.
2. **Extended Financial Support:** In addition to the first-month salary, the University extends further assistance by providing the total of the next three months' salary to the dependent family members. This extended financial support aims to alleviate financial burdens during the initial period of grief and adjustment.
3. **End-of-Service Gratuity:** The family of the deceased faculty member shall also be entitled to an end-of-service gratuity. This gratuity shall be equivalent to one month's salary for each year of service completed by the faculty member. For service periods of less than one year, the gratuity shall be pro-rated accordingly.
4. **Repatriation and Bereavement Assistance:** The University acknowledges the importance of honoring the deceased faculty member's final wishes and offers support in the following ways:
 - Preparation of the deceased faculty member's body: The University shall bear the expenses for the respectful preparation of the deceased faculty member's body.
 - Transportation: The University shall cover the costs associated with transporting the deceased faculty member's body to their home country.
 - Return of Family and Belongings: The University shall also cover the expenses for the return journey of the deceased faculty member's family to their home country, along with their belongings.

For faculty members contracted on secondment or through personal contracts, if one of their dependents passes away during the contract period, the University shall extend its support by covering the expenses for the preparation and transportation of the deceased dependent's body. Additionally, a return ticket for one family member shall be provided by the University, easing the burden of travel arrangements during such a difficult time.

The Demise Policy reflects the University's commitment to caring for its faculty members and their families, providing necessary support, and expressing sincere condolences during times of loss and bereavement.

Chapter 5: Faculty Development

Faculty development activities at the University of Sharjah are structured to cater to the diverse needs of faculty and are implemented at both the Department and University-wide levels. The responsibilities are divided as follows:

Department Level: Each department takes on the primary responsibility of addressing the individual needs of its faculty. They achieve this through various means, including providing travel funds, offering reassigned time, providing mentoring support, and implementing a range of less visible yet impactful activities tailored to individual requirements.

University Level: The University oversees faculty development programs that have a broader impact, benefiting the entire institution. These programs are designed to be relevant and valuable to faculty across different disciplines. While departments handle faculty development with a sense of coherence under the guidance of the department chair and department council, University-level faculty development may lack such centralization.

5.1 Goals and Objectives

The central goal of faculty development is to enhance instruction by equipping faculty with valuable information on teaching techniques, research tools, and current pedagogical issues in higher education. This empowers faculty to better support student learning and academic growth. Additional objectives of faculty development include promoting the professional and personal development of faculty, ultimately contributing to enhanced instruction and research outcomes.

The Program for Development and Support of Advanced Teaching Methods focuses on continually improving teaching methodologies and integrating advanced information technology into education. Its key objectives include:

- A. Moving from individual attempts to institutionalized efforts.
- B. Establishing a self-sustained knowledge-based in advanced teaching methods.
- C. Implementing and applying advanced teaching methods effectively.
- D. Initiating a mechanism for course development.
- E. Providing a platform for the creation and effective use of interactive learning environments.
- F. Encouraging and supporting the adoption of educational technology.
- G. Raising awareness of academic accreditation standards.
- H. Fostering a sense of community at the University and promoting collaborative relationships among participants.

5.2 Categories of Faculty Development

Faculty development activities at the University of Sharjah can be broadly classified into three categories:

1. **Instructional Development:** Programs under this category focus on enhancing teaching effectiveness. They include activities such as peer coaching, classroom performance videotaping, and conferences and workshops on effective teaching strategies.
2. **Professional Development:** These programs aim to cultivate faculty members' expertise and proficiency within their academic disciplines.
3. **Organizational Development:** Activities in this category foster faculty growth within the academic community of the University. They are geared towards promoting the overall health and welfare of the institution. Examples include new faculty orientation, university strategy, and accreditation/reaccreditation activities.

Faculty development is a joint responsibility between the University and its faculty. The University provides a range of continuous opportunities for faculty to enhance their effectiveness in fulfilling the institution's mission. Simultaneously, each faculty member is encouraged to develop individual strategies aligned with the academic programs and expectations of the University, college, and department. By working together, faculty development at the University of Sharjah continually evolves to meet the diverse needs of its esteemed faculty community.

5.2 New Faculty Development Training

At the University of Sharjah, we value the growth and success of our faculty, as their expertise directly impacts our students' learning experiences and the overall quality of service delivery. To uphold our commitment to professional development, the Institute of Leadership in Higher Education (ILHE) offers a comprehensive training program tailored for new faculty. This program, encompasses various elements aimed at equipping new faculty with the necessary tools for seamless teaching and fostering exceptional learning experiences for our students.

ILHE collaborates closely with colleges and departments within the University to ensure the effectiveness of the training. Colleges play a supervisory role in supporting departments with resources to implement policies that enhance teaching and learning, including incentives and rewards supported by University Administration.

The Program developed by ILHE comprises a wide array of training events and activities focusing on innovative teaching methodologies, assessment techniques, educational technology integration, and curriculum redesign. Additionally, new faculty undergo a comprehensive orientation, acquainting them with the University's policies and preferred innovative teaching and learning strategies.

Mentoring plays a pivotal role in academic and professional growth. Therefore, ILHE works with colleges and departments to train selected mentors who shall engage in collaborative and mutually beneficial peer learning with new faculty. This collaborative journey enables both mentors and mentees to enhance their personal and professional development. ILHE provides mentoring training, including collaborative and reverse mentoring techniques, mentor-mentee selection, and facilitation of the process. Regular debriefing is also emphasized to ensure the effectiveness of the mentoring scheme.

To foster personal and professional growth, ILHE works with colleges to develop peer learning observation initiatives. Additionally, faculty learning communities are established, providing a safe space for discussing teaching, learning, and individual emotions in a non-judgmental and collegial environment.

5.2.1 Program Details and Workshop Content

The New Faculty Development Training program aims to enhance the pedagogical skills of newly graduated academics joining the University of Sharjah as faculty. The Program covers various thematic areas, including:

1. **Pedagogical:** Focusing on psychological processes of learning, effective instructional design for employability, advanced presentation skills, assessment strategies, grading rubrics development, and engaging and motivating students.
2. **Technological:** Equipping faculty with practical teaching techniques using technology, hyflex tools and practices, interactive course creation and delivery in Blackboard, utilizing assignment tools and rubrics, and engaging students through various online learning tools.
3. **Institutional:** Familiarizing new faculty with the University's strategic direction, academic integrity, holistic advising, program development, accreditation processes, and examination rules and regulations.
4. **Research:** Enhancing faculty research skills by offering training on research grant proposal writing, SoTL and action research methodologies, qualitative and statistical data analysis (using tools like STATA, SPSS, and Nvivo), and advancing practice in higher education through evaluation.

ILHE provides ongoing one-to-one customized training, classroom observations, and constructive feedback through debriefing sessions. Additionally, faculty learning communities at the college level and an online collaborative knowledge-sharing community foster a supportive environment for discussions and personal development. The training concludes with evaluations in the form of written exams and capstone projects, where new faculty can implement innovative pedagogies, drawing on the training contents.

5.3 Faculty Peer Observation of Teaching

The University of Sharjah places a strong emphasis on quality education and continuous professional development for its faculty. As part of this commitment, the University has established the Faculty Peer Observation of Teaching (PoT) program, a voluntary and formative learning process designed to promote the enhancement of teaching practices through collaborative analysis and feedback from peers. Unlike traditional Peer Review of Teaching, which serves as an appraisal tool, the PoT program fosters a supportive and unofficial culture of professional learning among faculty members.

To ensure the effective implementation of the PoT program, a council comprising faculty members who have been awarded the university teaching award is to be formed. These faculty members shall serve as the nucleus of observers and shall receive specialized training in PoT through the Institute of Higher Education Leadership. The council members shall initially pilot the program among themselves, refining the observation system and tools. Once perfected, the program will be systematically expanded across the university. As the initiative progresses, additional observers will be appointed, and they too shall undergo comprehensive training.

The PoT process incorporates the principles of a Community of Practice (CoP) philosophy, fostering a non-threatening and secure environment for collaborative learning. The voluntary nature of peer observation allows faculty members to undertake it as needed. The PoT process involves the following key stages:

12. Pre-observation Conference:

- Establishing genuine two-way communication between the observer and the observed.
- Discussing and agreeing upon the objectives of the supervision cycle.
- Clarifying the expectations of the observer and the faculty member during the observation.

12. Classroom Observation:

- The observer attends the class session, instructional segment, or specific lesson to collect agreed-upon data.
- Observations focus on the designated objectives, avoiding value judgments and subjective opinions.

12. Observation Analysis and Strategy Session:

- The observer reflects on the class observation and organizes the collected data.
- Decisions are made on how best to utilize the data to support the faculty member's objectives.

12. Post-observation Session:

- The faculty member and the observer meet privately to discuss the observation and data analysis.
- The observer elicits feedback directly from the faculty member about the lesson and data analysis.
- Strategies for improvement and future observations are discussed.

5.3.1 Benefits

The Faculty Peer Observation of Teaching provides valuable opportunities for mutual learning and professional growth. It facilitates intellectual conversations, fosters innovative teaching practices, encourages reflective practices, and strengthens interpersonal and team management skills. Through PoT, faculty build their confidence, develop an effective work ethic, and contribute to a collegial work environment.

The PoT initiative targets several groups of faculty members to support their professional development:

- New faculty in their first year of appointment at the University.
- Faculty new to the higher education teaching and learning environment.
- Faculty with lower students' evaluations.
- Any faculty member seeking to enhance their instructional practices.

5.3.2 Implementation Stages

The implementation of the PoT initiative at the University involves the following stages:

- Stage 1: Orientation session/workshop to familiarize participants with the program's purpose and procedures.
- Stage 2: Pilot scheme involving faculty members who have received the University teaching award, sharing lessons learned.
- Stage 3: Faculty members requesting observation from colleagues with teaching expertise or those identified as critical friends.
- Stage 4: Faculty members receiving personalized support based on observed areas for improvement.
- Stage 5: Volunteering faculty members share their experiences in a yearly forum organized by the Institute of Higher Education Leadership.

5.4 Participation in Conferences

The University of Sharjah (UoS) recognizes the immense value of faculty's participation in conferences and seminars organized by scientific and specialized organizations, both at local and international levels. To encourage such scholarly engagement, UoS offers conference travel support to eligible faculty, subject to the following guidelines and conditions:

5.4.1 Policy

- The University is committed to supporting faculty participation in conferences and seminars organized by recognized scientific and specialized organizations at local, regional, and international levels. Such participation is crucial for professional development, networking, and advancing knowledge in various disciplines.
- Applicants must be regular faculty members who have passed the probationary period. Exceptions may be made by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs for cases that provide demonstrable benefits to the University's reputation.
- The University will only cover conference expenses for faculty members who are employed by the University at the time of the conference.
- Support will be provided for participation in well-recognized conferences that add value to both the University and the faculty member.
- Participation in conferences requires proof of publication in a Scopus-indexed outlet. Exceptions may be made for prestigious conferences that do not publish full papers, provided there is a commitment to publish the research in a Scopus-indexed journal afterward.
- Faculty members are allowed to attend a maximum of one international and one local university-supported conference per year, provided it does not conflict with their primary commitments.
- Attendance as plenary, keynote, or invited speakers fully sponsored by external organizations is allowed. If not fully sponsored and meeting the requirements, such attendance will count against the travel limits.
- Conferences supported by external research grants are permitted outside the college-allocated budget, provided they do not conflict with primary commitments and follow the same rules.
- Conferences attended at no cost to the University are discretionary and require the same approval process as cost-based conferences.
- Online conference attendance is treated the same as in-person attendance concerning conference count.
- Faculty teaching summer courses are not allowed to travel for conferences during the summer term.
- No travel is permitted during published exam periods.
- The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs approves travel requests and interprets the policy.

5.4.2 Eligibility and Application

- Faculty must demonstrate, with the approval of the Department Chair, how their teaching will be covered during the conference travel.
- Each college must define and share with its faculty and the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs a list of conferences that are considered:
 - Prestigious in the field.
 - Well recognized in the field.
 - Not recommended.
- The conference must align with the applicant's area of specialization or research agenda.
- The participant must be the main or joint author of the paper and must be the presenter.
- The paper must bear the name of the University of Sharjah.
- Participation in conferences is not permitted during the first and last weeks of teaching or during examination periods.
- Faculty teaching in the summer session are not allowed to attend conferences abroad during that session due to the shortness of the semester.
- University-supported participation without a paper may be permitted with the Chancellor's approval in cases such as:
 - Serving as a main member of the organizing committee.
 - Being a keynote speaker.
 - Participating in scheduled panel discussions.
 - Moderating workshops or sessions.
 - Representing the University in major academic activities.

5.4.3 General Guidelines and Prioritization

- The University allocates an annual budget for each college to cover conference expenses. Funds should be distributed equitably among faculty.
- Faculty priority for funding will consider:
 - Conferences closer to their specialization.
 - Representing the University.
 - Preparing papers upon request by organizers.
 - Holding organizational roles in a conference.
 - Those who have not attended conferences in the current or previous year.
- Participants must submit a report to their Department Chair and Dean's Office upon return.
- Participants must organize a seminar on the conference for their department colleagues.
- Faculty are entitled to participate in one local and one external university-supported conference annually, budget permitting.
- No participation is accepted without an accepted paper unless specially approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs.

5.4.4 Financial Support

The University covers expenses for conference participation, including:

- Per diem rates between AED 1000-1500 for a maximum of four days, depending on the conference location.
- Conference registration fees up to \$750.
- Economy round-trip tickets; summer conferences are limited to travel from the country of residence.
- Local conferences (e.g., Al Ain, Abu Dhabi) are covered for transportation and a per diem up to AED 700 for a maximum of three days.
- Only one paper's expenses will be covered if multiple papers are presented.
- No expenses will be covered if full financial support is provided by an external source.
- Partial financial support is supplemented by the University, not exceeding the allowable compensation.

5.4.5 Required Documentation

Requests must be submitted at least one month before the conference date, including:

- Approval from the concerned college.
- A copy of the full paper or abstract.
- Evidence of the conference's quality, such as the reputation of organizers or keynote speakers.
- Evidence that conference proceedings will be published in a Scopus-indexed outlet or commitment to submit to a Scopus journal within six months.
- A copy of the conference flier with fees stated.
- A final acceptance letter for the paper from organizers.
- Allow sufficient time for review; failure to do so may result in automatic rejection.
- The University is not obligated to reimburse expenses if the application was submitted after the conference dates.
- Conference travel during breaks is subject to the same scrutiny as during regular semesters.
- Uncompensated conference travel may be authorized based on its value to the University and is subject to the same review and approval process as compensated conferences.

5.5 Policy on Offering Courses in the Summer Semester

Courses offered during the summer semester are primarily limited to first and second-year classes. However, third, fourth, and fifth-year courses may be scheduled if a minimum of five students are expected to graduate in that summer semester. The summer schedule is developed by the Registration Department in coordination with the respective departments, with the capacity and number of sections determined according to the regulations that apply to regular semester courses. Teaching methods in the summer shall align with those implemented during the Fall and Spring semesters.

Faculty members who teach during the summer semester are not permitted to apply for participation in any conferences or training outside the University during that period and are required to remain on duty until the full term concludes. Faculty members whose contracts have ended, those who have resigned, and visiting faculty are generally not permitted to teach in the summer. However, in cases of urgent need and the unavailability of specialized faculty, they may be appointed upon the recommendation of the dean of the respective college and with the approval of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs.

The names of instructors assigned to teach summer courses or sections shall be announced in the schedule prior to registration. No changes to the instructor names or "To Be Announced" (TBA) placeholders shall be accepted once the schedule is published. The teaching load for sections will be distributed transparently among the faculty members in the department, alternating among them to ensure fairness.

Postgraduate courses will not be offered during the summer semester, except in exceptional cases, which require the recommendation of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and the approval of the Chancellor. The same rules and regulations, including section capacities and financial compensation, apply to postgraduate courses as they do to undergraduate courses.

Financial compensation for teaching during the summer semester shall be calculated according to the following guidelines:

1. Faculty members' compensation for teaching in the summer semester shall not exceed two months' basic salary.
2. Each teaching or practical training section is considered a single teaching load and is compensated with one month's basic salary, including courses with four credit hours (bachelor's, master's, or doctorate). The following conditions apply:
 - For University requirement courses and multi-sectional courses (theory), including those offered in men's and women's colleges, the minimum capacity must be 30 students per section. If the number falls below this threshold, compensation shall be calculated proportionally based on the number of students. To reach the minimum number of 30 students, male and female sections may be merged using a hybrid model that alternates between the two sections.
 - For single-section third, fourth, and fifth-year courses, the minimum capacity is 20 students, provided at least five students are expected to graduate in the respective summer term.
 - For practical training courses, the minimum section capacity is 30 students. If the number of students is less than 30, faculty members shall be paid a percentage of their basic monthly salary proportional to the number of students.
 - For practical training courses with zero or one credit hour, the teaching load shall be calculated per student (AED 500 per student), with total compensation not exceeding one month's basic salary for the faculty member.

- For practical training courses, compensation shall not exceed one month's basic salary per section, regardless of the number of students above the minimum capacity. Faculty members may only be assigned to teach one additional course besides the practical training course.
 - College deans, institute directors, and other administrators may teach one course only, provided the compensation does not exceed one month's basic salary.
 - For courses with four credit hours that include a laboratory component, the minimum section capacity is 30 students for theoretical courses and 24 students per laboratory section. Faculty shall be compensated with one and a half months' basic salary, with total compensation not exceeding two months' basic salary.
 - For sections with three or four credit hours taught by multiple instructors, the minimum capacity is 30 students. Compensation shall be divided equally among the instructors. If the number of students is below 30, faculty members shall be paid a percentage of their basic monthly salary proportional to the number of students.
3. The minimum capacity for laboratory courses is 24 students. Every two laboratory sections are counted as one teaching load. If the number of students is less than 24, faculty members shall be paid a percentage of their basic monthly salary proportional to the number of students.
4. In some cases, and with the approval of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs, sections with more than 15 students may remain open.

Chapter 6: Performance Evaluation

The University of Sharjah is committed to fostering excellence in teaching and curriculum development, research and scholarship, and university service and community outreach among its faculty. To ensure a comprehensive assessment of faculty performance, an annual evaluation is conducted annually, taking into account their contributions in the areas of teaching and learning, research and scholarly activities, and community service, as well as their impact on the quality and effectiveness of the academic unit, college, and the University and the community as a whole.

6.1 General Evaluation Considerations

- New faculty must undergo a probationary review within the first year of appointment.
- All faculty including those with administrative assignment shall undergo an annual evaluation.
- Depending on a number of factors, such instructional load, release hours and categories, faculty members are evaluated in key performance areas including teaching and learning, research and scholarship, and university and community service.
- Each faculty's unique combination of accomplishments shall be considered, respecting academic fields, specialized interests, and varying professional responsibilities.
- Although relative weights may vary, all faculty are expected to maintain productivity in each of the three areas over time.

6.2 Teaching and Learning Evaluation

Through their teaching, faculty play a crucial role in transmitting knowledge, fostering critical thinking, and engaging students in the learning process. The evaluation of teaching effectiveness includes considerations such as:

- Quality presentation and effective communication tailored to specific subject areas and student demographics.
- Clearly stated course objectives and evidence of employing appropriate teaching and learning methods to achieve these objectives.
- Relevance of subject matter, approach, and evaluation methods.
- Proactive involvement in creating a meaningful learning environment and providing guidance to students.
- Utilization of student evaluations and other mechanisms to assess teaching performance and enhance educational outcomes.
- Innovative course development and the use of technology to improve learning outcomes.
- Advising students and supporting student success.

6.3 Academic Advising

Academic advising is a critical component of a student's educational journey. Faculty are expected to engage actively in advising, helping students navigate their academic choices, degree requirements, and long-term career goals. Advising helps students make informed decisions about their coursework, majors, and post-graduation plans. Through effective advising, faculty not only enhance students' academic success but also contribute to their overall personal and professional development.

Each academic college and its departments implement specific procedures, requirements, and schedules for academic advising, ensuring that students are well-informed about their degree plans, course registration, and academic progress. Faculty advisers, assigned to students based on their chosen field of study, guide students in fulfilling their academic responsibilities and aligning their coursework with their career aspirations. Faculty advisers are expected to refer students to university resources such as the University Counseling Center or Career Services Center, where they can receive career counseling, testing, or vocational aptitude assessments. These resources provide additional support to help students identify their academic and career paths.

Faculty participation in academic advising will be evaluated as part of the overall faculty performance review. Evaluation will include the following aspects:

- **Adherence to Advising Schedules and Procedures:** Faculty will be assessed on their ability to follow the department's advising procedures and meet the scheduled advising commitments.
- **Student Feedback:** Student evaluations will provide insight into the effectiveness of faculty advising. These evaluations will consider how well faculty communicate degree requirements, provide guidance on course selection, and support students in achieving their academic goals.
- **Referrals and Collaboration:** Faculty are expected to demonstrate their ability to refer students to appropriate university services, such as career counseling or testing, when necessary, and collaborate effectively with these units to ensure comprehensive student support.

6.4 Research and Scholarly Activities Evaluation

UoS faculty members are expected to engage in scholarly activities that contribute to their respective disciplines and earn recognition in their fields. The evaluation criteria encompass a range of scholarly contributions, including:

- Publications in esteemed journals and conferences, with special recognition for publications in refereed journals of class (A) and (B).

- Creative works in the arts and humanities, fine arts and design, and media such as published fiction, poetry, film and video, and exhibitions.
- Recognition through awards, grants, contracts, patents, and peer-reviewed accolades.
- Technical innovations and practical applications with professional relevance.
- Adherence to professional standards and ethics governing research activities.
- Supporting graduate students including thesis and dissertation supervision.

6.5 Community Service Evaluation:

Faculty members play an essential role in the University's development and the wider community. The evaluation of service activities includes:

- Administrative duties within the University, including committee work and contributions to unit and college development.
- Participation in professional events, seminars, and workshops relevant to the individual's academic interests or the educational process.
- Involvement in community projects, consulting, and collaborations with external stakeholders.
- Mentoring colleagues and supporting a positive and professional work environment.

6.6 Evaluation Process and Criteria:

- Faculty members shall submit an annual report detailing their teaching and advising activities, research output, professional development, and service contributions.
- The Department Chair and College Dean shall conduct the faculty's evaluation based on their professional responsibilities and performance in the evaluation areas.
- The evaluation criteria encompass specific indicators for teaching, research, and service contributions, including recognized achievements and leadership roles.
- The evaluation process and evaluation ratings should be consistent with and benchmarked against average department and college performance.
- Special considerations, such as administrative appointments, may influence the evaluation.

6.7 Special Issues and Considerations

- The Year of the current academic rank was obtained.
- Number of years in non-academic position after getting the rank.
- Number of years in formal administrative appointments after the rank.
- Number of years of academic service in current rank.
- Professional Ethics.
- Number of years of services at UoS
- Average performance based on the previous evaluation of years of service at the University of Sharjah.



- Leadership and effectiveness of faculty involvement in the establishment of the department, programs and university systems during past years of service at UoS.
- Any formal appointment to an administrative position of direct responsibility (Chair, Dean or Director) for extended periods of time during years of service at UoS.

Key Data Points in Annual Evaluation Process

- Learning Outcomes Attainment by Students
- Quality of Instructional Delivery
- Quality of Students Advising
- End of Course Evaluation by Students.
- Peer Observation
- Research Quality and Productivity in Scopus Q1 and Q2 ranking journals.
- Number of Research Articles, with First Author designation
- Quality of Service Record
- Quality of Professional Development

UOS Faculty Annual Evaluation Process

- 1. CREATE DRAFT PERFORMANCE EVALUATION**
 Create your evaluation as early as you can to enter data anytime. September is a good time to start
- 2. REVIEW PERFORMANCE EVALUATION DATA, PROVIDE SELF-ASSESSMENT**
 Review evaluation data to ensure accuracy, enter any additional data, use evaluation rubric to score each criterion, ensure full accuracy with data points, and data provided.
- 3. SUBMIT EVALUATION TO DEPARTMENT CHAIR FOR REVIEW**
 Evaluation is submitted to Department Chair for Review. A meeting should take place to discuss the evaluation, provide feedback agree on agenda forward, discuss goals, initiatives, growth, etc.
- 4. EVALUATION REVIEWED BY DEPARTMENT CHAIR**
 Department Chair to review accuracy of data input, and benchmark performance across department to ensure full objectivity. Chair to keep in mind the fulfillment of other evaluations, such as promotion, and contract renewal
- 5. EVALUATION REVIEW SENT BACK TO FACULTY FOR ENDORSMENT**
 Faculty to provide consent/no consent on Chair's Review.
- 6. EVALUATION FORWARDED TO DEAN FOR FINAL ASSESSMENT**
 Dean to review faculty input, Chair's review, faculty consent, department performance, College performance, and provide final assessment.

6.8 Weights and Grades for each Criteria

The total score shall be out of 100 %. There are different weights for different faculty designation categories. The following table summarize the weights for each category:

Evaluation Type	Teaching and Learning (%)	Research and Scholarly Activities (%)	Community Service (%)	Academic Quality (%)	PD (%)	Formal Admin Appoint (%)
A. Normal Teaching Load (12 CH)	50	25	15	10	5	0
B. Teaching Load 15+CH due to shortage	65	15	5	10	5	0

C. Lecturer/Instructor	75	0	10	10	5	0
D. Teaching Track or 1 st Year of New Appointment	65	15	5	10	5	0
E. Lecturer Research Track (3 CH Load Reduction)	60	20	5	10	5	0
F. 3 CH Teaching Load Reduction for Research	45	35	5	10	5	0
G. 6 CH Teaching Load Reduction for Research	35	45	5	10	5	0
H. Total 6 CH Teaching Load Reduction for Academic Administration	40	20	2.5	10	2.5	25
I. Total 3 CH Teaching Load Reduction for Academic Administration	47.5	20	5	10	5	12.5
J. Total 12 CH Teaching Load Reduction for Academic Administration	20	15	2.5	10	2.5	50
K. Total 9 CH Teaching Load Reduction for Academic Administration	22.5	20	5	10	5	37.5
L. Total 18 CH Teaching Load	10	10	2.5	5	2.5	70

Reduction for Academic Administration						
M. Total 15 CH Teaching Load Reduction for Academic Administration	20	5	5	5	5	60
N. College of Fine Arts – CW Track	50	25	10	10	5	0
O. College of Law	50	25	10	10	5	0

The overall rating system is structured as follow:

Excellent 90-100 ممتاز	Very Good 80-89 جيد جدا	Meets Expectation 70-79 مطابق للتوقعات	0-69 Needs Attention يتطلب المتابعة
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6.9 The Faculty Information System

- All performance evaluations are conducted through the Faculty Information System
- Faculty members must ensure that their faculty profile is updated regularly.
- Faculty members must ensure that their research activities, teaching schedule, workload, students end of course evaluation, peer observation, and other automatically retrieved data is showing in the system and is displayed correctly.
- The annual evaluation system is available all year. It is recommended that faculty update their activities regularly, to avoid backlog at annual evaluation submission time.
- While the system is available for data entry all year, submission of performance evaluation is restricted to a specific time each year.

6.9.1 Features of the Faculty Information System-2024

The enhanced Faculty Information System (FIS) was upgraded with a primary objective: to ensure fairness, accuracy, and transparency in faculty evaluation and recognition, without altering the foundational evaluation framework previously established in the manual system.

The 2023-FIS already provided robust functionality, including automated workload calculation, faculty credentialing and biography management, performance evaluation tracking, contract

renewal workflows, and automatic retrieval of research output from Scopus, allowing faculty to review and update their records throughout the academic year.

With the 2024 updates, the FIS has introduced new features designed to refine the evaluation process, make it more interactive and discipline-sensitive, and enhance data transparency, all while strictly maintaining the original weights and criteria for evaluation in research, teaching, service, and academic quality. Importantly, no changes were made to:

- The percentage weights assigned to each evaluation domain.
- The threshold for meeting expectations (still defined as 2 publications without quartile requirement).
- The criteria for an "Excellent" rating in research (still requiring 4 Q1 publications with main authorship).
- The conditions for contract renewal or faculty appointment status.

Key Enhancements in the 2024 Faculty Information System:

1. **Interactive Evaluation Rubrics:** Replacing the previous static "guiding rubric," the new system uses dynamic, interactive rubrics that allow faculty and evaluators to engage more directly with performance criteria. This improves clarity and consistency in applying the evaluation standards.
2. **Refined Performance Bands:** The performance category previously labelled "Satisfactory" (score range 74–79) has been renamed "Meets Expectations," and the range expanded to 70–79. This aligns terminology with institutional performance benchmarks and provides more equitable attainment for faculty across all domains.
3. **Customized Rubric for Creative Disciplines:** Recognizing the unique nature of scholarly activity in fine arts and related fields, a tailored rubric was introduced to evaluate creative works. These customizations are grounded in existing promotion criteria, ensuring that artistic and design contributions are fairly represented and rewarded.
4. **Recognition of Professional Development:** An additional 5% weighting has been allocated for professional development to acknowledge faculty efforts in participating in workshops, training, mentoring, and scholarly learning opportunities that support ongoing professional growth.
5. **Automatic Adjustment for Research Release:** For faculty members granted a research release, the system now automatically adjusts the Distribution of Effort (DOE) to reflect the reduced teaching load and increased research focus, ensuring alignment between assigned duties and evaluation expectations.
6. **Peer Benchmarking Transparency:** Faculty can now view how their performance compares with peers in the same department across all domains. This data-driven benchmarking fosters fairness and encourages self-reflection and continuous improvement.
7. **Integrated Data Retrieval:** The system automatically pulls validated data from University-wide systems:
 - Publications & Journal Quartiles from Scopus and VCRGS
 - Teaching Load & Grade Distribution from Banner

- Student Evaluations from Blue
 - Advising Records from the Advising System: This integration ensures consistency, minimizes data entry errors, and enhances the reliability of evaluation results.
8. **Clear Rubric Interpretation:** New domain-specific rubrics have been implemented to eliminate ambiguity. For example, in research evaluation, the criteria for “Excellent” explicitly require 4 Q1 publications with main authorship. For disciplines with varied publication norms, the system allows a conversion (e.g., 1 Q1 = 2 Q2; 1 main author = 2 non-main author) based on departmental decisions, ensuring flexibility within a standardized framework.

Research Excellence

The upgraded system introduces several key features that promote fairness and data-driven evaluation:

- **Weighted Evaluation Adjustment:** Faculty granted research release now have their research performance weight adjusted proportionally, with a corresponding reduction in their teaching load evaluation. This reflects the institutional investment in their research activity and ensures the evaluation framework aligns with actual workload distribution.
- **Publication Analytics and Benchmarking:** The system now displays the total number of publications produced by each faculty member during the evaluation period, alongside departmental averages. It also breaks down publication quality by quartile (Q1–Q4), providing context and promoting meaningful benchmarking within departments.
- **Transparency and Accountability:** These enhancements promote a transparent environment where both faculty and evaluators can see comparative data. This mitigates subjective bias and encourages objective, evidence-based assessment.

Teaching Excellence

Teaching excellence is a cornerstone of the University of Sharjah’s academic mission. It reflects not only the mastery of subject matter and instructional skill, but also the integrity, fairness, and responsibility faculty members uphold in supporting student learning and academic development. In alignment with the University’s strategic commitment to quality education, faculty are entrusted with a set of clearly defined responsibilities in their roles as educators, mentors, and curriculum contributors.

Recent assessments of academic outcomes have identified a concerning trend of skewed grade distributions, with evidence of grade inflation in most programs. While the University firmly respects academic freedom and does not impose a grade distribution, this trend necessitates a renewed emphasis on the faculty’s responsibility to ensure fairness, academic rigor, and meaningful assessment.

Grade inflation compromises the integrity of academic programs, diminishes the value of student achievements, and ultimately affects the credibility of our degrees. More importantly, it undermines the principle of merit-based education and the University's ability to produce graduates

who are competitively equipped for the workforce or advanced study. Faculty are therefore reminded of their obligation to apply impartial grading standards, aligned with course objectives and student learning outcomes, as part of their commitment to teaching excellence.

It is important to clarify that the University is not mandating a fixed distribution of grades. Rather, the emphasis is on ensuring that each grade awarded is earned and justified by demonstrated student performance. Faculty are trusted to exercise academic judgment while honouring their responsibility to uphold the integrity of assessment and student learning outcomes.

Each faculty member is encouraged to reflect on their grading trends and evaluate whether their assessments are appropriately rigorous, aligned with learning objectives, and differentiated enough to reflect the true range of student performance. By doing so, we reaffirm our collective commitment to excellence in teaching and to preserving the academic reputation of the University of Sharjah. This approach preserves academic freedom while promoting accountability and excellence, ensuring our graduates are both well-prepared and genuinely deserving of their academic success.

Advising System

As part of the University of Sharjah's commitment to student success and academic quality, a modern, integrated Advising System has been implemented, upgrading the way students and faculty engage in academic advising. This system directly supports faculty in fulfilling their advising responsibilities and empowers students to make timely, well-informed decisions about their academic pathways. The advising system is built around accessibility, accountability, and personalized support. It incorporates a ticket-based appointment module, enabling students to easily schedule advising sessions with faculty advisors. This ensures that all advising interactions are organized, traceable, and conducted within the framework of responsibilities outlined in the University's expectations for teaching excellence and student mentorship. Faculty are now able to log each advising interaction, document guidance provided, and follow up as needed, creating a reliable record of academic support.

A cornerstone of the new system is the integration of an automated risk registry, which identifies students who are academically at risk based on a combination of indicators such as GPA trends, incomplete grades, course withdrawals, and deviations from the study plan. Faculty are alerted in real time when a student under their advisement is flagged as at-risk, allowing them to intervene early with tailored guidance and support. This risk-based advising model ensures that vulnerable students receive the attention they need to stay on track and succeed.

Both faculty and students benefit from clear visibility of each student's academic study plan, which is fully aligned with program requirements and graduation timelines. The system tracks course sequencing, elective selections, and prerequisites, and offers real-time compliance checks with the University's degree audit system (CAPP). This enhances accuracy in course registration and reduces delays caused by improper sequencing or elective misalignment. The ability to project schedules based on the student's study plan and semester alignment improves planning and reduces registration conflicts.

By integrating with the University's SIS and LMS, the advising system provides faculty with real-time data on student performance, study progression, and advising outcomes. This data not only

enhances the advising process but is also linked to annual faculty evaluations, recognizing, and reinforcing the critical role that advising plays in student success. Faculty engagement in advising is now more visible, measurable, and valued in performance reviews.

The advising system was designed to complement—not burden faculty and students. It reduces administrative overhead, improves communication, and allows for a more proactive and data-driven approach to student guidance. Its emphasis on timely advising, academic integrity, and student tracking contributes directly to better retention, reduced attrition, and more efficient time-to-graduation metrics, which are critical to both student outcomes and institutional performance.

Engagement in Professional Development

Professional development is a vital component of academic excellence and institutional advancement. At the University of Sharjah, faculty engagement in professional development activities reflects a commitment to continuous learning, pedagogical innovation, and academic leadership. While the weight assigned to professional development in the annual evaluation rubric is modest (only 5%) its impact on both individual performance and the collective academic environment is profound and deserving of recognition.

Professional development encompasses a broad range of activities that contribute to faculty growth, including participation in workshops, teaching and learning seminars, research methodology training, curriculum design programs, accreditation preparation sessions, and mentorship activities. These activities ensure that faculty remain up to date with the latest advancements in their fields, enhance their instructional effectiveness, and adopt innovative tools and practices that directly benefit students.

By formally incorporating professional development into the evaluation framework, the University recognizes and rewards faculty who invest in their own growth. This reinforces a culture of excellence and responsiveness to changing academic and technological landscapes. Faculty who engages in professional development demonstrate initiative, adaptability, and a proactive approach to enhancing their teaching and scholarly capabilities—traits that should be acknowledged and encouraged.

Moreover, professional development often serves as a catalyst for broader institutional improvements. Faculty who develops new teaching strategies or learn best practices from peer institutions often bring those insights back to their departments, enriching the learning experience for students and colleagues alike.

Though it accounts for a relatively small percentage of the evaluation score, the inclusion of professional development reflects the University's belief that sustained growth and innovation begin with individual initiative. Faculty are therefore encouraged to take full advantage of development opportunities offered by the University and to document their engagement as part of their annual performance review. Doing so not only benefits their own professional trajectory but also strengthens the institution's academic community.

6.10 Rubric for Contract Renewal

The University of Sharjah remains committed to fostering a stable and supportive academic environment where faculty can thrive and contribute meaningfully to the University's mission. At the same time, the University must ensure that faculty performance is consistently aligned with institutional goals for excellence in teaching, impactful research, and community engagement. Accordingly, the contract renewal process is governed by a well-defined rubric that remains unchanged, reflecting both the University's respect for faculty job security and its obligation to uphold high academic standards and global competitiveness.

Contract renewal is not based on a single year's performance but rather on the faculty member's cumulative contributions over the duration of the current contract. In the domain of research, faculty are expected to demonstrate a minimum average of two Scopus-indexed publications per year, calculated across the contract term. This approach allows for flexibility in scholarly output while ensuring that sustained productivity is maintained.

Equally important, teaching effectiveness and meaningful university service are critical components in determining the duration and renewal of contracts. Faculty who consistently demonstrate high-quality instruction, fair and rigorous assessment, active involvement in advising, and meaningful engagement in university committees or initiatives are more likely to be awarded the maximum contract duration, in line with institutional trust and strategic alignment.

In accordance with university policy and national regulations, faculty members over the age of 65 will be offered renewable one-year contracts, subject to annual performance evaluation, until the age of 70. This approach honours the continued contributions of senior faculty while ensuring ongoing alignment with performance standards.

The University recognizes that performance can vary due to a range of professional or personal factors. Faculty who doesn't meet expectations during a contract term will be provided with an opportunity to improve. This may include mentorship, development planning, and targeted support. However, continued underperformance without demonstrable improvement may impact future contract duration or renewal.

The contract renewal rubric reflects the University's dual responsibility to:

- Protect the rights of faculty members to fair, evidence-based evaluations and job stability.
- Safeguard the institution's academic reputation, including its position in global rankings where faculty productivity and student outcomes are key indicators.

Faculty members are vital to the University's academic profile, particularly as ranking agencies measure performance through indicators such as research output per faculty and citation impact. Faculty who actively contribute to Scopus-indexed publications, particularly in high-impact journals (Q1 and Q2), enhance the University's visibility and reputation on the international stage.

6.11 Evaluation Rubric

To ensure transparency, accountability, and shared understanding, UOS uses interactive evaluation rubric for each evaluation criteria. In addition, UOS also uses specific rubrics for certain colleges,

to ensure integrity of evaluation. Below are the rubrics used by UOS to evaluate Teaching, Research, Service, Adamic Quality, and Professional Development.

Teaching and Learning

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (0 - 69)
Instructional Delivery	25	A- Syllabus approved and delivered before class start date B- Syllabus is consistent with university format and includes required information C- Used additional resources and online resources in syllabus D- Coordinated and/or Developed at least two courses E- Supervised/Coordinated students (Thesis, SOP, Project) above average per faculty in program	A- Syllabus approved and delivered before class start date B- Syllabus is consistent with university format and includes required information C- Used additional resources and online resources in syllabus D- Coordinated and/or Developed one course E- Supervised/Coordinated students (Thesis, SOP, Project) inline with average per faculty in program	A- Syllabus approved and delivered before class start date B- Syllabus is consistent with university format and includes required information C- Used additional resources and online resources in syllabus	Failure to meet any of the below requirements: A- Syllabus approved and delivered before class start date B- Syllabus is consistent with university format and includes required information C- Used additional resources and online resources in syllabus
-Students achievement of Learning Outcome	15	Average outcome assessment of all delivered outcomes equal to or greater than 85	Average outcome assessment of all delivered outcomes is between 80-84	Average outcome assessment of all delivered outcomes is between 70-79	Average outcome assessment of all delivered outcomes is less than 69
-End of Course Evaluation by Students	10	Average end of course evaluation equal to or greater than 4.5	Average end of course evaluation between 4.1 and 4.4	Average end of course evaluation between 3.6 and 4	Average end of course evaluation equal to or less than 3.5
-Peer Observation	10	Average peer observation equal to or greater than 4.5	Average peer observation between 4.1 and 4.4	Average peer observation between 3.6 and 4	Average peer observation equal to or less than 3.5
-Grade Distribution Curve	10	Grade Distribution well distributed and is highly consistent with outcomes assessment	Grade Distribution well distributed and is considerably consistent with outcomes assessment	Grade Distribution well distributed	Grade Distribution is skewed
-Blackboard Content and Grade Center Preparedness	15	Blackboard course content ready and grade center is setup within 1 weeks from term start date	Blackboard course content ready and grade center is setup within 2 weeks from term start date	Blackboard course content ready and grade center is setup within 4 weeks from term start date	"Failure to meet any of the below requirements: Blackboard course content ready and grade center is setup within 4 weeks from term start date"
-Blackboard and Banner Grades Currency	15	A- Students grades are displayed in grade center within one week of assignment completion B- Final grades are in Banner within specified time frame	A- Students grades are displayed in grade center within two weeks of assignment completion B- Final grades are in Banner within specified time frame	A- Students grades are displayed in grade center before mid-term B- Final grades are in Banner within specified time frame	"Failure to meet any of the below requirements: A- Students grades are displayed in grade center before mid-term B- Final grades are in Banner within specified time

Advising

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (0 - 69)
Percentage of Students Advised compared to:	35	90-100 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	80-89 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	70-79 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	Less than 70% Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System
Percentage of advised students at risk compar	25	90-100 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	80-89 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	70-79 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	Less than 70% Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System
Number of Advising Records with a Resolution	30	90-100 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	80-89 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	70-79 Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System	Less than 70% Percentage of Advising Records from Advising System
Average duration for advising meeting and res	10	less than 24 hours	24 hours	48 hours	more than 36 hours

Research Rubric

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (60 - 69)
-Number of Articles published in Refereed Journals	80	In addition to the two baseline articles A - Minimum of 4 articles in Q1 Scopus/A- Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR B - Minimum of 8 articles in Q1 Scopus/A- Classification, without being first author OR C - Minimum of 8 articles in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR D - Minimum of 16 articles in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification, without being first author	In addition to the two baseline articles A - Minimum of 2 articles in Q1 Scopus/A- Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR B - Minimum of 4 articles in Q1 Scopus/A- Classification, without being first author OR C - Minimum of 4 articles in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR D - Minimum of 8 in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification, without being first author	A Total of : 2 articles in Refereed Journals. 2 Q1/A = 79 1 Q1/A + 1 Q2/B = 77 2 Q2/B = 75 1 Q1/A + Any other than Q2/B = 74.5 1 Q2/B + Any other than Q1/A = 72.25 Two of any other Q = 70	Less than 2 articles in Refereed Journals
-Number of Conferences, Projects, and IPs	10	A - 3 In Conference Proceedings OR B - 3 In Conference Presentation OR C - 3 Books Published OR D - 3 Chapters of Book Published OR E-3 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 3 IPs OR G - 3 of the combination of the above	A - 2 In Conference Proceedings OR B - 2 In Conference Presentation OR C - 2 Books Published OR D - 2 Chapters of Book Published OR E-2 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 2 IPs OR G - 2 of the combination of the above	A - 1 In Conference Proceedings OR B - 1 In Conference Presentation OR C - Book Published OR D - Chapter of Book Published OR E-1 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 1 IP	Failure to meet one of the below requirements: A - 1 In Conference Proceedings OR B - 1 In Conference Presentation OR C - Book Published OR D - Chapter of Book Published OR E-1 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 1 IP
-Number of membership of scientific journals,	10	6 activities or memberships	4-5 activities or memberships	2-3 activities or memberships	Less than 2 activities or memberships

Service Rubric

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (60 - 69)
-Number of committees served in University	70	More Than 3 committees	3 committees	1-2 committee	None
-Number of community service events	10	More Than 3 events	3 events	1-2 event	None
-Number of service activities to industry or co	10	More than 3 activities	3 activities	1-2 activity	None
-Number of service activities performed for cc	10	More Than 3 activities	3 activities	1-2 activity	None

Academic Quality Rubric

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (0 - 69)
Syllabus Score as provided by IE	40	Syllabus rating as provided by IE	Syllabus rating as provided by IE	Syllabus rating as provided by IE	Syllabus rating as provided by IE
Course File Score as provided by IE	60	Course Files rating as provided by IE	Course Files rating as provided by IE	Course Files rating as provided by IE	Course Files rating as provided by IE

Professional Development Rubric

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (0 - 69)
Number of new PD certificates earned	25	More Than 1 certificate	1 certificate	0	0
Number of PD Courses/workshop attended	50	More Than 3 course/workshop	3 course/workshop	1 course/workshop	0
Number of Awards Earned	25	More Than 1 award	1 award	0	0

College of Fine Arts and Design Creative Work Rubric

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (0 - 69)
-CW	70	At the International Level 2 Original Creative Works OR 2 Live Performance of Creative Works OR 2 Recorded/Rendered Creative Works OR 2 Curated or Produced Public Exhibitions/Events	At the Regional Level 2 Original Creative Works OR 2 Live Performance of Creative Works OR 2 Recorded/Rendered Creative Works OR 2 Curated or Produced Public Exhibitions/Events	At the National Level 2 Original Creative Works OR 2 Live Performance of Creative Works OR 2 Recorded/Rendered Creative Works OR 2 Curated or Produced Public Exhibitions/Events	LESS THAN 2 Articles in Refereed Journals OR 2 Original Creative Works OR 2 Live Performance of Creative Works OR 2 Recorded/Rendered Creative Works OR 2 Curated or Produced Public Exhibitions/Events
-Research	20	In addition to the two baseline articles: A - Minimum of 4 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR B - Minimum of 8 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification, without being first author OR C - Minimum of 8 articles in Q2 Scopus/B-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR D - Minimum of 16 articles in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification, without being first author	In addition to the two baseline articles: A - Minimum of 2 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR B - Minimum of 4 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification, without being first author OR C - Minimum of 4 articles in Q2 Scopus/B-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR D - Minimum of 8 in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification, without being first author	A Total of: 2 articles in Refereed Journals. 2 Q1/A = 79 1 Q1/A + 1 Q2/B = 77 2 Q2/B = 75 1 Q1/A + Any other than Q2/B = 74.5 1 Q2/B + Any other than Q1/A = 72.25 Two of any other Q = 70	Less than 2 articles in Refereed Journals
-Conferences	10	Presentation of a paper at a professional international conference, or event	Presentation of a paper at a professional regional conference, or event	Presentation of a paper at a professional national conference, or event	No Conference Presentation, or event

College of Law Research Rubric

Criteria	Weight	Excellent (90 - 100)	Very Good (80 - 89)	Meets Expectations (70 - 79)	Needs Attention (0 - 69)
-Number of Articles published OR <u>Accepted for publication</u>	80	In addition to the two baseline articles: A - Minimum of 4 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR B - Minimum of 8 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification, without being first author OR C - Minimum of 8 articles in Q2 Scopus/B-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR D - Minimum of 16 articles in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification, without being first author	In addition to the two baseline articles: A - Minimum of 2 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR B - Minimum of 4 articles in Q1 Scopus/A-Classification, without being first author OR C - Minimum of 4 articles in Q2 Scopus/B-Classification - Minimum of 1 article as first author OR D - Minimum of 8 in Q2 Scopus/B- Classification, without being first author	A Total of: 2 articles in Refereed Journals. 2 Q1/A = 79 1 Q1/A + 1 Q2/B = 77 2 Q2/B = 75 1 Q1/A + Any other than Q2/B = 74.5 1 Q2/B + Any other than Q1/A = 72.25 Two of any other Q = 70	Less than 2 articles in Refereed Journals
-Number of Conferences, Projects, and IPs	10	A - 3 in Conference Proceedings OR B - 3 in Conference Presentation OR C - 3 Books Published OR D - 3 Chapters of Book Published OR E-3 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 3 IPs OR G - 3 of the combination of the above	A - 2 in Conference Proceedings OR B - 2 in Conference Presentation OR C - 2 Books Published OR D - 2 Chapters of Book Published OR E-2 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 2 IPs OR G - 2 of the combination of the above	A - 1 in Conference Proceedings OR B - 1 in Conference Presentation OR C - Book Published OR D - Chapter of Book Published OR E-1 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 1 IP	Failure to meet one of the below requirements: A - 1 in Conference Proceedings OR B - 1 in Conference Presentation OR C - Book Published OR D - Chapter of Book Published OR E-1 Approved Institutional Project OR F - 1 IP
-Number of membership of scientific journals,	10	6 activities or memberships	4-5 activities or memberships	2-3 activities or memberships	Less than 2 activities or memberships

6.12 Continuous Improvement

The Faculty Information System (FIS) at the University of Sharjah represents a major institutional investment in academic quality, operational transparency, and faculty empowerment. From its inception, the system has been developed by the University's deans, whose input ensured that the platform reflects the real-world needs of academic leadership and aligns with the diverse operational requirements of colleges and departments.

As part of the system's deployment, the University has conducted multiple training workshops for faculty members. These workshops have served dual purposes: equipping faculty with the knowledge to effectively use the system and creating a structured environment for gathering constructive feedback. This feedback loop has proven essential in shaping system enhancements and ensuring that the platform remains responsive, user-friendly, and functionally robust.

The Faculty Information System is governed by a commitment to continuous improvement. It is not a static product, but an evolving tool designed to support academic excellence and institutional integrity. To that end, the system includes a built-in ticketing mechanism that enables faculty and administrators to log issues, request support, and propose enhancements. These tickets are reviewed and resolved in a timely and transparent manner, reinforcing the system's responsiveness and fostering user trust.

Furthermore, direct communication between faculty and the system manager has been a defining strength of the system's success to date. This active dialogue ensures that both day-to-day operational issues and long-term enhancement requests are addressed promptly and professionally. The University is committed to maintaining this open channel of communication as the system continues to mature and expand.

Importantly, all system improvements are developed and implemented within the boundaries of the University's bylaws, its strategic direction, and a foundational commitment to fairness and equity for all faculty members. The goal is to ensure that the Faculty Information System remains a powerful tool that supports institutional accountability, faculty development, and student success—while respecting the rights and contributions of the academic community.

The University of Sharjah views the Faculty Information System not merely as an administrative platform, but as a cornerstone of its academic mission. Through ongoing engagement, user support, and strategic refinement, the system will continue to evolve in ways that serve faculty better and enhance the institution's overall performance and standing.

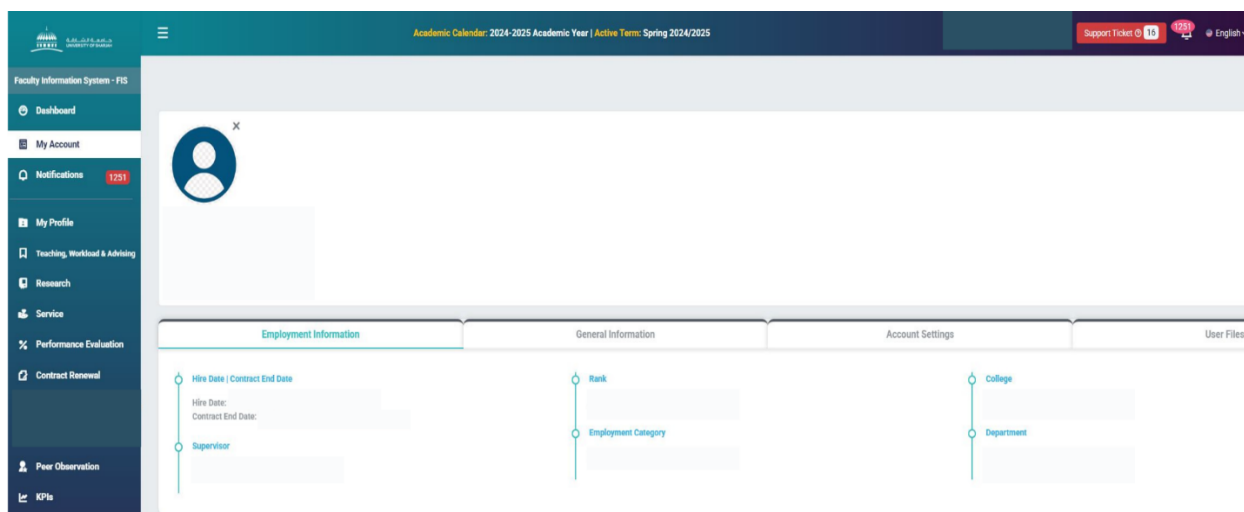
6.13 Faculty Information Systems User Guide

My Account:

Faculty members can access “My Account Page” to view employment information, general information, and account settings. Faculty members can save their ORCID and Scopus ID information, in the account settings tab.

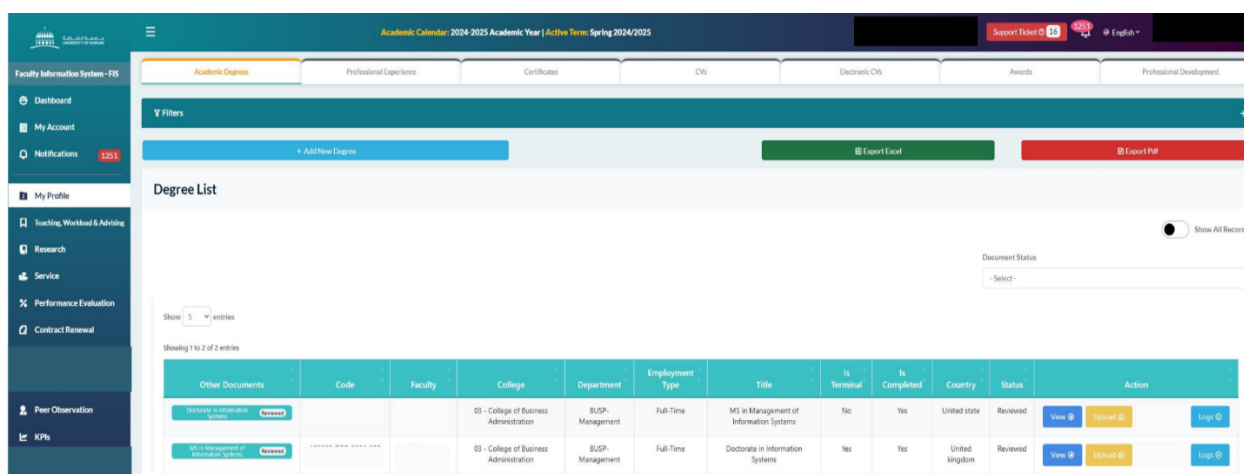
Notifications:

Faculty members can view all transactions notification under the “Notifications” menu. Notifications are also sent by email to faculty email.



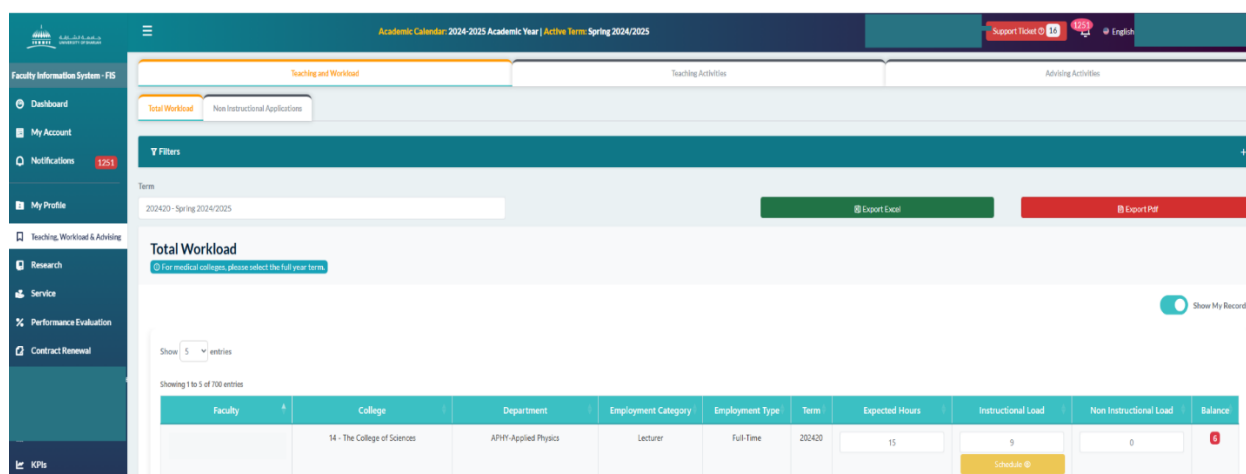
My Profile:

Faculty members can access “My Profile Page” to Add an academic degree, add professional experience, add a certificate, add a CV, add an award, or add a professional development.



Teaching, Workload, and Advising:

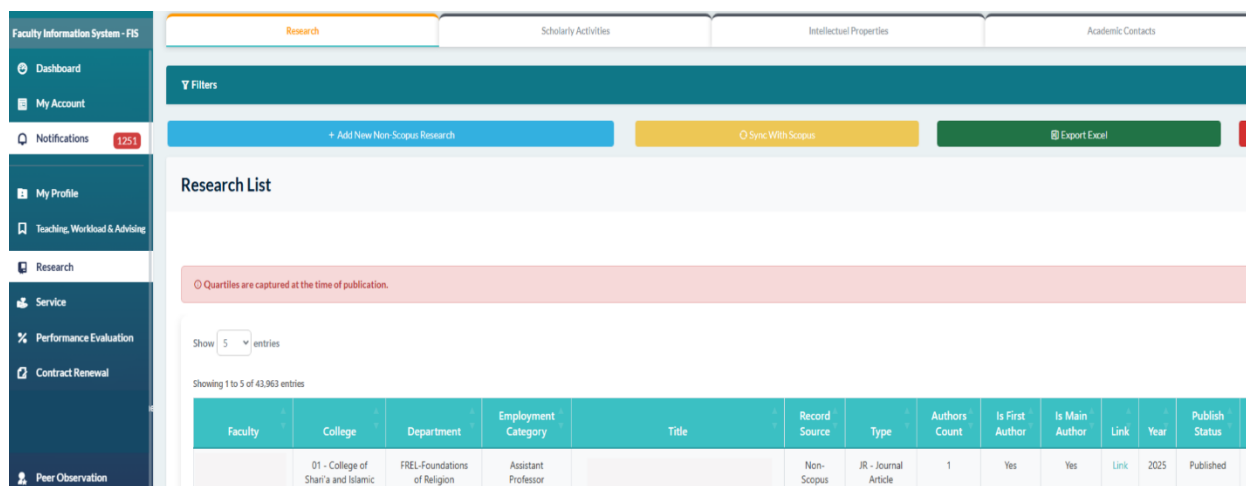
Faculty members can access the “Teaching, Workload, and Advising Page” to view their teaching schedule, view their workload, and view advising records. Add new advising activities.



Faculty	College	Department	Employment Category	Employment Type	Term	Expected Hours	Instructional Load	Non Instructional Load	Balance
	14 - The College of Sciences	APHY-Applied Physics	Lecturer	Full-Time	2024/20	15	9	0	6

Research:

Faculty members can access the “Research Page” to view Scopus-Indexed research, add non-Scopus research, add scholarly activities, intellectual properties, and academic contacts.



Faculty	College	Department	Employment Category	Title	Record Source	Type	Authors Count	Is First Author	Is Main Author	Link	Year	Publish Status
	01 - College of Sharjah and Islamic	FREL-Foundations of Religion	Assistant Professor		Non-Scopus	JR - Journal Article	1	Yes	Yes	Link	2025	Published

Service:

Faculty members can access the “Service Page” to view and add service records.

Faculty Information System - FIS

- Dashboard
- My Account
- Notifications 1251
- My Profile
- Teaching, Workload & Advising
- Research
- Service
- Performance Evaluation
- Contract Renewal

Filters

Add New Service
Export Excel
Export PDF

Service List

Show 5 entries
Showing 1 to 5 of 10,578 entries

Faculty	College	Department	Title	Date From	Date To	Status	Action
	01 - College of Shari'a and Islamic Studies	FREL-Foundations of Religion		06 November 2024	06 November 2024	Active	View Edit Inactivate C
	01 - College of Shari'a and Islamic Studies	FREL-Foundations of Religion		07 December 2024	07 December 2024	Active	View Edit Inactivate C

Performance Evaluation:

Faculty members can access the “Performance Evaluation Page” to view and add performance evaluation records. To create a new performance evaluation, the faculty member must choose an evaluation period from the evaluation period drop down, and an evaluation type from the evaluation type drop down. It is important to select the appropriate evaluation type, based on the faculty rank, teaching load, and assignment. Once the evaluation period, and evaluation type are selected, the faculty members can then click “Add New Evaluation” to create a new “draft” record. The draft record will retrieve all pertinent transactions, based on the evaluation period start and end dates.

[illegible]

Teaching Tab:

The Teaching tab displays teaching activities for the evaluation period, including assignments, grades, end of course evaluations by students, and workload. It also displays additional teaching

activities and advising activities. Faculty members are expected to use the evaluation rubric to enter their self-assessment.

Research and Scholarly Activities Tab:

The Research tab displays research activities for the evaluation period, including Scopus-Indexed, Non-Scopus-Indexed, published articles, accepted for publication articles, scholarly activities, and other pertinent information. Faculty members are expected to use the evaluation rubric to enter their self-assessment.

Service Tab:

The Service tab displays service activities for the evaluation period, including university service, community service, profession service, and other pertinent information. Faculty members are expected to use the evaluation rubric to enter their self-assessment.

Academic Quality Tab:

The Academic Quality tab is concerned with the review of course syllabus, and course files, for the evaluation period, conducted by the Office of IE. Faculty members are expected to use the evaluation rubric to enter their self-assessment.

PD and Awards Tab:

The PD and Awards tab displays Professional Development, and Award records, and other pertinent information, for the evaluation period. Faculty members are expected to use the evaluation rubric to enter their self-assessment.

Administrative Tab:

The Administrative tab displays academic administrative activities, and workload releases, for the evaluation period. Faculty members are expected to use the evaluation rubric to enter their self-assessment.

Submission of Annual Evaluation:

Faculty members are expected to score their performance for each category, based on the evaluation rubric, and enter their self-reflection for each evaluation category in each tab. Once complete, faculty members can use the Evaluation Summary tab to review the evaluation summary and submit the evaluation to the next level.

Workflow:

Once submitted, the annual evaluation application is sent to the Department Chair for review, then to the Faculty member for consent, then to the College Dean for final rating. The Department Chair is expected to fully review the submission, including each criterion in the rubric, against the faculty records, and benchmark it against other faculty performance within the department to ensure objectivity. The submission is then sent back to the faculty form 24 hours for consent, then send

to the College Dean for Final Rating. The College Dean is expected to benchmark performance at the college level.

Support, Feedback, and Continuous Improvements:

Faculty members can use the “Support Ticket” Button to request support, send feedback, and/or provide input for continuous improvements. All rickets are documented, and instantly shared with the support team for solutions, and enhancements.

The screenshot displays the Faculty Information System (FIS) dashboard. The top navigation bar includes the University of Sharjah logo, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs title, and the academic calendar for 2024-2025. A sidebar on the left lists various system modules. The main content area shows the 'My Profile' section, which is divided into four tabs: Employment Information, General Information, Account Settings, and User Files. The 'Employment Information' tab is currently active, showing fields for Hire Date, Contract End Date, Rank, Employment Category, College, and Department. A 'Support Ticket' button is visible in the top right corner of the dashboard.

Chapter 7: Academic Promotion

7.1 Promotion Criteria

The University of Sharjah sets forth the following three areas for evaluating faculty for promotion:

1. Research and Scholarship
2. Teaching and Academic Advising
3. University and Community Services

7.2 Research and Scholarship

For promotion purposes, research considered admissible includes:

A. Research published (or accepted for publication) in recognized specialized or multi-disciplinary periodicals and journals, provided they are refereed and related to the applicant's field or a closely related field. These publications should be regularly issued by reputable institutions, academic societies, research centers, or international publishing houses adhering to the University-approved standards. For promotion to associate professor, a maximum of two articles, based on the applicant's master's or doctoral theses, for which they served as the main or associate supervisor, may be considered. For promotion to full professor, a maximum of three such articles may be considered. It is expected that the applicant publishes in different journals.

B. Granted patents, with a maximum of two for promotion to associate professor and three for promotion to full professor. Each patent counts as Class B publication.

C. Case studies published (or accepted for publication) in refereed academic journals, limited to one for promotion.

D. Research published in specialized books in the applicant's field, which were refereed by at least two specialists before publication and released by reputable institutions, academic associations, or international publishing houses following the University-approved standards. Only one such work may be considered for promotion.

E. Published books contributing to knowledge in the applicant's field, with their contents being substantial. These books must have been evaluated by at least two specialists in the field before publication and published by reputable institutions, academic associations, or international publishing houses following the University-approved standards. A maximum of two such books may be considered.

F. Published university textbooks in the applicant's field, with substantial content and evaluated by at least two specialists in the field before publication. A maximum of one textbook may be considered for each promotion.

G. Heritage books that have been refereed, reviewed, and published by reputable institutions, academic associations, or recognized publishing houses in the applicant's field. Only one such book may be considered for promotion.

H. Artistic and creative works of fine arts, design, and media for relevant specializations. Each new creative work is considered equivalent to one research article, with a maximum of two such works for promotion to associate professor and three for promotion to full professor. Evaluations of these creative works adhere to University-approved criteria.

7.3 Teaching and Academic Advising

The evaluation of the applicant's teaching and academic advising performance includes the following criteria:

A. Effectiveness of teaching based on student evaluations for courses taught at the University of Sharjah.

B. Effectiveness of teaching based on peer evaluations of a sample of courses taught at the University of Sharjah.

C. The variety of courses taught by the applicant in their specialization at the University of Sharjah.

D. Contribution to graduate studies, if offered in the college, through teaching graduate courses and/or supervising theses/dissertations when applying for promotion to full professor.

E. Contribution to developing study plans and programs, including proposing new courses, or modifying existing ones at the University of Sharjah.

F. Contribution towards improving the teaching process by introducing effective learning and teaching methodologies, preparing instructional materials, or publishing the results of applied teaching methodologies.

G. Utilization of modern educational technologies in teaching.

H. Participation in organizing and providing student academic advising.

I. Active participation in seminars, conferences, or workshops focused on improving and developing teaching methodologies.

7.4 University and Community Service

The evaluation of the applicant's university and community service includes the following criteria:

- A. Serving on department, college, and university committees.
- B. Contributions to local, regional, or international academic and professional associations in the applicant's field of specialization.
- C. Contributions to training and/or educational activities within or outside the University.
- D. Provision of academic or professional consultations in the applicant's field of specialization.

7.5 Promotion to the Rank of Associate Professor

An assistant professor applying for promotion to associate professor should meet the following criteria:

- A. Have a minimum of five years of experience as an assistant professor, with at least one year at the University of Sharjah.
- B. Submit a minimum of six original publications in their field of specialization or a closely related field, with at least three as solo or main author for journal articles. In case of joint authorship, the applicant should specify their contribution and provide verification by the main author. The main author determination considers journal practices and the applicant's field of specialization.
- C. Have at least three articles that are published.
- D. Have research articles published (or accepted for publication) during the rank of assistant professor, not used to fulfil previous academic degree requirements (e.g., Master or PhD degrees). A maximum of two journal papers published after obtaining a Ph.D. and outside the period of Assistant Professor may be considered.
- E. Have at least two journal articles published (or accepted for publication) while employed at the University of Sharjah.
- F. Have at least two journal articles published or accepted for publication in class A journals, with the applicant as solo or main author.
- G. Candidates with a PhD from a foreign university should include at least three research journal articles published (or accepted for publication) in foreign journals, with at least two in class B journals.

H. Have a minimum overall evaluation in teaching and academic advising of at least “very good” and a minimum overall evaluation in university and community service of at least “good.”

7.6 Promotion to the Rank of Full Professor:

An associate professor applying for promotion to full professor should meet the following criteria:

A. Have a minimum of five years as an associate professor, with at least two years at the University of Sharjah.

B. Submit a minimum of nine original publications in their field of specialization or a closely related field, with at least five as solo or main author for journal articles. In case of joint authorship, the applicant should specify their contribution and provide verification by the main author. The main author determination considers journal practices and the applicant’s field of specialization.

C. Have at least five articles that are published.

D. Have research articles published (or accepted for publication) during the rank of associate professor, not used to fulfill previous academic rank or degree requirements (e.g., assistant professor rank, Master or PhD degrees). A maximum of three journal papers published outside the period of Associate Professor may be considered, provided the applicant has the rank of Associate Professor before submitting these journal papers.

E. Have at least four journal articles published (or accepted for publication) while employed at the University of Sharjah.

F. Have at least three journal articles published in class A journals, with the applicant as solo or main author.

G. Candidates with a PhD from a foreign university should include at least four research journal articles published (or accepted for publication) in foreign journals, with at least two in class A journals.

H. Papers submitted after the central promotion committee approves the applicant’s file for promotion to associate professor shall be considered for promotion to professor.

I. Have a minimum overall evaluation in teaching and academic advising of at least “very good” and a minimum overall evaluation in university and community service of at least “good.”

7.7 Criteria for Accrediting Periodicals and Journals for Promotion Purpose

Academic periodicals and journals must meet the following conditions:

1. Published by reputable universities, specialized academic associations, scientific research centers, or international publishing houses with high-quality publications and reputation.
2. Have a specialized editorial board comprising academicians of high academic standing.
3. Require articles to be refereed by at least two referees who are not part of the editorial or consultative boards. Refereeing process details should be explicitly stated, and referees' reports may be requested by the promotion committees if needed.
4. Publicize their regulations for publishing studies and research articles.
5. Meet established scientific publishing standards in terms of organization, citations/referencing, and editing.
6. Be regularly issued and in circulation.
7. Have a national or international standard serial number (e.g., ISSN).
8. Have been regularly issued for at least three years before the publication of the applicant's article.

Additionally, journals shall be ranked for promotion purposes according to the following three classes:

1. Journals in SCOPUS database are classified as A if their SJR metric ranks in the top 20% in the journals category of the applicant's field of specialization and are listed in the ISI database with an impact factor. Other journals in the same category in the SCOPUS Database are classified as B.
2. Papers written in English Language not in the SCOPUS Database with SJR metric are not counted.
3. For papers written in languages other than English, the University Promotion Committee classifies the corresponding journals (not in the SCOPUS Database with SJR metric) submitted by the applicant. Applicants planning to submit papers in the future can request journal classification from the University Promotion Committee before submission.

7.8 Promotion Procedures at the Department Level

The promotion procedures at the department level involve the following steps:

A. Applications for promotion can be submitted during the first week of January, April, or October of each year to the department chair. Applicants should attach a dossier with their application, including their CV, research submitted for promotion, evidence of teaching contributions, academic advising, university, and community service, and a summary of scientific research contributions. The department chair shall present these applications to the Department Academic Promotions Committee.

B. The Department Academic Promotions Committee should comprise at least three department faculty members holding an academic rank equivalent to or higher than the rank applied for. Members of this committee should not be part of higher-level committees for the same purpose.

The Committee is chaired by the department chair if a full professor or by another full professor within the department if the department chair is not a full professor. If no full professors are available within the department, an associate professor from the concerned department may serve as a committee member, but not when reviewing applications for full professor rank.

C. The Department Academic Promotions Committee shall review the promotion applications, ensuring they meet the promotion criteria. The Committee may request additional information and supporting documents from applicants. The Committee shall then prepare a detailed report with its recommendations on whether to proceed with the promotion process. If recommended, the department chair shall forward the Committee's report, application dossier, and report from the Department Academic Promotions Committee to the college dean within one month of receiving the application.

D. If the number of departmental faculty holding a rank equal to or higher than the desired rank for promotion is less than three, the college dean, in consultation with the department chair, shall select faculty members from outside the department to form a committee of at least three members. These external members should have the same field of specialization as the applicant and hold the same academic rank being applied for or higher.

7.8 Promotion Procedures at the College Level

The promotion procedures at the college level involve the following steps:

A. In September of each year, the College Council shall form the College Academic Promotions Committee, chaired by the college dean if a full professor or by another professor within the college if the dean is not a full professor. The Committee shall include a full professor from each department in the college. If there are no full professors in a particular department, an associate professor from the concerned department may be a committee member. However, associate professors are not involved in reviewing applications for full professor rank.

B. The College Academic Promotions Committee shall review promotion applications from various college departments to determine if candidates meet the requirements for promotion. The committee may request additional information and supporting documents from applicants. A detailed report with the results of the review and recommendations on proceeding with the promotion process shall be prepared. If recommended, the college dean shall forward the Committee's report, application dossier, and the report from the concerned Department Academic Promotions Committee to the chair of the University Central Committee for Promotion within one month from receiving the Department Academic Promotions Committee's report.

C. The college dean, in consultation with the department chair and full professor members of the College Academic Promotions Committee, shall suggest a list of ten referees, each holding the rank of full professor in the applicant's field of specialization from outside the UAE. Referees

must not have supervised the applicant's research at the master or doctoral levels, nor co-authored any studies or research with the applicant. The college dean shall attach CVs of potential referees, indicating their current position, specialization, and recent publications.

D. If the number of College Academic Promotions Committee members holding a rank equal to or higher than that being sought for promotion is less than three, the dean shall follow the same procedure mentioned above at the departmental level.

7.9 Promotion Procedures at the University Level

Applications for promotion shall be processed at the University level as follows:

A. At the beginning of each academic year, the University Central Committee for the Promotion of Faculty Members shall be formed and chaired by the Chancellor or a delegate. Its membership shall include at least six full professors from various University colleges.

B. The University Central Committee for the Promotion of Faculty Members shall review promotion applications from various colleges to determine if they meet the promotion criteria. The Committee may ask applicants for additional information and supporting documentation.

C. The Chancellor or delegate shall select four referees from those nominated by the college or other specialists in the field to evaluate the applicant's research compliance with the promotion criteria. The Chancellor or delegate may add names of other specialized referees after consulting the members of the Central Promotions Committee. The Chancellor or delegate shall correspond with the referees.

D. Each referee shall receive a copy of the applicant's CV, the University's promotion by-laws, the research accepted for promotion by the Central Promotions Committee, and a designated questionnaire for evaluating the applicant's research. If a referee does not respond within three months, the Chancellor or delegate may send the dossier to a replacement referee.

E. The University Central Committee for Promotion shall review and discuss the evaluation results after receiving responses from at least three referees for each case. Recommendations shall be made based on:

1. A minimum overall average of 75% in the research evaluation for promotion to associate professor.
2. A minimum overall average of 80% in the research evaluation for promotion to full professor.

F. The Chancellor shall refer the University Central Committee for Promotions recommendations to the Deans Council for consideration. Decisions to promote or not will be made by a simple

majority vote of the full professor committee members in attendance at the meeting. For promotion to associate professor, a simple majority vote of full and associate professors in attendance is required.

G. If the Deans Council approves a promotion, the Chancellor shall forward the decision to the Board of Trustees for approval. The Chancellor shall issue the Board of Trustee decisions that approve promotion cases. Promotion shall be effective as of the date of the Chancellor's issuance of these decisions.

H. If the Central Committee, Deans Council, or Board of Trustees does not approve a promotion, the Chancellor shall notify the applicant in writing. The faculty member may reapply for promotion after at least one year from the notification date. Reapplicants must present a minimum of two new journal articles for associate professor rank, where they are the sole or main author of at least one. For full professor rank, reapplicants must present three new journal articles, where they are the sole or main author of at least two.

7.10 Preparing the Promotion Dossier

The applicant must submit a soft copy of the promotion dossier, each containing:

1. A completed application form.
2. The applicant's curriculum vitae (CV), showing academic degrees obtained and their dates, academic ranks held before and after joining the University of Sharjah, all research submitted for promotion, teaching experience, academic advising, university, and community service.
3. Copies of research work submitted for promotion.
4. Sufficient information about the journals and periodicals in which the research work has been published (or accepted for publication), including details about the editorial board, refereeing process, publishing policies, SCOPUS indexation (with SJR) and ISI indexation (with Impact Factor), and the institution publishing the journal or periodical.
5. A list of the research submitted for promotion, including citations for various research publications.
6. Evidence to support the applicant's contributions to teaching and academic advising, such as peer evaluation reports and student evaluations.
7. Evidence to support the applicant's contributions to university and community service.

7.11 General Provisions

A. The University of Sharjah does not consider promotion or academic ranks granted to faculty by other universities while working at the University of Sharjah unless it is through official secondment and meets the University's criteria.

B. An assistant or associate professor may apply for promotion to a higher rank four months before completing the term at the lower rank if other conditions required for promotion to the higher rank have been fulfilled.

C. If promotion procedures are completed before the end of the required term at a lower rank, the promotion to the higher rank shall be effective at the end of that period.

D. A faculty member who produces a substantial amount of research (at least double the required publications for promotion) may apply for promotion after completing four years in the academic rank required for promotion to the higher rank.

E. All correspondence regarding the promotion process at the department, college, and university levels shall remain confidential.

F. No individual may participate in evaluating the academic contribution of an applicant for promotion at more than one level. Applicants have the right to request a review of any promotion committee's recommendations (departmental, college, or university) if their application was rejected and if they provide evidence of procedural irregularities in the evaluation.

7.12 Appeals

1. If an application for promotion of faculty member is denied he/she may submit an appeal in writing to the Chancellor. The appeal must be made in writing within one week of notification of the results of the promotion process and results. The appeal should address the specific procedural grounds upon which the request is based.

2. The Chancellor shall form a committee to investigate the case. The Committee shall make recommendations to the Chancellor within three weeks. The Chancellor may uphold or overturn the original decision based on the Committee recommendations. The decision of the Chancellor is final and is communicated to the College Dean and concerned faculty member. Should the application for promotion be approved, the HR Department is notified.

3. Once a final decision has been reached, all original documents prepared and submitted by the candidate shall be returned to the Faculty Promotion Office. All confidential reports are withheld in the Chancellor's Office.

Chapter 8: Scientific Research

Scientific research at the University of Sharjah is overseen by the University Research Board, which is dedicated to promoting outstanding research endeavors. The University fosters a conducive environment for research development and sustainability, recognizing research as a primary objective. Comprehensive support is provided to faculty and students, encompassing research projects, groups, publications, and patents, among others. The University's vision is to increase knowledge, foster scientific applications, and contribute to social and economic growth. To supervise and organize all research, development, and innovation activities, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies (VCRGS) plays a pivotal role. The VCRGS collaborates closely with the Chancellor, Research Institute Directors, College Deans, and other administrative units to identify and address research-related challenges while striving for excellence in both research and education.

Research organization at the UoS comprises several support departments:

1. Research Funding Department
2. Research Groups Department
3. Research Publishing Department

Department heads possess authority similar to academic department chairs, including reduction in teaching load and financial remuneration within their respective colleges.

8.1 Research Institutes

The University of Sharjah houses three research institutes, each led by an institute director. These institutes collaborate with research centers, research groups, executive committees, administrative assistants, researchers, post-doctoral fellows, and research assistants to conduct and organize research initiatives.

8.1.1 Research Institute for Medical and Health Sciences (RIMHS)

The Research Institute for Medical and Health Sciences (RIMHS), an integral part of the Office of the VCRGS, emphasizes cutting-edge research in medicine, dentistry, pharmacy, health sciences, and biotechnology. RIMHS focuses on innovative, multidisciplinary applied biomedical research relevant to human health, addressing national priorities, and contributing to the UAE's knowledge-based society. Research at RIMHS is categorized into research group activities (clinical or basic research) and Internal and External Advisory Boards oversight, responsible for strategic planning and researcher recruitment. The Institute comprises research centers, such as the Sharjah Institute for Medical Research, Public Health Research Center, and University of Sharjah Center of Excellence for Diabetes, Endocrinology, and Research.

8.1.2 Research Institute of Sciences and Engineering (RISE)

The Research Institute of Sciences and Engineering (RISE) positions the University of Sharjah as a research and innovation hub for science and technology in the UAE and the region. RISE's mission is to promote quality research and innovation in priority science and engineering areas that align with and serve the sustainable development needs of Sharjah, the UAE, and the region. RISE encompasses research centers like the Center for Advanced Materials Research, Renewable Energy Technologies Research Center, Sustainable Infrastructure and Built Environment Research Center, Information, Communication, and Network Technologies Research Center, Water and Environment Research Center, and Geographic Information Systems and Remote Sensing Center.

8.1.3 Research Institute of Humanities and Social Sciences (RIHSS)

The Research Institute of Humanities and Social Sciences (RIHSS) supports and advances research across all disciplinary areas of the humanities and social sciences at University of Sharjah. RIHSS plays a leading role in conducting quality research that benefits the local community and the region while fostering strategic collaborations with local, regional, and international research organizations. RIHSS encompasses research centers such as the Sharjah Islamic Center for Economy and Finance Studies and the Applied Sociology Research Center.

8.2 Research Support Units and Departments

8.2.1 Research Funding Department

The Research Funding Department (RFD) is responsible for pre- and post-awards administration of research project's funds. It facilitates the procurement of research funding and supports faculty and students in their research projects and groups. The Department ensures compliance with university regulations and bylaws for internal and external research funding and oversees the management of approved research projects, including purchasing and fund reallocation. Additionally, the RFD assists faculty in grant writing, monitors project progress, and maintains online databases for research activities, grants, and purchased research assets.

8.2.1.1 Internal Funding

As part of its robust research strategy, the University of Sharjah provides vital support for all research activities by offering various internal funding opportunities to its faculty and students. These internal funds are thoughtfully categorized to cater to diverse research needs:

1. Seed Research Grant: Allocated to newly appointed faculty, this grant aims to kickstart their research endeavors at the University.
2. Competitive Research Grant: Awarded to researchers through a competitive selection process, wherein research proposals undergo thorough review and evaluation by peers.

3. Targeted Research Grant: Offered to researchers associated with Research Centers, Research Laboratories, and Research Groups, following a rigorous evaluation of research proposals by peers.
4. Collaborative Research Grant: Jointly funded by the University and public or private organizations, these grants are highly competitive, with research proposals undergoing rigorous assessment by peers.

In addition to the above, internal funding includes a range of other grants, such as collaborative research grants, research visits grants, summer stay research grants, extra conference participation grants, researcher'' hosting grants, exchange student researchers grant, and grants for graduate research assistants.

8.2.2 Scientific Publication Unit

The Scientific publication unit at the University of Sharjah plays a pivotal role in enhancing the institution's reputation and achieving its objectives. It focuses on disseminating knowledge and contributing to the development and enrichment of the academic community. The Unit ensures that original scientific research outcomes are published in high-quality publications, making them accessible to both academia and the general public. The University presently issues the following peer-reviewed scientific publications:

1. UoS Journal of Humanities and Social Sciences
2. UoS Journal of Law Sciences
3. UoS Journal of Sharia' a Sciences
4. Refereed authored books
5. Refereed scientific technical reports
6. Refereed conference and symposia proceedings

8.2.3 Technology Transfer Office

The Technology Transfer Office (TTO) is entrusted with managing all intellectual property matters related to research activities and outputs at UoS. The TTO plays a crucial role in complementing the University mission of research excellence and innovation. It provides a framework to govern the ownership, disposition, use, and commercial development of inventions, discoveries, and creative works generated at or under the auspices of UoS. Moreover, the TTO safeguards the intellectual property rights of faculty, staff, and students, and facilitates licensing to external parties.

8.2.4 Research Support Services Coordinator

The Research Support Services Coordinator extends various technical and logistical support to researchers and assists in fulfilling diverse research-related tasks for the VCRGS Office, research

institutes, scientific publication unit, compliance office, research funding department, and other academic or administrative entities associated with the VCRGS. Additionally, the Coordinator plays a crucial role in assisting researchers in identifying external funding opportunities and serves as the administrator of SPIN, the world's largest funding opportunities database, to which UoS subscribes.

8.3 Research Priority Areas

To address the most pressing challenges faced by the local and global communities, UoS directs its research activities towards research priority areas in line with its vision and programs. Each research institute has identified specific priority areas, forming the foundation for disciplinary and multidisciplinary research, with the aim of achieving significant national and international impact.

RIMHS Research Priority Areas

The themes of RIMHS Research Centers are interrelated, facilitating biomedical investigation at UOS and advancing clinical translational research and discovery through advanced technologies. RIMHS focuses on enhancing the understanding of mechanisms of diseases, developing preventive, diagnostic, and therapeutic tools, and improving the health outcomes of the UAE community. Some of the preliminary challenges addressed by RIMHS include:

1. Epidemiological/Clinical Research and Genetic Studies on UAE Prevalent Diseases like Diabetes and Cancer
2. Inflammatory Disorders
3. Experimental Therapeutics and Immunological Disorders
4. Molecular and System Biology of Cancer

RISE Research Priority Areas:

1. Advanced/Nano Materials Research
2. Water and Environment Research
3. Renewable Energy and Energy Efficiency
4. Sustainable Infrastructure and Built Environment Research
5. Artificial Intelligence
6. Cybersecurity
7. Biomedical Engineering and Bioinformatics

RIHSS Research Priority Areas

The priority research areas in the field of humanities and social sciences encompass a diverse range of subjects that contribute to the betterment of society. The identified priority areas include:

1. Business Islamic Finance
2. Mass Media and Communication
3. Social Work and Social Policy
4. Public Relations and Institutional Communication
5. Criminal Justice
6. Islamic Studies
7. Family Relations (Divorce, Marital Adjustment)
8. Housing Programs in UAE
9. Education and Psychological Problems
10. Innovation and Entrepreneurship

These research priority areas reflect UoS's commitment to addressing critical issues and fostering meaningful research with both local and global impact.

8.4 Research Groups

The University of Sharjah actively encourages the establishment of research groups within various disciplines and fosters collaborations among them. These research groups play a crucial role in driving scientific research across diverse fields, contributing significantly to social, economic, and scientific development and sustainability.

Research groups serve as the nucleus for potential future research centers and units, subject to recommendations in line with approved regulations and rules set forth by the Research Board upon the Dean's recommendation. The Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies assumes responsibility for the research groups, which may be hosted by academic colleges that provide essential support and facilities to enable their effective functioning.

To facilitate the research group's work, the University provides Central Research Laboratories that cater to the needs of research groups. These laboratories are under the VCRGS supervision, with administrative coordination between the VCRGS and the University's Central Laboratories Department.

As of Fall 2024, there are 62 active research groups at UoS, administered and supervised by the three research institutes (RIMHS, RISE, and RIHSS). These groups enjoy strong support from the Research Institute Directors and the VCRGS Office. Below is a list of research group names organized by Research Institute:

8.4.1 RIMHS Research Groups

1. Drug Design and Discovery Research Group
2. Iron Biology Research Group
3. Environment and Cancer Research Group

4. Tissue Injury and Repair Research Group
5. Dental Biomaterials Research Group
6. Nutrition and Food Research Group
7. Health Promotion in the UAE Research Group
8. Improving Health Care Delivery and Medicines Use Research Group
9. Infectious Diseases and Anti-Infective Therapy Group
10. Oral Bio-films in Health and Disease Group
11. Diabetes and Metabolic Syndrome Group
12. Bioinformatics and Functional Genomics (with RISE)
13. Wound Healing and Oral Diagnosis Research Group

8.4.2 RISE Research Groups

1. Functional Materials Research Group
2. Sustainable Energy Development Research Group
3. Sustainable Construction Materials and Structural Systems Research Group
4. Information and Network Security Research Group
5. Distributed and Networked Systems Research Group
6. Autonomous Robotics and Active Vision Research Group
7. Human Genetics and Stem Cells Research Group
8. Sustainable Civil Infrastructure Systems
9. Ionizing Radiation, Environmental and Chemical Biology
10. Mixed Analogue-Digital Smart Electronic Circuits and Systems
11. Modeling and Simulation of Advanced Materials
12. Machine Language and Arabic Language Processing Group
13. Open UAE Research and Development Group
14. Bioinformatics and Functional Genomics (with RIMHS)
15. Organometallic Chemistry Research Group
16. Big Data Mining and Multimedia Research Group
17. Sustainable Engineering Asset Management Research Group

8.4.3 RIHSS Research Groups:

1. Social, Educational, and Health Problems Research Group
2. Hadeeth Studies Research Group
3. Mass Media: Applications and Effects Group
4. Public Relation and Institutional Communication Group
5. Business and Islamic Finance Quality Group
6. Art and Design Transformations and Additive Manufacturing Research Group

8.4.4 Research Laboratories and Facilities

The University's Research Institutes boast state-of-the-art laboratories equipped with cutting-edge technologies to support up-to-date and advanced research. Some of the research facilities available at RIMHS include labs and equipment for studying cancer, diabetes, genetic diseases, drug design and discovery, and more, such as the molecular imaging platform, animal facility, drug design and discovery research labs, inverted microscope system, high-performance liquid chromatography, and others.

RISE's core facilities encompass advanced materials research lab, renewable energy research lab, high-performance computing facility, integrated analytical lab, University of Sharjah seismic station, transportation and pavement research lab, functional nano-materials synthesis lab, as well as the multi-purpose and multi-functional workshop.

These research facilities empower researchers to conduct groundbreaking research, fostering innovation and excellence in scientific endeavors.

8.5 University Research Board

The University Research Board comprises the following members:

1. Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies (Chair)
2. Dean of Graduate Studies (member)
3. Secretaries or Representatives of the Scientific Research Committees in the Colleges (members)
4. Director of the Central Laboratories (member)
5. Head of Research Department (member)
6. Any new member the Chair chooses to add to the Board.
7. Anyone involved with academic research, whom the Chair invites to attend meetings as an observer without the right to vote.

The University Research Board holds several key duties and authorities, including:

1. Developing scientific research policies and proposals at the University.
2. Approving periodic reports on scientific research at the University.
3. Approving decisions on funding research projects for faculty members and graduate students based on recommendations from the College of Graduate Studies and Research.
4. Overseeing scientific research projects in collaboration with the College.
5. Approving funding decisions for major research equipment upon recommendation by the College.
6. Approving decisions related to registering and re-registering research groups at the University.

7. Approving the annual research budget for research grants, research groups, and major research bodies at the University, based on the College's recommendation.
8. Identifying the foundations of cooperation in the field of scientific research and agreements with scientific institutions inside and outside the UAE.
9. Addressing issues pertaining to the ethics of scientific research.
10. Handling matters related to intellectual property.
11. Considering any other issues related to scientific research.

The University Research Board plays a crucial role in shaping and advancing the University's research agenda, fostering a culture of innovation and excellence.

8.6 Research Committees

The coordination of scientific research affairs in colleges is a collaborative effort between the colleges and the VCRGS. To facilitate this process, research committees play a crucial role in overseeing various aspects of research activities. The responsibilities of these committees include:

1. Reviewing research grant applications submitted by faculty members, ensuring their eligibility, and providing appropriate recommendations to the Deanship through the deans of colleges.
2. Evaluating and recommending funding for the publication of authored books.
3. Compiling and submitting reports on scientific research in colleges, including scientific production, to support scientific documentation.
4. Assessing the colleges' needs for major research equipment and forwarding complete applications to the VCRGS through the College Deans.
5. Assisting the Colleges with other matters pertaining to academic research, ensuring smooth research affairs at the University.

8.7 Research Grants

The University of Sharjah provides robust support for research projects conducted by faculty members. These funded projects encompass a range of categories, including seed projects, competitive projects, collaborative research, and targeted research. Specific guidelines for these research grants are outlined in the Scientific Research Regulations at the University.

Additionally, research activities and projects at UoS also receive external funding from various local and international partners in the public and private sectors. These external funds are efficiently managed under the supervision of the VCRGS, Institute Directors, and the Research Funding Department. Notable external funders include the National Science Foundation, Emirates Foundation, Qatar Foundation, the British Council, the European Union, Al-Jalilla Foundation, Boehringer Ingelheim Pharmaceutical Company, Sharjah Research Academy, Swedish Foundation for International Relations, Sharjah Electricity and Water Authority (SEWA), UAE

Space Agency, Terry Fox Foundation (Canada), Harvard Medical School-Global Health, Sanofi-Aventis Pharmaceutical Company, GSK Pharmaceutical Company, Sheikh Hamdan Medical Award, and KEF Holding.

8.8 Research Regulations

To promote collaboration and cooperation with other scientific institutions, the University offers faculty members opportunities to participate in research grants visits and host visiting researchers and lecturers. These initiatives bolster scientific research and facilitate collaboration with international scientific institutions, adhering to the Scientific Research Regulations at the University.

8.8.1 Research Ethics

The University of Sharjah is committed to maintaining the highest ethical standards in all research activities. Faculty members, researchers, and students must conduct research responsibly, with integrity, transparency, and respect for the rights and dignity of all individuals and communities involved.

A. Guiding Principles

Research conducted under the auspices of the University of Sharjah shall be guided by the following core ethical principles:

- **Integrity:** Accuracy and honesty in data collection, analysis, reporting, and publication.
- **Respect for Persons:** Protection of the autonomy, privacy, and dignity of human participants.
- **Beneficence and Non-maleficence:** Maximizing benefits while minimizing harm.
- **Justice:** Fair and equitable treatment in the selection of research participants and in the distribution of research benefits.
- **Accountability:** Responsibility to the public, funders, and research participants.

B. Research Involving Humans or Animals

- All research involving human participants must obtain prior approval from the University's Ethics Committee and adhere to national and international ethical codes.
- Research involving animals must be reviewed and approved by the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) and follow humane care and use protocols.

C. Authorship and Publication Ethics

Faculty members must:

- Only claim authorship for work they have significantly contributed to.
- Acknowledge all collaborators and funding sources.
- Avoid plagiarism, redundant publication, or fabrication/falsification of data.
- Disclose conflicts of interest in publications and grants.
- Ensure co-authors approve the final version of manuscripts before submission.

The University subscribes to the standards of the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE) and encourages all researchers to familiarize themselves with its guidelines.

D. Data Management and Confidentiality

Researchers must:

- Collect, store, and process data in accordance with data protection laws and university policies.
- Maintain secure records of research data for the duration specified by the funding body or university.
- Protect the confidentiality and identity of human subjects unless explicit consent is obtained for disclosure.

E. Conflict of Interest

Faculty and researchers must disclose any financial or personal interest that could affect, or appear to affect, the integrity of research. Potential conflicts must be reported at the proposal stage and managed through appropriate university channels.

F. Training and Compliance

- All faculty supervising research must ensure that students and research assistants are trained in research ethics.
- Faculty are encouraged to complete research ethics training offered by the University.

G. Violations and Investigations

Allegations of unethical conduct in research will be investigated by the designated committee. Proven misconduct, such as plagiarism, data manipulation, or breach of confidentiality, may result in disciplinary actions, including revocation of research privileges, withdrawal of funding, or termination of employment, in accordance with University policies.

8.9 Scientific Publishing at the University of Sharjah Journal

The University is committed to supporting scientific publishing in all its forms, encompassing authored books, specialized scientific journals, scientific conference proceedings, and technical reports. These efforts are facilitated through the VCRGS, following the guidelines set forth by the Scientific Research Regulations at the University.

The University publishes a scientific refereed journal titled "The University of Sharjah Journal" through the VCRGS. The journal may be issued in multiple series or as specialized journals. The Chancellor assumes the role of the general supervisor of the journal, with an appointed Editor-In-Chief for each series. The Editorial Board comprises distinguished faculty members representing various specializations in each series, alongside an advisory body consisting of world-class researchers. Additionally, an Editorial Secretary from among the faculty members, nominated by the Editor-In-Chief and appointed with the Chancellor's approval, supports the journal's operations.

The terms of office for the Chief Editor, Editorial Board, and Editorial Secretary are two years, renewable. The Editorial Secretary may receive an appropriate financial remuneration or have their teaching loads reduced based on a percentage determined by the Chancellor.

8.10 Collaborative Research Agreements

The University of Sharjah places significant emphasis on enhancing cooperation in scientific research with local, regional, and international organizations. Collaborative agreements with external institutions follow specific principles:

1. The agreement should enhance the University's reputation in research and promote mutual research activities between the collaborating parties.
2. The agreement must align with the University's objectives and research guidelines.
3. The financial obligations and other requirements for implementing the agreement should be clearly defined and appropriate.
4. The agreement should specify the general and specific objectives of cooperation, participants, funding and other resources, duration of the cooperation and renewal methods, responsibilities of each party, and a basis for handling cooperation outcomes.

8.11 Scientific Research Procedures and Regulations

1. The University supports specialized, competitive, collaborative, and targeted research projects of high quality, aiming to enhance cooperation between the University and public and private institutions. This aims to enrich the University's capabilities in strategic domains, serving the interests of the Emirate of Sharjah and the UAE, based on the

- Research Board's approval upon the VCRGS recommendation and the Chancellor's approval.
2. Ethical conduct is of the utmost importance for all individuals involved in the research process. Researchers are expected to adhere to the highest ethical standards in their dealings with persons, materials, and information, following the Islamic Shari'a teachings, University By-Laws, regulations, and applicable laws.
 3. Research involving humans, animals, genetic materials, personal information, health, and safety must adhere to research ethics principles. Researchers should obtain appropriate approvals according to the preliminary regulations approved by the VCRGS.
 4. Intellectual property matters are addressed through the University Research Board, following the University's intellectual property policy as outlined in the policies and procedures manual.
 5. Research data and means of collection should be kept in the academic department or the VCRGS for at least five years for reference purposes.
 6. In cases where information about externally funded research cannot be published, clear and accurate agreements should be reached and approved by the Chancellor based on the VCRGS recommendation and Research Board approval.
 7. Authors are expected to acknowledge the efforts of all those who contributed to their work and the funding agencies supporting their projects. They should also acknowledge the sources of funding for their research in their publications (research, books, reports, patents, etc.).
 8. Researchers should disclose any conflict of interest that may impact research results.
 9. Violations and disagreements are addressed through the Board, based on the VCRGS recommendation and relevant and proper information preparation. The University Research Board and the Journal Editorial Boards reserve the right to cancel any project or research in cases where violations or conflicts of interest with the University's By-Laws and regulations are established.
 10. The University provides funding for the following types of research:
 - a. Seed projects.
 - b. Specialized and competitive research related to faculty's interests and research needs conducted through colleges and research groups, in coordination with the VCRGS.
 - c. Collaborative research with public and private institutions conducted through colleges and the VCRGS.
 - d. Targeted research conducted through the VCRGS and University research groups.
 11. Announcements for seed projects are made once a year during the period specified by the VCRGS. Researchers may apply for this funding type only once, during their first year at the University.
 12. To apply for research grants, the following steps must be taken:



- a. Complete the research grants forms and have them reviewed by research committees at the colleges to enhance their quality before forwarding them to the Deanship. The VCRGS then takes necessary actions for obtaining approval from the University Research Board and the Chancellor.
 - b. The project's duration should not exceed two years, but it may be renewed in special and justified cases.
 - c. The VCRGS determines the funding ceiling for research grants based on the Board's recommendation and the Chancellor's approval.
 - d. Colleges provide the VCRGS with names and addresses of potential referees related to the research proposal.
13. Applications for all types of research grants can be submitted from the beginning of the first semester until the end of April of every academic year. Seed projects are announced at the beginning of each academic year.
 14. Faculty members may not act as principal investigators for two projects simultaneously, except for seed projects. Research group members may apply for synchronous funding for two research projects, with one project conducted independently and the other through the research group.
 15. The principal investigator of a project must hold a Ph.D. degree or an equivalent degree recognized by the University in their specialty. Additionally, they must be full-time employees of the University and not visitors.
 16. Competitive, collaborative, and targeted research projects undergo a peer review process based on an approved form specifically prepared for this purpose. Evaluation criteria include the researcher's competence based on their scientific production and CVs, the research quality in terms of importance, originality, research methods' appropriateness, and the feasibility of achieving research objectives. The impact of the research on scientific, economic, social, and cultural development is also considered.
 17. The funding ceiling for such research projects is determined based on the annual research budget prepared by the VCRGS, upon the Board's recommendation and the Chancellor's approval.
 18. The research grant for a project covers various aspects of the research, including:
 - a. Costs for research assistants, capped at a maximum of 30% of the project's budget, which may be raised to 50% in special and justified cases by the Board.
 - b. Purchase of books, reference materials, and sources.
 - c. Publication of research and related activities.
 - d. Purchase of relevant research software.
 - e. Acquisition of equipment and materials necessary for research.
 - f. Insurance for research equipment and fees for periodic equipment maintenance.

- g. Costs of research tests, both within and outside the country.
 - h. Costs of field trips and other travel requirements within the country.
 - i. Costs of conducting field surveys and questionnaires.
 - j. Any other costs included in the project budget and approved by the Board.
19. The research grant for a project typically does not cover expenses related to participation in conferences, gatherings, seminars, or similar activities, except in limited and exceptional cases where the research is the primary subject matter of the event. Such exceptions require justifiable recommendations by the VCRGS and approval from the Chancellor.
 20. The principal investigator is entitled to a petty cash advance of up to AED 5000, subject to approval by the VCRGS. The advance may be closed at the end of the academic year or carried forward to the next academic year. The Principal Investigator may extend the advance to another period based on the project budget and approved completion period. The petty cash amount may also be substituted by original invoices approved by the Dean until the advance term's closure at the end of the project.
 21. The principal investigator may apply for a research advance of up to 10% of the basic research project grant. The Research Purchasing Committee under the VCRGS reviews the application and makes recommendations, subject to approval by the VCRGS.
 22. The advance may be raised to a maximum of 30% of the basic research project grant in special cases justified by the principal investigator and approved by the VCRGS upon the Research Purchasing Committee's recommendation.
 23. In case a reference book required for the research project is not available in the University Library, the following steps are taken:
 - a. The principal investigator submits a book acquisition application to the VCRGS.
 - b. The VCRGS, in coordination with the Library, verifies that the requested book is not already available in the Library's catalogue and indicates the book's price.
 - c. The VCRGS authorizes the principal investigator to purchase the book directly using their research budget.
 24. The principal investigator must immediately deliver the purchased book to the VCRGS for approval under the University Library Cataloguing System for Scientific Research. The principal investigator may then borrow the book from the library following the standard circulation system regulations, with special handling for the loan period based on the research project's completion period.
 25. Computers, laptops, and PCs fall under the responsibility of the University Purchasing Department, which provides them to all currently employed faculty members. Therefore, it is not permitted to purchase computers or their accessories for research projects if they are already available.
 26. Exceptions to the Purchase of Research Equipment

The principal investigator may submit a purchase order for consideration to the Deanship only in the following cases:

- a. The University does not possess a computer that meets the specifications required by the approved research project.
- b. The nature of the research demands reassembling or adjusting computer components to achieve a specific result.
- c. The nature of the project necessitates conducting field measurements for extended periods using a specialized computer system for monitoring, storage, and confidential documentation of particular measurements.
- d. The research assistant lacks a computer, and their work requires an extended period of time.

27. Acquisition of Computer Software

If the required computer software is unavailable at the IT, the following steps must be taken:

- a. The principal investigator should submit an application to the VCRGS for purchasing the required computer software.
- b. The VCRGS, in coordination with the Computer Center, will verify the unavailability of the software within the Electronic Library and check its compatibility with the University's systems and operating systems, including price comparisons.
- c. If the software is not available within the country, the principal investigator may purchase it directly from their research budget or collaborate with the University Purchasing Department, following approval from the VCRGS.

28. Funding for Student Research Projects

The University allocates a yearly budget to support distinguished research projects of undergraduate and graduate students, including senior projects models, theses and dissertations, to promote research among students. The following rules apply:

- a. Students must submit their research plans, theses, or dissertations through their academic department and college. The submission must include a budget for the project and written approval from the supervisor.
- b. The research plan is presented to the research committee of the college to ensure its integrity, originality, and suitability for funding.
- c. The research plan is then evaluated by the College Dean for necessary action.

d. The funding ceiling for each project is AED 5000.

29. Reporting Requirements for Research Projects

The principal investigator must provide the VCRGS with an annual progress report for the project, approved by the Dean. Upon project completion, a final report and a special form provided by the VCRGS must be submitted. The Dean may approve the project's closure if its objectives have been achieved. However, if the project period ends, and the final report is not submitted or justified, the Dean may refer the issue to the Board, which may close the project and reclaim any spent funds from the investigator.

30. Payment Procedures for Research Projects

All payment procedures for competitive, collaborative, targeted, seed, and student research projects must be approved by the Dean. Payments should be based on original invoices or purchase orders presented by the investigator, and deductions will follow the funding rules mentioned earlier.

31. Coverage of Publishing Academic Research

The University covers the costs of publishing academic research submitted by faculty members in international, refereed, and scientific journals, regardless of whether the research is part of a funded project.

32. Application for Publishing Academic Research

Faculty members can apply for covering the publishing cost of their academic research within the approved research plan. For research outside funded projects, the application must be made through the College Dean or the college to which the faculty member is affiliated. The application should include:

- a. A copy of the published research or the research accepted for publishing.
- b. Proof of publication or acceptance for publication.
- c. Evidence that the journal is scientific, refereed, and regularly published.
- d. The original invoice.

33. Criteria for Publishing Academic Research

The published research must list the researcher's affiliation as the University of Sharjah, and the researcher should be employed full-time at the University. For research within funded projects, the project number must be provided, along with an indication that the project was funded by the Board.

34. Coverage of Publishing Academic Research in Conferences

The College Dean may approve the coverage of publishing academic research presented at international scientific conferences and gatherings if the researcher is involved in an approved research project as a principal investigator, associate investigator, coordinator, or member of a research group. The publishing cost will be deducted from the research group's budget or the research project's budget, as applicable. For research projects outside funded projects or research groups, the cost will be covered by the scientific research budget, and the approval of the Chancellor is required if the amount exceeds AED 2,000.

35. Encouragement of Joint-Scientific Research

The University encourages joint-scientific research between researchers within and outside the institution, fostering specialized or interdisciplinary research groups. These research groups may act as nuclei for future research centers and units, maximizing research capabilities and promoting collaboration with private and public community institutions.

36. Formation of Research Groups

Research groups must observe the following:

- a. Groups of researchers (at least three) can register a research group under the VCRG with an appropriate name. One researcher, preferably holding the rank of Professor or Associate Professor, should coordinate its functions. Researchers can be from the same college or different colleges, and external researchers may join as associate members without receiving University member privileges.
- b. Researchers forming research groups should assess available expertise, competencies, and capabilities in their colleges and other colleges to avoid interference and duplication. Groups with overlapping efforts may be asked to merge into a single group before consideration.
- c. Research groups are registered for three renewable years, subject to performance evaluation, University policy, Board approval, and the Chancellor's endorsement.
- d. Research groups may receive an annual grant based on their performance, as per regulations established for this purpose.
- e. Research groups receive additional benefits, including synchronous funding for members, allowances, research projects, attendance at scientific conferences, or participation in research visits.

f. Annual and final reports on group activities must be submitted to the VCRGS for evaluation, dissemination of information, and continued support and registration approval.

g. The scientific outcome of research groups should bear the name of the colleges or centers to which the researchers belong, linked to the research group's name.

h. Researchers may participate in more than one research group, provided they can actively contribute and are not coordinators of more than one group simultaneously.

i. The University Research Board may approve partial or full sabbatical or financial awards for coordinators of research groups, upon the Chancellor's approval.

37. Hosting Research Groups

Research groups report to the VCRGS but may be hosted by colleges, which should publicize them through various media, including print and electronic formats. Hosting research groups offers several benefits:

- a. Presence of an actively engaged registered research group at the hosting college.
- b. Availability of additional research funding for participating faculty members.
- c. Increased publicity for the college's research activities due to the research group's involvement.
- d. Enhanced opportunities for training researchers and students in research-related fields.

38. Annual Progress Reports for Research Groups

Research groups are expected to submit annual progress reports on their performance. These reports are used to assess the group's achievements, allocate appropriate funds, report to the Board, and disseminate information about research groups. The VCRGS may request semi-annual summary reports if necessary.

39. Funding for Authored Books

The University of Sharjah provides funding for publishing authored books, including textbooks, scientific reference books, and general knowledge books. Specific financial awards for authors are also available, with the maximum and minimum amounts determined based on evaluations and recommendations from the VCRGS, subject to the Chancellor's approval.

40. Funding for Authored Books by External Authors

In special cases, upon the recommendation of the VCRGS and approval of the Chancellor, the University may fund publishing distinguished authored books by authors from outside the University. Such authors should follow the same funding procedures as faculty members when applying for support.

41. Implementation of Guidelines

The VCRGS is responsible for implementing these guidelines as the authority responsible for receiving applications and processing publishing requirements.

42. Evaluation and Determination of Book Awards

The maximum award limit is set at AED 42,000, and the minimum award is AED 16,000. The value of the award is calculated based on total points accumulated from the book evaluation.

43. Pricing of Published Books

The prices of books published by the VCRGS are determined by the VCRGS, upon the recommendation of the Head of the Scientific Research Department. The pricing is calculated based on specific criteria, multiplying the total cost of the book (including refereeing, mailing, author's copies, awards, wages, and deductions) by two and dividing it by the number of copies.

44. Dedication of Books and Journals

The right to dedicate a book or journal published by the University, whether on campus or outside, is restricted to the Chancellor or the VCRGS.

45. University Journals

The University publishes a refereed periodical, representing the University, to cover various fields of knowledge and offer faculty members, researchers within and outside the University, the opportunity to publish and disseminate their research for the benefit of all. The journal aims to contribute to scientific and cultural development, disseminate new research viewpoints, and strengthen communication with community institutions, especially those involved in scientific research within or outside the Arab World.

46. University of Sharjah Journal Series

The University publishes a refereed scientific journal in three series:

- a. University of Sharjah Journal for Humanities and Social Sciences.
- b. University of Sharjah Journal for Shari'a and Islamic Studies.

c. University of Sharjah Journal for Law Sciences.

47. Journal Aims and Scope

The University of Sharjah Journal aims to contribute to the development, enrichment, and dissemination of knowledge by publishing original scientific research and reviews in various fields.

48. Journal Publication Rules

University journals adhere to specific publication rules outlined in their latest issue. Editorial Boards may propose amendments subject to approval.

49. Editorial Board Responsibilities and Powers

Editorial Boards are responsible for formulating publication policies, deciding on research acceptance based on referees' recommendations, ensuring high scientific quality, and maintaining impartiality in the review process.

50. Publication of Conference Proceedings

The University publishes conference and symposium proceedings, with organizers responsible for collecting, editing, formatting, reviewing, and submitting the final document to the VCRGS for publication.

51. Requirements for Publishing Conference Proceedings

Organizers submit requests for publishing proceedings through the college or research group that organized the event. The VCRGS processes the request and coordinates with organizers for production and publication.

52. Funding of Research Equipment

The University of Sharjah allocates an annual budget for colleges and research groups to purchase costly research equipment, enhancing research capabilities in various fields and specialties.

53. Application for Research Equipment Funding

Applications for equipment valued above AED 40,000 are submitted to the Research Committee under the VCRGS. A special committee evaluates applications and recommends funding for the following year's budget.

54. Registration and Maintenance of Research Equipment

All research equipment must be registered with the Central Laboratories, following operating regulations and maintained as needed.

55. Use of Research Equipment

Faculty must coordinate with equipment supervisors and inform the VCRGS and Central Laboratories when requiring research equipment.

56. External Funding for Research Projects

The VCRGS facilitates obtaining external funding from national and international institutions for research projects, with 30% of research grants deducted for the University of Sharjah's account.

57. Allocation of Research Grants

University grants cover faculty members' costs based on a recommended equation, considering any external funding received from the host institution.

58. Sabbatical Leave and Research Grants

Faculty members on sabbatical leave are not allowed to combine teaching with research grant applications to focus on proposal development.

59. Faculty Member's Report on Research Project

Faculty members receiving external research grants must submit a comprehensive report on project conduct and achieved results, demonstrating research cooperation with the host institution.

60. Visiting Researcher Grants

Faculty members can apply for grants to host visiting researchers, subject to Board or VCRGS approval for research groups.

61. Application and Evaluation of Visiting Researcher Grants

Applications for hosting visiting researchers must meet specific requirements, and evaluations consider research significance, nature, and researcher competence.

62. Sabbatical Leave for Visiting Researchers



Sabbatical leave for visiting researchers should not exceed two months and should not interfere with University commitments.

Chapter 9: Intellectual Properties Management

The University of Sharjah has established the Technology Transfer Office (TTO) to manage all intellectual property assets derived from the exceptional research activities and outcomes at the University. The TTO serves as a platform to propel university research beyond the lab and towards commercialization in the marketplace.

The University of Sharjah's primary purpose of intellectual property protection policy is to facilitate the commercial development of intellectual property emerging at UoS while encouraging faculty and students to actively participate in this development. It acknowledges that the pursuit and dissemination of knowledge are fundamental values aligned with the university's strategic plan for innovation and growth. Additionally, this policy aims to foster good practice in defining ownership and protecting the intellectual property rights of UoS faculty, students, and staff. It establishes general guidelines for intellectual property management, ensuring equitable benefit allocation between inventors and the university, promoting widespread dissemination of innovative work, and maximizing the community's benefit from all inventions and discoveries.

The University of Sharjah views technology transfer as an integral component of its mission to disseminate knowledge, encourage creativity and innovation in research and scholarship, address community needs, and contribute to the knowledge-based economy of Sharjah and the UAE. This policy is designed to support this mission by providing a comprehensive framework governing the ownership, use, commercial development, and disposition of inventions, discoveries, and creative endeavors produced at or under the auspices of the University of Sharjah. It also lays the groundwork for safeguarding the intellectual property rights of its faculty, staff, and students and facilitates their commercial utilization through licensing to external parties.

The implementation of this policy falls under the purview of the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies (OVCGRS) and the TTO, ensuring adherence to the University's primary mission and executive bylaws.

For clarity, the following definitions apply to the terms mentioned in the Intellectual Property policy:

1. **Inventor:** Refers to an individual or group of individuals responsible for the creation of Intellectual Property, whether through invention, authorship, or any other means.
2. **Intellectual Property (IP):** Encompasses various rights such as inventions, discoveries, improvements, copyrightable works, integrated circuit mask work, trademarks, trade secrets, and licensable know-how, and their related rights.
3. **Gross Income:** Signifies the total monetary payments received by the University resulting from the transfer of Intellectual Property rights to a third party.
4. **Net Income:** Represents the monetary payments received by the University from transferring Intellectual Property rights to a third party, after deducting the University's

expenses (including legal fees) directly related to protecting, developing, maintaining, and transferring that Intellectual Property.

5. Research, Scholarly, and Creative Activity Work Product: Denotes copyrightable works that encompass artistic creations or other works resulting from research, such as books, theses, dissertations, articles, poems, musical works, dramatic works, film, product design, graphic and sculptural works.
6. Employee: Refers to individuals employed or compensated by the University, including faculty members, staff, and students. For the purpose of this guideline, students receiving compensation for their research activities are considered employees.

9.1 Intellectual Property Ownership Rights

Unless stated otherwise in this policy, the University of Sharjah shall own all Intellectual Property Rights of inventions or creative works produced by faculty, staff, and students at or under the auspices of the University while making substantial use of its resources.

9.1.1 Intellectual Property Created by Faculty and Staff

- a. Unless mentioned in paragraphs e and f of this section, UoS shall possess all Intellectual Property invented, created, or designed by faculty or staff members (including post-doctoral students, assistants, trainees, or students employed as staff) for the purposes of research, teaching, and administration during their employment at the University.
- b. Intellectual Property developed by faculty or staff with significant support from UoS, including funds, facilities, resources, and space, shall be assigned to the University and considered university-owned.
- c. Faculty or staff members shall be required to sign any documents or agreements necessary to facilitate the protection of the invention and filing of patent applications and related procedures, thereby assigning their intellectual property rights to UoS.
- d. By signing these documents or agreements, the inventor agrees to assign the intellectual property they have developed to UoS for management by the Technology Transfer Office.
- e. UoS does not claim ownership of copyright in any written work authored by faculty for scholarly research purposes, such as journal articles, conference proceedings, and books.
- f. UoS does not claim ownership of copyright material in artistic, or imaginative works created or composed by faculty, except when such works are considered potentially valuable IP assets—subject to the TT's recommendation—or have been specially commissioned by the university.

9.1.2 Intellectual Property Created by Students

a. Students who create intellectual property as a result of their participation in study programs at UoS, such as PhD dissertations, research reports, or graduation projects, shall retain ownership rights unless:

1. The creation involves substantial use of UoS property, personnel, or facilities.

2. The creation is supported by a direct allocation of funds through the University (e.g., grants, contracts, fellowships, scholarships, etc.).
3. The creation is commissioned by the University.
4. The creation is subject to contractual obligations, such as a sponsored research agreement.

b. If any of the above conditions are met, students shall be treated in the same manner as UoS employees. Students must disclose to the Technology Transfer Office any intellectual property they have developed in which UoS may have ownership rights.

c. A faculty member supervising students should have them sign an Assignment of Ownership Agreement Form and a non-disclosure form.

d. Any student involved in research or development of intellectual property under the supervision of a faculty member, concerning any program or activity subject to this Intellectual Property Policy, shall claim no ownership rights unless they have made significant contributions to the IP's creation. Such students shall be eligible to share the income and/or equity distribution, as determined by the Technology Transfer Office, proportional to their contribution, as per the signed IP disclosure form.

e. If a student independently creates and owns intellectual property believed to have commercialization potential, the student may request support from the TTO to involve the University in the commercial exploitation of that property and shall assign the IP rights to UoS. In such cases, all other procedures of IP policies, including revenue distribution, shall be applied.

9.2 University Responsibilities

The Technology Transfer Office (TTO) under the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research and Graduate Studies (VCRGS) shall undertake the following responsibilities on behalf of the University:

- a. Establish procedures for the exploitation of Intellectual Property created by UoS Inventors.
- b. Provide oversight of Intellectual Property management and technology transfer.
- c. Offer legal advice and services to support the commercialization of university-owned intellectual property.
- d. Reward inventors by ensuring a fair sharing of royalties from inventions assigned to the university.
- e. Allocate necessary financial resources for the protection and commercialization of intellectual property.
- f. License and market the Intellectual Property effectively.
- g. Implement measures to safeguard the University's Intellectual Property.

9.3 Responsibilities of UoS Inventors

Faculty, staff, and students have the following responsibilities:

- a. Adhere to the principles outlined in the above guidelines.
- b. Create, retain, and use Intellectual Property in accordance with applicable UAE and international laws and University Policies.
- c. Promptly disclose in writing any and all Intellectual Property, whether patentable or not, as per these guidelines and regardless of the funding source of the related research.
- d. Assign title to such Intellectual Property to the University.
- e. Provide all requested documents to the university in a timely manner.
- f. Sign, when requested by the TTO, any documents or formalities necessary for patent application filings (e.g., declaration of invention, deed of assignment, etc.).
- g. Collaborate with the TTO in securing and protecting the University's Intellectual Property, including cooperation with the university's agents (e.g., patent attorneys, IP Lawyers) during the process of obtaining and maintaining patent, copyright, or other suitable protection for such Intellectual Property and in legal actions taken against infringements.
- h. Work with the TTO to commercialize their inventions in compliance with university bylaws, including those related to conflicts of interest.
- i. Delay publication as stipulated in the terms of sponsoring contracts or grants and consider delaying public disclosure to ensure proper patent protection.
- j. Refrain from taking any actions inconsistent with the university's ownership of the intellectual property.
- k. Obtain prior written permission from the university before using the university's name, logo, or other identifier in any commercial context involving university-owned intellectual property.

9.4 Disclosure of Intellectual Property

9.4.1 The Obligation to Disclose

- a. Individuals subject to this Intellectual Property Policy are obligated to promptly disclose to the TTO all Intellectual Property in which the University has an ownership interest under the provisions of the Intellectual Property Policy, or for which disclosure is required by contract or law.
- b. Prompt disclosure is essential for Intellectual Property conceived and/or made with external funding to meet the University's legal obligations under such funding agreements.
- c. Any publication or verbal disclosure that describes patentable Intellectual Property before filing for patent protection may jeopardize patenting. Therefore, individuals covered by the Intellectual Property Policy are encouraged to disclose as soon as possible after the conception of the Intellectual Property or seek guidance from a technology licensing professional at the TTO as needed.
- d. An invention disclosure entails providing information about the inventor(s), the nature of the invention, and the circumstances leading to it. The inventor must also submit manuscripts, sketches, drawings, and other relevant data or materials as part of the disclosure.
- e. Disclosure shall be made using the IP Disclosure Form available from TTO and should include a complete and comprehensive description of the discovery and a list of Inventors, with distribution based on their percentage of contributions.

f. Failure to complete the IP Disclosure Form as required will not harm or weaken the ownership rights and obligations of either the University or the inventor, as described in this Policy.

9.4.2 Disclosure Evaluation

a. Upon receiving a completed disclosure form, the TTO will review it to determine the rights and obligations of all parties involved and assess the commercial significance of the discovery. Patentability issues will be evaluated through consultation with specialized patent attorney(s).

b. The Director of the TTO may, at their discretion, appoint evaluation committees with expertise in the relevant research field to assist in the patentability evaluation process.

c. As per this Policy, the TTO is required to consult with the Inventor(s) or other relevant parties to better understand the disclosure's scientific and commercial merit and develop strategies for protection, development, and commercialization.

d. The Inventor(s) must make additional information available to the TTO and university patent agents as required at all stages of this process.

e. The decision to seek patent protection is made by the TTO based on the disclosure data submitted by the inventor(s) after objective evaluation of the invention's originality and commercial potential.

f. In making the decision about whether or not to file patent applications, the TTO shall take the following factors into consideration:

- The extent of the university's ownership
- The extent to which the inventor(s) have disclosed the intellectual property to the TTO
- Any conflicts of interest
- The university's right to file the application if the inventor(s) are using an external grant

g. Throughout the evaluation process, the intellectual property's inventor, as well as staff and students with knowledge of the invention, must take all reasonable steps to protect the intellectual property by avoiding public disclosure.

h. The TTO shall inform the Inventor(s) of the outcome of its review regarding rights and obligations as soon as practical but no later than 90 calendar days from receipt of a complete Intellectual Property disclosure.

9.5 Patent Protection

1. In administering patent protection, the TTO shall actively promote the public disclosure and utilization of all inventions in which UoS holds ownership rights. The TTO shall employ suitable means to develop, promote, and license intellectual property, while adhering to the guidelines of this policy.
2. UoS, through its TTO, is authorized to engage in agreements with external parties that facilitate the development, patent acquisition, or commercialization of inventions, provided such agreements align with the university's intellectual property policy.

3. By securing intellectual property protection for UoS, the university gains the right to exclude external parties from manufacturing, using, or selling the invented products within the jurisdictions where UoS has sought protection.
4. The TTO is not obligated to seek patent protection for inventions it deems lacking sufficient commercial potential.

12.3 Copyright Protection Policy

1. This Policy also covers copyright protection for books, computer software, artworks, and other copyrightable materials, with the following objectives:
 - a. Acknowledging and safeguarding authorship of creative works.
 - b. Licensing, using, and commercializing university-owned works.
 - c. Allowing the university to reproduce individually owned copyrighted materials for educational purposes with the written consent of the author/creator.
2. Copyrighted materials remain the property of their creators (individually owned) unless they are:
 - a. Developed as part of a university project or program funded by the university.
 - b. Developed as part of a university-commissioned project or program.
3. With the written consent of the author/creator, UoS may use, reproduce, or commercialize individually owned materials after reaching a mutual agreement on royalty distribution.
4. To acknowledge authorship and protect the originality of the work, the author/creator is required to complete and submit an IP Disclosure Form (available on the TTO website) to the TTO before publication.
5. Upon approval by the VCRGS and the TTO, the creative work is added to the university-owned copyrighted materials.
6. UoS has a royalty-free non-commercial use of any copyrightable materials developed by staff or students (except for books and materials published outside the university) if they were developed using university facilities, supplies, equipment, or services.

9.7 Tangible Research Property

1. University-Owned Tangible Research Property (TRP) without a pending patent application typically remains under the protection of the principal investigator and the research team.
2. Faculty or students seeking to transfer TRP to another institution for research purposes must complete and submit a Materials Transfer Agreement Form (MTA) available from the TTO.
3. For commercial purposes, transferring TRP to external parties requires the approval of the VCRGS through a written agreement between UoS and the external party.
4. Faculty or students intending to take copies or samples of TRP upon leaving the university must obtain approval from the VCRGS before removing such materials from the university premises. However, TRP undergoing IP evaluation remains confidential within the university premises.

9.8 Commercialization

1. Commercialization is a priority for UoS in developing and distributing its owned intellectual property and facilitating technology transfer for the benefit of the local and international community.
2. UoS's commercialization policy aims to benefit the university, the inventor, and the public. Decisions regarding the commercialization of UoS Intellectual Property by the TTO shall comply with the guidelines outlined in this policy.
3. The TTO, in consultation with the inventor(s), shall choose the most suitable method to transfer UoS Intellectual Property that aligns with its mission and benefits the public.
4. The TTO is authorized to manage agreements concerning the transfer of university-owned patent rights, computer software, other copyrightable materials, and tangible research materials.
5. Successful commercialization requires collaboration between the TTO, Colleges, Departments, and the Inventor(s).
6. The TTO, in consultation with the inventor(s), holds the authority to make decisions regarding the method of commercializing UoS Intellectual Property. External parties, including legal advisors and patenting agencies, may be consulted to facilitate commercialization.
7. The authority to sign licenses or agreements related to the transfer of university-owned intellectual property remains with the VCRGS and the TTO. Inventor(s) of university-owned intellectual property have no right to negotiate licensing agreements with any external party under any circumstances.
8. The University may establish additional guidelines addressing potential conflicts of interest in licensing, in addition to existing conflict of interest policies.

9.9 Distribution of Licensing Revenues

1. Unless otherwise stated in this policy, the University shall share revenues derived from the commercialization of its owned intellectual property with all involved Inventors among its employees and students.
2. The administration of all royalty payments derived from university-owned intellectual property shall be handled by the TTO and the VCRGS.
3. After recovering IP protection expenses, the net royalty revenue shall be distributed as follows: 50% to the inventor(s), and 50% to the University. The University's share, in turn, shall be distributed as follows:
 - a. 40% to the VCRGS to support TTO and research activities at the University.
 - b. 5% to the Inventors' College(s), if applicable.
 - c. 5% (or 10% if is not applicable) to the Inventors' Department(s) or equivalent unit(s).

4. The VCRGS may allocate portions of the University's share of the net royalty income to any other relevant unit.
5. In cases where inventor(s) of Intellectual Property cannot be clearly or fairly identified, royalties shall be shared between the university and the relevant academic department or research institute.
6. The reimbursement of expenses, net royalty income for intellectual property, and the final distribution of shares shall be determined by the VCRGS based on recommendations by the TTO.
7. In the commercialization of intellectual property owned by more than one inventor, the net royalty income shall be shared equally among all inventors, unless they agree otherwise as specified in the IP Disclosure Form.

9.10 Dispute Resolution

1. In case of a dispute arising from the application of this policy or any related procedures, the VCRGS shall appoint a moderator (arbiter) to assist the parties in resolving the dispute.
2. If the dispute cannot be resolved with the help of the appointed moderator, the VCRGS shall engage a qualified expert from the university or an external entity to recommend an impartial and fair settlement of the dispute.
3. To gather sufficient evidence, the expert may interview the parties to the dispute, including staff and students who may submit their responses in writing.
4. The expert's findings and resulting recommendations, following consultation with the TTO, shall be submitted to the VCRGS for a final decision.
5. Following examination of the expert's recommendations, the VCRGS shall issue a final judgment on the dispute in writing.

Chapter 10: Information Technology¹

The Information Technology Center (ITC) upholds its mission to furnish cutting-edge technological infrastructure for University administration and academic activities. It remains committed to delivering world-class IT services and support, ranking among the finest in the region. To achieve this, the ITC offers extensive networks, inter-university links, and state-of-the-art hardware and software to cater to both administrative and academic needs. The ITC places significant emphasis on user support and training to ensure the effective utilization of technological resources.

Faculty benefit from a range of specialized services offered by the ITC, including:

1. Online Learning System (Blackboard): A web-enabled e-learning platform that facilitates course management and student-centric learning for both faculty and students.
2. MyUOS Portal: An access gateway to personalized web-tools and online services for the entire University community, delivering essential information tailored to faculty, students, and staff.
3. Banner Self Service: Available in both Arabic and English, this service enables students to handle registration, grade inquiries, and other functions, while faculty can enter grades, view course information, and access student details.
4. Classroom Technologies: Equipped with multimedia solutions, over 240 classrooms with custom-made Multimedia units provide enhanced teaching experiences for faculty, ensuring innovative content delivery through Virtual Desktops.
5. Service Help Desk: The ITC delivers prompt and quality Service Support & Delivery to the University community, ensuring all technical support requirements are met for desktop, printing, and classroom technologies.
6. IT Technical Support and Services: From desktop operating systems to security and applications, the ITC extends comprehensive technical support for both physical and virtual environments, including printing support services and IT equipment maintenance.

Furthermore, UoS boasts college and department-specific computer labs, totaling around 94 with 1,875 computers, offering essential technological resources to over 20,000 students. A robust network infrastructure based on Gigabit Ethernet fiber-optic backbone extends to more than thirty-four buildings, with over 13,500 voice/data points, providing high bandwidth for data, voice, and video services. Telecommunications services include over 2,700 telephone extensions with advanced IP telephony and video conferencing facilities.

The ITC also maintains a cutting-edge Data Center, accommodating over 3,000 connected computers used by faculty, staff, and students. Through various servers, users access network-based resources, including internet, email, administrative packages, and more. The ITC

¹ Additional information can be found at <https://www.sharjah.ac.ae/en/Administration/ITC/Pages/pp.aspx>

administers various information systems for student information, finance, human resources, and document management.

Additionally, the ITC ensures the University website is up-to-date and globally accessible, interfacing with learning management systems, library catalogs, and other resources. The Intranet integrates all online resources, offering easy access to computer-based training CD-ROMs, library databases, and instructional material, contributing to independent and efficient learning.

The Information Technology Center takes pride in providing a supportive environment with innovative technologies and learning resources linked to the UoS portal, facilitating easy access to information resources for all students, faculty, and staff. By offering world-class services and continuous support, the ITC plays a crucial role in shaping the University's technological landscape.

10.1 Acceptable Use Policy

The Policy applies to all individuals using computing resources owned or managed by the University of Sharjah, including faculty, staff, students, alumni, contractors, volunteers, guests, agents of the administration, and external entities accessing network services via the University's computing facilities. It encompasses processing facilities, hardware, software, user accounts, and both physical and wireless connections to the University's network.

10.1.1 Acceptable Use

1. Prompt Reporting: Employees must promptly report any theft, loss, or unauthorized disclosure of the University of Sharjah's information.
2. Reasonable Personal Use: Employees are responsible for the reasonable personal use of University information systems.
3. Compliance with Laws: Under no circumstances should any activity that violates local, federal, or international law be carried out using University resources.
4. Representation: Users accessing the internet using University resources should be mindful of representing the University of Sharjah. Opinions expressed should be clearly identified as personal and not necessarily reflective of UoS.
5. Confidentiality: University of Sharjah's information, including academic transcripts, research patents, health records, etc., is considered confidential and must not be disclosed on public forums or social media without authorization.
6. Avoiding Harm: Negative public comments on social media or to the media that may harm the University's image or reputation are strictly prohibited.
7. Responsible Sharing: Users sharing views on external websites must exercise caution, avoiding violations of legal and privacy rights or the transmission of malicious content.
8. Regular Data Backup: Users are expected to back up their data regularly using approved IT storage media.

9. Information Security: Users must not share classified information outside the organization, complying with the Data Classification Policy.
10. Secure Computer Screens: Users should secure their computer screens when away from their desks, adhering to the Clear Desk Policy.

10.1.2 Unacceptable Use

1. Software Piracy: Installation or distribution of unauthorized software products is strictly prohibited.
2. Copyright Violations: Unauthorized copying or distribution of copyrighted material is not allowed.
3. Unauthorized Access: Accessing data, servers, or accounts for purposes other than UoS business is prohibited.
4. Illegal Export: Exporting software or technology in violation of international or UAE laws is illegal.
5. Malicious Activities: Introducing malicious programs or disrupting network communication is strictly prohibited.
6. Password Sharing: Users must not reveal their account passwords to others or allow others to use their accounts.
7. Fraudulent Offers: Making fraudulent offers originating from a UoS account is not permitted.
8. Breach of Information Security: Any form of network monitoring or information security breach is prohibited.
9. Interference with Network: Executing activities that interfere with other terminal sessions is not allowed.
10. Unauthorized Sharing: Providing information about UoS employees to external parties is prohibited.

10.1.3 Internet Usage

1. Official Use: Internet facilities should be used strictly for official purposes.
2. No Unauthorized Access: Users must not establish unauthorized means of accessing the internet.
3. Responsible Internet Access: Users must use their own credentials for internet access.
4. Data Protection: Users should refrain from downloading and distributing malicious software on the University's network.
5. Restricted Content: Users must not access illegal or unethical websites with explicit content.
6. Personal Accountability: Users are responsible for internet usage originating from their accounts.

10.1.4 Email and Communication Activities

1. No Email Spam: Sending unsolicited email messages or junk mail is strictly prohibited.
2. No Harassment: Conducting harassment via email, telephone, or paging is not allowed.
3. No Unauthorized Use: Unauthorized use or forging of email header information is prohibited.
4. No Chain Letters: Creating or forwarding chain letters or pyramid schemes is not permitted.

10.1.5 Violations and Breaches

1. Reporting: Any violation of this Policy should be reported immediately to the "Information Security Team".
2. Compliance: Users are expected to comply with existing policies, laws, and legislation related to Information Security.
3. Consequences: Breach of this Policy may lead to disciplinary action, including legal proceedings, as per UAE laws and the University's Violations and Penalties Policy.

10.2 Anti-Malware and Anti-Virus Policy

1. Preventive Measures: All possible and practical measures shall be taken to prevent malware from infiltrating the University of Sharjah's information systems.
2. Antivirus Solutions: Approved antivirus solutions must be installed on all information systems, including servers, laptops, desktops, storage devices, High-performance computing systems, and IoT devices.
3. Mobile Devices: Whenever technically possible, mobile devices should also have antivirus software installed. Malware detection infrastructure must be implemented at points where malware can potentially enter the University of Sharjah's information network.
4. Real-Time Operation: Antivirus software shall operate in real-time on all servers and client computers.
5. Scheduled Scans: Virus scanners shall be scheduled to perform auto-scans at regular intervals, with the frequency of scanning clearly defined.
6. Email Scanning: Both inbound and outbound email messages, along with their attachments, shall be scanned for viruses.
7. Regular Updates: The malware detection infrastructure will be kept up-to-date with the latest product and virus signature updates released by the antivirus vendor.
8. No Disabling: Antivirus software and clients on University of Sharjah's systems must never be disabled or stopped while connected to the network.
9. Gateway Level Scanning: All files downloaded or transferred within the University of Sharjah's network and information systems shall undergo malware scanning at the gateway level.

10. Network Traffic Scanning: All network traffic entering and leaving the University of Sharjah as network, including internet, email, and file transfers, shall be scanned for malware.
11. User Awareness: All University of Sharjah's information system users shall receive appropriate awareness training on antivirus best practices and policies.
12. Prompt Reporting: Users are responsible for immediately reporting any malware or virus incidents to the IT Service Desk or Information Security Team.
13. Email Systems Security: Email systems must be enforced with appropriate malware and phishing controls, and email attachments from unreliable sources should not be opened.
14. Caution with Mobile Codes: Mobile codes like ActiveX controls should not be activated unless from a trusted source and deemed acceptable.
15. Software Testing: Software from untrustworthy sources, when necessary to be tested, must be done on an isolated system with proper approval from the Information Security Team.
16. Antivirus Configuration: The antivirus solution shall be configured to scan all files, including compressed files, and automatically clean detected malware. Infected files that cannot be cleaned shall be quarantined or deleted.

10.2.1 Antivirus Standards

University of Sharjah-approved antivirus software must be installed on desktops, laptops, mobile devices, and servers with up-to-date definitions.

10.2.2 Exceptions

Any exceptions to this policy must be explicitly reviewed by the Information Security Team and approved by the ITC Director. These exceptions shall have a specified validity period and shall be re-assessed and re-approved if necessary.

10.2.3 Policy Compliance, Enforcement, and Violations:

1. Clarification and Advice: Users unsure or unclear about any aspect of this policy should seek clarification or advice from the Information Security Team.
2. Reporting Incidents: All users shall immediately report any known or suspected information security incidents.
3. Anonymity: The anonymity of users reporting suspected incidents shall be maintained unless the matter is referred to a court of law.
4. Violations: Violations of this policy and supporting policies may result in corrective or disciplinary action by the Management.
5. Internal Audit: An internal audit shall be conducted annually, and a compliance report shall be submitted to the IT Information Technology Committee.

10.3 Archiving and Retention

This policy outlines the regulations governing the definition, capture, utilization, storage, disposal, and archival of University Records meeting the criteria of “University Records.” It provides guidance to University offices on creating and using records, sets records management standards, and establishes Records Retention Schedules. Additionally, it ensures the maintenance and accessibility of historical records in all formats.

University Records Lifecycle: Regardless of format, University Records stored in IT/Digital format have a specific lifespan. When these records become inactive, the University shall determine their appropriate disposition based on economy, efficiency, historical significance, or administrative necessity.

Records Categories: Records shall be designated as University Records stored within IT, Archival Records transferred to the custody of the University Archives, or other designated categories as per the University’s policies and guidelines.

Custodianship and Disposal: University Records in the custody of originating and receiving units are University property and may not be disposed of without adherence to this policy. Access to such records is governed by applicable statutes, regulations, and University policies.

Mergers and Reorganizations: Records from merged units should be transferred to the new units, while records from phased-out units shall be reviewed by the Records Management Program and University Archives for appropriate action.

10.3.1 Archival and Retention System

The University of Sharjah is committed to archiving its data as per regulatory requirements to ensure data availability, integrity, and confidentiality.

Archival System: The University must build and manage a secure archival system to ensure permanent accessibility to authorized personnel.

Maintenance: The archive should be retained on an online storage system, maintained by designated backup operators and system administrators.

Access: Access to archives shall be granted only to authorized personnel, ensuring efficient and secure operations.

Security and Encryption: Archiving must maintain data integrity, and encryption measures shall be implemented to ensure data confidentiality.

Archival of Hard Copies: Hardcopies of documents/records must be archived in fireproof safes/cabinets and accessible to authorized personnel only.

10.3.2 Retention

The University shall retain archived data for the defined period or as per requirements. Data disposal shall be authorized by the concerned Head of Department.

Retention Schedule: A retention schedule shall list record series and their respective active retention periods.

Electronic Documents: Email retention shall be based on relevance to business matters, ensuring confidential information is not shared with external sources.

University Identities: Identity data retention shall follow UoS established processes.

10.3.2 Policy Compliance, Enforcement, and Violations

Users should seek clarification or advice from the Information Security Team regarding policy queries. Reporting information security incidents is mandatory, and violations shall result in corrective/disciplinary action. An internal audit shall be conducted annually, and compliance reports shall be submitted to the IT Information Technology Committee.

10.4 Authentication Policy

This Policy serves as a governing statement for all information security key processes, establishing rules for expected behavior by users, system administrators, management, and end-users. It authorizes security personnel to monitor, investigate, and define consequences for violations, ensuring a consensus baseline stance on security. The Policy aims to minimize risks and track compliance with regulations and legislation.

10.4.1 Password Usage Responsibilities

1. Passwords must be confidential and remain the sole responsibility of respective individuals. Failure to abide by this policy will result in disciplinary action.
2. All University of Sharjah information systems require identification and authentication using passwords, passphrases, PINs, one-time passwords, or similar mechanisms before granting access.
3. Users are liable for all actions performed on University systems using their user-ids and passwords.

4. In case of forgotten passwords, users should contact the "ITC Service Desk" for a password reset after proper verification.
5. Users must not enable the "Remember Password" feature in applications, websites, or web browsers.
6. Easily guessable passwords, such as family names or popular places, should be avoided.
7. The use of generic IDs or group accounts is prohibited, except in specific business needs, where one user is designated as responsible for activities using those accounts.

10.4.2 Password Management

All user-level and system-level passwords should adhere to the following guidelines:

1. Minimum length: 8 characters (no maximum limitation).
2. Complex passwords must contain characters from at least three of the following categories: uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and non-alphanumeric characters
3. Passwords are case-sensitive and must not include the user's name.
4. Users must change their passwords every three months, and the last five passwords cannot be repeated.
5. Administrator and privileged user" passwords should be at least 14 characters, meeting complex requirements, and changed every 45 days or upon an employer's departure.
6. Systems must force users to change initial, temporary passwords upon first login.
7. Default vendor passwords should be changed after installing any third-party device.
8. Temporary passwords must be unique, secure, and not easily guessable.

10.4.3 Account Lockout

1. The system should lock inactive sessions within 15 minutes.
2. After five unsuccessful tries, accounts should be locked for five minutes, with logging of lock and unlock events.

10.4.4 External Users Authentication

1. All external access to the University of Sharjah network must have an authentication mechanism.
2. External users must be provided with unique user-ids and passwords for accountability.
3. External users should follow the University's authentication policy for IDs created for them on Active Directory.
4. Monitoring and logging should be enabled for external users accessing web applications for support and mirroring functions.
5. External vendors require a mutually agreed Non-Disclosure Agreement before granted authentication access to University networks.

10.4.5 Authentication Policy Implementation

1. Default passwords on systems, applications, databases, and devices must be changed after the first login.
2. Applications developed or procured for the University must enforce the authentication policy during development/procurement.
3. Administrator/root passwords should not be used for day-to-day activities and must be kept securely in a fireproof safe, with usage recorded and changed when possible.
4. Core IAM services like AD and ERP should follow tiered administrative levels.
5. Applications should use UoS's centralized authentication and authorization infrastructure whenever possible, avoiding ad hoc processes with approval from the Director of Information Technology.

10.5 Privacy Policy

The purpose of this Policy is to outline the Privacy Management processes to safeguard personally identifiable information (PII) and related information assets. It aims to protect the confidentiality of information both during and after contractual relations with the University of Sharjah (UoS) for employees, contractors, vendors, and consultants. The Policy ensures that all classified information regarding UoS remains confidential, and all individuals are aware of their responsibilities to prevent inappropriate sharing and releasing of information. The privacy of information and its use through electronic means must comply with the Federal Legal Decree No. 45 for 2021 on combating cybercrimes.

1. All employees, contractors, vendors, and consultants must sign a formal undertaking to protect the confidentiality of information during and after their contractual relations with UoS.
2. Confidential information related to UoS must be kept confidential at all times.
3. The Information Security Team is responsible for ensuring that all employees are fully aware of their corporate duties and responsibilities regarding information sharing, both internally and externally. Induction programs and ongoing security awareness shall be utilized for this purpose.
4. UoS shall safeguard the privacy of its employees by incorporating IT security clauses into employment contracts and NDAs, conducting annual awareness sessions on the importance of privacy, and holding individuals accountable for any private information and personal data leakage in line with HR Disciplinary Action.

10.5.1 Employee Personal Information

1. All digital personal information of faculty, employees, students, outsourced employees, and third parties held by UoS shall be protected from unauthorized access, modification, and disclosure.

2. Personal information, including contact numbers, addresses, email addresses, and other details, stored by any department shall not be shared with external parties without the consent of the information owner.
3. Medical records and background verification checks conducted during employee onboarding shall be stored securely and treated as confidential information, shared only when required by the government and approved by UoS management.

10.5.2 Medical Patients Information

1. Patient medical record information may be sent to specialists/physicians as part of referrals for continuity of care.
2. Health information and identifying details may be used for billing or other health insurances.
3. Patient information may be used for operations or administrative purposes to improve treatment methods.
4. Taking personal photos, video, or audio recordings in patient care areas by faculty, staff, and students is prohibited to avoid capturing patients' or patient information inadvertently.

10.5.3 Protection of Students Information

Students' personal information shall be treated as confidential, and appropriate security controls shall be implemented to safeguard the information.

10.6 Learning Management System (LMS) Policy

The purpose of this Policy is to address important considerations in the use of the Learning Management System (LMS) at the University of Sharjah. The IT department administers the LMS to provide enhanced access to education by offering courses in various virtual methods to students, thereby expanding the course offerings.

E-Learning Courses: E-Learning classes are offered with all work completed using electronic technologies. Learners access primary content and instruction from an e-learning environment using various tools such as email, text and voice chat, discussion boards, web pages, and multimedia technologies. Instruction can be synchronous (participants log in simultaneously) or asynchronous (participants log in at their convenience), or a combination of both.

Online Courses: Courses offered fully online use an LMS or web presence to enhance the course.

Distance Learning: Distance learning is carried out remotely using electronic communication and is not limited by geographical locations, providing flexibility for working students and those with family commitments.

Hybrid/Blended Courses: Hybrid classes combine online learning and face-to-face interaction through video conferencing and/or an LMS. Students attend physical or video conferencing courses and log in to their e-learning environment.

Web-Enhanced Courses: Web-enhanced classes are traditional face-to-face courses that use tools in the e-learning environment to extend student learning beyond the classroom.

10.6.1 LMS Account Management

1. All eligible users have LMS accounts for as long as they are signed up for university services.
2. Registered students have LMS accounts with Student level privileges, valid during their progress at the University.
3. Faculty members have LMS accounts with Instructor privileges as long as they are signed up with the University services. They become Course Instructors for the respective LMS courses.
4. Instructors may nominate additional teaching assistants for their LMS course upon request, but they retain responsibility as the primary course instructor.
5. Non-members of UoS requiring temporary access to the LMS must request it through appropriate university divisions for officially recognized activities.

10.6.2 Exam Verification

Any student found using identification fraud in an online course will face disciplinary actions. Secondary identification is required for each student at the registration level to verify proof of identity.

10.6.3 Course Management

Course Enrollment: Courses in LMS will be generated based on the course schedules provided by the Student Information System.

Written Assignment Requirements: Written work must follow academic honesty, copyright, and intellectual property policies. Text-based papers are recommended to be submitted in suitable formats for feedback and plagiarism detection.

Attendance and Participation: Student attendance for online courses must follow the University policy on attendance.

Evaluations and Assessment: Online examinations may be conducted using LMS Test tool, and online proctoring tools should be utilized. Course coordinators may request separate LMS courses for midterm and final exams.

Course Backups: Instructors are recommended to regularly take backups of their LMS courses during and at the end of each semester.

Course Availability and Retention Policy: Courses will be potentially available to students for five years after the course has ended. Course archives can be provided upon request by the Instructor.

Course Quota: Each course is allotted 1 GB of space by default, and quotas can be updated upon request.

File Types and Size: Content uploaded to the LMS should not contain executables or scripts and should not exceed 100 MB in size.

10.6.4 Third-party Tools and Functionality Policy:

LMS can be integrated with various vendors, applications, and enterprise solutions through "building block" or APIs. Requests for academic solutions can be made to the LMS administrator for integration possibilities.

Chapter 11: Library Resources

The UoS Libraries' mission is centered around the following core principles, which are in line with the University Administration's goals and global advancements in information management, storage, retrieval, and dissemination:

1. Support the learning, teaching, and research processes by acquiring information resources that cater to the needs of the university community, including faculty, students, and administrative staff.
2. Process, organize, arrange, and offer these resources according to high library standards and practices.
3. Provide training and learning opportunities to enable users to effectively utilize these resources through continuous user teaching and training.
4. Foster cooperation and coordination with other institutions to maximize resource sharing.
5. Maintain qualified and trained library staff to meet the organizational needs of the University of Sharjah.

11.1 Library Values

The library upholds the following core values:

Knowledge:

- Encouraging learning and critical thinking.
- Promoting research and scholarly inquiry.
- Contributing actively to further scholarly endeavors.
- Viewing the library as an extension of the classroom, both physical and virtual.
- Recognizing the library as a custodian of the intellectual record.

Service:

- Providing an environment based on creativity, flexibility, and collaboration.
- Valuing each library user as unique and important.
- Committing to meet the evolving needs of the library and its users.
- Creating a comfortable, welcoming, and secure place for study, research, work, reflection, and interaction.

Quality:

- Striving for constant excellence in all endeavors.
- Recruiting qualified personnel and acquiring quality resources.
- Supporting individual growth and organizational development.

- Exceeding the community's expectations through dedicated service.

Integrity:

- Practicing honesty and candor in all interactions.
- Applying principles of fairness, justice, and equality in library operations.
- Advocating for open and equitable access to information.
- Demonstrating strong work ethics and taking responsibility for actions and commitments.

Respect:

- Treating everyone with equal consideration and courtesy.
- Embracing diverse perspectives, opinions, and ideas.
- Fulfilling the needs of library users comprehensively.
- Providing a comprehensive and diverse environment.

Communication:

- Maintaining open and honest communication at all levels.
- Encouraging Library-wide participation.
- Engaging with all segments of user communities.
- Sharing information and seeking opinions related to decisions affecting the library's success.

11.2 Code of Conduct

The Library Code of Conduct serves to create a secure, pleasant, and productive learning environment while supporting study, teaching, and research activities at the university. Library users are expected to adhere to this code, and violations may result in penalties and consequences according to University regulations.

11.2.1 Conditions of the Code of Conduct

- All users have the right to access library services and facilities safely and without distraction.
- Valid UoS ID cards are required for all UoS users to access library services. Visitors must identify themselves and register their information in the "Visitors Logbook" available at the Circulation Desk.
- Security and Library Staff have the right to inspect user's belongings while entering or leaving the library and may request ID cards for investigation purposes.
- Users must be courteous and respectful to library and security staff and comply with their directions and instructions.

- The library is not responsible for any lost or stolen personal belongings left unattended.
- Reserving study rooms, reading spaces, or seats is not permitted in the library, and users must remove their belongings when vacating a study area.
- Emergency exits should be used solely for emergency situations and not for normal exit use. Penalties may be imposed for improper usage, as exits are monitored by cameras.
- Displaying materials like posters, banners, and flyers in the library requires permission from the librarian.
- Any misbehavior observed in the library should be reported to Library or Security staff.

11.2.2 Collection and Equipment Protection

- Unauthorized removal, stealing, or concealment of library materials or property is unacceptable and may result in penalties.
- Library materials should not be concealed for limited personal use, and mutilating, damaging, or abusing library materials is not permitted.
- Users are responsible for the library materials borrowed under their names and must pay overdue fines and replacement costs for lost or damaged materials.
- Copyright laws, including photocopying, downloading, printing, or disseminating content, must be observed and respected.

11.2.3 Library Environment Protection

- Users must maintain a quiet environment in the library, with designated quiet study areas strictly for silent study. Quiet discussion is allowed in the Group Study Room.
- Mobile phones should be silenced or switched off to ensure a quiet reading area.
- Eating, drinking, and smoking are not allowed in the library, and litter should be placed in the designated bins.

11.2.4 Actions and Penalties

- Library staff may take gradual responses and impose penalties based on the violation or breach of the code, such as verbal warnings, asking users to leave the library, submitting reports to the Deanship of Students' Affairs and the student's College, and suspending library access and borrowing privileges for a specific period.

11.3 Computer Use Policy

The primary purpose of providing computer network and Internet access in the library is to support teaching, learning, research, and instructional activities at the University of Sharjah.

- Public access computers are primarily for Library-related activities, such as searching the online catalog, electronic databases, trusted websites, and educational-related links.
- Users must log on to the university network with their assigned IDs and passwords to get unrestricted access to the resources and the Internet.
- Priority for public access computers is allocated to University of Sharjah students, faculty, and staff.
- Users are responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of their passwords and accounts and for all transactions that occur under their account.
- The library disclaims any responsibility for damage or loss of data or corruption that may occur while using library computers and network facilities.
- Social and moral practices in the UAE should be observed on the Internet, and users must not use obscene language.
- Prohibited activities include sending offensive messages or graphics, receiving or sending pornographic images, sending chain letters, harassing or attacking other users, and unauthorized use of other'' IDs and passwords.
- Food and drink are not allowed near the public access computers, and the space should be used quietly and appropriately.
- Modification, destruction, or misuse of library computers is strictly prohibited.
- Damaging any computer, computer system, or computer network is not allowed.
- Recreational use of public access computers, which may prevent other users from accessing them for research and educational purposes, is strictly prohibited.
- Users are allowed to configure their laptops and use the wireless network in the library, provided it does not cause danger to others.
- Unauthorized installation of software or downloading files on the workstation's hard drives, unauthorized access to system files, copying copyright-protected materials, attempting to corrupt electronic communications systems and services, and removing or modifying information stored on the computers are all prohibited.

11.4 Library Staff

Library staff provide assistance and instruction in using the library resources, catalog, online databases, and computer networking facilities. They have the right to intervene when public access computers are misused, and network administrators may review files to ensure proper use of the system. Library staff may monitor public access computers and report any misuse or violations.

11.5 Facilities

Library facilities include printing, saving, downloading, and emailing capabilities on all computers. Students should save their files on their own devices (USBs or CDs) and not on the workstation's hard drives. Downloading programs and files to the hard drives is prohibited. The library does not charge for computer facilities, but users must bring their own papers for printing.

11.6 Locations

The University of Sharjah manages all functions of nine libraries. The following summary presents basic information about these libraries:

Main Library (W16): a central library for women on the University's Women Campus (W16). It includes physical resources covering all subjects except medical and fine arts. The total area of the library is 10000 square meters. The library became operational in September 2012. The library has been designed and constructed using the latest high-tech standards with sufficient space and facilities to satisfy the university community. Radio frequency identifier technology has been selected as a security and organization tool for the holdings. The library has 70 PCs connected to a network along with printers, data show projectors and photocopying machines.

Main Library (M16): a central library for men on the University's Men Campus. It includes physical resources covering all areas except the medical and fine arts. The total area of the library is 10000 square meters. The library has been designed and constructed using the latest high-tech standards with sufficient space and facilities that will satisfy the university community. Radio frequency identifier technology has been selected as a security and organization tool for the holdings. The library has 70 PCs connected to network along with printers, data show projectors and photocopying machines.

Medical Library: a specialized library in medicine and health sciences located on the Medical and Health Campus of the University. The total book holding of the library are more than 20,000 volumes The total area of the library is 1000 square meters. The library has all facilities and specifications of a modern library buildings. The library is equipped with sufficient PCs, B&W Printers, color printers, scanners, photocopiers, etc.

Fine Arts and Design Library (M22): a specialized library in fine arts and design subjects, located at the Fine Arts and Design College. It serves the learning and research needs of the College. The total holding of the library are more than 9,000 volumes The total area of the library is 500 square meters. The library has all facilities and specifications of a modern library building. The library has 10 PCs connected to a network along with printers, data show projectors and photocopying machines.

11.7 Copyright Policy

The University of Sharjah adheres to the UAE Copyright Law (Federal Law No.7 of 2002 regarding Copyright and Related Rights) for all copyright-related matters. Photocopying of copyrighted materials is governed by this law, and libraries and other non-profit institutions are exempted from the law if photocopying is used for research, scholarship, teaching, and studying.

- Copies of printed materials are permitted for personal use or instructor requests, and they must comply with acceptable copying parameters according to copyright law.
- Interlibrary Loan requests must respect copyright law, and libraries will not process requests that violate copyright regulations.

- All non-print/electronic resources are covered by licensing agreements for non-profit use by UoS faculty, students, and staff for educational and research purposes. Access to resources should be through university network or restricted user accounts.
- The library may lend non-printed materials for non-profit purposes.

11.8 Printed Materials

The library strictly follows the UAE Copyright Law for the photocopying of copyrighted materials. Libraries and non-profit institutions are exempt from the law if photocopies are used for research, scholarship, teaching, and studying. Acceptable copying parameters are followed for printed materials.

11.9 Interlibrary Loan

UoS libraries respect copyright law and shall not process any Interlibrary Loan requests that violate copyright regulations.

11.10 Non-Print/Electronic Information Resources

All non-print/electronic resources are covered by licensing agreements for non-profit use by UoS faculty, students, and staff for educational and research purposes. Access to these resources is restricted to UoS classes, library workstations, university network, or designated user accounts.

11.11 Circulation Regulations

Circulation privileges are extended to currently enrolled UoS faculty, students, and staff with valid UoS ID cards. Users must present their valid ID cards in person to check out materials, and each borrower is responsible for all library materials checked out under their ID number.

11.12 Loan Periods for Library Resources:

Loan periods for library resources vary based on user status:

- Undergraduate: 4 books for 2 weeks
- Graduate: 8 books for 4 weeks
- Faculty: 20 books for a full academic semester
- Teaching Assistants: 8 books for 6 weeks
- Staff: 4 books for 2 weeks

11.13 Reserved Materials

- Reserved materials include textbooks, leaflets, and book titles assigned by faculty for student use.
- Instructors may place items on Reserve, and the libraries reserve the right to keep highly demanded materials on the "Reserve Shelf for in-library use.
- Borrowing of Reserved Materials is restricted during exam periods.

11.14 Reference Collection

Reference materials are primarily not for circulation, but faculty and teaching assistants may check them out for a 7-day loan period.

11.15 Periodicals

Bound periodicals are primarily not for circulation. Current periodicals can be borrowed by faculty for 2 days.

11.16 Renewals

- Borrowed items may be renewed if not in high demand and no "Recall" or "Hold" request has been placed on the item.
- Renewals are not allowed for items borrowed for a full semester or overdue materials.
- One renewal is allowed for borrowed items.

11.17 Hold

- Users may place a "Hold" request for a checked-out item at the Circulation Desk.
- The patron will be notified when the book is returned and will have one week to pick it up.

11.18 Recalls

- All books are subject to recall if needed urgently.
- Users may place a "Recall" request for an item at the Circulation Desk, and the current borrower will have six days to return the item.

11.19 Reminders

- Library users will receive automatic reminders when their borrowed items are nearing the due date.
- It is the borrower's responsibility to keep their contact information updated.



11.20 Overdue Materials

- Library materials are due on the date stamped on the "Due Date" card in the back of the book.
- Borrowing privileges will be blocked for students with overdue library materials.

11.21 Library Fines and Charges

- Regular overdue fines are one Dirham per day per item (maximum 45 Dirham).
- Charges for lost or damaged items include processing/service fees and may be double the actual cost of the item.

Chapter 12: Admission and Instruction Policies

12.1 Undergraduate Admission

The University of Sharjah welcomes applications from academically qualified and behaviorally distinguished students, irrespective of nationality, color, religion, or disability. To apply for admission to the University of Sharjah, a student must have completed secondary education and accumulated at least 12 years of schooling prior to the date of application.

Applicants are required to have graduated from a school that is licensed and recognized by the Ministry of Education in the UAE. They must submit a certified copy of their secondary school certificate or its equivalent, accompanied by a grade transcript verified by the school and the Ministry of Education or the relevant Education Zone in the UAE.

For applicants who have completed their education outside the UAE, their school must be recognized by the official education authority in their country of study. The submitted certificates must be authenticated by the education authority in the respective country (e.g., the Ministry of Education, Boards of Education, British Council), and then further validated by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs in that country, followed by the relevant UAE Embassy or the Embassy of the applicant's country in the UAE, and finally, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the UAE.

To be considered for admission, applicants must submit the following basic requirements:

1. **Educational Background:** Completion of secondary education or its equivalent, with the required average. This should be within three years of applying, except for the College of Medicine and Dental Medicine, where secondary education must be completed within the past year.
2. **Disciplinary Record:** Applicants must not have been expelled from the University of Sharjah or any other institution for academic or disciplinary reasons.
3. **Health Requirements:** Applicants must be medically, physically, and mentally fit, and must provide evidence of immunization against major blood-borne viral infections relevant to their chosen major.
4. **Application Preferences:** Applicants should indicate their major preferences on the application form.
5. **Admission Criteria:** Acceptance is based on college quotas, grades, preferences, and competitive outcomes. Priority is given to UAE citizens and students with high academic averages.
6. **Application Process:** Applicants must submit their application form and required documents to the Admissions Department by the specified deadlines, and pay a non-refundable application fee of AED 360. For the Colleges of Medicine and Dental Medicine, a non-refundable application fee of AED 1500 is required.

7. **Reservation Fee:** Meeting the grade and application requirements does not guarantee admission. Accepted students must pay a reservation fee after meeting competitive criteria. This fee is non-refundable if the student withdraws or does not enroll, but will be applied towards tuition if the student enrolls.
8. **Conditional Admission:** Applicants still completing their secondary education will receive conditional admission until final results are available. They must fulfill specific conditions to maintain their admission status.
9. **ID and Registration:** Students will not receive an ID or be allowed to register for courses unless their admission file is complete.
10. **Professional Diplomas:** Professional Diploma certificates are not accepted for undergraduate degree completion.

12.1.1 Students Holding a High School Certificate or Its Equivalent:

Students who have completed secondary education either from schools within the UAE that follow the Ministry of Education's curriculum or from recognized institutions inside or outside the country are eligible to apply to the University of Sharjah. Admission to the University is subject to meeting the conditions and criteria set by the University and is also dependent on available capacity.

The following minimum success rates are required for admission into specific colleges and programs:

Colleges and Programs	High School Averages and Certificates Sections	English Language Score	Subjects Grades in High School Certificate or its Equivalent
College of Sharia and Islamic Studies College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences College of Fine Arts & Design College of Communication College of Public Policy	70% for all tracks	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent for programs taught in English	-
College of Communication (Public Relations and Mass Communication in Arabic) College of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences (Early Childhood)	70% for all tracks	400 in TOEFL or its equivalent, or taking a remedial course with zero credit hours.	-
College of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences (French Language and Literature)	70% for all tracks	-	70% in French Language or pass DELF A-1 French Proficiency Exam
College of Business Administration College of Computing and Informatics (Business Information System)	70% for all tracks	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent	-
College of Law	75% for all tracks	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent for Law in English program	70% in Mathematics subject
College of Sciences College of Computing and Informatics (Computer Science, Information Technology-Multimedia, and Biomedical Informatics)	70% for Advanced & General tracks	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent	70% in Mathematics and one science subject (Biology, Chemistry, or Physics)
College of Engineering College of Computing and Informatics (Cybersecurity Engineering and Computer Engineering)	75% for Advanced track 85% for General track	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent	80% in Physics, Mathematics and in one science subject (Biology, Chemistry)
College of Medicine	95% for Advanced track	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent (required for competition)	90% in Mathematics and two science subjects (Biology, Chemistry, or Physics)
College of Dental Medicine	85% for Advanced track	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent (required for competition)	90% in Mathematics and two science subjects (Biology, Chemistry, or Physics)
College of Pharmacy	85% for Advanced track	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent	80% in Mathematics and two science subjects (Biology, Chemistry, or Physics)
College of Health Sciences (Medical Diagnostic Imaging)	75% for Advanced track 85% for General track	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent	75% in Physics, Mathematics, and one science subject (Biology or Chemistry)
College of Health Sciences (Physiotherapy, Clinical Nutrition and Dietetics, Nursing, Medical Laboratory Sciences, Audiology and Speech Language Pathology)	75% for Advanced track 85% for General track	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent	75% in Mathematics and one science subject (Biology or Chemistry)
College of Health Sciences (Environmental Health Sciences, Healthcare Management)	75% for Advanced track 85% for General track	500 in TOEFL or its equivalent	-

Important Notes

- The high school grades mentioned are those of the UAE educational curriculum (Advanced Track) or their equivalents as per the framework approved by the Ministry of Education.
- English proficiency test Certificates older than two years are not accepted.
- Students who achieve a score of 5.5 in the IELTS test are exempted from remedial skill courses.
- Students who couldn't obtain the required score in any of the above listed English Proficiency tests will be enrolled in an (Intensive English Program) course, in which their English level will be determined by the result of their English proficiency test. All students are placed in the Intensive English program with a recognized Language qualification.
- Students must submit the original English language proficiency certificate to the Languages Institute at UoS for verification and approval.
- The UoS reserves the right to require students to attend an interview in the Languages Institute. Students may be required to take a further in-house test to ensure their scores are consistent with their English Language proficiency.
- Students who did not achieve the required subjects grades in high school will be accepted conditionally and will have to register and pass alternative qualifying courses at the university, which is equivalent to zero credit hours and is not included in the calculation of the cumulative average.

12.1.2 Admission to the College of Medicine and Dental Medicine:

For admission to the College of Medicine and the College of Dental Medicine at the University of Sharjah, applicants must meet the following criteria:

A. Criteria for Entry into the Medicine and Dental Medicine Colleges:

1. **Secondary Education Requirement:** Admission to the College of Medicine is restricted to students who have obtained their secondary education certificate from the United Arab Emirates.
2. **Competitive Selection:** All applicants to the Medicine and Dental Medicine Colleges will undergo a competitive selection process based on university regulations. The selection will be based on academic competition among applicants.
3. **Competition Fee:** Applicants must pay a non-refundable fee of AED 1500 to enter the competition process. This fee will not be refunded under any circumstances, including acceptance, non-acceptance, withdrawal, or non-attendance. If accepted, this fee will be credited as the first installment of tuition fees.

B. Confirmation of Admission for Medicine and Dental Medicine Colleges:

1. **Payment of Tuition Fees:** Accepted students must pay the tuition fees within one week of receiving their acceptance notification. Failure to enroll in the semester for which they were admitted will result in forfeiture of admission and any fees paid will not be refunded.

C. Minimum Requirements for Promotion to the First Year of the Bachelor of Medicine and Surgery or Bachelor of Dental Surgery:

1. **Completion of Foundation Year:** Students must successfully complete the Foundation Year.
2. **GPA Requirements:** Students must achieve a minimum cumulative GPA of 2.5 out of 4.0.
3. **Subject-Specific GPA:** Students must also obtain a minimum cumulative GPA of 2.5 in Chemistry and Biology, including their respective labs in the first and second levels.
4. **Competitive Promotion:** Students meeting the above GPA requirements will be subject to competition for available seats in these programs. Priority for promotion to Year One will be given to students with higher cumulative GPAs and higher GPAs in Biochemistry 1 & 2 and Biology 1 & 2, including their labs.

12.1.3 Bridging Programs:

The University of Sharjah (UoS) admits students based on academic merit and program suitability. This policy details the admission procedures for students with Diplomas or Extended Diplomas seeking entry into Bachelor's Degree programs.

Eligibility: Students may be admitted to a Bachelor's degree program if they have:

- Successfully completed a Recognized Diploma.
- Met high school requirements recognized by the UAE.
- Submitted authenticated high school diplomas and transcripts with the admission application.
- Applied to a Bachelor's degree program related to their Diploma or Extended Diploma. Note: Admission to the College of Medicine or the College of Dental Medicine is not permitted under this policy.
- Provided attested Diploma or Extended Diploma degrees and transcripts for all completed courses.
- Achieved a CGPA of 2.5 out of 4.0 or higher. Exceptions to the CGPA requirement are limited as described in this policy.
- Met the language proficiency requirements for the desired program.

Program Restrictions:

- Students admitted under this policy are restricted to their original program of admission. Transfer to another degree program is not permitted, except to a related field after meeting the new program's admission criteria.
- Students must complete all remaining credits in their original program. Transfer of credits does not apply.
- Students must fulfill any additional requirements specific to the college or program.

Conditional Admission:

- Applicants with a CGPA of 2.0-2.49 may be conditionally admitted if they:
 - Complete remedial courses up to 12 credit hours, registering for and passing them with a minimum grade of C or higher. Failure to do so will result in automatic academic dismissal.
 - Register for 9-12 credit hours in the following semester, with the possibility of up to 15 credit hours with the Dean's permission.
 - Pass all courses with a minimum grade of D. The UoS Course Repeat Policy applies.
 - Be aware that academic dismissal will result in a ban on further admission to Bachelor's Degree programs at UoS.

Superseding Regulations:

- This policy is subject to the regulations set forth by the UAE Ministry of Education.

12.1.5 Admission Procedure:

1. Application Completion:

- Students must personally complete the application form and ensure that all information is accurate. Incomplete applications will not be processed.

2. Admission Deadlines:

- Students are responsible for adhering to all admission procedures and deadlines as specified by the Admissions Office in the academic calendar. The University is not liable for applications that are incomplete or submitted late.

3. Website and Exam Information:

- Students must regularly check the University's website (www.sharjah.ac.ae) for updates on admission exam dates, TOEFL test schedules, personal interview details, and results.

4. Reservation Fees:

- Reservation seat fees are non-refundable if the student withdraws or does not enroll. If the student enrolls, these fees will be applied toward tuition.

5. Admission and Enrollment:

- Admission is granted for the specific semester for which the application is made. If a student fails to enroll in that semester, their admission will be canceled.

6. Postponement:

- New students may postpone admission for a maximum of one semester after paying the required fees and submitting the appropriate form to the Admissions Office. Note that this postponement policy does not apply to programs in the Colleges of Medicine and Dental Medicine.

7. Submission of Documents:

- Original High School Certificates will not be accepted. Students must provide certified copies of their certificates. All submitted documents become the property of the University and cannot be retrieved.

8. Scholarship Applications:

- The University does not manage scholarship applications. Students must contact sponsors directly.

9. Late Applications:

- Applications submitted after the designated admission period may not be considered.

10. Fee Adjustments:

- The University reserves the right to increase fees annually.

11. Compliance:

- Students must comply with all other University requirements.

12.1.6 Students must adhere to all other University requirements.

The University of Sharjah is committed to transparency when dealing with students, and upon accepting transfer students, the University will inform them of the exact number of credits allowed to transfer to the University.

12.2 Graduate Admission

12.2.1 Master Programs

Academic Qualifications:

- Applicants must hold a bachelor's degree or an equivalent qualification from a recognized university, with a minimum CGPA of 3.00 out of 4.00.
- Applicants with a CGPA between 2.50 and 2.99 may be admitted on a conditional basis.
- The bachelor's degree must be in a major relevant to the master's program being applied for.

English Language Proficiency:

- **Programs Taught in English:** Applicants must meet one of the following English proficiency requirements:
 - EmSAT English: Minimum score of 1400
 - TOEFL (ITP): Minimum score of 550 (or equivalent)
 - IELTS: Minimum score of 6.0
- Applicants with slightly lower scores (EmSAT 1250, TOEFL 530, or IELTS 5.5) may be conditionally admitted, provided they meet the following conditions:
 - Achieve an EmSAT score of 1400 or equivalent by the end of the first semester.
 - Register for a maximum of 6 credit hours in the first semester, excluding intensive English language courses.
 - Attain a minimum CGPA of 3.00 out of 4.00 in the first 6 credit hours of the master's program.
- **Programs Taught in Arabic:** For students in Arabic-taught programs that do not require a specific TOEFL score:
 - They must enroll in and pass an English language course during the first semester.
 - If they achieve an EmSAT score of 950, TOEFL 450 (or equivalent), or IELTS 4.5, they may be exempted from this course.
- **Programs Requiring a TOEFL Score:** For programs like the Master in Applied Sociology or Master in Law:

- Applicants must achieve an EmSAT score of 950, TOEFL 450 (or equivalent), or IELTS 4.5.
- **Exemptions:**
 - Native English speakers are exempt from the TOEFL requirement if their undergraduate instruction was in English.
 - Graduates from institutions where English was the primary medium of instruction are also exempt.

Additional Requirements:

- **Male Emirati Students (Aged 18-30):** Must attach a "No Objection Certificate" from the authorities responsible for national service.
- **Kuwaiti Students:** Must attach a letter of study approval from the Kuwait Embassy Cultural Office.
- **People of Determination:** Must attach their People of Determination card if applicable.
- **Employed Students:** If employed, a letter from the employer confirming employment must be attached.

English Language Proficiency Equivalency Table:

EmSAT Score	TOEFL ITP*	IELTS Academic
950-1075	450	4.5
1100-1225	500	5.0
1250-1375	530	5.5
1400-1525	550	6.0

*Note: The TOEFL ITP exam is offered by the University of Sharjah, AMIDEAST Dubai, and the Abu Dhabi head offices only.

Further Assessment:

- The University of Sharjah reserves the right to require applicants to attend an interview at the Languages Institute.
- Applicants may also be required to take an additional in-house test to confirm the consistency of their English language proficiency.

12.2.2 Ph.D. Programs

Academic Qualifications:

- Applicants must hold a master's degree with a minimum grade of "Very Good" (3.0 out of 4.0) and a bachelor's degree with a minimum grade of 2.5 out of 4.0 (or equivalent) from an institution recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education.

English Language Proficiency:

- **Programs Taught in English:**
 - A minimum score of 550 in TOEFL (ITP) (or its equivalent), 6.0 in IELTS, or 1400 in EmSAT English is required.

Programs Taught in Arabic:

- **PhD in Private Law, Public Law, and Applied Sociology:** A minimum score of 1100 in EmSAT English, 500 in TOEFL (ITP) (or its equivalent), or 5.0 in IELTS is required.
 - **Other Arabic Programs:** A minimum score of 950 in EmSAT English, 450 in TOEFL (ITP) (or its equivalent), or 4.5 in IELTS is required.
- For programs requiring a specific TOEFL score, instructions provided by the Commission for Academic Accreditation shall be followed.

Exemptions:

- **Native English Speakers:** Applicants whose native language is English and who completed their bachelor's or master's degree in a country where English is the official language are exempt from the English language proficiency requirement.
- **Graduates from English-Medium Institutions:** Applicants who graduated from a university where English is the language of instruction are also exempt, provided they obtained a minimum score of 1400 in EmSAT English, 500 in TOEFL (ITP) (or its equivalent) upon enrolling in the bachelor's program, and 550 points (or equivalent) upon joining the master's program.

Additional Requirements:

- **Personal Interview:** Applicants must pass a personal interview as part of the admission process.
- **No Objection Certificate:** Male Emirati students must attach a "No Objection Certificate" from the authorities responsible for national service.
- **Kuwaiti Students:** A letter of study approval from the Kuwait Embassy Cultural Office must be attached.
- **People of Determination:** Applicants must attach their People of Determination card, if applicable.

- **Employed Students:** If employed, a letter from the employer confirming employment must be attached.

English Language Proficiency Equivalency Table:

EmSAT Score	TOEFL ITP*	IELTS Academic
950-1075	450	4.5
1100-1225	500	5.0
1250-1375	530	5.5
1400-1525	550	6.0

*Note: The TOEFL ITP exam is offered by the University of Sharjah, AMIDEAST Dubai, and the Abu Dhabi head offices only.

Further Assessment:

- The University of Sharjah reserves the right to require applicants to attend an interview at the Languages Institute.
- Applicants may also be required to take an additional in-house test to verify the consistency of their English language proficiency.

12.2.3 Higher Diploma Programs

Academic Qualifications:

- Applicants must hold a bachelor's degree or its equivalent from a recognized university with a minimum CGPA of 2.00 out of 4.00.
- The degree must be in a field that qualifies the applicant to pursue the postgraduate diploma program.

English Language Proficiency:

- **Programs Taught in English:**
 - A minimum score of 550 on the TOEFL (PBT) if taken inside the university.
 - A minimum score of 79 on the TOEFL (IBT) if taken outside the university.
 - A minimum score of 6.0 on the IELTS (Academic).

Additional Requirements:

- **Personal Interview:** Applicants must successfully pass a personal interview as part of the admission process.
- **No Objection Certificate:** Male Emirati students must submit a "No Objection Certificate" from the authorities responsible for national service.
- **Kuwaiti Students:** Kuwaiti applicants must provide a letter of study approval from the Kuwait Embassy Cultural Office.
- **People of Determination:** Applicants should submit a copy of their People of Determination card, if applicable.
- **Employed Students:** If employed, applicants must attach a letter from their employer confirming their employment.

12.3 Student Transfer Policy

12.3.1 Transfer within the University of Sharjah

The students' major choices are taken into consideration when applying for the University of Sharjah. However, they will be allowed to transfer to other specializations available in the College, according to established rules and in consideration of the limited numbers allowed for each specialization. After completing at least fifteen (15) credit hours, a student may apply to change his/her major, during the last two weeks of the Fall or Spring semesters. After receiving the appropriate fees, the Registrar sends his/her application with its comments to the Dean of the concerned College to decide the matter within a period not later than the end of the first week of the following semester. The College Council sets the procedures that organize changing or transferring from specializations within the College, and the Dean approves them. A summary of these rules is as follows:

- A student may not be transferred from one specialization to the one from which he/she was transferred by an administrative decision or due to probation.
- No application to transfer or change major is accepted from students in their third year or above, except due to probation.
- No student may change his/her major voluntarily more than once during his/her period of study at the University.
- A College Council may accept the transfer of students holding a technical high school certificate from one College to another based on the recommendation of the Department.
- Applications for transfer are submitted during the last two weeks of the Fall or Spring semesters. After receiving the transfer application and fees, the Registrar sends the application with its opinion to the Dean of the concerned College to reach a decision no later than the end of the first week of the following semester.
- The Registrar includes a student's GPA and CGPA only the compulsory courses that the student has successfully completed in his/her old major meet the requirements of the new specialization.

- The Registrar counts as part of a student's GPA and CGPA the elective courses that the student completed in his/her old specialization and that are required by the study plan of his/her new specialization, but only at his/her request.

12.3.2 Transfer Students from Another Institution

The University Admission Office accepts transfer applications from students currently enrolled in other universities accredited by the Ministry of Education, provided the following conditions are met:

Academic Standing:

- The applicant must have successfully completed at least two semesters or one full academic year at a recognized university, maintaining a minimum CGPA of 2.50 out of 4.00 (Good).
- For students transferring from a Community College or Higher Institutes, a minimum CGPA of 3.00 out of 4.00 (Very Good) is required.

Admission Criteria:

- The applicant must meet the University of Sharjah's general admission criteria as well as any specific requirements of the college to which they are applying.

Continuity of Studies:

- Students who have discontinued their studies for four or more regular semesters will not have their previous academic records considered for transfer.

Availability of Seats:

- The college to which the student is applying must have available seats.

Full-Time Requirement:

- The student must have been enrolled full-time at their previous institution, and must not have been expelled from the University of Sharjah or any other educational institution for academic or disciplinary reasons.

Course Repetition:

- Courses that a student has already completed at another institution and has taken again at the University of Sharjah will not count towards the student's degree requirements.

12.4 Credit Transfer

12.4.1 Undergraduate Students Transferring from Another University

Eligibility for Transfer:

- The maximum number of credit hours that can be transferred from a recognized university to the University of Sharjah (UoS) is limited to 50% of the total required for the degree.
- The Department Council may approve the transfer of credits for courses completed at the previous institution if the student achieved a minimum grade of C+ (2.5 out of 4.0).
- Students transferring from a recognized institute of higher education or community college must have earned a minimum grade of B (3.0 out of 4.0) for credit transfer consideration.

Conditions for Transfer:

- Students who have discontinued their studies for four or more regular semesters are not eligible to transfer their academic records.
- Grades and credit hours transferred from another university will not be included in the student's CGPA calculation at UoS.
- No transfer of credits is allowed for the foundation year in Medicine and Dental Medicine, as these grades are required for promotion.
- Credits earned towards a previously completed degree cannot be transferred.
- The University of Sharjah permits the transfer of credits for clinical training only if the training is conducted within the UAE and approved by the Commission for Academic Accreditation (CAA).

Non-Transferable Coursework:

- Remedial courses (e.g., remedial English or mathematics).
- Vocational courses.
- Cooperative education or work experience credits.
- Physical education activity credits.
- Graduation projects or internships.
- Credits that do not align with the degree program.

Special Conditions:

- Conditionally admitted students cannot transfer credits until they have met their admission conditions.
- The Registrar's Office will inform transfer students of their accepted credits before enrolment.
- Transferred credits must have been earned within five years prior to enrolment in the degree program.
- Graduate credits applied towards a graduate degree cannot be used for a second undergraduate degree.

Undergraduate Coursework from Other Institutions:

- Undergraduate courses taken at other accredited institutions while enrolled at UoS may be transferred under specific conditions, including pre-approval by the College Dean, Department Chair, and Vice Chancellor.
- Only courses with a grade of C+ or higher will be considered for transfer.
- A maximum of 50% of the program's required credit hours may be transferred.
- Grades and credit hours transferred from UoS's partner universities will count towards the student's GPA and credit hours.

Intra-University Transfers:

- Undergraduate courses taken at UoS may be transferred to another undergraduate program at UoS with program approval.
- Only courses meeting the new program's requirements will be accepted, with a maximum of 50% of the program's required courses taken on a non-degree basis.

12.4.2 Postgraduate Students Transferring from Another University

Eligibility for Transfer:

- The Department Council may transfer credits for courses completed at the previous institution, provided that the student earned a minimum grade of B (3.0 out of 4.0) in master's and doctorate programs, or C+ (2.5 out of 4.0) in postgraduate diploma programs.
- Grades and credit hours transferred from another university will not be included in the student's CGPA calculation at UoS.

Conditions for Transfer:

- The duration required to complete the degree will be reduced by one semester for every 6-9 credit hours transferred for postgraduate diplomas and master's degrees, and 9 credit hours for doctoral programs.

- A maximum of nine credit hours may be transferred for postgraduate diploma and master's programs, and 12 credit hours for doctoral programs, subject to approval by the Graduate Studies Committee and the Dean.

Special Conditions:

- Graduate credits previously applied towards a graduate degree cannot be applied again towards a second graduate degree.
- Transferred courses will not affect GPA calculations at UoS.
- Courses taken on a non-degree or non-credit basis are not transferable.
- Graduate courses taken at UoS may be transferred to another graduate program at UoS with program approval, with the maximum number of credits subject to the new program's policies.

Dual and Joint Degrees:

- A student who has completed a master's degree at UoS and is admitted to a PhD program at UoS may transfer up to nine credit hours towards the PhD program, pending approval.
- No transfer of credits is permitted for theses or dissertations.

12.4.3. Credit Transfer Evaluation Process

- Credit transfer is applicable for students participating in exchange programs, study abroad programs, or under agreements such as MoUs.
- New students must submit transcripts and course syllabi to the Admissions Department for verification before credit transfer review by the respective college.
- Continuous students must submit their transcripts and course syllabi to the Office of the Registrar for evaluation.

Evaluation Criteria:

- Courses will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis.
- Transferred credit hours must not exceed the limits specified in this policy.
- Course content must match at least 75% of the equivalent course offered at UoS.
- The medium of instruction must be the same for both courses.
- Courses with pass/satisfactory grades will not be transferred.

Finalization:

- Evaluation results will be sent to the Office of the Registrar, which will update the student's record.

- All transferred credits will be recorded on the student's transcript, with qualifying credits counting towards graduation.
- Transferred courses are indicated with the grade 'TR' on the transcript, along with the name of the previous institution and the equivalent UoS courses.

12.5 Dual and Joint Degrees

The University of Sharjah (UoS) aims to establish itself as a globally recognized institution for research excellence. A key component of this initiative is fostering international collaborative graduate degrees to strengthen research partnerships, promote faculty and student mobility, and enhance UoS's global standing. This policy specifically governs dual and joint graduate degree programs between UoS and partner institutions.

Dual Degree Programs:

UoS discourages dual degree programs that contribute to credential inflation and will not authorize programs that award two degrees for the same body of work. Students who meet the degree requirements at both UoS and a partner institution are entitled to receive a UoS degree for the work completed at UoS. Admission to UoS and the partner institution must be synchronized, adhering to each institution's admission requirements, and an equal number of students from both institutions is expected for each admission round. Students must complete at least half of the credits required for the UoS degree, including coursework and research credits, at UoS. All grades recorded on the UoS transcript must adhere to the UoS grading system, and grade equivalencies must be established in the agreement between UoS and the partner institution.

For non-thesis dual degree master's programs, more than half of the credits must be earned at UoS. Credits earned at a partner institution to fulfil UoS degree requirements must be recorded on the UoS transcript as transfer credits, with the partner institution's name noted. The maximum number of transferred credits should not exceed half of the total UoS degree credit requirements. UoS reserves the right to accept or reject courses transferred from a partner institution to ensure they meet UoS degree requirements. If the partner institution does not offer courses for the degree program, all required courses for the UoS degree must be taken at UoS.

Doctoral students must pass the comprehensive and proposal exams at UoS to be eligible for a dual degree. Students are only entitled to the degree they have successfully completed, and neither institution is obligated to award a degree for incomplete work. Unless otherwise stated, students are responsible for all financial obligations to both institutions. The partner institution must comply with UoS accreditation activities and provide timely access to materials, facilities, and personnel as required. The Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs is responsible for reviewing dual degree agreements, which require the Chancellor's approval. Any exceptions to the policy may be granted at the Chancellor's discretion. No dual degree program shall be offered at UoS

without an officially signed agreement between UoS and the partner institution. The agreement must address all relevant policy statements and clearly define the equivalency and mechanism for course equivalency between the two institutions.

Joint Degree Programs:

UoS approves joint degree programs that are equivalent to UoS degree programs. To be admitted into a joint degree program, students must meet UoS's admission requirements for similar degree programs as outlined in the Admissions Policy. Students must complete at least half of the joint degree's credit requirements at UoS. All grades recorded on the UoS transcript must follow the UoS grading system, and grade equivalencies must be established in the joint degree agreement. Both institutions must issue transcripts with identical content for joint degree students, indicating where the credits were earned.

Course and grade equivalencies must be detailed in the joint degree agreement between UoS and the partner institution. If the partner institution does not offer courses for the degree program, all required courses for the UoS degree must be taken at UoS. Doctoral students must pass the comprehensive and candidacy exams at UoS to be eligible for a joint degree. Unless otherwise stated, students are responsible for all financial obligations to both institutions. The partner institution must comply with UoS accreditation activities and provide timely access to materials, facilities, and personnel as required. The relevant Vice Chancellor (Academic or Medical) is responsible for reviewing joint degree agreements, which require the approval of the relevant Vice Chancellor. Exceptions to the policy may be granted at the Chancellor's discretion. No joint degree program shall be offered at UoS without an officially signed agreement between UoS and the partner institution. The agreement must address all relevant policy statements and clearly define the equivalency and mechanism for course equivalency between the two institutions.

12.6 Accelerated Programs

Students seeking admission to accelerated degree programs at UoS, specifically those combining bachelor's and master's degrees or master's and doctoral degrees must adhere to the following conditions.

Admission to Accelerated Bachelor's-Master's Programs

- Applicants must have completed at least 90 credit hours in their UoS bachelor's program and have a minimum cumulative GPA (CGPA) of 3.0.
- Students will be fully admitted to the master's program upon completing their bachelor's degree.
- Students from outside UoS are responsible for transferring credits from other institutions.
- Any additional college- or program-specific requirements must be met.

Degree Requirements for Bachelor's-Master's Accelerated Programs

- Students must fulfill all requirements for both degrees.
- Up to six credit hours of master's coursework at UoS may count toward both degrees.

- c. Students must maintain a minimum CGPA of 3.0 in their master's coursework to be eligible for graduation.
- d. Transfer credits will not be included in the CGPA calculation.
- e. The bachelor's and master's degrees will be awarded separately, with the master's degree not awarded before the bachelor's degree.
- f. Students will be classified as undergraduates until they complete their bachelor's degree requirements. Their status will then be updated to graduate.
- g. Academic progress standards must align with UoS policies.
- h. Students must complete both degrees within seven years of initial enrollment.
- i. Students who withdraw from the program after completing the bachelor's degree but before completing the master's degree will be awarded the bachelor's degree. If they wish to return to complete the master's degree within one year, they will be automatically readmitted. After one year, readmission will be competitive, and previously taken courses will be reviewed.

Degree Requirements for Master's-Doctorate Accelerated Programs

- a. Students must fulfill all requirements for both degrees.
- b. Up to six credit hours of master's coursework may count toward both degrees.
- c. Students must maintain a minimum CGPA of 3.0 in their master's coursework.
- d. The master's and doctorate degrees will be awarded separately, with the doctorate degree not awarded before the master's degree.
- e. Students must complete the master's degree before enrolling in the doctorate program. If they fail to complete the doctorate requirements, they may exit with a master's degree.

Interpretation and Dispute Resolution

The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs is responsible for interpreting this policy and its procedures in case of disputes.

12.6.1 Procedures

Admission to Accelerated Bachelor's-Master's Programs

- a. Applicants must submit a completed master's program application through the UoS Admissions Office.
- b. The Admissions Office will verify that applicants have completed at least 90 credit hours in their bachelor's program with a CGPA of 3.0 or higher.
- c. Qualified applicants will be admitted to the master's program and notified accordingly.

Registration in Accelerated Bachelor's-Master's Degree Programs

- a. The Registrar's Office will assign proper coding to students to ensure they meet the requirements for both degrees.
- b. Students may count up to six credit hours of master's coursework toward both degrees.
- c. Students must maintain good academic standing.
- d. The credit transfer policy will apply to any courses taken outside the degree program.

- e. Transfer credits are excluded from the CGPA calculation.
- f. Degrees will be awarded separately, and the bachelor's degree must be awarded before the master's degree.
- g. Students' classification will change from undergraduate to graduate after fulfilling bachelor's degree requirements.
- h. Students must complete both degrees within seven years of initial enrollment.
- i. If a student withdraws after completing the bachelor's degree but before completing the master's degree, they will receive the bachelor's degree and must reapply to complete the master's degree.

Admission to Accelerated Master's-Doctorate Programs

- a. Applicants must submit a completed doctorate program application through the UoS Admissions Office.
- b. The Admissions Office will verify that applicants have completed at least 18 credit hours of graduate coursework with a CGPA of 3.5 or higher.
- c. Qualified applicants will be admitted to the doctorate program and notified accordingly.

Registration in Accelerated Master's-Doctorate Degree Programs

- a. The Registrar's Office will assign proper coding to students to ensure they meet the requirements for both degrees.
- b. Students may count up to six credit hours of graduate coursework toward both degrees.
- c. Students must maintain good academic standing.
- d. The credit transfer policy will apply to any courses taken outside the degree program.
- e. The master's and doctorate degrees will be awarded separately, and the master's degree must be awarded before the doctorate degree.
- f. Students' classification will change from master's to doctorate after fulfilling master's degree requirements.
- g. The Registrar's Office will oversee the process for awarding credit for coursework taken outside the degree program.
- h. Students must complete the master's degree before enrolling in the doctorate program. If students fail to complete the doctorate requirements, they may exit with a master's degree. Readmission to complete the doctorate degree will require a new application.

12.7 Curricula Approval and Revision Policy:

1. Faculty members may propose course modifications or curriculum improvements, providing proper justification and implications of the suggested changes.
2. The department chair/council shall evaluate the merit of the proposals and develop detailed proposals to be presented to the College Council for discussion and approval.
3. Curriculum change proposals are then referred to the Study Plans and Curricula Committee, which seeks input from the Vice Chancellor for Quality Assurance, Institutional Effectiveness, and Accreditation, to ensure alignment with University goals, standards, and the Commission for Academic Accreditation (CAA) stipulations.

4. Once approved, proposals are submitted to the Chancellor, who engages in discussions with the University Academic Advisory Council.
5. The Deans Council holds discussions and makes the final decision on the suggested changes.
6. For substantive changes, the CAA is informed about the nature and justification of the applied modifications.

The academic departments conduct regular internal and external stakeholder's demands analyses, considering the University's strategic directions and proposing changes to existing programs or the addition of new ones. The colleges discuss these proposals and forward them to the University Study Plans and Curriculum Committee and the Deans Council. Subsequently, the Chancellor forwards the proposals to the Board of Trustees' Academic Committee and, ultimately, to the Board of Trustees for approval. In cases of interdisciplinary programs, joint committees are established from the concerned departments or colleges, following the same procedure.

12.8 Internship Policy:

The University of Sharjah places significant emphasis on developing students' knowledge and personal growth by closely monitoring their practical training, which applies the theoretical knowledge acquired. Providing comprehensive academic and administrative support during field training is paramount, as it allows students to implement various skills, theories, and concepts learned throughout their studies. Such training equips students to shoulder their professional and specialized responsibilities within the work environment, fulfilling an essential graduation requirement.

The University of Sharjah actively participates in initiatives such as IAESTE and the Arab Council for Student Exchange, facilitating opportunities for students to engage in training within the industrial sector and government agencies. Moreover, the UoS collaborates with foreign institutions and universities to secure training opportunities for its students, fostering increased self-confidence and independence.

12.9 Undergraduate Completion Policy:

The University offers a diverse array of undergraduate programs at the Diploma and Bachelor Level. Before graduation, students must fulfil all graduation requirements, including the successful completion of all program courses, any practice or internship components, and obtaining a minimum Cumulative GPA of 2.0.

12.10 Graduate Completion Requirements Policy:

Before graduation, graduate students must meet all graduation requirements, which include successfully completing all program courses, the thesis, and/or essays as specified in the curriculum, and obtaining a minimum cumulative GPA of 2.5.

12.11 Academic Progress Policy:

- The minimum residency requirement for all undergraduate students at the University of Sharjah is six regular semesters in the Colleges of Sharia, Law, Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences, Business Administration, Fine Arts and Design, and Communication, except for the Colleges of Engineering, Health Sciences, and Pharmacy, where it is eight regular semesters.
- Students transferred from another university must spend a minimum of four regular semesters to receive a bachelor degree.
- No student may exceed thirteen semesters for obtaining a bachelor degree in the Colleges of Sharia, Law, Arts Humanities and Social Sciences, and Sciences, Business Administration, Fine Arts and Design, and Communication, with exceptions for Colleges of Engineering, Health Sciences, and Pharmacy, where the maximum duration is fifteen semesters.
- Periods of permissible withdrawal from the University are not calculated as part of the student's study duration.
- Each fifteen credit hours transferred from within the University or from another institution shall count for one semester.

12.12 Examinations Policy:

12.12.1 Teaching and Evaluation

- Instructors are required to prepare detailed syllabi that outline the course objectives, outcomes, content, teaching methods, evaluation criteria, references, and additional readings. These syllabi shall be distributed to students at the beginning of the semester and uploaded on Blackboard and kept in the course files within the college.
- For multi-section courses taught by multiple instructors, a coordinator shall be appointed by the department. The Coordinator shall collaborate with other instructors to develop a uniform examination schedule and syllabus for the course.

12.12.2 Examination Questions

The questions shall be:

- Aligned with the objectives and outcomes stated in the syllabus.
- Appropriately tailored to fit within the allocated examination time.

- Clearly formulated and appropriately weighted.
- Diverse to assess students' aptitude and skills in recall, comprehension, application, and analytical thinking.
- Presented in the language of instruction for the course.

12.12.3 Answer Sheets or Booklets

- The College Council, based on the recommendation of the academic departments, will establish procedures for documenting and storing final examination answer sheets or booklets for a minimum period of four regular semesters. Afterward, a committee formed by the College Council shall supervise their destruction.
- The instructor shall consult with the department's Chair to determine the appropriate format for answer sheets or booklets and provide necessary instructions.
- Course instructors must retain examination results for one regular semester.

12.12.4 Evaluation of Students' Performance

- The final grade for any course shall be a combination of the grade obtained in the final examination and all other grades earned during the semester.
- The general examination framework for purely or mainly theoretical courses is as follows:
 - 40-50% allocated for the final examination, covering the entire course content and objectives, and held at times specified in the University calendar.
 - 50-60% given to course work, including two written examinations, reports, research papers, quizzes, and other assigned tasks. The department shall determine the relative weight of each component.
- Practical course evaluation and grade distribution will be determined by the College Council upon the recommendation of departmental councils, and procedures will be communicated to the Registrar's Office.
- Courses with special characteristics will have evaluation methods specified by the College Council based on recommendations from the Department Council, with full explanations and justifications forwarded to the VCAA.
- The Department Council will approve evaluation methods for each course individually, considering course components, objectives, recognition of self-instruction, objective implementation, full documentation, and alignment with academic and scientific objectives.
- Instructors are responsible for grading examination papers, recording final grades accurately in both letter grades and percentages.
- Students will receive their examination sheets or booklets within one week of the examination date, and grades shall be reported to the Department's Chair a week later.
- Final grades will be recorded in letters, specifying the credit hours allocated for the course.

The College Council shall establish policies and procedures for evaluating examinations in courses offered by academic departments within the college.

Instructors must correct final examination answer sheets or booklets and submit the results, documented in letter grades and percentages, to the Department Chair within forty-eight hours of the examination date. The Department Chair shall then submit the results to the College Council for approval. The documents submitted will include:

- Final examination sheets or booklets
- Attendance sheet
- Five copies of the final examination questions
- Grades, with fractions rounded to the nearest integer
- All extra, unused answer sheets or booklets
- A report on the results, including:
 - Number of students enrolled in the course
 - Number of students allowed to sit for the examination
 - Number of students failing to attend the examination
 - Distribution of grades and their percentages
 - Percentages of failing and passing grades
 - Number of students receiving incompletes or forfeiting the right to attend the examination and the percentages thereof

Faculty members shall directly enter the grades electronically into the blackboard which will forward it automatically to the registration system (Banner). The Registration Department shall document and announce the results to students.

12.12.6 Department Chair's Responsibilities

The Department Chair shall:

- Receive examination documents from the instructor.
- Ensure that the number of answer sheets or booklets corresponds to the number of students attending the examination.
- Submit all examination-related documents to the Dean as soon as they become available.
- Prepare a report on the examinations with an analysis of the results for the Dean, including:
 - Number of students enrolled in the course
 - Number of students permitted to sit for the examination
 - Number of students who were absent
 - Distribution of grades and their percentages
 - Percentages of passing and failing grades
 - Numbers and percentages of students receiving incompletes and those barred from sitting for the examination

- Three copies of the final examination questions

12.12.7 Monitoring Examination Results

The College Council or designee shall review comprehensive reports prepared by academic departments on examinations to monitor, develop, and improve the educational process.

12.12.8 Reviewing Final Examination Answer Sheets or Booklets

Students have the right to submit a written petition (e-service) to the College Dean offering the course within two weeks after grades have been posted to have their final examination answer sheets or booklets reviewed. The petition must be submitted through the Registrar's Office after payment of a fixed fee.

If the petition is granted, a Committee formed by the Department Chair, consisting of the Chair and two other members of the Department (one being the course instructor), shall conduct the review. The review shall verify the absence of material errors in grading, question components, or partial/complete question corrections. If any errors are found, the course instructor shall correct them, and the corrected result shall be approved following standard procedures.

12.12.9 Additional Regulations:

- Students must settle all financial obligations to the University before being allowed to sit for examination.
- Failure to attend the final examination without an acceptable excuse may result in a failing grade for the course. If illness or other compelling circumstances are acceptable reasons for absence, the student will receive an "Incomplete" grade.
- Any student receiving an Incomplete must remove this mark from their record within the first week after the commencement of the next regular semester by sitting for a special examination, arranged with the instructor and department. The result shall be submitted to the Registration Department within this period. Failure to do so will result in the student receiving an "F" grade for the course.
- In cases where the reason for not attending the examination mentioned above still exists, the College Council may permit the student to withdraw from the course(s) in question, resulting in a mark of "W" in their record.
- The mark obtained for removing an Incomplete shall be recorded in the semester in which the course was taken.
- The cumulative grade point average (CGPA) is calculated by multiplying the points obtained in each course by the number of credit hours allocated for the course and then dividing the result by the total number of credit hours of all courses.
- Semester averages represent the average of all points obtained in all courses taken during that semester, regardless of whether the student passed or failed any of them. Students will

have a cumulative grade point average (CGPA) by the end of their second semester at the University.

- The cumulative grade point average (CGPA) at any point in time is calculated based on all courses studied up to that date, regardless of pass or fail status.
- CGPA is rounded to the nearest two decimal digits.
- Distinguished students will be recognized in three lists: Chancellor's list, Dean's list, and List of the Deans of Students' Affairs (males/females) in accordance with the University's regulations and by-laws for honor lists.

12.13 Student Assessment and Grading System:

12.13.1 Course Outline

Instructors are responsible for preparing comprehensive syllabi that outline the course's objectives, outcomes, content, teaching methods, evaluation criteria, references, and additional readings. These syllabi shall be distributed to students at the beginning of the semester, uploaded on blackboard and maintained in the course files within the college.

12.13.2 Final Exam

The final examination questions are prepared adhering to the following guidelines:

1. Questions are closely aligned with the objectives and outcomes specified in the course outline.
2. The questions are appropriately proportionate to the allocated examination time.
3. Course instructors, either individually or collaboratively with other instructors (in the case of multi-instructor courses), must formulate the questions clearly, assigning appropriate grades to each question.
4. The examination questions vary in number and type to effectively assess students' knowledge and skills in recalling, understanding, applying, and analyzing course material.
5. The language used in both the questions and answers during the exam must correspond to the language of instruction for the course.

12.13.3 Final Grade

The final grade for any course comprises the grade obtained in the final examination combined with all other grades earned throughout the semester. The general framework for examinations is as follows:

12.13.3.1 Purely or mainly theoretical courses:

1. 40-50% of the final grade shall be allocated to the final examination, a comprehensive written test covering the entire course content and fulfilling its objectives and outcomes. The final examination will be conducted as per the University calendar.
2. 20-30% of the final grade shall be reserved for the Midterm examination, scheduled according to the University Calendar.
3. 20-40% of the final grade shall be attributed to course work, including continuous assessment components such as reports, research papers, quizzes, and other relevant tasks. The department concerned shall determine the relative weight of each component.

12.13.3.2 Practical courses:

The distribution of grades for practical courses shall be determined by College Councils upon the recommendation of departmental councils. The Registrar's Office shall be notified of the implemented procedures.

12.13.3.3 Exceptions:

Courses with distinctive characteristics necessitating special evaluation methods shall have their evaluation procedures specified by the College Council based on recommendations from the Department Council. All decisions in this regard shall be fully explained and justified, with information conveyed to the VCAA.

12.14 Grading System:

All final course grades are evaluated numerically and converted to a point average according to the following grading system:

Grades	Percentages	Points
A	90-100	4.00
B+	85-89	3.50
B	80-84	3.00
C+	75-79	2.50
C	70-74	2.00
D+	65-69	1.50
D	60-64	1.0
F	Below 60	0.00

12.14.1 Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA):

CGPA is calculated based on the total points obtained in each course, multiplied by the respective credit hours, and then divided by the total credit hours of all courses. CGPA is rounded to the nearest two decimal digits.

12.15 Student Attendance and Assessment Policies:

1. Students are required to attend all theoretical lectures, laboratory hours, training sessions, research sessions, and examinations for the courses they are enrolled in.
2. If a student's absences exceed 10% of the total designated hours for one or more courses without an acceptable excuse, the instructor will issue a warning. Absences reaching 15% without an acceptable excuse shall result in a final warning.
3. Absences reaching 20% will prohibit the student from sitting for the final examination(s). If the absence is due to acceptable reasons, such as ill health, the student will receive a withdrawal mark (W) in their transcript. All such cases shall be reported to the Registrar's Office.

12.16 Penalties for Academic Misconduct During Exams:

A. Breach of Exam Rules: If a student breaches exam rules, disregards instructor instructions, or disrupts the required silence during exams intentionally, the instructor will collect the student's answer sheet, and the student will be asked to leave the exam room. The instructor must report the breach to the College Dean for further action.

B. Attempted Cheating in an Exam: If a student is found attempting to cheat during an exam, the following penalties will apply in combination:

1. The student will receive an "F" grade in the course where cheating was attempted.
2. The student's registration in the courses for the respective semester will be canceled.

C. Detected Cheating During an Exam or Quiz: If a student is caught cheating during an exam, assessment or quiz, the following penalties will apply in combination:

1. The student will receive an "F" grade in the course where the exam violation occurred.
2. The student's registration in the courses for the respective semester will be canceled.
3. The student will be suspended from the University for the academic semester following the detection of cheating. The Summer semester will not count as an academic semester during this suspension. The student will not receive credit for any courses studied at another university during the suspension.

D. Late Detection of Cheating: If cheating is detected at a later stage, the offender will still be held accountable, and the case will be referred to the appropriate committee for investigation and determination of the suitable penalty.

E. Plagiarism: In the event of plagiarism, the student will receive an "F" grade in the course with no option to take an alternative course. The student must repeat the same course to improve their CGPA.

12.17 Instructor Responsibilities:

Instructors are responsible for developing detailed syllabi that encompass the course's objectives, outcomes, content, teaching methods, evaluation, references, and additional readings. These syllabi shall be handed out to students at the beginning of the semester and kept in the college's course files. Furthermore, examination questions must meet the guidelines outlined above.

12.18 Class Size Policy:

The University of Sharjah prioritizes the efficient delivery of curricular programs, ensuring students complete their degree requirements in a timely and structured manner. To optimize institutional resources, UoS has established a class size policy to maintain an ideal balance between the number of students and instructional effectiveness. The policy outlines the maximum and minimum class sizes for various class types to uphold academic standards.

Definitions:

- Class: Refers to the type of activity associated with a subject, such as lecture, tutorial, laboratory, seminar, or practical.
- Lecture: A formal class where the lecturer presents program material to all enrolled students in a particular subject.
- Laboratory Class: A class conducted in a workshop, studio, or laboratory.
- Tutorial: A smaller, less formal class for detailed discussion of material covered in lectures and readings.
- Seminar: A class combining elements of lectures and tutorials, encouraging interaction between students and the teacher for enhanced subject delivery.

12.18.1 Maximum and Minimum Class Size:

The enrollment limits for each course are determined by various factors, including the level of student learning, instructional method, available classroom capacity, and other considerations such as accreditation and safety requirements. The maximum and minimum number of students for each class type, including undergraduate core subjects, are as follows:

Class Type	Maximum Enrollment	Minimum Enrollment
Lecture	70-120 (online)	30
Tutorial	30-40	15
Seminar	30	15
Laboratory Studio	Limited to the available space, equipment, and tutor/demonstrator allocation	

Under specific circumstances, certain classes may require exceptions to the minimum enrollment requirement. Approval for exceptions must be granted by the appropriate College Dean and Vice Chancellor. Exceptions will be considered for the following class types:

1. Clinical experiences
2. Studios
3. Student teaching supervision
4. Office hours
5. Honors Seminars
6. Internships/Field Experience
7. Practicums/Capstone courses
8. Independent/Directed Research/Thesis/Dissertation

The Department Chair, with approval from the College Dean and Vice Chancellor, may offer courses below the minimum class size requirements in the following scenarios:

1. The course is mandatory for graduation, and suitable substitutions are unavailable for students.
2. The course is vital for a major and must be offered in the current semester to maintain the proper course sequence.
3. The course is part of a newly established degree program, concentration, or support area, or it is required to maintain accreditation.
4. The course is cross-listed, or an undergraduate/graduate course taught as a single class by the same faculty at the same time.
5. The course is offered for the first time.

12.18.2 Class Cancellation Procedure:

One month before the start of classes, the Registration Department will provide weekly class section status reports to Department Chairs, College Deans, and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs. Two weeks before the first day of classes, the department chair will review the section status report with the dean and provide a list of canceled classes to the Registration Department, which will promptly notify affected students of the cancellations. In the event of a canceled class, the Chair and Dean, in consultation with the faculty member, will reallocate the faculty member's time to other courses or responsibilities.

12.18.3 Course Files Policy:

Faculty members are responsible for maintaining and updating an E-Course File for each course they teach. These course files must contain comprehensive information about each course presentation to assess program effectiveness and inform future improvements. Each course file shall contain:

1. Syllabi for the current and previous course offerings.
2. Copies of all instructor teaching materials.
3. Copies of all assessment instruments.
4. Instructor worked answers and marking schemes for assessments.
5. Examples of graded responses to assessments across the range of student performance.
6. An instructor review covering various aspects of course presentation.
7. Quantitative analysis of student performance during the course presentation, including grade distributions.
8. Summary of student feedback on the course evaluation.

Department Chairs are responsible for assessing the contents and quality of course files prepared by faculty members in their departments at the end of each term. The Vice Chancellor of Quality Assurance, Institutional Effectiveness, and Accreditation plays a supporting role in assisting colleges and departments in maintaining and improving the quality of course files during periodic internal review processes.

12.18.4 Intensive Mode of Study:

Intensive mode of delivery refers to courses offered over a shorter duration than the standard semester, excluding summer courses. New programs must include all modes of delivery, including intensive mode if applicable, in their initial accreditation applications. For existing programs planning to introduce an intensive mode of delivery, prior approval from the CAA (Commission for Academic Accreditation) must be obtained. The University must clearly communicate the start and end dates of the teaching period, program/course outlines, and due dates for assessment tasks to both students and the administration for intensive mode courses.

When introducing intensive mode, colleges and departments must ensure that:

- Study plans, contact hours, and credit hours align with international practices and are appropriate for the program/course level.
- The full content of the syllabi can be covered, and all learning outcomes can be achieved within the shortened period.
- All necessary student services and facilities are available during the intensive study period.

12.18.5 Direct Study/Independent Study:

Directed/Independent Study refers to courses where students receive individual supervision from faculty, allowing them to pursue learning opportunities that might not otherwise be available. Such courses must have an appropriate syllabus, learning outcomes, teaching/learning methods, and assessment tools. The amount of credit that can be applied to an undergraduate qualification for such courses is limited by the CAA Standards. The UoS offers independent studies in the form of "special" or "selected" topics.

12.18.6 Special Topics:

A selected topics course is initiated by the instructor, who identifies a specific topic for the course. Instructors must submit a proposed course outline to their Department Chair. The outline should include a rationale for the topic, learning outcomes, and details of student evaluation. Approval from the College/Department Council must be obtained for special topics offered in selected topics courses.

Departments or programs may limit the number of special topics courses an individual student can take and/or the number of special topics courses they can use for program credit.

12.19 Student Code of Honor Student Disciplinary Policy:

At the University of Sharjah, students embark on a transformative journey of education that differs significantly from their experiences in high school. With this transition comes the responsibility to conduct themselves in a mature and responsible manner towards everyone. Embracing freedom, a fundamental principle, entails acknowledging the legitimate demands others impose on that freedom. To foster a thriving student life, it is crucial to act responsibly, adhere to ethical conduct, and demonstrate moral integrity. The time spent at the university is unique and valuable, and students should make the most of it, striving for a balanced life that harmonizes their interests with academic pursuits. Respect for the University's rules and the rights of others is essential, and any violation of these guidelines will have consequences. The University's By-laws outline the student code of conduct, and it is the students' responsibility to familiarize themselves with and uphold these principles.

12.19.1 Student Academic Dishonesty Policy:

12.19.1.1 Cheating:

Any student caught cheating or attempting to cheat during an examination or quiz will face collective penalties:

- The student will receive a failing grade in the course where the cheating occurred.

- All other courses in which the student was enrolled during the same semester will be canceled.
- The student will be dismissed from the University for one full semester following the semester in which the cheating took place. The summer session will not be considered a regular semester for this purpose. No courses completed elsewhere during the period of dismissal will be counted for the student.

12.19.1.2 Violations:

- Breaking federal and emirate laws and explicit University rules.
- Misbehaving in classrooms, laboratories, libraries, and all other areas within the University.
- Plagiarism: Stealing someone else's work, including papers, books, ideas, computer programs, experiments, exam papers, answers, and more. Plagiarism is unethical and illegal, and students caught plagiarizing will face disciplinary action.
- Inappropriate Collaboration: Collaborating on academic work without acknowledging other contributors, such as working on projects or take-home examinations without proper acknowledgment.
- Dishonesty in Examinations and Submitted Work: All academic work must be the student's own. Cheating includes copying from others' work, giving unauthorized assistance, using devices or procedures to achieve false scores, or submitting work prepared by another person or company.
- Work Submitted for Multiple Courses: Presenting the same work for more than one course is prohibited. Incorporating one's past research in current projects requires proper referencing.
- Deliberate Falsification of Data: Falsifying data or supporting documentation for academic work or other academic activities is strictly prohibited.
- Interference with Other Students' Work: Intentionally sabotaging others' laboratory experiments, research, digital files, providing misleading information, or disrupting class work is not allowed.
- Copyright Violation: Observance of copyright laws is mandatory, including proper use of printed materials, computer software, images, photo duplication of copyrighted material, and reproducing audio-visual work.
- Complicity in Academic Dishonesty: Assisting or attempting to help others commit acts of academic dishonesty or violating the academic code of conduct is not acceptable.

12.19.2 Policy Against Sexual Harassment

The University of Sharjah is dedicated to fostering an educational and workplace environment that is free from sexual harassment, ensuring the safety, dignity, and respect of all community members. Sexual harassment is a form of unlawful discrimination, and any such behaviour, regardless of the gender of the complainant or respondent, is strictly prohibited.

Sexual harassment encompasses unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature. It includes, but is not limited to:

- Unwelcome sexual propositions or solicitations.
- Threats affecting employment or academic standing in exchange for sexual favors.
- Offensive verbal comments, jokes, or innuendoes related to a person's appearance or sexuality.
- Inappropriate physical contact or gestures of a sexual nature.
- Displaying sexually explicit materials in the workplace or study areas.
- Favoritism arising from consensual sexual relationships that negatively affect others.

Members of the community are encouraged to report any incident of sexual harassment or misconduct promptly to designated grievance resolution officials. Reports can be filed through formal or informal channels, and there is no restriction on the timing for reporting such complaints. The university ensures confidentiality to the extent possible while conducting investigations.

The university strictly prohibits retaliation against individuals who report sexual harassment, participate in an investigation, or serve as witnesses. Any form of reprisal or intimidation will result in disciplinary action.

Violations of this policy may lead to severe consequences, including written warnings, suspension, termination, or expulsion, depending on the severity of the misconduct. The university may also impose interim measures, such as administrative leave or restrictions on campus access, during the investigation.

Procedures for Handling Complaints

- **For Students:** Complaints of harassment by students or employees can be directed to the Deanship of Student Affairs or the Department of Public Safety.
- **For Employees:** Employees should report incidents to the Human Resources Department or a Sexual Harassment Process Coordinator.
- **Investigation:** A formal investigation will be conducted by a committee designated by the university, ensuring a fair and thorough review of the complaint.

Confidentiality and Privacy: While the university respects the privacy of those involved in a complaint, it must also balance this with the need to conduct a thorough investigation. Information will be disclosed only on a need-to-know basis, in compliance with university policies and legal requirements.

12.19.3 Anti-Bullying Policy

The University of Sharjah is committed to maintaining a respectful and inclusive environment where the rights and dignity of all students, faculty, staff, and visitors are upheld. Bullying, in any

form, is a violation of this principle and is strictly prohibited. The university provides mechanisms for assessing allegations of bullying and addressing such behaviour promptly and fairly.

Bullying is defined as repeated aggressive behavior aimed at causing physical or emotional distress to another person. This behavior can include, but is not limited to:

- Verbal abuse, name-calling, or insults.
- Spreading rumors, manipulation, or exclusion from social or work activities.
- Physical harm, including hitting, pushing, or other acts of violence.
- Intimidation through actions like staring, laughing, or making derogatory remarks.
- Cyberbullying or harassment through online platforms.

Bullying behavior may be motivated by a desire for power, attention, or as a result of previous bullying experiences.

Members of the university community are encouraged to report incidents of bullying to the appropriate university authorities. The university offers both informal and formal grievance procedures to handle complaints. Individuals who believe they have been subjected to bullying may file a formal complaint by completing the bullying report form.

The university prohibits retaliation against anyone who reports bullying, participates in an investigation, or serves as a witness. Acts of retaliation will be treated as violations of this policy and will result in disciplinary action.

Persons found to have engaged in bullying behavior may face disciplinary actions, including written warnings, demotion, suspension, termination, or expulsion, depending on the severity of the behaviour. The university will also take immediate preventive measures, such as administrative leave or temporary suspension, if necessary, during investigations.

The university ensures that all reports of bullying are handled confidentially and with respect for the privacy of all parties involved. The university balances confidentiality with the need to conduct a thorough investigation and prevent further occurrences. All procedures will be carried out fairly and in accordance with university policies.

12.19.4 Student Grievance Policy and Procedures:

If a student believes they have been treated unjustly by a decision of the disciplinary committee, they may submit a grievance according to the following procedures:

- The student must submit a written letter to the Chair of the Disciplinary Committee within fifteen days of receiving the committee's decision, explaining the perceived injustice.
- The grievance will be forwarded to the Chancellor's Office.

- The Chancellor will refer the grievance to the Council of Deans.
- The Council of Deans will examine the grievance and decide whether to approve, modify, or reject the penalty. Once approved by the Council of Deans, the decision is considered final and may not be appealed further.

12.19.5 Student Appeals Policy and Procedures:

Within two weeks after grades have been posted, a student may submit a e-service petition to have their final examination answer sheets or booklet reviewed. The petition should be submitted through the Registrar's Office after paying the required fee. If the petition is granted, a committee formed by the Department's Chair will review the materials to check for any material errors in grading. If such errors are found, the instructor will make the necessary corrections in accordance with standard procedures.

12.20 Student Rights and Responsibilities Policy:

During the investigation before a disciplinary committee, certain points must be observed:

- The student may be referred to the disciplinary committee under two conditions: a complaint lodged against the student for a specific violation, and a detailed description of the violation provided by the complainant.
- The disciplinary committee must provide a suitable investigation time, ensuring the student's sense of security and respect for their feelings, regardless of guilt or innocence.
- If the student wishes to call a witness, the committee may refuse if the witness is not directly related to the case. The student's right to self-defense will not be violated by such a refusal.
- If the student or witness does not speak Arabic, a translator will be provided, and an oath will be administered to ensure accurate translation. The translator must not be a member of the committee or a witness.
- The investigation may not use recording equipment clandestinely, but recording with the student's knowledge is permissible for the purpose of documenting statements accurately.
- If the student suffers a nervous breakdown or faints during the investigation, the committee must postpone the investigation and resume it later to ensure justice.
- The description of the violation must align with the disciplinary rules and regulations at the University.
- A student may not be punished multiple times for the same violation, as this goes against the disciplinary rules and the spirit of justice.
- As a rule, a student may not be investigated by multiple committees simultaneously.

Chapter 13: Health and Safety

The University of Sharjah campus is committed to ensuring the safety and well-being of its community members. As part of this commitment, active fire/life safety procedures are in place to prepare for various emergencies, including fires, earthquakes, and other natural disasters. Additionally, a comprehensive disaster recovery plan covers all services provided by the Facilities Management team.

13.1 Role of the Health and Safety Office

The Health and Safety Office at the University of Sharjah is dedicated to ensuring a safe, healthy, and secure environment for all members of the university community, including students, faculty, staff, and visitors. The office's primary mission is to promote safety awareness, mitigate risks, and ensure compliance with health, safety, and environmental regulations in all university operations.

The Health and Safety Office is responsible for the following:

- **Policy Development and Implementation:** Establishing and maintaining health and safety policies in accordance with local, national, and international standards. This includes ensuring that university operations comply with relevant safety laws and regulations.
- **Risk Assessment and Management:** Conducting regular risk assessments in all university facilities, including laboratories, classrooms, offices, and public spaces. The office identifies potential hazards and develops strategies to mitigate risks.
- **Emergency Preparedness and Response:** Developing and implementing emergency response plans, including fire safety, medical emergencies, and disaster response procedures. The office conducts drills and training sessions to prepare the university community for emergency situations.
- **Health and Safety Training:** Providing mandatory training for faculty, staff, and students on health and safety practices. Training programs cover areas such as laboratory safety, fire safety, and workplace ergonomics, ensuring that all members of the community understand their roles in maintaining a safe environment.
- **Incident Reporting and Investigation:** Establishing procedures for the reporting of accidents, injuries, and unsafe conditions. The office investigates incidents, identifies root causes, and recommends corrective actions to prevent recurrence.
- **Monitoring and Compliance:** Ensuring that the university complies with health, safety, and environmental regulations. The office conducts regular audits and inspections of university facilities and activities, ensuring adherence to safety standards and protocols.
- **Collaboration with Other Departments:** Working closely with departments such as Facilities Management, Student Affairs, and the Research Office to ensure that health and safety considerations are integrated into all university operations and activities.

- **Environmental Sustainability:** Supporting the university's sustainability initiatives by promoting safe practices in waste management, energy use, and environmental conservation.

13.2 Health and Safety Policy

This policy is achieved through the following measures:

- Specification of life safety procedures administered by UoS and/or contracted staff.
- Coordination with local governmental agencies, including fire, police, and emergency medical services.
- Regular and proactive training of UoS and contracted staff to execute emergency procedures effectively.
- Documentation of routine security and safety procedures.
- Coordination with ownership to adhere to legal and insurance liability guidelines.
- Designation of a Safety Director within the onsite team, usually the Facility Manager.
- Conducting periodic life safety audits to assess site safety.

13.3 Performance Standard

Site faculty and staff must demonstrate adherence to established life safety procedures, proper documentation of procedures, and training of building personnel in their respective roles.

- Demonstrate the implementation and documentation of the life safety program.
- Ensure the program aligns with legal and insurance guidelines.
- Conduct regular faculty and staff training and include representatives of building occupants.
- Maintain accurate and up-to-date logs of life safety incidents, using them to improve site safety and inform the owner of any necessary actions.
- Coordinate emergency procedures with local agencies.
- Perform these duties to the satisfaction of the Director of Facilities and Operations and Facility Manager.

13.4 Life Safety Personnel

The site designates the following fire/life safety personnel:

- **Safety Director:** Normally the Facility Manager, responsible for coordinating security and life safety procedures on site.

- Evacuation Supervisor: Usually the lobby security guard, in charge of operating the fire command center, making announcements, directing evacuation, and implementing actions specified in the site's Emergency Procedures Manual.
- Evacuation Coordinators and Searchers: Designated by building occupants, responsible for coordinating tenant space evacuations and communicating with the fire command center as required.

13.5 Training and Drills

The managed site must have an active training and drill program covering all life safety situations and procedures. All training and drills must be documented. Evacuation drills, especially, should be coordinated with the local fire department for their participation. UoS staff and on-site vendor staff should participate in drills quarterly, while building occupants should be included in appropriate drills at least semi-annually.

Life safety procedures must provide guidelines for managing emergencies that threaten the safety of individuals or property. For each situation, the procedures should address:

- Notification requirements
- Public agency assistance
- Annunciation protocol, if applicable
- Basis to begin evacuation
- Required documentation
- Steps to maximize safety during the incident
- Clearly defined responsibilities of building staff

Procedures should be documented for various emergency categories, including:

- Fire
- Bomb Threat
- Explosion
- Suspicious Persons
- Theft
- Vandalism
- Civil Unrest
- Violent Intruder/Hostage
- Pipe Break
- Vehicular Accident
- Gas Leak
- Chemical Spill
- Power Failure

13.6 Emergency Communications

The managed site should maintain up-to-date emergency contact lists and include a notification sequence chart for various emergency conditions. These materials must be available at the site's Emergency Procedures Manual, main building security/command station, office of the building, branch emergency contact file, and property information book.

13.7 Evacuation Procedures

The site must have written evacuation procedures that undergo regular review and drills. Both training and drill activities must be documented. Evacuation procedures should be reviewed and, whenever possible, approved by the local fire department. Consideration should be given to relative risks and safety benefits of evacuation under different circumstances.

The managed site must maintain a list, with the assistance of building occupants, of individuals who may need special attention or assistance during emergencies. This may include persons with mobility, sight, hearing disabilities, or special medical conditions. The Facility Manager should coordinate with tenants regarding their staff with special needs and with the local fire department for necessary procedures or special equipment.

A listing of persons requiring special assistance and designated procedures for helping them should be included in the Site Emergency Procedures Manual.

13.8 Laboratory Safety

The Health and Safety Office, along with the Central Laboratories Directorate, is responsible for ensuring that all laboratory activities adhere to safety regulations. The responsibilities include:

- **Training:** All laboratory users, including students and staff, must receive safety training before using any laboratory equipment or materials. This training includes proper handling of chemicals, use of protective equipment, and emergency response procedures.
- **Supervision:** Laboratory supervisors are responsible for enforcing safety rules and ensuring that all users follow proper safety protocols. Laboratories are regularly inspected to maintain compliance with safety standards.
- **Risk Assessment:** Before commencing any experiment, a detailed risk assessment must be performed to identify potential hazards and implement necessary precautions.

13.8.1 Laboratory Safety Guidelines

To maintain a safe laboratory environment, the following general safety guidelines must be strictly observed:

- **Personal Protective Equipment (PPE):** All users must wear appropriate PPE, such as lab coats, safety goggles, and gloves. Long hair must be tied back, and loose clothing or open-toed shoes are prohibited.
- **Chemical Handling:** All chemicals must be properly labeled and stored. Special care should be taken when handling hazardous substances, and appropriate safety equipment, such as fume hoods, must be used to minimize exposure to fumes and vapors.
- **Waste Management:** Hazardous chemical waste must be disposed of according to the university's waste management policy. Waste containers must be clearly labeled, and incompatible substances must not be mixed.
- **Housekeeping:** Laboratories must be kept clean and organized at all times. Spills must be cleaned immediately, and all equipment must be returned to its proper place after use.

13.8.2 Emergency Procedures

In the event of an emergency, such as a chemical spill, fire, or personal injury, the following steps must be taken:

- **Incident Reporting:** All incidents must be reported immediately to the Health and Safety Office using the official incident report form.
- **Evacuation:** Familiarize yourself with the emergency exits and evacuation routes. In case of a fire or other emergency, activate the nearest alarm and follow the evacuation plan.

13.8.3 Inspections and Compliance

The Central Laboratories Directorate conducts regular inspections using specialized safety management software. These inspections ensure that all laboratories comply with health, safety, and environmental regulations, and they identify areas for improvement.

13.9 Health Services Policy

At the University of Sharjah, the health and well-being of our students are of utmost importance. In line with this commitment, we provide medical clinics for both male and female students, operating on a 24-hour basis. Additionally, we offer ambulance services for emergency situations to ensure timely and efficient support whenever needed.

It is mandatory for all University students to have health insurance coverage under one of the following three schemes:

1. **Health Card by the Ministry of Health:** Students may obtain a health card issued by the Ministry of Health, which will entitle them to utilize University medical services during emergency cases and for basic routine treatment. Students will be required to pay applicable University fees for these services.

2. Health Card by a Private Insurance Company: Alternatively, students can opt for a health card provided by a private insurance company. Similar to the previous scheme, they will have access to University medical services during emergencies and for basic routine treatment upon payment of the respective University fees.
3. University-Contracted Health Insurance: The University has established contracts with reputable health insurance companies that offer competitive costs for interested students. Under this scheme, students can benefit from both University clinic services and those provided by the insurance company without incurring extra fees.

This policy ensures that all students have access to comprehensive health services, promoting a healthy and safe environment on campus. The University encourages students to take advantage of the health insurance options available to them, safeguarding their well-being during their academic journey at UOS.

13.10 Student Counselling Policy

The Deanship of Student Affairs at the University of Sharjah offers comprehensive Counseling services with the aim of assisting students in understanding themselves, recognizing their strengths and weaknesses, and fostering personal growth. Our mission is to support students in their holistic development, empowering them to explore various opportunities and make well-informed decisions that align with their unique personalities, potential, and circumstances.

Our Counseling services encompass a wide range of areas, including but not limited to:

1. Personal Counseling: Our trained counselors provide a confidential and supportive environment for students to discuss personal issues, challenges, and concerns. Whether it's stress management, emotional well-being, or relationship difficulties, our counselors are here to listen, empathize, and guide students through their personal journey.
2. Psychological Counseling: Mental health is of paramount importance, and our counselors are trained to address psychological issues such as anxiety, depression, and other mental health concerns. We provide a safe and non-judgmental space for students to discuss their emotional well-being and offer appropriate support and referrals as needed.
3. Personal Development Workshops: Throughout the academic year, we organize workshops and seminars on various topics related to personal growth and self-improvement. These workshops aim to equip students with essential life skills and enhance their overall well-being.

The counseling services are available to all enrolled students and are entirely confidential. Students can schedule appointments with our counselors or seek assistance through walk-in sessions during designated hours. Our team is dedicated to fostering a positive and nurturing environment, promoting personal growth, resilience, and academic success.



Chapter 14: Student Services

The University of Sharjah is committed to providing comprehensive and high-quality student services to support the holistic development and well-being of our diverse student body. Our dedicated team of professionals is available to assist students throughout their academic journey, ensuring a positive and enriching university experience. This chapter outlines the various student services offered at the University of Sharjah.

14.1 Counseling and Guidance Services:

The Deanships of Student Affairs offers Counseling and Guidance services to support students in their personal, academic, and career development. Our trained counselors provide a safe and confidential environment for students to discuss their concerns, challenges, and aspirations. Whether it's academic planning, career exploration, emotional support, or personal growth, our counselors are here to lend a listening ear and provide expert guidance. Workshops and seminars are also organized to equip students with essential life skills, stress management techniques, and strategies to enhance their overall well-being. Through individual counseling sessions and group workshops, students can build resilience, develop coping strategies, and cultivate a positive mindset to navigate the challenges of university life successfully.

14.2 Health Services:

The health and well-being of our students are of paramount importance. The University provides medical clinics for both male and female students, operating on a 24-hour basis. In case of emergencies, ambulance services are readily available to ensure timely and efficient support. Our qualified medical professionals are equipped to handle a wide range of health concerns, from minor injuries to more complex medical issues. Regular health awareness campaigns and workshops are conducted to promote preventive care, healthy lifestyle choices, and mental health awareness. All University students are required to have health insurance coverage, which can be obtained through various schemes. This policy ensures that students have access to comprehensive health services, including medical consultations, vaccinations, laboratory tests, and referrals to specialized care when needed, promoting a healthy and safe environment on campus.

14.3 Career Development:

The University's Career Development Center is dedicated to helping students explore their career options, set career goals, and make informed decisions about their future. The center provides a range of resources, including career counseling, workshops, job fairs, internships, and job placement services. Our career advisors work closely with students to align their interests, strengths, and aspirations with suitable career paths, equipping them with the skills and knowledge necessary to excel in their chosen fields. Through mock interviews, resume building sessions, and networking opportunities, students are prepared to enter the job market confidently. The Career

Development Center also fosters partnerships with employers and industry professionals to provide students with valuable insights into the job market and internship opportunities, bridging the gap between academia and industry.

14.4 Student Activities:

The Department of Student Activities organizes a vibrant array of social, cultural, and entertainment programs to enrich the student experience at the University of Sharjah. Through student societies, such as the Art Society, Music Society, Communication Society, Engineering Society, Computer Society, Scientific Society, Heritage Society, and more, students can engage in their hobbies and interests while developing their talents and skills. These student-led societies foster a sense of belonging and camaraderie among students with shared interests. Additionally, the University hosts numerous events, including cultural festivals, talent shows, sports tournaments, and charity initiatives, providing students with opportunities to showcase their talents, build leadership skills, and contribute to the community. The University places great emphasis on extracurricular activities and encourages students to actively participate in various events and programs to enhance their personal growth, leadership abilities, and interpersonal skills.

14.5 Sports and Recreation:

The University promotes a healthy and active lifestyle among students through its Sports and Recreation services. Students have access to state-of-the-art sports facilities, including gyms, sports fields, and swimming pools. A wide range of sports and fitness programs are offered, catering to students of all skill levels and interests. Whether it is participating in team sports, group fitness classes, or individual recreational activities, students can engage in physical activities that promote overall well-being and stress relief. The University also encourages sportsmanship and team spirit through intramural sports competitions, providing students with opportunities to foster friendships and build a sense of community. Participation in sports not only enhances physical well-being but also fosters teamwork, discipline, and leadership, contributing to the overall personal growth and development of students.

14.6 Disability Resource Center:

The University of Sharjah is committed to promoting inclusivity and providing equal opportunities for all students. The Disability Resource Center offers tailored support and accommodations to students with disabilities. DSS works closely with students to identify their individual needs and provide appropriate assistance, ensuring an accessible and supportive learning environment. Our team collaborates with faculty members to implement reasonable accommodations, such as extra time during exams, accessible learning materials, and adapted classroom arrangements. The DSS office also advocates for the rights and needs of students with disabilities and fosters awareness and understanding of disability-related issues across the campus community. Through proactive support and advocacy, the University ensures that students with disabilities can fully participate in

academic, extracurricular, and social activities, fostering an inclusive and diverse learning environment.

14.7 Library Services:

The University's libraries are equipped with extensive resources, including books, journals, electronic databases, and multimedia materials. Knowledgeable librarians are available to assist students in locating and utilizing relevant information for their academic pursuits. The libraries also offer study spaces, computer labs, and collaborative areas to facilitate a conducive learning environment. Through regular workshops and training sessions, students are taught research skills, information literacy, and effective use of library resources. These services empower students to become critical thinkers, independent learners, and proficient researchers, supporting their academic success and intellectual growth.

14.8 International Student Support:

The University of Sharjah welcomes international students and provides dedicated support services to assist them in their transition to a new academic and cultural environment. The International Student Services office offers guidance on immigration matters, cultural adaptation, academic support, and social integration, ensuring a smooth and enriching experience for international students. Our team organizes orientation programs, cultural events, and social activities to help international students acclimate to campus life and connect with their peers. Additionally, language support services, such as English language courses and conversation groups, are offered to enhance students' language skills and facilitate effective communication. The University celebrates the diversity and global perspectives that international students bring to the campus community and strives to create a welcoming and inclusive environment for all.

14.9 Peer Tutoring Services:

Peer Tutoring Services are designed to provide academic support and enhance student learning through collaborative peer-to-peer interactions. Our peer tutors are experienced students who have excelled in their respective courses and are trained to assist fellow students in areas where they may be struggling academically. Peer tutoring sessions offer students an opportunity to clarify concepts, ask questions, and receive personalized guidance on course material.

Benefits of Peer Tutoring:

- **Enhanced Understanding:** Peer tutors provide explanations and insights from a student's perspective, making complex concepts more accessible and relatable.
- **Improved Academic Performance:** Regular peer tutoring sessions can lead to improved grades and academic achievement.

- **Increased Confidence:** Peer tutoring fosters a supportive and non-judgmental environment, boosting students' confidence in their academic abilities.
- **Active Learning:** Students engage in active learning during tutoring sessions, which can lead to better retention of information.
- **Time Management Skills:** Peer tutors can help students develop effective study strategies and time management skills.

How to Access Peer Tutoring Services: Students can access peer tutoring services through the University's Peer Tutoring Office. The Office offers a schedule of available peer tutors for various subjects, and students can sign up for one-on-one or group tutoring sessions based on their needs. Peer tutoring services are available throughout the academic year and are free of charge to all registered students.

14.10 Peer Advising Services:

Peer Advising Services at the University of Sharjah aim to support students in their academic and personal development through guidance and mentorship provided by experienced and knowledgeable peer advisors. Peer advisors are senior students who have successfully navigated the academic system and campus life. They are trained to provide valuable insights and practical advice on course selection, academic planning, co-curricular opportunities, and campus resources.

Benefits of Peer Advising:

- **Relatable Guidance:** Peer advisors understand the challenges and experiences that students face and can offer relatable and empathetic guidance.
- **Personalized Support:** Peer advisors work one-on-one with students to understand their unique goals and aspirations, providing personalized advice and support.
- **Campus Integration:** Peer advisors can help new students acclimate to campus life, fostering a sense of belonging and community.
- **Resource Navigation:** Peer advisors are well-informed about the various support services and resources available on campus and can direct students to the appropriate channels.

How to Access Peer Advising Services: Students can access peer advising services by reaching out to the Peer Advising Office. They can schedule appointments with peer advisors to discuss academic planning, career goals, co-curricular involvement, and any other concerns related to their university experience. Peer advising sessions are confidential and provide a supportive space for students to explore their options and make informed decisions.

14.11 Coursera Academy:

The University of Sharjah is committed to equipping its students with the necessary employability skills and providing them with opportunities to enhance their knowledge and competencies beyond

the traditional classroom setting. As part of this commitment, the University has partnered with Coursera, a leading online learning platform, to offer access to Coursera Academy for all students.

What is Coursera Academy?

Coursera Academy is an online learning platform that provides access to a wide range of high-quality courses and certifications from top universities and organizations around the world. It offers a diverse selection of courses in various disciplines, including business, technology, health sciences, engineering, arts, and humanities, among others. Through Coursera Academy, students can access expert-led content, gain valuable skills, and earn certifications recognized by industry leaders.

Benefits of Coursera Academy:

- **Diverse Learning Opportunities:** Students have access to a vast library of courses spanning different subjects and industries, allowing them to explore their interests and broaden their knowledge.
- **Flexibility:** Coursera Academy offers self-paced learning, enabling students to study at their own convenience and balance their coursework with other commitments.
- **Industry-Relevant Skills:** Courses on Coursera Academy are designed to address current industry demands, ensuring students acquire practical and relevant skills that enhance their employability.
- **Global Recognition:** Certifications earned through Coursera Academy are recognized and valued by employers worldwide, providing students with a competitive edge in the job market.
- **Supplemental Learning:** Coursera Academy complements traditional classroom education by offering supplementary learning resources that reinforce concepts taught in courses.

How to Access Coursera Academy: All registered students at the University of Sharjah can access Coursera Academy using their university email address. Once registered, students can browse the extensive course catalog, enroll in courses of interest, and begin their learning journey. The University provides support and resources to help students make the most of their Coursera Academy experience.

14.12 Interdisciplinary Certificate Programs:

The University of Sharjah recognizes the value of interdisciplinary learning in preparing students for the complexities of the modern workforce. In line with this vision, the University has introduced Interdisciplinary Certificate Programs that encourage students to explore and integrate knowledge from multiple disciplines.

What are Interdisciplinary Certificate Programs?

Interdisciplinary Certificate Programs are designed to enable students to pursue areas of interest that cut across traditional academic boundaries. These programs combine courses from different disciplines, allowing students to gain a holistic understanding of complex issues and challenges. Interdisciplinary learning fosters creativity, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills, preparing students to address real-world problems from diverse perspectives.

Benefits of Interdisciplinary Certificate Programs:

- **Broadened Perspectives:** Students engage with diverse viewpoints and approaches, broadening their understanding of complex issues.
- **Enhanced Problem-Solving:** Interdisciplinary learning equips students with the ability to tackle complex challenges by drawing from various disciplines.
- **Personalized Learning Paths:** Students can tailor their learning journey by selecting courses aligned with their unique interests and career aspirations.
- **Competitive Advantage:** Completion of an Interdisciplinary Certificate Program showcases a student's adaptability and innovative thinking, making them more competitive in the job market.
- **Collaborative Skills:** Interdisciplinary learning promotes collaboration and teamwork, essential skills for success in professional settings.

Participating in Interdisciplinary Certificate Programs: Students interested in participating in Interdisciplinary Certificate Programs can explore the available programs and course options through the University's official website. They can consult with academic advisors to design a personalized learning path that aligns with their academic and career goals. Successful completion of the required courses within the chosen program will lead to the awarding of the Interdisciplinary Certificate.

Chapter 15: Campus Facilities

The University of Sharjah is committed to fostering an enriching and supportive environment for its community, ensuring that they have access to world-class facilities that enhance their academic, research, and professional endeavors. Our campus is equipped with state-of-the-art resources designed to support the diverse needs of our faculty, enabling them to excel in teaching, research, and service to the university community.

UoS offers a comprehensive range of facilities that cater to the academic, technological, and personal needs of faculty members. These include advanced research laboratories, modern lecture halls, and fully equipped offices that provide a conducive atmosphere for both teaching and scholarly activities. Faculty members also have access to the university's extensive library system, which houses a vast collection of academic resources, including digital databases, journals, and books to support their research and teaching requirements.

In addition to academic facilities, UoS provides various amenities that promote a balanced and fulfilling work-life experience. The campus features a variety of recreational and wellness facilities, including fitness centers, sports complexes, and leisure areas where faculty can unwind and maintain a healthy lifestyle. Faculty members can also take advantage of on-campus dining options, offering a range of cuisines to cater to diverse tastes and preferences.

Furthermore, UoS is dedicated to supporting the professional development of its faculty by providing access to continuous learning opportunities, workshops, and conferences. These initiatives are designed to support faculty stay at the forefront of their fields and contribute to the university's mission of excellence in education and research.

15.1 Central Laboratories

The Central Laboratories Directorate (CLD) at the University of Sharjah was established in 1997, the same year the University was inaugurated. Since its inception, the CLD has expanded significantly, now managing over 117 teaching labs, 49 research labs, and 16 multifunctional labs that support both teaching and research. These labs are strategically located across the campus, including in buildings M12, W12, M2, W8, M23, M27, M28, M31, M32, and at the Sharjah Academy for Astronomy, Space Sciences and Technology (SAASST). Each semester, more than 450 lab sessions are conducted on the main campus.

The CLD is responsible for a broad range of critical functions, including the efficient management of lab space, technical support for laboratory equipment and consumables, in coordination with the needs of various colleges, research institutes, and the Procurement Department. The CLD also oversees the maintenance of lab equipment, central lab service systems, and lab inventories, enforces safety measures, manages central lab stores, and contributes to continuous improvement activities. It administers the teaching labs in the Colleges of Sciences, Engineering, Health

Sciences, Pharmacy, Dentistry, and Medicine, as well as all research labs within the Research Institute for Science and Engineering (RISE), the Research Institute for Medical and Health Sciences (RIMHS) and the Research Institute for Humanities and Social Sciences.

The University's laboratories house more than 13,100 items that meet contemporary international standards and specifications, thereby supporting the University of Sharjah's educational and research objectives. The University places great emphasis on the laboratory experience, allocating an annual budget to the CLD to maintain its technological assets and meet the evolving needs of faculty and students.

The CLD has made significant strides in improving its operations to better serve students, staff, and faculty. Innovations include an online safety inspection system that tracks all inspections and corrective actions, an online system for managing equipment maintenance and asset control, an online lab safety training portal, and an online chemical inventory management system.

15.2 Business Service Department

The Business Services Department was established to deliver high-quality services to all colleges, departments, centers, and units within the University of Sharjah. Its mission is to ensure excellence in service provision, with a focus on improving transaction processing procedures to achieve the highest levels of customer satisfaction.

The Department is committed to upholding the highest standards of professionalism, providing the University with outstanding services that support its growth and development. Its primary focus is on delivering quality services that contribute to the advancement of scholarly work across the University.

In line with its mandate, the Business Service Department offer essential support and continuously strive to enhance the performance of our various divisions. Its place a strong emphasis on simplifying operational procedures, ensuring that services remain efficient, effective, and aligned with the University's goals.

15.2.1 Security Service Unit

The Security Services Unit (SSU) is a crucial component of the University of Sharjah, operating 24/7 to ensure the security of the University's premises and the safety of its students. The SSU plays an essential role in maintaining a safe and nurturing educational environment.

Key Services Provided by the SSU:

- **Fire Protection:** The SSU takes all necessary measures to protect the University's facilities against fire, ensuring a safe environment for all.

- **Reception Duties:** During work hours, the SSU performs receptionist duties, which include answering visitors' inquiries, supervising student entry into the main building, and informing students of relevant bylaws issued by the University Administration.
- **Emergency Medical Assistance:** The SSU coordinates with ambulance services in response to any medical emergencies on UoS campuses, ensuring timely and efficient care.
- **Car Stickers and Entry Cards:** The SSU provides faculty, staff, and students with official UoS car stickers. Additionally, it issues entry cards to faculty and staff, granting them access to the University buildings' main gates after work hours and during vacations, upon the approval of the University Administration.
- **Permit Issuance:** The SSU is responsible for issuing various permits, including:
 - Exit permits for female students with guardian approval.
 - Entry permits for lessees of on-campus food venue and external restaurant owners, following the submission of necessary documents and fees as specified by the University Administration.
- **Parking Access:** Faculty and staff are issued magnetic cards for accessing car parks located at the back of the Main Building (M11).
- **Lost and Found Management:** The SSU manages lost and found items, ensuring that misplaced belongings are returned to their rightful owners.
- **Additional Duties:** The SSU also performs any other duties as assigned by the University Administration, contributing to the overall security and smooth operation of the campus.

15.2.2 Transportation Unit

The Transport Section at the University of Sharjah is dedicated to providing high-quality transportation services to enhance convenience and support the needs of both students and staff. The section ensures compliance with the University's commitment to excellence in service delivery.

Transport Section Services for Students:

1. **Off-Campus Training:** Transportation services are provided for students participating in off-campus training programs.
2. **Airport Transportation:** The section offers 24-hour transportation services to Sharjah and Dubai airports exclusively for female dormitory students.
3. **Shopping Service:** Weekly shopping trips are organized for dormitory students to various shopping centers, adhering to a scheduled timetable.
4. **Emergency Transportation:** In case of emergencies, female dormitory students have access to 24/7 transportation to hospitals or medical centers, as directed by Dormitory Management.
5. **On-Campus Transportation:** Buses provide transportation within the campus from 7:00 am to 5:00 pm according to the following schedule:
 - **Female Students:**
 - From the female dormitory (W13) to the colleges: One bus every 10 minutes.
 - From the nurse housing complex and medical colleges housing G to the medical and women's colleges: One bus every 20 minutes.

- Inter-campus transportation: Buses run every 10 minutes between the colleges.
- Waiting Areas: W7, W3, W1, and the W2 roundabout.
- **Male Students:**
 - From the male dormitory to the medical colleges and College of Fine Arts and Design: One bus every hour.
 - From male student waiting areas at M1 and M2 to the colleges: One bus every 15 minutes.

Transport Section Services for Faculty and Staff:

1. **Official Visits and Conferences:** Transportation services are provided for staff members attending official visits and conferences.
2. **New Faculty Assistance:** New faculty members receive transportation support for completing their administrative transactions for the first two weeks.
3. **Regular Trips to Sharjah and Ajman:** The section organizes regular transportation for staff members to Sharjah and Ajman.
 - **Sharjah:**
 - Male staff members: Jamal Abdalnaser area, Rola, Qasimia.
 - Female staff members: Maliha, Jamal Abdalnaser area, Rola.
 - **Ajman:** Transportation services are provided for both male and female staff traveling from Ajman to the University of Sharjah.
4. **Faculty Housing Transportation:** Regular transportation is provided for faculty members traveling between housing complexes and the campus.
5. **Visitor Transportation:** Coordination with concerned departments ensures transportation services for visitors and guests.

15.2.3 Mail Office

The Mail Office is responsible for collecting and managing mail from all University departments and colleges, ensuring its delivery to the Post Office. It handles parcels, letters, and local newspapers, distributing these items to their respective departments through designated staff. The office provides a range of mail services to students, faculty, and staff members, including:

- Dispatching and receiving letters, printed materials, and small bundles.
- Handling express mail.
- Managing local and international parcels.
- Processing registered mail.
- Offering special mailbag services for shipping books.

In addition to its core mail services, the Mail Office is dedicated to achieving high levels of customer satisfaction by offering a variety of miscellaneous services. These include:

- Coordination with international mail services for local and international parcel dispatch and receipt.
- Subscription management for newspapers and journals.
- Assistance with customs clearance for shipments at customs, airports, and seaports.

15.3 Facilities Management

The Facilities Management and Planning Department (FMPD) oversees a broad scope of services across the University of Sharjah's Campus, as well as its branches in Khorfakkan, Al Dhaid, and Kalba, and the Sharjah Academy of Astronomy, Space Sciences and Technology (SAASST). The Department operates through four specialized subgroups:

1. Environmental, Health, and Safety Management (EHSM)
2. Facilities Management (FM)
3. Projects Management (PM)
4. Energy Management

Each subgroup works collaboratively to achieve the Department's mission and objectives.

Environmental, Health, and Safety Management Section (EHSM)

Established in 2022, the EHSM Section is dedicated to aligning with the University of Sharjah's strategic goals and fulfilling legal and ethical responsibilities. The section focuses on:

- Enhancing campus wellness and support for students.
- Improving employee safety, wellbeing, and healthcare.
- Developing an environmentally sustainable campus.

The EHSM Section has been consulting with stakeholders to define its purpose, objectives, and responsibilities.

Facilities Management Section

The Facilities Management Section consolidates all maintenance services into one cohesive unit, managed by a team of qualified professionals. This team handles both in-house and outsourced services using a reliable performance management system. Core maintenance activities include:

- Air Conditioning Systems (HVAC)
- Plumbing Services
- Electrical Services
- Carpentry Services
- Soft Services
- Emergency Responses
- Event Support
- Civil Maintenance
- Elevator Services
- Fire Alarm/Firefighting Systems

The Facilities Management Section also operates a 24/7 help desk for reporting maintenance issues, which are tracked via a unique ticketing system.

Projects Management Section

The Projects Management Section is responsible for supervising the design, renovation, and construction of projects across UoS campuses. This includes:

- Project planning and estimates
- Interior design services

- Furniture procurement

Recent key projects include the construction of dining halls, multi-story parking facilities, new academic buildings, and various campus improvements aimed at enhancing student and faculty experiences.

Energy Management Section

The Energy Management Section focuses on optimizing facility operations through digital transformation and strategic energy management. Key activities include:

- Monitoring and analyzing energy and water consumption
- Implementing advanced technology to improve efficiency
- Developing programs for strategic decision-making

Recent projects include replacing street light luminaires, studying high power consumption equipment, and installing new metering devices for various systems.

The Facilities Management and Planning Department remains committed to supporting the University's infrastructure needs and contributing to its mission of excellence in education and research.

15.4 Child Care Center

The University of Sharjah Nursery is dedicated to providing the highest quality care and services for children, prioritizing their psychological and physical health and wellbeing. Since its establishment, the nursery has maintained exceptional standards, recognizing its crucial role in fostering feelings of security, love, and stability especially during the formative first year when children are away from their parents.

The nursery mission is to create a nurturing environment that promotes the development of a distinctive identity and core values for each child. We aim to help children become active participants in their nation, empowering them to utilize their talents and skills effectively in shaping the future. At the Child Care Center of the University of Sharjah, we strive to nurture creative and happy children who embrace life's joys in a fun and engaging atmosphere.

We focus on discovering and enhancing each child's unique attributes, building their confidence through high-quality care and comprehensive support for their physical and mental wellbeing. Our approach is rooted in a deep understanding of the principles of childrearing that align with our Islamic values and the customs and traditions of the UAE.

The nursery plays a vital role in preserving each child's identity and first language while also broadening their awareness and developing sound values. We are committed to meeting the developmental needs associated with each stage of childhood, introducing scientific reasoning, methodology, and advanced technology in a child-centered environment tailored to their needs.

15.5 Disability Resource Center

Established by Decision No. 299 of 2013-2014, the Disability Resource Center (DRC) is dedicated to supporting individuals with disabilities at the University of Sharjah. Our mission is to ensure

the inclusion, integration, and empowerment of these individuals from their initial enrollment through their graduation and beyond.

The DRC is committed to creating an inclusive environment that guarantees individuals with disabilities access to their rights as outlined by relevant federal and Sharjah laws. DRC facilitate opportunities for individuals with disabilities to pursue and achieve higher education, implementing accessible teaching methods and curriculum adaptations to meet learning objectives. Our efforts extend to offering activities and learning opportunities that enhance the personal, educational, and professional development of individuals with disabilities. DRC are dedicated to promoting respect for the dignity of individuals with disabilities within the university community while protecting them from discrimination, abuse, neglect, or exploitation. The Center integrates individuals with disabilities into the university community, aiding their adjustment to university life, and providing support to ensure their active participation. DRC ensure competent evaluation and professional integration while upholding privacy, confidentiality, and regulatory standards.

The DRC adheres to a set of policies aimed at ensuring students with disabilities have full access to higher education. DRC implement procedures to guarantee educational rights, plan sustainably to provide appropriate resources and facilities, and evaluate university facilities to meet international accessibility standards. DRC oppose all forms of discrimination and classify disabilities based on valid ID cards issued by the Ministry of Social Affairs, requiring additional documentation for pending or renewal cases. The Center respects students' privacy and maintains confidentiality, except when information is requested by relevant university departments or competent authorities based on legitimate grounds. The DRC Director has the authority to disclose such information as necessary. DRC safeguard students' personal files and do not disclose them without written consent. DRC support is provided through effective methods and specialized professionals who treat students with disabilities appropriately. DRC utilize all resources to achieve the Center's goals and coordinate with university colleges, institutes, centers, administrative departments, and the Deanship of Student Affairs to deliver the best educational and developmental programs and services. Faculty and staff are encouraged to contribute to supporting students with disabilities, and we facilitate communication between these students and various university departments and colleges. Students with disabilities have the right to appeal support methods, with objections addressed first to the DRC Director and, if unresolved, to the Chancellor. DRC also partner with Sharjah City for expertise exchange and sustainable cooperation and engage with local and international entities concerned with disability support.

The DRC is responsible for implementing policies, plans, and initiatives to protect the rights of individuals with disabilities in coordination with Sharjah City. DRC achieve objectives set forth in the bylaws, including promoting disability awareness within and outside the university community and maintaining an electronic record of individuals with disabilities from admission to graduation. DRC provide support and counseling, evaluate the quality of services, and handle complaints from individuals with disabilities, referring them to relevant departments and monitoring resolutions. DRC represent individuals with disabilities to defend their rights and

monitor academic performance and learning effectiveness. Additionally, DRC identify suitable job opportunities, assist in securing employment within and outside the university, and create communication channels with the Alumni Association for career counseling and guidance. DRC also organize and participate in conferences, seminars, and workshops related to disability issues and promote volunteerism within the Center and the broader community.

15.6 Medical Clinics

The University Medical Clinics (UMC) is dedicated administrative, medical, and nursing staff are committed to ensuring your health and safety while on campus, whether you are in classrooms, university buildings, student dormitories, or faculty housing.

At UMC, offer a comprehensive range of medical services including diagnostic, therapeutic, preventive, and educational care. UMC approach is grounded in evidence-based medical practices and delivered by experienced professionals. UMC prioritize a patient-centered care model that addresses the physical, psychological, and social aspects of each individual's health. UMC services are designed to be easily accessible, cost-effective, integrated, comprehensive, and of the highest quality, ensuring a safe and healthy environment for all members of the university community.

15.7 Sport Facilities

The main campus of the University of Sharjah boasts two state-of-the-art sports complexes, one for men and one for women. These facilities include Olympic-sized swimming pools, several multipurpose indoor sports halls, and fully-equipped gymnasiums. Additionally, the campus features a standard-sized soccer field, a running track, and outdoor lighting for evening use.

The University offers a wide range of sports and recreational activities, including bodybuilding, swimming, volleyball, karate, shooting, aerobics, yoga, bowling, table tennis, chess, billiards, tennis, squash, football, snooker, and basketball.

Outstanding student-athletes may be eligible for scholarships to support their academic pursuits while recognizing their athletic achievements.

15.8 Food Courts

The campus offers a variety of restaurants, food courts, and coffee shops that serve healthy and reasonably priced meals. These dining facilities are situated in spacious areas, providing students with comfortable spaces to socialize while enjoying a diverse selection of food.

Dining services are available throughout the day for commuting students and extend into the evening to accommodate those residing in campus dormitories. Additionally, opt for meal deliveries from off-campus restaurants and cafeterias is available.



Chapter 16: Other Policies

16.1 Faculty Professional Consultancy

The University of Sharjah recognizes the value of faculty consultancy as a means to contribute to the professional development and growth of faculty members while potentially benefiting the University through enhanced expertise and networking opportunities. This policy outlines the guidelines and procedures for faculty members engaging in consultancy activities and ensures that such activities are conducted with transparency, fairness, and integrity.

16.1.1 Definition of Consultancy:

Consultancy is defined as any professional activity related to the faculty member's field or discipline, where a fee-for-service or equivalent relationship with a third party exists. This includes consulting for companies owned by oneself or an immediate family member.

16.1.2 Purpose of Faculty Consultancy:

Faculty consultancy is encouraged to foster academic growth, expand professional networks, and explore opportunities for sponsored research. It provides faculty members with opportunities to apply their expertise beyond the university setting, while also potentially benefiting the University through collaborations and partnerships.

16.1.3 Pre-Approval for Consultancy Activities:

All proposed faculty consultancy activities must receive prior review and approval through the appropriate channels, including the Department Chair, Dean, and Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs, to ensure that they do not present conflicts of interest and do not compromise the faculty member's duties and responsibilities at the University.

16.1.4 Non-Compensated Consultancy:

Even in cases of non-compensated consultancy, where faculty members engage in public service related to their area of expertise, prior approval is required whenever potential conflicts of interest exist. Faculty members are responsible for assessing whether the potential for a conflict of interest exists and, when in doubt, should submit a consulting form for review.

16.1.5 Use of University Facilities and Resources:

Faculty members must obtain prior approval for the use of University equipment, facilities, or the employment of University faculty, staff, and students in their consultancy activities. The inconsequential use of office-based computing equipment and telephone equipment, such as

exchanging emails or local telephone calls with a consulting client, is permitted without prior approval.

16.1.6 Liability and Responsibility:

The University assumes no responsibility for any aspects of faculty consultancy activities. Consultancy agreements must include a clause stating that the University is not liable for the consultancy activity.

16.1.7 Time Allocation for Consultancy:

Full-time faculty members are permitted to spend up to 20% of their time or an equivalent of one working day per week on professional consultancy activities. Other academic members' consultancy days are per a written approval of the individual they report to, but should not exceed the time limit imposed on full-time faculty. Consultancy time limits do not apply to official holidays or faculty members on sabbatical leave receiving full compensation from the University. Faculty members must accurately report the time spent on consultancy activities.

16.1.7 Conflict of Interest and Intellectual Property:

Faculty members engaging in consultancy must comply with the University's conflict of interest, conflict of commitment, and intellectual property policies. Any violations or perceived violations must be disclosed, and relevant IP ownership resulting from the consultancy will be determined by the University's designated office.

16.1.8 Use of University Name:

The use of the University's name in relation to any professional consultancy activity, except to describe the credentials of the academic member, is not permitted unless explicitly approved in writing by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs.

16.1.9 Independent Consultancy:

Independent consultancy is the sole responsibility of the academic member consultant. The academic member must obtain pre-approval from the College Dean, and in the event the Dean is planning to engage in independent professional consultancy, a written approval from the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs is required.

16.1.10 Limitations on Consultancy:

Professional consultancy that implies managerial responsibilities in for-profit organizations is not allowed.

16.1.11 Scholarly Communications and Consultation:

Scholarly communications that may earn academic member compensation are not viewed as consultancy. Articles produced via paid consultation services must disclose a statement to exempt the University from any liability.

16.1.12 Ambiguities and Compliance:

The responsibility of adhering to the faculty consultancy policy lies with the individual faculty member. Any ambiguities or questions should be resolved with the College Dean before commencing any consultancy activity.

16.2 Conflict of Interest

The University of Sharjah (UoS) is committed to academic freedom and excellence in teaching and research. As part of its pursuit of this mission, the University recognizes that actual or perceived conflicts of interest may arise due to the various activities and situations in which its faculty members engage. Rather than disallowing all conflicts, UoS assesses conflict considerations and, when appropriate, permits certain managed conflicts. This policy aims to promote transparency, integrity, and accountability in managing conflicts of interest and commitment within the University community.

Definitions:

- **Conflict of Commitment:** Occurs when an academic member's outside activities compromise or may compromise their ability to meet their obligations to the University.
- **Outside Activities:** Paid tasks performed by academic members or researchers outside of the University.
- **Professional Consultancy:** Any professional activity where a fee-for-service or equivalent relationship with a third party exists.
- **Academic Members:** Include regular faculty, post-docs, and research assistants, holding ranks such as teaching assistants, lecturers, assistant professors, associate professors, and professors.
- **Conflict of Interest:** Any circumstance in which the personal, professional, financial, or other interests of an individual, including second-degree relatives by blood, may be

perceived as potentially or actually diverging from their professional obligations to the University or the interests of the University.

- Second-Degree Relatives by Blood: Includes sons, daughters, brothers, sisters, spouse, fathers, and mothers.

Primary Commitment to the University:

Academic members must prioritize their time and intellectual energies for the University's teaching, research, and other programs and services.

Primary Professional Allegiance to the University of Sharjah:

In all scholarly production, the University of Sharjah must be the first affiliation of academic members.

Disclosure of Conflicts:

UoS requires the disclosure of all apparent or perceived conflicts of interest or commitment. Faculty members must disclose such conflicts at the time they arise or are recognized.

Adherence to Professional Consultancy Policy:

Academic members engaging in professional consultancy activities must comply with the Professional Consultancy Policy.

Conflict of Commitment:

Conflict of commitment constitutes professional misconduct and is subject to the University's professional conduct policy and procedures.

Examples of Activities Creating Conflicts of Interest:

The following activities are examples of conflicts of interest that academic members must avoid or disclose:

- Improper use of University resources for personal use or outside activities.
- Obtaining, using, or disclosing the University's confidential information for personal interest or profit.
- Failing to disclose and assign intellectual property in accordance with the University's policy.
- Engaging in activities in direct competition with the University.

- Participating in business arrangements involving the University and an entity in which the faculty member holds an ownership interest or employment/management role.
- Evaluating students' academic success based on considerations unrelated to their achievements.
- Teaching second-degree relatives by blood.
- Accepting gifts or gratis services from students, parents, or relatives of students.
- Supervising or participating in decisions that affect second-degree relatives by blood.
- Reporting to a second-degree relative by blood.
- Participating in decisions to benefit external organizations with personal interest.

University's Authority:

The University of Sharjah has the authority to require disclosures, investigate conflicts of interest, manage or eliminate conflicts, impose appropriate sanctions for policy violations, and release information about conflicts of interest.

16.3 Animal Use in Research

The University of Sharjah (UoS) is committed to conducting high-quality research to advance knowledge and improve human and animal health. In compliance with international standards and ethical guidelines, UoS recognizes the essential role of animals in biomedical and scientific research. This policy outlines the principles and procedures governing the use of animals in research at UoS and ensures the responsible and ethical treatment of animals.

16.3.1 Ethical Principles:

UoS adheres to the following ethical principles in conducting research involving animals:

- Respect for Animal Welfare: UoS researchers must ensure the well-being and humane treatment of animals throughout all stages of the research process.
- Replacement, Reduction, and Refinement (3Rs): UoS encourages researchers to adopt the 3Rs principles, which advocate for the replacement of animals with non-animal alternatives whenever possible, the reduction of the number of animals used, and the refinement of research methods to minimize potential pain and distress for the animals.

16.3.2 Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC):

UoS establishes an Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee to oversee and approve all research activities involving animals. The IACUC is responsible for ensuring that animal research is conducted in accordance with applicable laws, regulations, and ethical guidelines. Researchers must obtain IACUC approval before commencing any animal research.

16.3.3 Animal Welfare and Housing:

UoS provides appropriate housing and care facilities for research animals to meet their physiological and behavioral needs. Animal housing and management follow the guidelines established by the IACUC and are regularly monitored for compliance with animal welfare standards.

16.3.4 Training and Certification:

Researchers, staff, and students involved in animal research must receive adequate training in animal handling, welfare, and ethical considerations. UoS offers training programs and encourages certification from recognized animal welfare organizations to ensure competent and responsible animal care.

16.3.5 Animal Procurement:

Animals used in research at UoS must be sourced from reputable suppliers and comply with ethical standards. The acquisition of animals should prioritize the 3Rs principles and ensure that the species, number, and strain of animals are scientifically justified for the research objectives.

16.3.6 Pain and Distress Minimization:

Researchers must employ appropriate methods to minimize pain and distress in animals during research. Whenever possible, alternative approaches or methods should be used to reduce potential suffering.

16.3.7 Anesthesia and Analgesia:

Researchers must use appropriate anesthesia and analgesia when necessary to alleviate pain and discomfort in animals undergoing procedures or surgery. The use of these agents should follow established veterinary guidelines.

16.3.8 Data Reporting and Sharing:

UoS encourages researchers to publish research findings, including animal study data, to promote scientific transparency and facilitate the advancement of knowledge. Any relevant information on animal use in research should be made available to the scientific community through appropriate channels.

16.3.9 Compliance and Oversight:

UoS is committed to complying with all national and international regulations and guidelines pertaining to animal research. The IACUC ensures regular audits, inspections, and reviews of animal research activities to maintain ethical standards and adherence to the policy.

16.4 Human Use in Research

The University of Sharjah (UoS) is committed to conducting research of the highest ethical standards. As part of its research endeavors, the University may engage in studies involving human participants. This policy outlines the principles and procedures to ensure the protection of human subjects involved in research conducted at UoS. The policy adheres to the ethical guidelines and principles set forth by the international best practice and is applicable to all faculty, staff, students, and researchers involved in human research at the University.

Definitions:

- Human Subject: An individual whose data, specimens, or information are used in research, either as a participant or as a recipient of intervention.
- Informed Consent: The process of obtaining voluntary and informed agreement from an individual to participate in research, based on an understanding of the study's purpose, procedures, potential risks, and benefits.
- Institutional Review Board (IRB): An independent committee responsible for reviewing and approving research protocols involving human subjects to ensure ethical and regulatory compliance.
- Research: A systematic investigation designed to develop or contribute to generalizable knowledge.
- Vulnerable Populations: Individuals who may have limited autonomy, diminished decision-making capacity, or face undue influence, making them susceptible to potential harm in research.

Ethical Principles:

All research involving human participants at UoS must adhere to the ethical principles outlined in the NIH guidelines, including respect for autonomy, beneficence, justice, and the principles of informed consent.

IRB Review and Approval:

All research protocols involving human subjects must be submitted to the Institutional Review Board (IRB) for review and approval before commencement. The IRB ensures that the research is conducted in compliance with ethical guidelines and relevant regulations.

Informed Consent:

Informed consent is a fundamental aspect of human research. Researchers must obtain written informed consent from all participants before their involvement in the study. The consent process should be transparent, and participants must be provided with sufficient information to make an informed decision.

Privacy and Confidentiality:

Researchers must ensure the privacy and confidentiality of participants' data and information. Identifiable information should be securely stored and only accessible to authorized personnel.

Protection of Vulnerable Populations:

Special consideration must be given to the protection of vulnerable populations, including minors, pregnant women, prisoners, and individuals with cognitive impairments. Researchers must take additional precautions to safeguard their rights and well-being.

Monitoring and Reporting:

Researchers must monitor the progress of the study regularly and promptly report any adverse events or unanticipated problems to the IRB. The IRB may suspend or terminate the study if necessary to protect participants' rights and welfare.

Conflict of Interest:

Researchers involved in human research must disclose any potential conflicts of interest that may affect the objectivity of the study or the well-being of the participants.

Training and Education:

All researchers, faculty, staff, and students involved in human research must undergo appropriate training on research ethics, informed consent, and human subjects' protection.

16.5 Policy Prohibiting Sexual Harassment

The University of Sharjah is dedicated to fostering a safe and respectful environment characterized by mutual trust, dignity, and respect for all members of its community. As such, the University strictly prohibits any form of sexual harassment, ensuring that individuals' personal security and comfort are safeguarded. This policy applies to all members of the University community, regardless of gender, and extends protection against sexual harassment regardless of the gender of

the aggressor or the victim, in accordance with the UAE Penal Code (Article 359, pursuant to the amendment of Federal Law No. 4 of 2019).

Definitions:

Sexual harassment is considered any persistent harassment of individuals (regardless of their gender) through actions, language, or signals offensive to modesty, intended to compel someone to respond to sexual desires. It includes but is not limited to:

- a. Invitations to engage in sexual activities, either explicitly or implicitly.
- b. Exposure of intimate body parts to sexually provoke an individual.
- c. Prolonged inappropriate staring at someone's body.
- d. Excessive interest in someone's personal affairs without their consent.
- e. Offering work or academic benefits in exchange for sexual demands.
- f. Making facial expressions or noises with sexual connotations.
- g. Making sexual remarks, jokes, or insinuations about someone's appearance or manner.

16.5.1 Legal Accountability:

The conduct prohibited by this policy not only violates University regulations but also constitutes a violation of UAE law, subjecting the offender to criminal and civil liability at the discretion of the competent judicial authorities.

16.5.2 Reporting and Legal Action:

Anyone who experiences or witnesses conduct considered prohibited under this policy is encouraged to report it promptly. The University will respond swiftly, impartially, and lawfully by taking appropriate action to address and prevent such conduct. The accused individual will be subject to internal disciplinary procedures as per the University's bylaws. Additionally, this disciplinary action will not impede or hinder any criminal prosecution pursued by the accuser before the UAE judicial authorities.

16.5.3 Prohibition of Retaliation:

Engaging in threats or retaliation against individuals who report sexual harassment is strictly prohibited under this policy. Any act attempting to obstruct the investigation of sexual harassment complaints or retaliating against the complainant will also be dealt with severely.

16.5.4 Scope of Application:

This policy applies to all members of the University community, including students, faculty, academic staff, administrators, temporary and part-time employees, as well as contractors, suppliers, volunteers, visitors, and campus patrons. Although the University lacks legal disciplinary authority over some categories, appropriate precautionary measures will be taken by the Chancellor of the University in the event of harassment allegations against such individuals.

16.5.5 Protecting Complainants, Defendants, and Witnesses:

The University ensures that individuals who report sexual harassment will not face disciplinary action for making a complaint in good faith. Retaliation against complainants, witnesses, or individuals providing assistance is strictly prohibited.

16.5.6 Procedures:

The University provides multiple channels for reporting sexual harassment, both formal and informal. Individuals seeking help, advice, or wishing to report sexual harassment incidents are encouraged to contact the designated Sexual Harassment Proceedings Coordinator or Officer. The University guarantees confidentiality to the extent permitted by law while conducting a fair and effective investigation.

16.5.7 Sexual Harassment Prevention Strategies:

The University is committed to preventing sexual harassment through education, awareness, and psychological support for all members of the University community. Strategic measures will be implemented to foster a safe and respectful environment.

16.6 University of Sharjah Guidelines on Artificial Intelligence and Large Language Models

The rapid advancements in Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Large Language Models (LLMs) have profoundly impacted various domains, including teaching and learning. Although AI has been in use across several applications since the 1980s, recent developments in Generative AI tools, such as Chat Generative Pre-trained Transformer (ChatGPT), have revolutionized human-machine interaction and become mainstream. These technological advances have presented challenges to

regulators, with some countries, like Italy, opting to ban ChatGPT over privacy concerns, while others explore measures to limit or control its growth. However, researchers argue that controlling generative AI is impractical, given its development in foreign jurisdictions, where regulatory reach is limited.

Despite the concerns, Generative AI has proven beneficial, enabling the creation of new products and reducing the time required to complete certain tasks. AI's predictive texting, originally developed in the 1980s as an assistive tool for individuals with disabilities, has evolved significantly. However, AI generative technology is still maturing and may produce inaccurate or fabricated responses, known as "hallucinations." Nonetheless, AI and the Internet of Things (IoT) are considered pivotal elements in the sixth cycle of innovation.

The use of AI in higher education has sparked diverse opinions. While some view AI as a tool that enhances teaching, learning, and research, others see it as a threat to academic integrity, as it may facilitate cheating and plagiarism. The issue of authorship has also surfaced, with AI-generated work not being recognized under copyright law. Leading publishers have similarly ruled that AI cannot be listed as an author.

Academic integrity is central to the debate within academic institutions. Students have been increasingly turning to services that allow others to complete their academic work, with tools like Chegg and content mills flourishing. ChatGPT, offering almost free and readily accessible assistance, exacerbates these concerns, as students may rely on the technology rather than engaging with the material themselves. Although various detection tools claim to distinguish between AI and human writing, research suggests that producing a foolproof detector is impossible. A recent case at the University of California-Davis highlighted the unreliability of such detectors, as a student successfully contested a wrongful accusation based on GPTZero. The creator of GPTZero even advised against making definitive academic decisions based on their tool.

In response to these challenges, the University of Sharjah has developed this document to guide the ethical use of AI technology for faculty, students, and researchers.

Core Principles:

1. AI technology is a permanent feature in the academic landscape, and its use must be ethical and responsible.
2. AI should enhance human creativity, not hinder it.
3. AI technology is still evolving and may produce incorrect or misleading results.
4. The University's Code of Academic Integrity remains paramount, with the following provisions:
 - Responsibility for any submitted academic work lies with the submitter and those claiming authorship.

- Attribution and citation must be accurate, following guidelines such as those provided by the APA for citing AI-generated content.
- Violations of academic integrity are subject to penalties as per University Policy and Procedures.

These guidelines are tailored to the specific needs of the University of Sharjah community.

Guidelines for Students:

- The use of AI language models like ChatGPT in academic projects and assignments must be ethical and in accordance with UoS guidelines and academic integrity policies.
- Extensive use of AI language models to complete assignments is considered academically dishonest, equivalent to having someone else complete your work.
- In written assignments, any materials, notes, or sources generated by AI tools, including those not freely available online, must be properly cited following APA guidelines.
- If AI language models are used in a project or assignment, this must be disclosed, with an explanation of how they were used.
- Text generated by AI tools may not always be accurate or suitable for your work. Students are responsible for verifying the accuracy of AI-generated content and will be evaluated accordingly.
- The use of AI tools is strictly prohibited in exams and quizzes.
- Instructors have the authority to check whether an assignment has been generated by AI tools.
- Instructors may establish grading policies for assignments involving AI tools, provided these are aligned with UoS guidelines.
- Students should seek guidance from their instructor or academic advisor if they have any doubts or concerns.

Guidelines for Faculty:

- AI language models, including ChatGPT, generate content based on training data, which may not always be accurate. Faculty should verify information before using it in teaching or research.
- Faculty are encouraged to discuss AI tools with students, highlighting their impact on education and the potential drawbacks of reliance on such tools.
- AI tools like ChatGPT can enhance productivity in teaching and research by assisting with various tasks, such as developing programs or summarizing research.
- Faculty should include AI generative tools in the academic integrity statements on course syllabi and clearly communicate whether and how these tools may be used in their courses.
- Written reports generated by AI tools have limited value unless students demonstrate a clear understanding of the content. Faculty are encouraged to assess student learning

outcomes effectively and minimize the weight of written assignments in final grades, favoring face-to-face assessments.

- Suspected academic misconduct involving AI-generated work should be reported to Department Chairs, following proper procedures for evidence collection.
- Using AI-generated content without proper attribution is considered academic misconduct.
- Faculty should follow UoS guidelines and academic integrity policies and seek guidance from colleagues or department chairs if needed.

Instruction for Course Syllabus:

"Artificial Intelligence (AI) language models, like ChatGPT, are trained on extensive datasets that allow them to generate responses to questions and prompts. While this technology is evolving, inaccuracies may occur. Students are responsible for the accuracy of all submitted work, including any content generated by AI tools. Work must be original, with proper attribution where AI tools have been used. Submitting work generated or assisted by AI without proper attribution constitutes a violation of Student Conduct and may result in penalties. If in doubt, consult with your course instructor regarding the acceptable use of AI tools."

Guidelines for Researchers:

- AI tools like ChatGPT should not replace critical thinking, original research, or creative exploration.
- Researchers must evaluate the quality and relevance of AI-generated content and apply their own judgment before incorporating it into their work.
- AI-generated content may not always be accurate; researchers are responsible for verifying facts before using such content.
- AI tools can be useful for generating ideas and insights, but should not be the sole source of information for research projects.
- Researchers should use AI tools alongside other academic resources, such as databases, textbooks, and scholarly articles.
- Researchers should follow UoS guidelines and academic integrity policies, and seek guidance from mentors or department chairs as needed.

Guidelines for Staff:

- AI tools can significantly enhance productivity by assisting with tasks like summarizing reports, drafting meeting minutes, and managing schedules.
- Staff must ensure that sensitive and confidential information is not disclosed to AI tools to protect data security.

Recommendations for Deans:



(These are intended as working recommendations rather than formal policy.)

- Task department or program curriculum committees with:
 - Discussing the implications of AI tools on curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs).
 - Identifying courses where AI tools could be effectively integrated.
 - Developing assessment methods that creatively deploy AI tools in classrooms.
 - Benchmarking the curriculum with AI-friendly and top 200 institutions.
 - Updating the curriculum, if necessary, to align with technological advancements and the needs of students and the job market.
 - Considering assessment types that encourage students to use AI tools in preparation for internships and employment.
- Deans should report findings for all programs offered by the College, including:
 - Identifying curriculum reforms resulting from these discussions.
 - Highlighting the strengths and weaknesses of the exercise.
 - Preparing necessary documentation for curriculum changes, if any.